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Coverage through 30 September 2026.

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Read. Connect. Practise.

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Notes develop understanding. **Practice** tests recall and application. **Answers and explanations** help you understand why an option is correct.

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Begin with **Jammu & Kashmir** and **Economy, Banking & Finance**. Then work through the remaining chapters. Attempt each question set before reading its answers.

Return to the topics behind your wrong answers, then revisit their comparison tables and **Remember** points. Keep a short list of facts you repeatedly confuse for your final revision.

Navigate this book

The overview contents links to **notes, practice and answers** for every chapter. The detailed contents lists each numbered topic; PDF bookmarks provide direct section and topic navigation.

Question numbers restart within each chapter. Tap a question number to reach its explanation, and tap the answer-table number to return to the question.

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Choose the subject, then go straight to its notes, practice or answer explanations.

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01 Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh

Regional governance, public finance, schemes and the places behind the news.

A. Who's Who - J&K and Ladakh

- **Earlier LGs of Ladakh, in order:** R.K. Mathur (2019-23) → Brig. (Dr) B.D. Mishra (2023-25) → Kavinder Gupta (2025-26) → **Vinai Kumar Saxena (2026-)**.

Post	Holder	Since / note	Essential distinction
Lieutenant Governor, J&K	**Manoj Sinha**	7 Aug 2020. 2nd LG of the UT (1st: G.C. Murmu)	LG controls police, public order, All-India Services and ACB under JKRA 2019
Chief Minister, J&K	**Omar Abdullah**	16 Oct 2024. First CM of the UT of J&K	Also holds **Finance**. Presented Budget 2026-27
Deputy CM	**Surinder Kumar Choudhary**	16 Oct 2024. MLA, Nowshera	Only Deputy CM
Speaker, Legislative Assembly	**Abdul Rahim Rather**	Nov 2024	-
Leader of Opposition	**Sunil Sharma**	Nov 2024	-
DGP, J&K	**Nalin Prabhat**	1 Oct 2024 (18th DGP)	Earlier DG, NSG
Chief Justice, HC of J&K and Ladakh	**Dr Justice Pushpendra Singh Bhati**	Appointed 5 Sep 2026. Oath 9 Sep 2026, SKUAST-K auditorium, Srinagar	Oath given by **LG Ladakh Vinai Kumar Saxena** (holding additional charge of J&K)
Lieutenant Governor, Ladakh	**Vinai Kumar Saxena**	Oath 13 Mar 2026. **4th LG of Ladakh**	Ex-LG Delhi. Predecessor **Kavinder Gupta** became **Governor of Himachal Pradesh**
BCCI President	**Mithun Manhas** (J&K)	28 Sep 2025. **37th** President, 94th AGM	Succeeded Roger Binny
Rajya Sabha (J&K, NC)	Chowdhary Mohammad Ramzan, Sajjad Ahmad Kichloo, Gurvinder Singh (Shammi) Oberoi	Elected 24 Oct 2025. Oath 1 Dec 2025	Ladakh has **no** Rajya Sabha seat

B. Governance, Polity and Elections

1.1 Assembly resolution for "immediate restoration of full statehood"

- **In focus:** On **28 Sep 2026** the J&K Legislative Assembly passed a resolution seeking the *"immediate and urgent restoration of full statehood"*. The resolution referred to the Assembly's **autonomy resolutions of 2000 and 2024**.
- **Facts:** The resolution is **non-binding**. Restoring statehood needs an **Act of Parliament** (Articles 3 and 4, and an amendment of the J&K Reorganisation Act, 2019).
- **Background:** The JKRA 2019 (appointed day **31 Oct 2019**) created two UTs: **J&K with a legislature** (Article 239A model, like Puducherry) and **Ladakh without a legislature**. On **11 Dec 2023** the Supreme Court (*In Re: Article 370*, 5-judge bench led by CJI D.Y. Chandrachud) upheld the abrogation. It directed elections by 30 Sep 2024 and statehood "at the earliest". The Assembly elections of Sep-Oct 2024 brought the NC-led government to power.

  Static link: Article 370 sat in Part XXI as a "temporary provision". Assembly: **90 elected seats** (Jammu 43, Kashmir 47; 9 ST, 7 SC after the 2022 delimitation by the Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai Commission), plus up to **5 nominated** by the LG (2 women, 2 Kashmiri migrants including 1 woman, 1 PoK-displaced person). 24 PoK seats stay vacant.

1.2 Darbar Move revived

- **In focus:** The bi-annual Darbar Move **resumed after four years**. The Civil Secretariat opened in **Jammu on 3 Nov 2025**; It reopened in **Srinagar on 4 May 2026** for the summer.

  Static link: J&K has two capitals. The Dogra dynasty began with Gulab Singh (Treaty of Amritsar, 1846).

1.3 Representation and local government

- **Facts:** J&K has **5 Lok Sabha and 4 Rajya Sabha seats**; Ladakh has **1 Lok Sabha seat and no Rajya Sabha seat**. Rajya Sabha elections from J&K resumed in October 2025.

  Static link: Elected MLAs choose Rajya Sabha members by proportional representation through the **single transferable vote**, under **Article 80(4)**.
- **Facts:** J&K's first District Development Council elections were held in **2020**: 20 districts, 14 seats each, or **280 seats**. The J&K Panchayati Raj Act dates to 1989.

  Static link: The J&K Reservation Act, 2004 and Rules, 2005 govern reservation. Pahari Ethnic Group, Paddari Tribe, Koli and Gadda Brahmin were added to the ST list in 2024; ST reservation rose to **20%**.
- The four Rajya Sabha seats had been vacant since 2021; the **October 2025 polls were the first from J&K after the 2019 reorganisation**. The important institutional distinction is between representation in the two Houses: both UTs return Lok Sabha members, but only J&K has Rajya Sabha representation. An absence of Rajya Sabha seats should not be confused with absence of representation in Parliament altogether.
- The ST reservation change splits the **20% total into two 10% components**: the existing Scheduled Tribes, including Gujjar-Bakarwal communities, and the newly included groups. This is separate from the **nine ST-reserved Assembly constituencies** created by the 2022 delimitation. Employment reservation and the reservation of constituencies concern different systems; their percentages and seat numbers should not be interchanged.

1.6 Reservation framework in J&K

- **Facts:** In 2024, the **Pahari Ethnic Group, Paddari Tribe, Koli and Gadda Brahmin** were added to J&K's ST list. ST reservation rose to **20%**: **10% for existing ST communities, including Gujjar-Bakarwal, and 10% for newly added communities**.

  Static link: The J&K Reservation Act, 2004 and Rules, 2005 govern reservation.

1.7 Panchayati Raj and District Development Councils

Static link: J&K's Panchayati Raj Act, 1989 (amended after 2019). The first **DDC elections were held in Nov-Dec 2020** (20 districts × 14 seats = 280).

1.8 Census 2027 - J&K and Ladakh go first

- **In focus:** For **Ladakh and the snow-bound, non-synchronous areas of J&K** (and of Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand), the reference date is **00:00 hours, 1 Oct 2026**. For the rest of India it is **1 Mar 2027**. Population enumeration in these snow-bound areas ran in **Sep 2026**.
- **Facts:** Two phases: **Houselisting (Apr-Sep 2026)**, then **Population Enumeration**. It is India's **first digital census**, with a self-enumeration option, and includes **caste enumeration for the first time since 1931**. It is the **16th census** overall and the **8th since Independence**. Notified in Jun 2025.

  Static link: Census Act, 1948. Registrar General and Census Commissioner, under the MHA. 2011 population: J&K (including Ladakh) 1.25 crore; Ladakh 2.74 lakh.

1.9 Ladakh: districts and safeguards

- **Facts:** Five districts notified in April 2026 increased Ladakh's total to **seven**. The existing districts were Leh and Kargil.
- **Facts:** The June 2025 regulations provide up to **85% reservation in government jobs, excluding EWS**, a 15-year residence requirement for domicile, and **one-third reservation for women in Hill Councils**.

  Static link: Ladakh's official languages are **English, Hindi, Urdu, Bhoti and Purgi**. LAHDC Leh was established in 1995 and LAHDC Kargil in 2003.
- **Remember:** The **Sixth Schedule**, under Articles 244(2) and 275(1), applies to Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram. It is distinct from Article 371 provisions and does not automatically apply to Ladakh.
- Three new districts-**Nubra, Sham and Changthang**-were carved from Leh; **Zanskar and Drass** were carved from Kargil. The headquarters table therefore provides two links for each new district: the administrative centre and the parent district. **Nyoma is the headquarters of Changthang**; Hanle is a separate Ladakh place associated with astronomy. This distinction links the district map with the Science and Technology chapter.
- The **85% employment-reservation provision excludes EWS** from that stated percentage. It should not be read as a promise that all jobs are reserved. The **one-third women's representation** concerns the Hill Councils, whose institutions predate Ladakh's UT formation. The **Sixth Schedule and Article 371 are different constitutional mechanisms**; neither is interchangeable with the Article 239 arrangement that identifies Ladakh as a UT without a legislature.
- **Vinai Kumar Saxena succeeded Kavinder Gupta** as Lieutenant Governor in March 2026. Gupta moved to **Himachal Pradesh as Governor**. The earlier Ladakh LGs were **R.K. Mathur and B.D.**

Mishra, followed by Gupta and Saxena. The relevant appointment comparison is Governor of a State versus Lieutenant Governor of a UT, rather than ceremony details or the venue of an oath.

1.9.1 Ladakh's five new districts

District	Headquarters	Carved from
Nubra	**Diskit**	Leh
Sham	**Khaltse**	Leh
Changthang	**Nyoma**	Leh
Zanskar	**Padum**	Kargil
Drass	**Drass**	Kargil

C. Economy and Finance (FAA PRIORITY)

1.10 J&K Budget 2026-27

- **Presented: 6 Feb 2026** by **CM Omar Abdullah** (Finance Minister). This is the second budget of the elected government; the first, on 7 Mar 2025, was the first by an elected government since 2018.
  - **RWBCIS** (Restructured Weather Based Crop Insurance) extended to **apple, saffron, mango and litchi**, with a sum insured of ₹6,595 crore.
  - **6 free LPG cylinders a year** for AAY families.
  - **Full fee waiver** for AAY students (Class IX-XII and degree colleges).
  - **1,000 Anganwadis upgraded to Bal Vidyalayas** (₹72,000 each).
  - **₹4,000 a month DBT** to 6,000 orphans.
  - **Free public transport for persons with disabilities.**

Item	2026-27 (BE)
Gross budget	**₹1,27,767 crore** (includes ₹14,000 crore ways-and-means/overdraft)
Net budget	**₹1,13,767 crore** (2025-26: ₹1,12,310 crore)
Revenue expenditure	₹80,640 crore
Capital expenditure	₹33,127 crore (capital outlay ₹25,236 crore)
Own revenue	₹31,800 crore. **SGST is the largest own tax (≈63%)**
Central assistance	₹42,752 crore + CSS ₹13,400 crore
GSDP projection	**₹3,15,822 crore** (+9.5%)
Fiscal deficit	**4.6% of GSDP** (≈₹14,685 crore)
Item	**2026-27 (BE)**
Revenue balance	**Revenue surplus ≈3%** of GSDP (≈₹9,378 crore)
Debt	≈48% of GSDP. Off-budget borrowings ₹23,133 crore

Item	2026-27 (BE)
SASCI (Special Assistance for Capital Investment)	₹3,000 crore

1.11 J&K Economic Survey 2025-26

Indicator	Value
Real GSDP growth	**5.82%**
Nominal GSDP growth	**8.89%**
GSDP size	**₹2.86 lakh crore** (nominal) · ₹1.50 lakh crore (real)
Per capita NSDP	**₹1,68,243** (national: ₹2,19,575)
Real GSDP CAGR (2019-20 to 2024-25)	4.47%
Per capita income CAGR	8.81%
Sector shares	**Tertiary 61.02%** · Primary 20.45% · Secondary 18.52%
Inflation	4.5% (2024) → **3.8% (2025)**
Share in national GDP	≈0.8%

1.12 J&K Bank

- **Established 1 Oct 1938**, under Maharaja Hari Singh; HQ Srinagar. The J&K Government is the majority shareholder.
  - In 2026 its total business **crossed ₹3 lakh crore**. FY 2024-25 net profit was a record **₹2,082 crore**.

1.13 J&K schemes - quick table

Scheme	Launched	What it does	Distinction / note
MUMKIN (Livelihood Generation Scheme)	2021, Mission Youth	Unemployed youth (**18-35 yrs**) buy **small commercial vehicles**. Subsidy: **₹80,000 or 10% of on-road price, whichever is lower**	**Asked in LA, May 2026**
Tejaswini	2021, Mission Youth	Financial help for **young women** entrepreneurs (18-35)	Don't confuse with MUMKIN
Mission YUVA (Yuva Udyami Vikas Abhiyan)	Approved Dec 2024, rolled out 2025	Targets **1.37 lakh enterprises and 4.25 lakh jobs in 5 years**	Entrepreneurship mission

Scheme	Launched	What it does	Distinction / note
HADP (Holistic Agriculture Development Programme)	2022, runs to 2026-27	**₹5,013 crore, 29 projects**. Designed by a committee under **Dr Mangala Rai** (ex-DG, ICAR)	Ends 2026-27
AB-PMJAY SEHAT	26 Dec 2020	**₹5 lakh health cover for all residents** of J&K	J&K was "Best Performing UT" at Aarogya Manthan 2026
Budget 2026-27 package	Feb 2026	RWBCIS for horticulture, 6 free LPG cylinders (AAY), fee waiver, Bal Vidyalayas, orphan DBT	See 1.10

D. Infrastructure and Connectivity

1.14 Zojila Tunnel - breakthrough

- **In focus: Breakthrough on 9 Jun 2026** at **Minamarg (Kargil)**, witnessed by Nitin Gadkari, LG Manoj Sinha and CM Omar Abdullah.
- **Facts:** Main tunnel about **13.15 km**; cost about **₹6,809.69 crore**; about 85% complete at breakthrough. Commissioning target: **Feb 2028**. It will give all-weather links between **Sonamarg (Ganderbal, J&K)** and **Drass/Kargil (Ladakh)** on **NH-1**, bypassing the avalanche-prone **Zoji La pass**.
- **Background:** The **Z-Morh (Sonamarg) Tunnel** (about 6.5 km, Gagangir-Sonamarg) was **inaugurated on 13 Jan 2025**. Z-Morh and Zojila together give year-round access to Ladakh.

  Static link: Zoji La connects the Kashmir Valley with the Drass valley, on the Srinagar-Leh highway. It was asked in FAA 2024.

1.15 Rail connectivity - USBRL, Chenab bridge and Vande Bharat

Item	Fact
USBRL (Udhampur-Srinagar-Baramulla Rail Link)	**272 km**, completed in 2025
Inauguration	**6 Jun 2025**: PM dedicated the **Chenab** and **Anji Khad** bridges and flagged off **Katra-Srinagar Vande Bharat**
Chenab Rail Bridge (Reasi)	**World's highest railway arch bridge**, **359 m** above the river bed, about 1,315 m long
Item	**Fact**
Anji Khad Bridge (Reasi)	**India's first cable-stayed railway bridge** (Anji is a tributary of the Chenab)

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Item	Fact
Direct Jammu Tawi-Srinagar Vande Bharat	Flagged off **30 Apr 2026** by Railway Minister **Ashwini Vaishnaw**. Regular runs from 2 May 2026 (26401/26402), with a longer rake than the 8-coach Katra train
Longest tunnel on USBRL	**T-50 (≈12.77 km)**, Khari-Sumber. Pir Panjal tunnel (11.2 km, Banihal-Qazigund) opened in 2013

1.16 Chenab hydropower and the Indus Waters Treaty

- **In focus:** India placed the **Indus Waters Treaty in abeyance on 23 April 2025**. The projects below connect energy current affairs with river geography.

  Static link: The treaty was signed at **Karachi in 1960** by Jawaharlal Nehru and Ayub Khan, with World Bank involvement.

  - **Eastern rivers:** Ravi, Beas and Sutlej - allocated to India.
  - **Western rivers:** Indus, Jhelum and Chenab - allocated to Pakistan, with limited permitted Indian uses.

- **Remember: Pakal Dul is on the Marusudar**, a Chenab tributary. **Sawalkote lies between Baglihar upstream and Salal downstream**, in Ramban/Udhampur.
- The treaty's allocations distinguish **three eastern rivers from three western rivers**, rather than placing every Indus-system river in one category. The treaty permits limited Indian uses on western rivers, including run-of-river hydropower. Consequently, a hydropower project in India on the Chenab is not evidence that the Chenab was classified as an eastern river. The April 2025 abeyance decision is a current event; the river classification is the static connection.
- The regional tributary links are **Marusudar, Niru and Tawi with the Chenab**, while **Ujh joins the Ravi**. Tawi joins the Chenab in Pakistan. Pakal Dul is the **first storage-type hydropower project in J&K** and lies on the Marusudar; Kiru, Kwar and Ratle are on the Chenab main stem in Kishtwar. Sawalkote's Ramban/Udhampur location distinguishes it from the Kishtwar group.

1.16.1 Hydropower: project, capacity, river

Project	Capacity	River / district
Pakal Dul	**1,000 MW**	Marusudar; Kishtwar
Kiru	**624 MW**	Chenab; Kishtwar
Kwar	**540 MW**	Chenab; Kishtwar
Ratle	**850 MW**	Chenab; Kishtwar
Sawalkote	**1,856 MW**	Chenab; Ramban/Udhampur

E. Culture, Literature and Awards

1.17 Padma Awards 2026 - J&K and Ladakh

- **Context:** Padma Awards 2026 were announced on 25 Jan 2026 (131 awards in all). See Chapter 8 for the national list.

Awardee	UT	Field	Note
Brij Lal Bhat	J&K	**Social Work**	Veteran horticulture expert. Received the award on 23 Jun 2026
Prof. Shafi Shauq	J&K	**Literature & Education**	Kashmiri writer and scholar. Received on 25 May 2026
Dr Padma Gurmet	Ladakh	**Medicine**	Sowa-Rigpa (Amchi) practitioner. Received on 23 Jun 2026

1.18 Sahitya Akademi Awards 2025 - J&K winners

- **Announced 16 Mar 2026** in 24 languages and presented on 31 Mar 2026. Each award is ₹1 lakh, a copper plaque and a shawl.

  Static link: **Dogri** (with Maithili, Bodo and Santali) was added to the **Eighth Schedule by the 92nd Amendment (2003)**. **Kashmiri** has been in the Eighth Schedule from the start. The **J&K Official Languages Act, 2020** lists Kashmiri, Dogri, Urdu, Hindi and English.

Language	Book (genre)	Author
Dogri	*Thakur Satsayie* (poetry, couplets)	**Khajur Singh Thakur**
Kashmiri	*Najdavanek'y Pot Aalav* (poetry)	**Ali Shaida**
Urdu	*Safar Jaari Hai* (poetry)	**Pritpal Singh Betab** (J&K)
English (national)	*Crimson Spring* (novel)	Navtej Sarna
Hindi (national)	*Jeete Jee Allahabad* (memoir)	Mamta Kalia

1.19 GI tags - J&K and Ladakh

Static link: GI of Goods (Registration and Protection) Act, 1999, in force 2003. GI Registry in **Chennai**, under DPIIT. A tag is valid **10 years** and renewable. India's first GI was **Darjeeling Tea (2004)**.

Category	J&K registered GI (selected)	Ladakh registered GI
Agriculture / food	Kashmir Saffron, Mushqbudji rice, Basmati (shared), Bhaderwah Rajmash, Ramban Anardana, Ramban Sulai honey, Udhampur Kaladi	Ladakh Seabuckthorn, Raktsey Karpo apricot
Textiles	Pashmina, Sozani craft, Kani shawl, Kashmir hand-knotted carpet, Basohli Pashmina	Pashmina wool, Pashmina textiles, Nambu, Thigma (tie-dye)
Crafts	Papier-mâché, Walnut wood carving, Khatamband, Basohli painting, Kashmir willow bat, Chikri wood craft (Rajouri)	Shingskos (wood carving), Chilling metal work, Likir pottery, Thangka, Pabu (footwear), Challi (woollen)

1.21 Pilgrimage and tourism

- **Shri Amarnath Ji Yatra 2026: 3 Jul - 28 Aug 2026** (57 days, ending on Raksha Bandhan), with about **4.8 lakh yatris** (Rising Kashmir). The yatra was briefly suspended from 9 Aug for track repairs by BRO after rains. Routes: **Pahalgam-Chandanwari (Anantnag)** and **Baltal (Ganderbal)**. The **Shri Amarnath Ji Shrine Board** is chaired by the **LG**. The yatra ends with the **Chhari Mubarak** rites; visarjan is in the **Lidder**.

F. Environment and Wildlife

1.22 Hangul (Kashmir stag) census

- **Facts:** Hangul (*Cervus hanglu hanglu*) is the **state animal of J&K**. It is now largely confined to **Dachigam National Park**, Srinagar, in the **Zabarwan range**, with small pockets in south Kashmir. A conservation breeding centre is at **Shikargah, Tral**. It is in **Schedule I** of the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972, and is reported as Critically Endangered (IUCN, subspecies level).

1.23 Wetlands and Ramsar sites - J&K and Ladakh

Static link: **Wular is India's largest freshwater lake**; the **Jhelum** flows through it. The Tulbul Navigation Project at its mouth was paused under the IWT and is again in discussion. The India-wide Ramsar count is in Chapter 6.

UT	Ramsar sites (year designated)
J&K (5)	**Wular** (1990) · **Hokersar** (2005) · **Surinsar-Mansar** (2005) · **Hygam** (2022) · **Shallabugh** (2022)
Ladakh (2)	**Tso Moriri** (2002) · **Tso Kar** (2020)

G. Sports

1.24 J&K wins its first Ranji Trophy (2025-26)

- **Final: 24-28 Feb 2026** at the **KSCA Rajnagar Stadium, Hubballi**. **J&K beat Karnataka on first-innings lead** (584 and 342/4 declared). **Captain: Paras Dogra.**
- **Run-up:** Outright wins over former champions **Delhi, Hyderabad, Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh** and **Bengal**. Earlier best: quarter-finals (2013-14, 2019-20, 2024-25).

1.25 Khelo India Winter Games 2026 (6th edition)

- **Ice-sports leg: Leh, 20-26 Jan 2026** (NDS Stadium, Gupuk Pond). **Snow-sports leg: Gulmarg, 23-26 Feb 2026**.
  - **Overall champion: Indian Army**, with **23 medals (9 gold, 6 silver, 8 bronze)**. The Army defended its title.

Static link: KIWG began in **Gulmarg in 2020**. Khelo India is a Central Sector Scheme of the Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports.

1.26 Mithun Manhas - BCCI President

- Elected **unopposed** as the **37th BCCI President** at the **94th AGM** on **28 Sep 2025**. He succeeded **Roger Binny** (2022-25). A Jammu-born former first-class cricketer, he played for Delhi and J&K.

H. Health and Social

1.30 J&K: "Best Performing UT" at Aarogya Manthan 2026

- J&K was recognised as the **Best Performing UT** at **Aarogya Manthan 2026** (Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi, Sep 2026), which marked **8 years of AB-PMJAY** (launched 23 Sep 2018, Ranchi). In J&K the scheme runs as **AB-PMJAY SEHAT**, covering every resident.

I. Regional map reference

1.31 J&K and Ladakh: places behind the news

Place	District / area	Why in news	Static hook
Zehanpora	Baramulla	Kushan-era Buddhist stupas; *Mann Ki Baat* 28 Dec 2025	Kanishka; Fourth Buddhist Council
Mudh-Nyoma	Leh / Changthang	Air base operational 12 Nov 2025	DBO = highest airstrip
Dulhasti	Kishtwar	Stage-II (260 MW) cleared	Stage-I: 390 MW (2007)
Sawalkote	Ramban / Udhampur	1,856 MW fresh clearance	Between Baglihar and Salal

Place	District / area	Why in news	Static hook
Wular / Tulbul	Bandipora / Sopore	TNP revival talk	Largest freshwater lake; Ramsar 1990
Tawi	Jammu	Record flood, Aug 2025	"Surya Putri"; joins Chenab in Pakistan
Chashoti	Kishtwar (Paddar)	Cloudburst, 14 Aug 2025	Machail Mata yatra
Chatroo	Kishtwar	Cloudburst, 1 Aug 2026; counter-terror ops	Kishtwar-Sinthan road (NH-244)
Ardhkuwari	Reasi	Landslide, 26 Aug 2025	Trikuta hills, Vaishno Devi
Zabarwan hills	Srinagar	Forest fires, Feb 2026	Dachigam, Mughal gardens
Siraj Bagh	Srinagar	Tulip Garden opened 16 Mar 2026	Asia's largest tulip garden
Dal Lake	Srinagar	In-situ rehabilitation model	Telbal Nallah; not a Ramsar site
Amira Kadal	Srinagar	Redeveloped heritage bridge-market	First of seven historic bridges (1774)
Drung	Baramulla (Tangmarg)	Frozen waterfall opened to tourists	Chillai Kalan
Minamarg	Kargil	Zojila tunnel breakthrough, 9 Jun 2026	NH-1
Shinku La	Lahaul-Zanskar	Tunnel about half built	All-weather connection to Ladakh
Hanle	Leh / Changthang	Observatory; Dark Sky Reserve	India's first Dark Sky Reserve (2022)

02 National Affairs and Polity

Key laws, institutions and constitutional developments.

A. National Who's Who

Office	Holder	Since / exam note
President	**Droupadi Murmu** (15th)	25 Jul 2022. First tribal woman President
Vice-President (ex officio Chairman, Rajya Sabha)	**C.P. Radhakrishnan** (15th VP)	Sworn in 12 Sep 2025, after Jagdeep Dhankhar resigned (21 Jul 2025)
Prime Minister	**Narendra Modi**	Third consecutive term from 9 Jun 2024
Speaker, Lok Sabha	**Om Birla**	Second term from 26 Jun 2024. A resolution to remove him was **negatived by voice vote on 11 Mar 2026**
Chief Justice of India	**Justice Surya Kant** (53rd)	24 Nov 2025. Due to retire 9 Feb 2027
Chief Election Commissioner	**Gyanesh Kumar** (26th)	19 Feb 2025. First CEC appointed under the 2023 Act
Union Home Minister	**Amit Shah**	Also Minister of Cooperation
Union Law Minister	**Arjun Ram Meghwal** (MoS, Independent Charge)	Introduced the 129th and 131st Amendment Bills
Leaders of Opposition	**Rahul Gandhi** (LS) · **Mallikarjun Kharge** (RS)	-
CAG	**K. Sanjay Murthy** (15th)	Nov 2024
National Security Adviser	**Ajit Doval**	-

B. Elections and Electoral Reforms

2.1 Assembly elections 2026: results and new Chief Ministers

- **In focus:** Four States and one UT voted in spring 2026 and results came out in early May 2026. Three of the five chose a new party.
- **Party names:** TVK = **Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam**. AINRC = All India N.R. Congress. UDF is Congress-led and LDF is CPI(M)-led.

Static link: The **Governor** appoints the CM (**Art 164**). In Puducherry, the **LG** does so under **Art 239A** and the Government of Union Territories Act, 1963. An Assembly's term is 5 years (**Art 172**). The ECI conducts elections under **Art 324**.

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State / UT	Chief Minister
West Bengal	**Suvendu Adhikari** (9 May 2026)
Tamil Nadu	**C. Joseph Vijay** (10 May 2026)
Kerala	**V.D. Satheesan** (18 May 2026)
Assam	**Himanta Biswa Sarma** (second term, May 2026)
Puducherry (30 elected)	**N. Rangasamy** (13 May 2026, fifth time)

2.2 Bihar 2025 and Delhi 2025 (carry-forward)

- **Bihar (243 seats):** The **NDA won 202** (BJP 89, JD(U) 85, LJP (Ram Vilas) 19, HAM(S) 5, RLM 4). **Nitish Kumar** took oath as CM for a **record 10th time** on **20 Nov 2025** at Gandhi Maidan, Patna. Bihar was the **first State where the SIR was carried out** (Jun-Sep 2025).
- **Delhi (70 seats):** The **BJP won 48**, ending 10 years of AAP rule. **Rekha Gupta** became CM on **20 Feb 2025**: Delhi's **fourth woman CM**, after Sushma Swaraj, Sheila Dikshit and Atishi.

  Static link: Delhi's Assembly and the special status of the NCT are set out in **Art 239AA** (69th Amendment, 1991).

2.3 Vice-Presidential election 2025

- **Result (9 Sep 2025): C.P. Radhakrishnan** (NDA; then Governor of Maharashtra) got **452** votes. **B. Sudershan Reddy** (INDIA bloc; a retired Supreme Court judge) got **300**. President Murmu administered the oath on **12 Sep 2025**.
- **About him:** He is from Tamil Nadu, a former Coimbatore MP, and was earlier Governor of Jharkhand and of Maharashtra.

  Static link: The electoral college is made up of **all members of both Houses of Parliament, elected and nominated** (**Art 66**). State legislators **do not** vote, unlike in the presidential election. Voting is by proportional representation with a single transferable vote and secret ballot. Disputes go to the **Supreme Court** (**Art 71**). The VP must be at least **35** and qualified for election to the Rajya Sabha.

2.4 Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls

- **In focus:** The ECI's first door-to-door **intensive** revision of electoral rolls in about 20 years.
- **Phase 1, Bihar:** Ordered on 24 Jun 2025. The final roll was published on **30 Sep 2025** with about **7.42 crore** electors.
- **Phase 2:** Announced on 27 Oct 2025 for **12 States and UTs**, with enumeration from 4 Nov 2025. They included the poll-bound West Bengal, Tamil Nadu, Kerala and Puducherry, as well as UP, MP, Rajasthan, Gujarat, Chhattisgarh, Goa, Andaman & Nicobar and Lakshadweep. **Assam** had a separate "Special Revision".
- **Scale:** About **13.3 crore names** had been deleted from draft rolls nationwide, over **71%** of them marked "absent, shifted or others" (EC data reported by The Hindu).
- **Supreme Court:** It let the exercise continue and directed that **Aadhaar be accepted as the 12th document** (Sep 2025), as proof of identity, **not citizenship**.

Static link: **Art 324** (ECI's superintendence of rolls) · **Art 326** (adult suffrage; voting age cut from 21 to 18 by the **61st Amendment, 1988**) · **RP Act, 1950, Sec 21(3)** (special revision). Since the Election Laws (Amendment) Act, 2021, there are **four qualifying dates: 1 Jan, 1 Apr, 1 Jul and 1 Oct**.

2.5 One Nation, One Election (ONOE)

- **Bills:** The **Constitution (129th Amendment) Bill, 2024** and the **Union Territories Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2024** were introduced in the Lok Sabha on **17 Dec 2024**.
- **Content:** A new **Art 82A** (simultaneous elections), with amendments to **Arts 83, 172 and 327**. Local bodies are **not** covered.
- **Origin:** The **Ram Nath Kovind High-Level Committee** (report Mar 2024).
- **How it would work:** The President notifies an "appointed date" at the first sitting of a new Lok Sabha. Assemblies elected after that date end with that Lok Sabha's term. If the date is notified in 2029, the first fully synchronised elections would be in **2034**.

2.6 Delimitation and women's reservation: the 131st Amendment Bill (Apr 2026)

- **In focus:** On **16 Apr 2026**, Law Minister **Arjun Ram Meghwal** introduced the **Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill, 2026** and the **Delimitation Bill, 2026**. Home Minister Amit Shah introduced the **UT Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026**.
- **Key proposals:** Raise the **maximum Lok Sabha strength to 850** (Art 81 now caps it at **550**: 530 from States and 20 from UTs; the House currently has 543 seats). Link this to implementing women's reservation.
- **Southern States:** Shah said they would gain **66 seats** (from **129** to **195**).
- **Women's reservation:** The **106th Amendment Act, 2023** (Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam) reserves **one-third of seats** in the Lok Sabha, State Assemblies and the Delhi Assembly. Its commencement was **notified on 16 Apr 2026**. Under **Art 334A**, the reservation itself starts only **after delimitation based on the first census after commencement**, and it lasts **15 years**. It does **not** apply to the Rajya Sabha or Legislative Councils.

Static anchor	What it did
Art 82	Seats readjusted after every census
42nd Amendment (1976)	Froze seats on the **1971 census** until 2001
84th Amendment (2001)	Extended the freeze until the **first census after 2026**
87th Amendment (2003)	Constituency boundaries redrawn on the **2001 census**; seat numbers unchanged
Delimitation Commissions	1952, 1963, 1973, 2002 (Justice Kuldip Singh)
J&K (2022)	Justice **Ranjana Prakash Desai** Commission: **90** seats (43 Jammu, 47 Kashmir), 9 ST seats (Chapter 1)

2.7 Constitution (130th Amendment) Bill 2025: removal after 30 days in custody

- **In focus:** Amit Shah introduced it in the Lok Sabha on **20 Aug 2025**, together with the **J&K Reorganisation (Amendment) Bill, 2025** and the **Government of Union Territories (Amendment) Bill, 2025**.

- **What it says:** A **PM, CM or Minister** (Union, State, Delhi, Puducherry, **J&K**) who is **arrested and held in custody for 30 consecutive days** for an offence punishable with **5 years or more** must be removed or will cease to hold office **on the 31st day**. They can be reappointed after release.
- **Articles amended: 75** (Union), **164** (States) and **239AA** (Delhi). For J&K, the JKRA 2019 is amended, because J&K is now a UT with a legislature.

Static link: Disqualification follows only **conviction** (RP Act 1951, **Sec 8**: 2 years or more; *Lily Thomas*, 2013). There is no constitutional rule requiring resignation on arrest.

2.8 Resolution to remove Speaker Om Birla (Mar 2026)

- **In focus:** Opposition MPs gave notice during the **Budget Session 2026**. The Lok Sabha **negatived it by voice vote on 11 Mar 2026**. Amit Shah said it was the first such motion against a Speaker in **nearly four decades**.

Static link: **Art 94(c):** The Speaker can be removed by a resolution passed by a **majority of all the then members** of the House (an **effective majority**), after **14 days' notice**. **Art 96:** While the resolution is being considered, the Speaker **cannot preside** but can speak and **vote in the first instance** (not a casting vote).

- **Precedents:** Motions against **G.V. Mavalankar (1954)**, **Hukam Singh (1966)** and **Balram Jakhar (1987)** all failed.

C. Parliament and New Laws

2.9 Laws board 2025-26 (Acts to know)

Law	What it does	Date / status	Exam hook
VB-G RAM G Act, 2025	Replaces **MGNREGA 2005**. Guarantees **125 days** of wage work to every rural household	Passed by both Houses **18 Dec 2025**; assent Dec 2025	Full form; 100 → 125 days
SHANTI Act, 2025	Opens nuclear power to **private companies**. Replaces the **Atomic Energy Act 1962** and the **CLND Act 2010**	Winter Session 2025	**LA PYQ (May 2026)**
Sabka Bima Sabki Raksha (Amendment of Insurance Laws) Act, 2025	Allows **100% FDI in insurance**	Winter Session 2025	See Chapter 3
Promotion and Regulation of Online Gaming Act, 2025	**Bans online money games**, their ads and payments. Promotes e-sports and social games. Sets up an Online Gaming Authority	Aug 2025	"Bans" vs "regulates"

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Law	What it does	Date / status	Exam hook
Immigration and Foreigners Act, 2025	Consolidates 4 laws: **Passport (Entry into India) Act 1920**, **Registration of Foreigners Act 1939**, **Foreigners Act 1946**, **Immigration (Carriers' Liability) Act 2000**	In force **1 Sep 2025**	Does **not** repeal the Citizenship Act 1955
Waqf (Amendment) Act, 2025	Renames the 1995 Act as **UMEED** (Unified Waqf Management, Empowerment, Efficiency and Development)	Assent 5 Apr 2025. SC interim order 15 Sep 2025	See 2.13
National Sports Governance Act, 2025	Sets up a National Sports Board and governance rules for sports federations	Aug 2025	National Sports Board; sports-federation governance
Income-tax Act, 2025	Replaces the IT Act 1961. Brings in the "tax year" concept	In force **1 Apr 2026**	See Chapter 3
Maritime package, 2025	**Bills of Lading Act** (replaces the 1856 Act) · **Carriage of Goods by Sea Act** (1925) · **Coastal Shipping Act** · **Merchant Shipping Act** (1958) · **Indian Ports Act** (1908)	2025	Colonial-law replacement theme
Four Labour Codes	Wages (2019), Industrial Relations, Social Security, OSH & Working Conditions (2020). They subsume **29** laws	In force **21 Nov 2025**	Number of laws subsumed
DPDP Rules, 2025	Operationalise the Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023. Sets up the Data Protection Board. Phased compliance	Notified **Nov 2025**	Act = 2023, Rules = 2025
Jan Vishwas (Amendment of Provisions) Act, 2026	"Jan Vishwas 2.0": decriminalises minor offences	LS 1 Apr / RS 2 Apr 2026	Jan Vishwas 1.0 (2023): 183 provisions in 42 Acts
AP Reorganisation (Amendment) Act, 2026	Recognises **Amaravati as the sole and permanent capital** of Andhra Pradesh	LS 1 Apr / RS 2 Apr 2026	Amends the 2014 Act

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Law	What it does	Date / status	Exam hook
Kerala (Alteration of Name) Act, 2026	Kerala → **Keralam**	LS 11 Aug / RS 12 Aug; in force **25 Aug 2026**	See 2.18

2.10 VB-G RAM G Act 2025: MGNREGA replaced

- **Full form: Viksit Bharat - Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin)**.
- **Timeline:** Introduced in the Lok Sabha on **16 Dec 2025**, passed by both Houses on **18 Dec 2025**, and received assent in Dec 2025.
- **Background:** NREGA was passed in **2005**, launched on **2 Feb 2006** (Bandlapalli, Anantapur, AP), extended to all districts in 2008, and renamed "Mahatma Gandhi NREGA" on **2 Oct 2009**.

  Static link: **Art 41** (DPSP: the right to work), **Art 21** (livelihood, through interpretation).

2.11 SHANTI Act 2025: nuclear sector opened up

- **Full form: Sustainable Harnessing and Advancement of Nuclear Energy for Transforming India**.
- **Facts:** Allows **private-sector** participation in nuclear power generation, under licence. Replaces the Atomic Energy Act 1962 and the Civil Liability for Nuclear Damage Act 2010. Linked to the **100 GW nuclear by 2047** goal and the Nuclear Energy Mission for **SMRs** (Budget 2025-26).

  Static link: India's three-stage nuclear programme (Homi Bhabha). The **PFBR, Kalpakkam** reached first criticality on 6 Apr 2026, the start of stage two (Chapter 5).

2.12 Online gaming and immigration laws

- **Online Gaming Act 2025:** Online **money games** (stakes for monetary gain, whether based on skill or chance) are **banned**, along with their **ads** and **payments**. **E-sports** gets recognition and promotion under the Sports Ministry. Penalty: up to **3 years and/or ₹1 crore** for offering money games.
- **Immigration and Foreigners Act 2025:** A single law for passports, visas, registration and carriers' liability. It requires mandatory reporting of foreigners by hotels, universities and hospitals. In force **1 Sep 2025**.

2.13 Waqf (Amendment) Act 2025 and the Supreme Court's interim order

- **Passage:** LS 3 Apr 2025, RS 4 Apr 2025, assent **5 Apr 2025**. The **UMEED** portal for registering waqf properties was launched in Jun 2025.
- **SC interim order (15 Sep 2025; bench of CJI B.R. Gavai and Justice A.G. Masih):** The Court **refused to stay the whole Act**. It **stayed** the clause requiring a person to have **practised Islam for 5 years** before creating a waqf (until rules are framed) and the **Collector's** power to decide disputes over government land. It capped non-Muslim members at **4 (of 22) in the Central Waqf Council** and **3 (of 11) in State Waqf Boards**.

  Static link: **Arts 25-26** (freedom of religion; managing religious affairs). Waqf falls under "charitable and religious endowments", **Concurrent List, Entry 28**.

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D. Constitution and Judiciary

2.15 Presidential Reference on Governors' assent (opinion, 20 Nov 2025)

- **In focus:** After the *State of Tamil Nadu v. Governor of TN* judgment (**8 Apr 2025**), in which a two-judge bench set **timelines** and declared "**deemed assent**" for 10 Bills, President Murmu referred **14 questions** to the Supreme Court under **Art 143(1)** in **May 2025**.
- **Bench:** Five judges: CJI **B.R. Gavai**, Justices **Surya Kant, Vikram Nath, P.S. Narasimha** and **A.S. Chandurkar**. The opinion was unanimous (Special Reference No. 1 of 2025).
  - 1. Under **Art 200**, the Governor has **three options**: give assent; **reserve** the Bill for the President; or **withhold assent and return it** to the legislature with comments. The Governor **cannot sit on a Bill indefinitely** (no "pocket veto").
  - 2. **No court-imposed timelines** for the Governor (Art 200) or the President (Art 201), and **no "deemed assent"**. **Art 142** cannot be used to assume assent.
  - 3. Courts cannot review the merits of the decision. But "**prolonged, unexplained and indefinite inaction**" can attract **limited judicial scrutiny**: a court may direct a decision without saying what it should be.
  - 4. A Bill is **not justiciable before it becomes law**.

Static link: **Art 143**: the advisory opinion is **not binding**, and the SC **may** decline to answer (as in the 1993 Ayodhya reference). **Art 145(3):** at least 5 judges. Earlier references: *Kerala Education Bill* (1958), *Berubari* (1960), *Special Courts Bill* (1978), *Third Judges* (1998), *2G* (2012).

2.16 Chief Justices of India, 2025-27

Static link: **Art 124(2):** The President appoints judges, and they serve until the age of **65**. By convention under the Memorandum of Procedure, the **senior-most judge** becomes CJI. The oath is administered by the **President** (Art 124(6), Third Schedule).

CJI	No.	Tenure	Note
Sanjiv Khanna	51st	11 Nov 2024 - 13 May 2025	-
B.R. Gavai	**52nd**	14 May - 23 Nov 2025	**First Buddhist CJI** and second Dalit CJI (after K.G. Balakrishnan). Headed the Presidential Reference bench
Surya Kant	**53rd**	**24 Nov 2025 - 9 Feb 2027**	**First CJI from Haryana** (Hisar). Was on the Art 370 (2023) bench

E. Federal Affairs and Governance

2.18 Kerala becomes "Keralam" (in force 25 Aug 2026)

- **In focus:** The **Kerala (Alteration of Name) Act, 2026** changes the State's name in the **First Schedule** from Kerala to **Keralam**.

- **Timeline:** Passed by the Lok Sabha on **11 Aug 2026** and the Rajya Sabha on **12 Aug 2026**. President Murmu gave assent in Aug 2026. The MHA notified **25 Aug 2026** as the commencement date. This followed unanimous resolutions of the Kerala Assembly (2023 and 2024).

  Static link: **Art 3(e):** Parliament may by law **alter the name of any State**. The Bill needs the **President's recommendation**, and the President refers it to the State legislature for its **views**, which are **not binding**. **Art 4:** Such a law is **not** an amendment under Art 368, so it needs only a **simple majority**.
- **Earlier renamings:** Madras → **Tamil Nadu** (1969) · Mysore → **Karnataka** (1973) · Laccadive, Minicoy and Amindivi Islands → **Lakshadweep** (1973) · Pondicherry → **Puducherry** (2006) · Uttaranchal → **Uttarakhand** (2007) · Orissa → **Odisha** (2011).

2.19 Colonial-era names replaced: Lok Bhavan, Lok Niwas, Seva Teerth

Old	New	Who uses it / when
Raj Bhavan	**Lok Bhavan**	Governors' residences (MHA order, late 2025)
Raj Niwas	**Lok Niwas**	Lieutenant Governors' residences. The Puducherry CM took oath at Lok Niwas (May 2026)
PMO in South Block	**Seva Teerth**	New complex housing the **PMO, NSC Secretariat and Cabinet Secretariat**. PM inaugurated it on **13 Feb 2026**, together with **Kartavya Bhavan-1 and 2**
Scattered ministry offices	**Kartavya Bhavan**	Common Central Secretariat. Kartavya Bhavan-3 was the first, opened on **6 Aug 2025**
Rajpath	Kartavya Path	Sep 2022
Mughal Gardens	Amrit Udyan	Jan 2023
Durbar Hall / Ashok Hall (Rashtrapati Bhavan)	Ganatantra Mandap / Ashok Mandap	Jul 2024
Port Blair	Sri Vijaya Puram	Sep 2024

2.20 Manipur: President's Rule imposed and revoked

- **Timeline:** CM **N. Biren Singh resigned on 9 Feb 2025**. **President's Rule** was imposed on **13 Feb 2025**, with the Assembly kept in **suspended animation**. Parliament extended it in Aug 2025. It was **revoked on 4 Feb 2026**, when **Yumnam Khemchand Singh** took oath as CM.
- **Deputy CMs: Nemcha Kipgen** (BJP, from the Kuki community) and **Losii Dikho** (NPF, from the Naga community).
- **Background:** Ethnic conflict between the Meitei and Kuki-Zo communities since **3 May 2023**.

  Static link: **Art 356:** Both Houses must approve the proclamation within **2 months**. Each approval lasts **6 months**, up to a **maximum of 3 years**. Going **beyond 1 year** requires a **National Emergency** in operation **and** an **ECI certificate** (**Art 356(5)**, 44th Amendment). ***S.R. Bommai* (1994):** the floor test, and judicial review of proclamations.

2.21 Amaravati: the "sole and permanent" capital

- **In focus:** The **AP Reorganisation (Amendment) Act, 2026** (LS 1 Apr, RS 2 Apr 2026) recognises **Amaravati** as the **sole and permanent capital** of Andhra Pradesh.
- **Background:** Under the AP Reorganisation Act 2014, Hyderabad was the common capital for up to **10 years** (ended **2 Jun 2024**). The YSRCP government's **three-capitals** plan (2020: Visakhapatnam, Amaravati, Kurnool) was dropped, and the TDP government (2024) revived Amaravati.

  Static link: **Telangana** was formed on **2 Jun 2014**. Parliament's power to reorganise States comes from Arts 3-4.

2.22 Census 2027: the national picture

- **Facts:** India's **16th Census** and the **8th since Independence**. It is the **first digital census** (mobile app plus self-enumeration on a portal) and the **first with caste enumeration since 1931** (CCPA decision, **30 Apr 2025**). The Cabinet approved ₹**11,718.24 crore** on **12 Dec 2025**.
- **Phase 1, Houselisting and Housing Census:** Apr-Sep 2026. Each State gets a **30-day** window, preceded by **15 days of self-enumeration**. Helpline: **1855**.
- **Phase 2, Population Enumeration:** Feb 2027. The reference date is **00:00 hrs on 1 Mar 2027**.
  - **Snow-bound areas** (Ladakh, J&K, Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand): The Census reference date is **00:00 hours on 1 October 2026**. See topic **1.8**.

  Static link: The **Census Act, 1948** and Census Rules, 1990. Census is in the **Union List** (Entry 69). The first census (not synchronous) was in **1872** under **Lord Mayo**; the first synchronous one was in **1881** under **Lord Ripon**. **2011** was the 15th. The 2021 census was postponed because of COVID-19.
- **Linkages:** It ends the delimitation freeze (2.6) and triggers women's reservation (Art 334A).

F. Social Sector and Commemorations

2.25 Fully literate States and UTs under ULLAS

- **Scheme: ULLAS (Nav Bharat Saaksharta Karyakram)**, 2022-27, for adults aged 15 and over. "Fully literate" means about **95%** literacy.

  Static link: **Art 21A** (free and compulsory education for ages 6-14; 86th Amendment, 2002). Census 2011 literacy was **74.04%**: Kerala highest (93.91%), Bihar lowest (61.80%).

Order	State / UT	Declared
First UT	**Ladakh**	24 Jun 2024
First State	**Mizoram**	20 May 2025
-	**Goa**	30 May 2025
-	**Tripura**	Jun 2025
5th State/UT	**Himachal Pradesh**	**8 Sep 2025** (International Literacy Day)

2.26 Kerala: first State free of extreme poverty (1 Nov 2025)

- **Facts:** CM Pinarayi Vijayan declared it on **Kerala Piravi Day (1 Nov 2025)** at a special Assembly session. It was the outcome of the **Extreme Poverty Eradication Project** (2021).

  Static link: In NITI Aayog's National MPI (2023), Kerala had the lowest share of multidimensionally poor people (**0.55%**).

2.27 Commemorations 2025-26 and Republic Day 2026

- **Republic Day 2026 (77th):** The chief guests were **António Costa** (President, European Council) and **Ursula von der Leyen** (President, European Commission), the first time EU leaders were joint chief guests. The **India-EU FTA was concluded on 27 Jan 2026** at the summit that followed. Republic Day 2025's chief guest was **Prabowo Subianto** (Indonesia).
- **Memory hook, the "1875 trio":** Vande Mataram composed, Patel born, Birsa born. All three turned 150 in 2025.

Commemoration	Person / work	Key date	Static hook
150 years of Vande Mataram	**Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay** (composed 1875; in *Anandamath*, 1882)	Year-long celebration from **7 Nov 2025**. Special Lok Sabha debate on 8 Dec 2025. Theme of **Republic Day 2026**	Adopted as the **National Song** on **24 Jan 1950**. First sung by **Tagore** at the INC session of **1896** (Calcutta)
150th birth anniversary of Sardar Patel	Born **31 Oct 1875**, Nadiad	Rashtriya Ekta Diwas, 31 Oct 2025, at **Ekta Nagar**	Statue of Unity (182 m, 2018)
150th birth anniversary of Birsa Munda	Born **15 Nov 1875**, Ulihatu	Janjatiya Gaurav Varsh ended on 15 Nov 2025	*Ulgulan* (1899-1900)
350th martyrdom of Guru Tegh Bahadur	9th Sikh Guru, martyred in Delhi in **1675**	Nov 2025	Gurdwara Sis Ganj Sahib

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03 Economy, Banking and Finance

The FAA core: monetary policy, public finance, taxes, institutions and schemes.

A. Monetary policy and economic measurement

3.1 RBI policy: rates and instruments

- **In focus:** In **August 2026**, the MPC unanimously held the **repo rate at 5.25%** with a **neutral stance**. It projected FY 2026-27 GDP growth at **6.7%** and CPI inflation at **5.0%**.
- **Facts:** The repo rate reached 5.25% in December 2025, after **125 basis points of cuts** since February 2025. A **100-basis-point CRR cut**, announced in June 2025, was implemented in phases during September-November 2025.

  Static link: The **six-member MPC** is constituted under **Section 45ZB, RBI Act, 1934**: three RBI members and three external members. The Governor has a **casting vote**.
- **Remember: SDF forms the floor and MSF the ceiling** of the liquidity corridor. **Bank Rate equals MSF**.
- The 2025 cuts moved the repo from **6.50% to 5.25%** through a cumulative **125 basis points**. The June policy changed the stance from accommodative to neutral, and the December cut produced the 5.25% rate subsequently held in 2026. The rate, the stance and the CRR decision are separate policy dimensions. **A hold in the repo rate does not mean that the Government has changed the inflation target**.
- The MPC must meet at least **four times a year**; the normal pattern is six. Minutes are published on the **14th day under Section 45ZL**. In September 2026, the RBI members were **Governor Sanjay Malhotra, Deputy Governor Poonam Gupta and Executive Director Indranil Bhattacharyya**. The external members are **Nagesh Kumar, Saugata Bhattacharya and Ram Singh**. Its three-plus-three structure is different from a board made entirely of RBI officials.

3.1.1 Policy-rate dashboard

Instrument	Policy rate - August 2026
Repo	5.25%
Standing Deposit Facility (SDF)	5.00%
Marginal Standing Facility (MSF)	5.50%
Bank Rate	5.50%
Cash Reserve Ratio (CRR)	3%
Statutory Liquidity Ratio (SLR)	18%

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3.2 Flexible inflation targeting

- **In focus:** The **Central Government**, in consultation with the RBI, retained the **4% CPI inflation target with a ±2% tolerance band** for **1 April 2026-31 March 2031**.

  Static link: **Section 45ZA, RBI Act**, introduced through the Finance Act, 2016, governs the framework. The target measure is **headline CPI-Combined**.

- **Remember: The Government notifies the target; the MPC decides monetary policy to pursue it.** The tolerance range is **2-6%**, while the central target remains 4%.

- The framework began in **2016 for 2016-21**, was retained in March 2021 for **2021-26**, and was retained again in March 2026 for **2026-31**. The **4% midpoint and ±2% tolerance** are therefore an established target framework rather than an August MPC forecast. The **5.0% inflation forecast for FY27** sits inside the 2-6% band, but a forecast's value does not replace the notified 4% target.

3.3 RBI leadership and origins

- **Facts: Sanjay Malhotra** is the **26th RBI Governor**, in office from December 2024. Deputy Governors are **Swaminathan J, Poonam Gupta, S.C. Murmu and Rohit Jain**; Rohit Jain took office in May 2026.

  Static link: The RBI Act permits up to **four Deputy Governors**. RBI began operations on **1 April 1935**, following the Hilton Young Commission, and was nationalised on **1 January 1949**.

3.4 New statistical bases

- **Facts:** The new **CPI base is 2024=100**, released in February 2026. Its consumption weights draw on **HCES 2023-24**.

- **Facts:** The new **GDP/National Accounts base is 2022-23**, replacing 2011-12. It incorporates sources such as GST data, company filings and household/labour surveys.

  Static link: The **National Statistical Office (NSO)** is under **MoSPI**. NSO was formed in 2019 by merging CSO and NSSO.

- **Remember:** CPI's base is a **calendar year**; GDP's is a **financial year**. Figures from different bases and reporting stages should not be compared as though they were identical series.

- The earlier CPI base was **2012**; the new one is **2024**. The national-accounts base moved from **2011-12 to 2022-23**. CPI weights use the **Household Consumption Expenditure Survey 2023-24**, while the GDP series draws on GST and company data plus labour, enterprise and consumption surveys. The base year, the year of the data used for weighting, and the publication year need not be the same.

3.5 Growth: estimate versus projection

- **Facts:** The **June 2026 Provisional Estimates**, on the new GDP base, put FY 2025-26 **real GDP growth at 7.7%**, nominal growth at **8.9%** and real GVA growth at **7.9%**.

- **Facts: Q1 FY 2026-27 real GDP growth was 7.8%**, released in August 2026. The Economic Survey's earlier FY26 estimate was **7.4% on the old base**.

- **Remember:** The Survey projected **6.8-7.2%** growth for FY 2026-27; the RBI's August projection was **6.7%**. A forecast is not a recorded annual outcome; the institution and date matter.

- The FY26 **Provisional Estimates were released on 5 June 2026**, and the FY27 first-quarter figures on **31 August 2026**. Real GDP growth, nominal GDP growth and GVA growth carry separate values: FY26 **7.7%, 8.9% and 7.9%**, respectively. Q1 FY27 nominal GDP growth is **10.3%**, alongside real

growth of 7.8%. A nominal-growth percentage should not be substituted for real growth merely because both belong to the same release.

- The IMF's **July 2026 World Economic Outlook Update** projected Indian fiscal-year growth at **6.4%**, compared with the Survey's 6.8-7.2% range and the RBI's August 6.7%. The IMF's global-growth projections were **3.0% for calendar 2026 and 3.4% for 2027**. Country fiscal-year forecasts and global calendar-year forecasts use different periods. These figures are forecasts at named dates, not the recorded FY26 outcome.

3.1.2 CRR, SLR and the liquidity corridor

- **CRR is cash kept with the RBI**, as a share of net demand and time liabilities, and earns no interest. **SLR is the bank's own holding of liquid assets**, including cash, gold and government securities. The relevant laws differ: **CRR is under Section 42 of the RBI Act, 1934; SLR under Section 24 of the Banking Regulation Act, 1949**. The stated 3% and 18% ratios describe different requirements, not alternative names for one reserve.
- The corridor places the **repo policy rate between SDF and MSF**. In August 2026, the corridor was **5.00% SDF → 5.25% repo → 5.50% MSF**. **SDF does not require collateral**; MSF is the upper borrowing facility and permits banks to dip into SLR securities. A 25-basis-point difference on either side produces a half-percentage-point corridor between floor and ceiling. Bank Rate was aligned with MSF.

B. Union finances

3.6 Union Budget 2026-27

- **In focus: Nirmala Sitharaman** presented the Budget on **1 February 2026**. The figures below are **Budget Estimates**, distinct from Revised Estimates and actual expenditure.
- **Facts:** The fiscal deficit estimate is **4.3% of GDP**, compared with **4.4% in RE 2025-26**. Central debt is budgeted at **55.6% of GDP**, with a **50±1% target by 2030**.

  Static link: **Article 112**: Annual Financial Statement; **Article 110**: Money Bills; **Article 266**: Consolidated Fund; **Article 267**: Contingency Fund. The **FRBM Act, 2003**, is the fiscal-responsibility framework.
- **Remember: Effective capital expenditure = capital expenditure + grants for creation of capital assets.** The ₹12.2 lakh crore public-capex figure is not itself effective capex.
- The Budget's **total expenditure of ₹53.5 lakh crore** and **non-debt receipts of ₹36.5 lakh crore** are different sides of the financing statement. **Net tax receipts to the Centre are ₹28.7 lakh crore**; this is not the same measure as total receipts or States' share of the divisible pool. **Finance Commission grants to States are ₹1.4 lakh crore**. Grants, tax devolution and central scheme expenditure should retain their own labels instead of being combined into one unnamed "transfer" figure.
- The debt comparison is **55.6% of GDP in BE 2026-27 versus 56.1% in RE 2025-26**, with a **50±1% goal by 2030**. The deficit comparison is **4.3% versus 4.4%**. A deficit is a year's balance; the debt ratio describes the accumulated debt relative to GDP. The policy target is forward-looking and should not be reported as an already achieved 50% ratio.

3.6.1 Budget figures

Measure	BE 2026-27
Total expenditure	₹53.5 lakh crore
Non-debt receipts	₹36.5 lakh crore
Net tax receipts to Centre	₹28.7 lakh crore
Public capital expenditure	₹12.2 lakh crore
Fiscal deficit	4.3% of GDP
Revenue deficit	1.5% of GDP
Gross / net market borrowing	₹17.2 / ₹11.7 lakh crore

3.6.2 The rupee charts: largest components

- **Facts:** In the Budget's **"rupee comes from"** chart, **borrowings and other liabilities are the largest component at 24%**, followed by income tax at 21% and corporation tax at 18%.
- **Facts:** In **"rupee goes to"**, **States' share of taxes is largest at 22%**, followed by interest payments at 20% and Central Sector Schemes at 17%.
- **Remember:** These are the Budget presentation's shares; they should not be confused with tax devolution as a percentage of the divisible pool.

3.6.3 Selected Budget announcements

Announcement	Essential purpose / outlay
Biopharma SHAKTI	**₹10,000 crore over five years** for biopharma manufacturing.
Electronics Components Manufacturing Scheme	Outlay raised to **₹40,000 crore**.
Rare Earth Corridors	**Odisha, Kerala, Andhra Pradesh and Tamil Nadu**.
Infrastructure Risk Guarantee Fund	Construction-phase risk cover for private infrastructure developers.
CPSE REITs	Recycling public-sector real-estate assets.
Container Manufacturing Assistance Scheme	**₹10,000 crore**.

3.7 Economic Survey 2025-26

- **Facts:** Tabled on **29 January 2026** by the Finance Minister; prepared under **CEA V. Anantha Nageswaran** in the Economic Division, Department of Economic Affairs.
- **Facts:** FY25 total exports were **US$825.3 billion**, including **US$387.6 billion of services exports**. Average CPI inflation in April-December 2025 was **1.7%**.

- **Remember:** India's share of global **merchandise exports was 1.8%** in 2024; its share of global **commercial-services exports was 4.3%**. India had a **services-trade surplus**.

  Static link: The Survey is presented **before the Budget** by the Finance Minister; the CEA leads its preparation. A Survey projection is not a final statistical estimate.

- The Survey records **US$81 billion FDI inflows in calendar 2025**, a 13% rise, and an unemployment rate of **3.2% for 2023-24**, compared with 6% in 2017-18. These are distinct reporting periods and measures. The Survey also places equity and mutual funds at **15.2% of household financial savings in FY25**, compared with 2% in FY12. That household-savings share is not the same as individual investors' share of equity ownership.

3.8 Sixteenth Finance Commission

- **In focus:** Chaired by **Arvind Panagariya**, the 16th Finance Commission covers **2026-31** and retained **41% vertical tax devolution** to States.

  Static link: **Article 280** requires the President to constitute a Finance Commission every **five years**. The 15th Commission was chaired by **N.K. Singh**.

- **Remember:** Vertical devolution determines the **Centre-States split**; horizontal criteria determine **distribution among States**. J&K, as a UT, receives central assistance rather than a share in State tax devolution.

- The new **contribution-to-GDP criterion has 10% weight**; the earlier **tax and fiscal effort criterion was dropped**. The other changes are income distance **45% to 42.5%**, population **15% to 17.5%**, demographic performance **12.5% to 10%**, and area **15% to 10%**. Forest and ecology remains **10%**. These are horizontal-distribution weights, which total 100%; they must not be added to the separate 41% vertical-devolution percentage.

3.8.1 Sixteenth FC: horizontal distribution

Criterion	Weight
Income distance	42.5%
Population, 2011	17.5%
Demographic performance	10%
Area	10%
Forest and ecology	10%
Contribution to GDP - new	10%

3.6.4 Deficits: four different calculations

- **Fiscal deficit = total expenditure - revenue receipts - non-debt capital receipts.** It is the net borrowing requirement. Borrowed funds are not included as non-debt receipts in this calculation; otherwise the financing of the deficit would wrongly erase the measured gap.

- **Revenue deficit = revenue expenditure - revenue receipts.** A revenue surplus means receipts exceed revenue expenditure; it can coexist with an overall fiscal deficit when other spending and financing are considered. This explains the J&K Budget's simultaneous revenue-surplus and fiscal-deficit figures.

- **Primary deficit = fiscal deficit - interest payments.** It separates the interest burden from the overall fiscal gap. **Effective revenue deficit = revenue deficit - grants for creation of capital assets**; this measure was introduced in 2011-12. Effective revenue deficit and effective capital expenditure both refer to capital-asset grants, but they are not the same formula.

3.6.5 Public funds and legislative authorisation

- **Article 112 calls the Budget the Annual Financial Statement**. Its expenditure is divided into **charged and voted** items. The annual statement, the demands for grants and the authority to withdraw funds are related stages, rather than different names for a single document.
- **The Consolidated Fund of India, Article 266(1), receives government revenues, loans raised and repayments of loans granted.** Money is withdrawn through an **Appropriation Act**. **The Public Account, Article 266(2), contains items such as provident funds, small savings, deposits and remittances**, for which the Government acts as a banker; their disbursement does not require Parliament's vote in the same way.
- **The Contingency Fund, Article 267(1), is at the President's disposal for unforeseen expenditure pending parliamentary approval.** Its corpus is **₹30,000 crore**, increased from ₹500 crore in 2021. It is distinct from ordinary receipts in the Consolidated Fund and from deposit-type liabilities in the Public Account. **Article 267(2)** provides the State-level counterpart.
- **Charged expenditure is not voted, but may be discussed.** It includes the President's emoluments, specified parliamentary presiding officers, Supreme Court judges' salaries and pensions, High Court judges' pensions, CAG salary and debt charges. **High Court judges' salaries are charged on the State's Consolidated Fund**, whereas their pensions are charged on the Consolidated Fund of India. The salary/pension distinction matters as much as the court's name.

3.6.6 Money Bills, appropriation and interim grants

- **A Money Bill under Article 110 originates only in the Lok Sabha with the President's recommendation.** The Rajya Sabha may recommend changes within **14 days**. The Money-Bill route is not the same as an ordinary Bill moving through both Houses with equal powers.
- **Article 114 concerns appropriation**; amendments cannot vary a grant's amount or purpose or alter charged expenditure. **Article 115 concerns supplementary, additional and excess grants**; excess grants follow examination by the Public Accounts Committee. **Article 116 provides vote on account, vote of credit and exceptional grants**. A vote on account is an advance grant, usually for two months, rather than a new permanent tax measure.
- **Financial Bills under Article 117** form a separate category. Article 117(1) combines Money-Bill matters with other matters and follows the Lok Sabha/President's-recommendation conditions; Article 117(3) concerns expenditure from the Consolidated Fund and may originate in either House. **Policy, economy and token cut motions** seek reductions to ₹1, by a stated amount and by ₹100, respectively.

C. Taxes and financial-sector law

3.9 GST reform and the Council

- **In focus: GST 2.0**, effective **22 September 2025**, introduced two main slabs, **5% and 18%**, with a **40% special rate** for specified sin and luxury goods. The 12% and 28% slabs were removed.

Static link: GST came through the **101st Amendment, 2016**, and began on **1 July 2017**. **Article 279A** establishes the GST Council, chaired by the Union Finance Minister.

- **Facts:** The Council's quorum is **half its members**. Decisions require **three-fourths weighted majority**: Centre one-third of the votes, States two-thirds.
- **Remember:** Council recommendations are **not binding**, as held in **Mohit Minerals, 2022**. Institutional voting rules are distinct from GST rate percentages.
- The **56th Council meeting in September 2025** produced GST 2.0 rate changes, effective later that month. Monthly collections reached a high of **₹2.42 lakh crore in April 2026**. That collection value is a dated revenue figure; it is not a rate slab. **Five, eighteen and forty per cent** are tax rates, while **one-third/two-thirds and three-fourths** describe the Council's voting system.

3.10 Income-tax Act, 2025

- **In focus:** Effective **1 April 2026**, the Act replaces the **Income-tax Act, 1961**, and introduces the **tax-year** concept in place of previous-year/assessment-year terminology.
- **Facts:** The law simplifies the statutory structure. It does **not, by itself, change tax rates or abolish the old tax regime**; rates and slabs are set through Finance Acts.
- **Remember:** Under the Budget 2025-26 carry-forward provision, income up to **₹12 lakh** is tax-free in the new regime; for salaried taxpayers, the figure is **₹12.75 lakh including the standard deduction**.
- The new Act received assent in **August 2025** and commenced on **1 April 2026**. The Act has a simplified structure of about **536 sections, 23 chapters and 16 schedules**. Its **tax-year terminology** addresses how the statute expresses the reporting period. Rate changes still depend on Finance Acts, so statutory simplification is not the same as an automatic change in every taxpayer's slab or the abolition of the alternative regime.

3.11 Banking Laws (Amendment) Act, 2025

- **Facts:** Its nomination provisions, effective **1 November 2025**, permit **up to four nominees** for accounts, through simultaneous or successive nominations.
- **Remember: Lockers and safe custody permit successive nominations only.** The simultaneous option should not be applied to them.
- **Facts:** The substantial-interest threshold rose from **₹5 lakh to ₹2 crore**. Specified unclaimed dividends, shares and bond money transfer to the **Investor Education and Protection Fund**.
- The nomination provision differentiates **simultaneous and successive nomination**. Accounts may use either method for up to four nominees, while lockers and safe custody use successive nomination only. The Act also raises the **substantial-interest threshold from ₹5 lakh to ₹2 crore** and transfers specified unclaimed dividends, shares and bond money to the IEPF. The nominee count and substantial-interest threshold concern different provisions and should not be treated as one eligibility rule.

3.12 Insurance reform

- **Facts:** The **Sabka Bima Sabki Raksha (Amendment of Insurance Laws) Act, 2025**, permits **up to 100% FDI in insurance companies**, replacing the earlier 74% cap.

  Static link: It amends the Insurance Act 1938, LIC Act 1956 and IRDA Act 1999. **Ajay Seth** is the IRDAI Chairperson in the 2026 coverage period.

- **Remember: Insurance intermediaries already had a 100% cap**. The new change concerns **insurers**.
- The change to **100% insurer FDI** follows an earlier **74% limit**. It should not be confused with the pre-existing 100% limit for **insurance intermediaries**. The Act's name indicates amendments to insurance laws, including the **Insurance Act, 1938, LIC Act, 1956 and IRDA Act, 1999**. **IRDAI** is the insurance regulator; it is not the same institution as the RBI or SEBI, which regulate different parts of finance.

3.13 Financial Stability Report

Static link: RBI publishes the **Financial Stability Report twice yearly, in June and December**, reflecting the views of the FSDC sub-committee.

- **Remember:** The report's assessment of bank quality is distinct from the MPC's growth and inflation projections.

3.13.1 Bank asset quality: NPA and SMA

- **An NPA has interest or principal overdue for more than 90 days**. **Special Mention Accounts** identify stress earlier: **SMA-0 up to 30 days, SMA-1 from 31-60 and SMA-2 from 61-90 days**. The early-warning category should not be called an NPA merely because a payment has become overdue.
- **Prompt Corrective Action, PCA**, is an RBI supervisory framework triggered by measures of **capital, asset quality and leverage**; it is not a moratorium. **CRAR measures capital against risk-weighted assets**. India's minimum is **9%**, plus a **2.5% capital-conservation buffer**, compared with the Basel global minimum of 8%. These concepts explain the banking-quality context of the Financial Stability Report.

D. Inclusion, payments and the external sector

3.15 Financial inclusion and UPI

- **Facts: PM Jan Dhan Yojana**, launched **28 August 2014**, had about **59.09 crore accounts in August 2026**. The RBI Financial Inclusion Index reached **70.0 for March 2026**, up from 67.0 a year earlier.
- **Facts: UPI**, launched **11 April 2016**, recorded **24.51 billion transactions worth ₹29.82 lakh crore in August 2026**. These are dated monthly figures, not permanent totals.

  Static link: **NPCI**, created in 2008 through an RBI-IBA initiative, is a not-for-profit **Section 8 company**.
- **Remember:** FI-Index ranges from **0, complete exclusion, to 100, full inclusion**. Its three components are **Access 35%, Usage 45% and Quality 20%**.
- The FI-Index's **35% Access, 45% Usage and 20% Quality** weights total 100%. It is published annually for the March-ending period. More accounts show access, but the index also separately considers use and quality, so an account count and the FI-Index score are not interchangeable. PMJDY's account total belongs to **August 2026**; the index's **70.0** belongs to **March 2026**.

3.16 Foreign-exchange reserves: composition

Static link: RBI manages reserves under the **RBI Act, 1934**, and **FEMA, 1999**. Components are **foreign-currency assets, gold, SDRs and the IMF reserve-tranche position**.

- **Remember:** Reserve totals change weekly; the composition links international transactions with RBI and IMF institutions.

3.17 Trade agreements: distinct names

Agreement	Recorded milestone	Core association
India-EFTA TEPA	In force **1 October 2025**	EFTA: **Switzerland, Norway, Iceland, Liechtenstein**; US$100 billion investment commitment over 15 years.
India-UK CETA	In force **15 July 2026**	Paired with the Double Contributions Convention.
India-Oman CEPA	In force **1 June 2026**	Oman: Gulf trade partner.

3.17.1 EFTA is different from the EU

- **Remember: TEPA, CETA and CEPA are distinct agreement names.** EFTA is not the European Union;

  Static link: **Entry into force is different from signature or completion of negotiations**.

3.18 Sovereign ratings

- **In focus: S&P upgraded India to BBB in August 2025**, from BBB-. **Fitch affirmed BBB- in August 2026**; Moody's rating is **Baa3**.
- **Remember:** Among these three agencies, **S&P places India above the lowest investment grade**. Do not interchange S&P/Fitch letter ratings and Moody's alphanumeric scale.
- Sovereign-rating changes include **S&P's move from BBB- to BBB in August 2025**, while Fitch retains BBB- and Moody's uses **Baa3**. These are three agencies' assessments, not three successive stages of one rating. A useful comparison is that S&P is above the lowest investment-grade category, while the other two retained their stated lowest-investment-grade ratings. The agency must therefore remain attached to the symbol.

3.15.1 Digital rupee and rupee-trade settlement

- **The CBDC/e-rupee is a digital form of the rupee issued by the RBI**. It is **legal tender and an RBI liability**, not a cryptocurrency issued by NPCI. The RBI Act was amended through the Finance Act, 2022; the wholesale and retail pilots began in November and December 2022. The issuer and legal character distinguish digital currency from a payments organisation's role.
- **A Special Rupee Vostro Account, SRVA**, is a rupee account opened by a foreign bank with an Indian authorised-dealer bank for invoicing and settling trade in rupees. It belongs to the RBI's **July 2022 framework**. **Vostro means "your account with us"; Nostro means "our account with you"**. The account arrangement is different from the RBI's national reserve holdings of foreign-currency assets, gold, SDRs and reserve-tranche position.

E. Schemes, accounting and institutions

3.19 Economic missions: purpose before detail

Mission / scheme	Core purpose	Key figure
Aatmanirbharta in Pulses	Self-sufficiency in pulses	**₹11,440 crore; target 2030-31**
PM Dhan-Dhaanya Krishi Yojana	Agriculture development in **100 districts**	**₹24,000 crore annually for six years**
PM Viksit Bharat Rozgar Yojana	Employment-linked incentives	**₹99,446 crore; target 3.5 crore jobs**
RDI Scheme	Long-term private research and innovation funding	**₹1 lakh crore corpus**
PM Surya Sarovar Yojana	**Floating solar** on water bodies	**5,000 MW; ₹5,070 crore**

3.19.1 Solar schemes: the distinction

- **Remember: PM Surya Sarovar is floating solar; PM Surya Ghar is rooftop solar**, launched in 2024 with a one-crore-household goal.
- The Pulses Mission's **₹11,440 crore** covers **2025-26 to 2030-31**. PM Dhan-Dhaanya's ₹24,000 crore is an **annual figure for six years**, not the total six-year outlay. PM Viksit Bharat Rozgar Yojana, formerly ELI, covers eligible jobs created during **August 2025-July 2027**, with a target of 3.5 crore jobs. RDI's **₹1 lakh crore is a corpus** for long-term low/zero-interest private R&D funding. Annual outlay, total outlay, corpus and target are different labels.

3.20 Accounting and financial regulators

Body	Head in the 2026 coverage period	Statutory / institutional link
ICAI	**CA Prasanna Kumar D**, 74th President	**CA Act, 1949**; founded **1 July 1949**, observed as CA Day.
CAG	**K. Sanjay Murthy**	**Article 148**; tenure six years or age 65.
IRDAI	**Ajay Seth**	**IRDA Act, 1999**.
PFRDA	**Sivasubramanian Ramann**	Regulates **NPS and APY**.
SEBI	**Tuhin Kanta Pandey**	**SEBI Act, 1992**.
NABARD	**Shaji K.V.**	Established **12 July 1982**.

3.20.1 CAG: independence and expenditure

Static link: The CAG is removed through the same procedure as a Supreme Court judge. The CAG's salary is **charged on the Consolidated Fund**, protecting independence from annual voting.

- **Remember: CAG is the constitutional audit authority; ICAI is the chartered-accountancy professional body.** Both connect current appointments with the accountancy part of FAA preparation.

3.21 International financial institutions

Institution	Head	Headquarters
IMF	**Kristalina Georgieva**	Washington DC
World Bank Group	**Ajay Banga**	Washington DC
WTO	**Ngozi Okonjo-Iweala**	Geneva
ADB	**Masato Kanda**	Manila
AIIB	**Zou Jiayi**	Beijing
NDB	**Dilma Rousseff**	Shanghai
BIS	**Pablo Hernández de Cos**	Basel

3.20.2 Government accounting: CAG, CGA and standards

- **Government of India accounts use a cash basis**. **GASAB, the Government Accounting Standards Advisory Board**, was established in **2002 under the CAG**. The **Controller General of Accounts** sits in the **Department of Expenditure**, heads the Indian Civil Accounts Service and runs the **Public Financial Management System, PFMS**.
- The CAG's statutory duties are linked to the **DPC Act, 1971**, and Union audit reports go to the **President under Article 151**, then to Parliament and the **Public Accounts Committee**. Accounts were separated from audit in **1976**, when the Indian Civil Accounts Service was created.
- **Ind AS are converged with IFRS**, notified in **2015** and phased in from 2016-17. **NFRA**, established in **2018**, is under **Section 132 of the Companies Act, 2013**. These regulate corporate reporting; government accounts use a cash basis. **GeM is the Government e-Marketplace; e-Kuber is RBI's core banking solution**-procurement and banking platforms, respectively.

04 International Affairs

Summits, organisations, leadership and the geography behind major international developments.

A. World Who's Who

Country / body	Leader
USA	**Donald Trump** (47th President)
Japan	**Sanae Takaichi**
Germany	**Friedrich Merz** (Chancellor)
Canada	**Mark Carney**
Australia	**Anthony Albanese**
South Korea	**Lee Jae-myung**
Hungary	**Péter Magyar** (Tisza party)
Bangladesh	**Tarique Rahman** (BNP)
Nepal	**Balendra (Balen) Shah** (RSP)
Myanmar	**Min Aung Hlaing** (President)
Iran (Supreme Leader)	**Mojtaba Khamenei**
Vatican	**Pope Leo XIV** (Robert Francis Prevost)
UN Secretary-General	**António Guterres** (9th)
UNGA President	**Khalilur Rahman** (Bangladesh), 81st session
WTO DG	**Ngozi Okonjo-Iweala**
UNESCO DG	**Khaled El-Enany** (Egypt)
IOC President	**Kirsty Coventry** (Zimbabwe)
SCO Secretary-General	**Nurlan Yermekbayev** (Kazakhstan)
BIMSTEC Secretary-General	**Indra Mani Pandey** (India)
NDB President	**Dilma Rousseff**
ICJ President	**Iwasawa Yuji** (Japan)

B. Wars and Crises

4.1 Strait of Hormuz

Static link: The Strait connects the **Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman and Arabian Sea. Iran lies to the north; Oman's Musandam peninsula lies to the south**.

- **Facts:** About **one-fifth of the world's oil** passes through this route. Disruption therefore matters for India's oil, LPG/LNG supply and import costs.
- **Remember:** Hormuz is not the passage connecting the Red Sea with the Gulf of Aden. Learn the adjoining waters and bordering countries together.
- Hormuz disruption affects **oil-import costs, LPG/LNG supply risk, remittance concerns and Chabahar**. These are different channels of exposure, rather than four names for the strait. Oil supply and import prices also provide the link to **imported inflation** in the economy chapter. The geographical anchor remains the Persian Gulf's outlet toward the Gulf of Oman;

4.1.1 Indian evacuation and relief operations

- **Facts: Operation Sindhu** evacuated Indians from **Iran and Israel during the June 2025 conflict**, including evacuation through Armenia.
- **Facts: Operation Sagar Bandhu** was India's relief effort for **Sri Lanka after Cyclone Ditwah in November 2025**.
- **Remember:** The operation name, country and purpose form the essential pair.

4.1.2 Three straits: adjoining waters

Strait	Connects
Hormuz	**Persian Gulf ↔ Gulf of Oman**.
Bab-el-Mandeb	**Red Sea ↔ Gulf of Aden**.
Malacca	**Andaman Sea ↔ South China Sea**.

4.2 Gaza: ceasefire, Board of Peace and UNSC Resolution 2803

- **Facts:** Trump's **20-point "Comprehensive Plan to End the Gaza Conflict"** (29 Sep 2025) → ceasefire (**10 Oct 2025**) → **Sharm el-Sheikh Peace Summit**, Egypt (**13 Oct 2025**, co-chaired by Trump and el-Sisi; India represented by MoS **Kirti Vardhan Singh**) → **UNSC Resolution 2803 (17 Nov 2025)**, which endorsed the plan, welcomed a **Board of Peace (BoP)** and authorised an **International Stabilization Force (ISF)**.

  Static link: Under **Art 25** of the UN Charter, Security Council decisions are binding. **Art 27(3)** gives the P5 their veto on substantive matters.

4.20 India-Afghanistan: embassy and recognition

- **In focus:** During Taliban Foreign Minister **Amir Khan Muttaqi's October 2025 visit**, India announced an upgrade of its technical mission in **Kabul** to an embassy.
- **Remember:** Embassy engagement is distinct from **formal recognition**. India had not formally recognised the Taliban government during the coverage period; **Russia became the first country to do so in July 2025**.

C. Summits and Groupings

4.6 BRICS 2026: India's chairship and the New Delhi Summit (12-13 Sep 2026)

- **In focus:** India hosted the **18th BRICS Summit** in **New Delhi** on **12-13 Sep 2026**. It was India's **4th** chairship (**2012, 2016, 2021, 2026**). India took over the chair on **1 Jan 2026**.
- **Theme:** "**Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability**", which spells out B-R-I-C-S. EAM Jaishankar unveiled the logo on **13 Jan 2026**.
- **Outcome:** The **New Delhi Declaration**, a **140-paragraph** consensus document adopted **unanimously on 12 Sep 2026**. It covered UN, IMF and World Bank reform, West Asia, AI governance and terrorism. **Xi Jinping and Vladimir Putin attended**. India's main diplomatic achievement was getting **Iran and the UAE**, on opposite sides of the war, to agree to the text.
- **Build-up:** The BRICS Foreign Ministers' Meeting was held in **New Delhi on 14 May 2026**. Ten **partner countries**: Belarus, Bolivia, Cuba, Kazakhstan, Malaysia, Nigeria, Thailand, Uganda, Uzbekistan, Vietnam.
- **Members:** Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa, plus **Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, UAE** (2024) and **Indonesia** (Jan 2025).
- **Previous summit: 17th, Rio de Janeiro (Jul 2025)**: Rio Declaration, a framework declaration on climate finance, and a statement on AI governance. It **condemned the Pahalgam attack**.

Static link: The term BRIC was coined by **Jim O'Neill (2001)**. First summit: **Yekaterinburg (2009)**. South Africa joined in **2010**. **NDB:** headquartered in **Shanghai**, set up in **2014 (Fortaleza)**; first President **K.V. Kamath**. **CRA:** a **$100 billion** reserve pool.

4.7 SCO: Tianjin 2025 and Bishkek 2026

- **J&K hook:** At the **SCO Defence Ministers' meeting in Qingdao (Jun 2025)**, **Rajnath Singh refused to sign** the joint document because it **left out Pahalgam** but mentioned Balochistan. The leaders' Tianjin Declaration later condemned Pahalgam.

Static link: The **Shanghai Five (1996)** became the SCO in **2001**. HQ: **Beijing**. **RATS: Tashkent**. Official languages: Russian and Chinese. **10 members**: India and Pakistan joined in **2017**, Iran in **2023**, Belarus in **2024**. Next summit: **Islamabad (2027)**. **Kashi (Varanasi)** was the first SCO Tourism and Cultural Capital (2022-23).

	25th Summit	26th Summit
Venue and date	**Tianjin, China** (31 Aug-1 Sep 2025)	**Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan** (31 Aug-1 Sep 2026)
Outcome	**Tianjin Declaration**. **SCO Development Strategy to 2035**. A proposed **SCO Development Bank**. **Laos** became a partner	**Bishkek Declaration on the 25th Anniversary of the SCO**
India	Modi's **first visit to China in 7 years**. The declaration **condemned the Pahalgam attack**	Modi attended and signed. He called for **dismantling the "entire ecosystem of terrorism"**, with **no double standards**

4.8 G20: Johannesburg 2025 and the US year

- **Johannesburg (22-23 Nov 2025):** The **20th** G20 summit and the **first in Africa**. Theme: "**Solidarity, Equality, Sustainability**". The **Leaders' Declaration** was adopted on day one (22 Nov), even though the **US boycotted** the summit. Modi attended. An **IBSA** leaders' meeting was held alongside.
- **India's proposals at Johannesburg:** a Global Traditional Knowledge Repository, an Africa Skills Multiplier Initiative, and a G20 initiative on the **drug-terror nexus**.

Static link: G20 founded in **1999** (finance ministers); leaders' summits since **2008**. **India's presidency (2023):** the **African Union became a permanent member** at the New Delhi Summit, under the theme "*Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam*".

4.9 Quad: no leaders' summit, but a Delhi foreign ministers' meeting

- **Facts:** The **Quad Foreign Ministers met in New Delhi (25-27 May 2026)**: **S. Jaishankar, Marco Rubio, Penny Wong** and **Toshimitsu Motegi**.
- **Outcomes:** A **Quad Critical Minerals Initiative Framework** (the initiative was launched at the Washington FMM, 1 Jul 2025) and a **Statement on Indo-Pacific Energy Security**. The ministers **condemned the Pahalgam** and Bondi Beach terror attacks.

Static link: First proposed in **2007 (Shinzo Abe)**, revived in **2017**, leaders' level from **2021**. It is **not a military alliance or treaty**. **IPMDA** (maritime domain awareness) dates from 2022. The **Malabar** exercise is separate from the Quad.

4.10 G7 Evian 2026 and NATO Ankara 2026

- **G7 2026 (French presidency), Evian-les-Bains, Jun 2026: Modi** addressed the outreach sessions on **16 Jun 2026** ("Forging New Partnerships and Rebuilding International Solidarity"). Earlier, on 14 Jun, he and Macron inaugurated **Bharat Innovates 2026** in **Nice**. The G7 2025 summit was at **Kananaskis (Canada)**.
- **NATO Ankara Summit (7-8 Jul 2026):** The **Ankara Summit Declaration** reaffirmed the "ironclad" **Article 5** commitment. The Hague Summit (2025) set a target of **5% of GDP** on defence by 2035 (3.5% core plus 1.5% related spending). NATO SG: **Mark Rutte**. Members: **32** (Finland 2023, Sweden 2024).

4.11 Other groupings at a glance

Grouping	Latest (2025-26)	Static hook
ASEAN	47th Summit, **Kuala Lumpur** (Oct 2025): **Timor-Leste became the 11th member**. **Philippines** chairs in **2026**. 2026 is the **ASEAN-India Year of Maritime Cooperation**	Founded 1967 (Bangkok); HQ **Jakarta**
BIMSTEC	6th Summit, **Bangkok** (Apr 2025): **Bangkok Vision 2030** and a Maritime Transport Agreement. **Bangladesh** is now chair. India offered to host the first BIMSTEC Games (2027)	7 members; HQ **Dhaka**; India leads on **Security**
IORA	**India chairs 2025-27**	HQ **Ebene, Mauritius**; 23 members

Grouping	Latest (2025-26)	Static hook
NAM	19th mid-term Ministerial, **Kampala** (2025). Uganda chairs 2024-27	121 members; founded 1961 (Belgrade)
Colombo Security Conclave	**Seychelles** joined (2025)	India, Sri Lanka, Maldives, Mauritius, Bangladesh, Seychelles
Pax Silica (US-led chip and AI supply-chain club)	**India joined in Jan 2026**	-
WTO MC14	**Yaoundé, Cameroon**, 26-30 Mar 2026	MC13: Abu Dhabi (2024). WTO set up in 1995; HQ Geneva
SAARC	Dormant. No summit since **Kathmandu 2014**; the 2016 Islamabad summit was cancelled	HQ Kathmandu

D. United Nations

4.12 Choosing the 10th UN Secretary-General

- **In focus: António Guterres**'s second term ends on **31 Dec 2026**. The **fourth Security Council straw poll** was held on **29 Sep 2026**.
- **Candidates: Rebeca Grynspan** (Costa Rica; UNCTAD chief), **Carolyn Rodrigues Birkett** (Guyana; nominated 15 Jun 2026), **Rafael Grossi** (Argentina; IAEA DG), **Michelle Bachelet** (Chile), **María Fernanda Espinosa** (Ecuador), **Ivonne A-Baki** (Ecuador), **Macky Sall** (Senegal), **Olara Otunnu** (Uganda; nominated 24 Jul 2026).

  Static link: **UN Charter Art 97:** The **General Assembly appoints** the SG **on the recommendation of the Security Council**, so P5 vetoes apply at the recommendation stage. GA Resolution **79/327** (2025) sets out a transparent process: vision statements, interactive dialogues and financing disclosures. Informal regional rotation favours **Latin America and the Caribbean** this time, and there is a strong push for the **first woman SG**.
- **Past SGs:** Trygve Lie · Dag Hammarskjöld · U Thant · Kurt Waldheim · Javier Pérez de Cuéllar · Boutros Boutros-Ghali · Kofi Annan · Ban Ki-moon · António Guterres.

4.13 UNGA presidents, UN at 80 and the ICJ climate opinion

- **UNGA 80th session (2025-26):** President **Annalena Baerbock** (Germany).
- **UNGA 81st session:** President **Khalilur Rahman** (**Bangladesh**), elected on **2 Jun 2026**. The session opened on **8 Sep 2026**.
- **UN at 80:** The UN Charter came into force on **24 Oct 1945**, so 24 Oct 2025 marked 80 years. The **"UN80"** reform initiative is under way.
- **ICJ advisory opinion on climate change (23 Jul 2025):** Requested by the UNGA in 2023, a **Vanuatu**-led effort. The Court was **unanimous** that States have legal obligations to protect the climate system, under treaties and customary law, and that breaching them can be an **internationally wrongful act**. It treated **1.5 °C** as the primary goal.

Static link: The **ICJ** sits at **The Hague** and has **15 judges** with **9-year** terms. Its advisory opinions are **not binding**.

E. Elections and Leadership Changes Abroad

4.14 The neighbourhood's new governments

Country	What changed	Exam hook
Bangladesh	After the Aug 2024 uprising and **Muhammad Yunus**'s interim government, the **BNP** won the election of **Feb 2026** (≥212 of 299 seats). **Tarique Rahman** became PM on **17 Feb 2026**	Sheikh Hasina was sentenced to death in absentia (17 Nov 2025)
Nepal	**Gen-Z protests** (Sep 2025) brought down the K.P. Sharma Oli government. **Sushila Karki**, a former Chief Justice, became **Nepal's first woman PM** (interim, 12 Sep 2025). In the election of **5 Mar 2026**, the **RSP won 182 of 275** seats, and **Balendra Shah** (ex-rapper and former Kathmandu mayor) was sworn in on **27 Mar 2026**	House of Representatives = 275 (165 FPTP + 110 PR)
Myanmar	Phased elections held under the junta (Dec 2025-Jan 2026). Junta chief **Min Aung Hlaing** was elected **President** by Parliament on **3 Apr 2026**	ASEAN's Five-Point Consensus (2021)
Sri Lanka	President **Anura Kumara Dissanayake** (NPP, since Sep 2024); PM **Harini Amarasuriya**	India-Sri Lanka defence MoU (Apr 2025)
Pakistan	PM Shehbaz Sharif, President Asif Ali Zardari. **Field Marshal Asim Munir** became the first **Chief of Defence Forces** under the 27th Amendment	-
Maldives	President **Mohamed Muizzu**. **Modi was guest of honour** at the **60th Independence Day** (26 Jul 2025)	-

4.14.1 Leaders in the September 2026 coverage period

Country / office	Leader	Essential distinction
United States	**Donald Trump**	47th President.
Japan	**Sanae Takaichi**	First woman Prime Minister, from October 2025.
Germany	**Friedrich Merz**	Chancellor, from May 2025.
Canada	**Mark Carney**	Prime Minister, from March 2025.
Australia	**Anthony Albanese**	Re-elected in May 2025.

Country / office	Leader	Essential distinction
South Korea	**Lee Jae-myung**	President, from June 2025.
Hungary	**Péter Magyar**	Elected in April 2026.
Bangladesh	**Tarique Rahman**	Prime Minister, from February 2026.
Nepal	**Balendra Shah**	Prime Minister, from March 2026.
Myanmar	**Min Aung Hlaing**	Elected President by Parliament in April 2026.
Sri Lanka	**Anura Kumara Dissanayake / Harini Amarasuriya**	President / Prime Minister.
Maldives	**Mohamed Muizzu**	President.
Vatican	**Pope Leo XIV**	Robert Francis Prevost; first US-born Pope.

F. India's Bilateral Diplomacy

4.18 India-Russia: partnership and economic links

- India and Russia describe their relationship as a **Special and Privileged Strategic Partnership**, established in **2010**. It includes **S-400 deliveries** and a **rupee-rouble trade mechanism**. The terminology identifies a bilateral relationship; it is different from India's membership of multilateral groupings such as BRICS or SCO.

4.19 India-China: a cautious thaw

- **Facts:** Modi went to **Tianjin** for the SCO summit (Aug-Sep 2025), his **first China visit in 7 years**. Direct flights **resumed on 26 Oct 2025**, and the **Kailash Mansarovar Yatra resumed** in Jun 2025. India has raised concerns about China's **Medog (Yarlung Tsangpo) mega-dam**, whose construction began in **Jul 2025**.
- **Ladakh link:** The thaw rests on the **Oct 2024 disengagement agreement** covering **Depsang and Demchok** (Eastern Ladakh). The Special Representatives' talks have resumed.

  Static link: The **Yarlung Tsangpo** becomes the **Siang** in Arunachal Pradesh and the **Brahmaputra** in Assam.

4.20.1 India-Afghanistan: back in Kabul

- **Facts:** Taliban Foreign Minister **Amir Khan Muttaqi** visited India in **Oct 2025**, the first such visit since 2021. India announced that its **technical mission in Kabul would be upgraded to an embassy**. India helped after the **Kunar earthquake** (Aug-Sep 2025).

05 Science and Technology

Missions, discoveries and technologies connected to concise static science.

A. S&T Who's Who

Post	Holder	Note
ISRO Chairman and Secretary, Dept of Space	**V. Narayanan**	Since 14 Jan 2025 (succeeded S. Somanath). A cryogenic-propulsion expert
IN-SPACe Chairman	**Pawan Goenka**	Regulator and promoter of private space activity
DRDO Chairman	**Samir V. Kamat**	-
Principal Scientific Adviser	**Ajay Kumar Sood**	-
ICMR Director-General	**Rajiv Bahl**	-
CSIR Director-General	**N. Kalaiselvi**	First woman DG of CSIR
Union Minister for S&T (MoS, Independent Charge); MoS for Space and Atomic Energy	**Jitendra Singh**	MP from **Udhampur (J&K)**

B. Space: ISRO Missions 2025-26

5.1 ISRO launch scoreboard

Static link: **PSLV** has **4 stages** (solid-liquid-solid-liquid: PS1 solid, PS2 liquid **Vikas**, PS3 solid, PS4 liquid). **GSLV Mk II** has an indigenous **cryogenic** upper stage. **LVM3** (formerly GSLV Mk III) has the **CE-20** cryogenic engine and launched Chandrayaan-3. Sriharikota is in **Tirupati district, Andhra Pradesh**. A **third launch pad** there was approved in Jan 2025.

Rocket / mission / Payload	Result	Hook
PSLV-C60 / **SpaDeX**; SDX-01 (Chaser), SDX-02 (Target)	**Docking on 16 Jan 2025**	India became the **4th country** to dock in space (after the USA, Russia and China). ****
PSLV-C61; EOS-09 (radar imaging)	**Third stage** failure	-
GSLV-F16; **NISAR**		First GSLV to a **sun-synchronous** orbit. NASA-ISRO joint satellite
LVM3-M5; **CMS-03** (≈4,410 kg; Navy's GSAT-7R)		**Heaviest communication satellite** launched from Indian soil

Rocket / mission / Payload	Result	Hook
LVM3-M6; **BlueBird Block-2** (AST SpaceMobile, USA)		**Heaviest payload** ever put up by LVM3 (≈6,100 kg, to LEO). Commercial (NSIL)
PSLV-C62; **EOS-N1** (DRDO's "**Anvesha**" hyperspectral) + 14 co-passengers	**Third-stage (PS3)** chamber-pressure drop	A second consecutive PSLV failure
GSLV-F17 (19th GSLV flight); **EOS-05 / GISAT-1A** (≈2,367 kg)		**India's first imaging satellite in geosynchronous orbit. ISRO's first success of 2026**, ending the "GISAT jinx" (GISAT-1 was lost in 2021)

5.2 Axiom-4 and Shubhanshu Shukla

- **Facts: Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla** (IAF; from Lucknow) flew as **pilot** of **Axiom Mission 4**. It launched on **25 Jun 2025** from Kennedy Space Center on a **Falcon 9**, in the Crew Dragon "**Grace**", **docked with the ISS on 26 Jun**, and **splashed down off California on 15 Jul 2025**.
- **Firsts:** The **first Indian aboard the ISS** and the **second Indian in space** (after **Rakesh Sharma**, 1984, Soyuz T-11).
- **Crew: Peggy Whitson** (USA, commander), **Sławosz Uznański** (Poland) and **Tibor Kapu** (Hungary). Poland and Hungary were also returning to space after decades.
- **Gaganyaan astronaut-designates: Prasanth Balakrishnan Nair, Ajit Krishnan, Angad Pratap, Shubhanshu Shukla**.

5.3 NISAR: NASA-ISRO Synthetic Aperture Radar

- **Facts:** Launched on **30 Jul 2025** by **GSLV-F16** into a **sun-synchronous polar orbit**. It is the first satellite with **dual-frequency radar**: **L-band (NASA)** and **S-band (ISRO)**. At about **$1.5 billion**, it is among the costliest Earth-observation satellites.
- **Uses:** It maps Earth's land and ice about **every 12 days**, tracking earthquakes, landslides, glaciers (Himalayas, including J&K and Ladakh), crops, forests and soil moisture.

5.4 Human-spaceflight programmes: objective and target

- **Facts: Gaganyaan G1 is an uncrewed orbital test** associated with the humanoid **Vyommitra**; the later H1 flight is the crewed stage. A programme target is not an achieved launch.
- **Facts:** The **Bharatiya Antariksh Station (BAS)** is planned as a **five-module low-Earth-orbit station**. The approved targets are **BAS-1 by 2028**, a full station by **2035**, and an Indian lunar mission by **2040**.

  Static link: **Chandrayaan-4** concerns lunar sample return; **Chandrayaan-5/LUPEX** is a collaboration with Japan's **JAXA**. The **Venus Orbiter Mission** and **Next Generation Launch Vehicle** are distinct programmes.

5.5 Private space: Skyroot's Vikram-1 reaches orbit (Jul 2026)

- **Facts: Skyroot Aerospace** (Hyderabad) launched **Vikram-1** from Sriharikota on **17-18 Jul 2026**. It put its payload into a **≈450 km orbit** about 15 minutes after lift-off. This was **India's first private orbital launch**.

- **Background:** Skyroot's **Vikram-S** (Nov 2022) was India's first **private sub-orbital** rocket. **Agnibaan SOrTeD** (Agnikul, May 2024) was the first with a **semi-cryogenic** engine and a **3D-printed** engine, launched from India's first **private launchpad** (Dhanush). The rockets are named after **Vikram Sarabhai**.

  Static link: The **Indian Space Policy 2023**. **IN-SPACe** authorises private launches. **NSIL** is ISRO's commercial arm.

5.6 Global space milestones 2025-26

Mission	Agency	Key fact
Artemis II	NASA (+ CSA)	Launched **1 Apr 2026** from KSC; flew around the Moon (far side on 6 Apr); **splashed down on 10 Apr 2026** off San Diego. Crew: **Reid Wiseman, Victor Glover, Christina Koch, Jeremy Hansen** (Canada). The first crewed lunar flight since **Apollo 17 (1972)**. Artemis III (2027) will practise docking in Earth orbit; **Artemis IV** aims for a south-pole landing (2028)
3I/ATLAS	ATLAS survey (Chile)	Found 1 Jul 2025. The **third interstellar object** seen, after ʻOumuamua (2017) and Borisov (2019)
Tianwen-2	China (CNSA)	Launched May 2025 to bring back samples from the asteroid **Kamoʻoalewa**
Vera C. Rubin Observatory	US (Chile)	First images in Jun 2025. Running the Legacy Survey of Space and Time

C. Digital, AI, Semiconductors and Quantum

5.7 India AI Impact Summit 2026 and the IndiaAI Mission

- **Summit:** The **India AI Impact Summit** was held at **Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi**, on **15-20 Feb 2026**, with the leaders' segment on 19-20 Feb. It was the **first** summit in this series hosted in the **Global South**.
- **The series:** Bletchley Park (UK, 2023, "AI Safety") → Seoul (2024) → Paris (Feb 2025, "**AI Action Summit**", co-chaired by **India and France**) → **New Delhi (2026, "Impact")** → **Geneva (2027)** → **UAE (2028)**.
- **Sovereign AI: Sarvam AI** (the first start-up chosen to build India's sovereign foundation model, in Apr 2025) and **BharatGen's Param-2** were showcased.
- **IndiaAI Mission:** Approved Mar 2024 with **₹10,371.92 crore**. It has 7 pillars, including compute (over **38,000 GPUs** offered at subsidised rates), the **AIKosh** datasets platform, foundation models and the IndiaAI FutureSkills programme.

5.8 Semiconductors: from the first chip to commercial production

- **Milestones:** At **Semicon India 2025** (2-4 Sep 2025, Yashobhoomi, New Delhi), the PM received **Vikram 3201**, an indigenous **32-bit space-grade processor** made at **ISRO's Semi-Conductor Lab (SCL), Mohali**. In **2026**, commercial **ATMP/OSAT** production began. **Micron (Sanand, Gujarat)** was **first**, and **CG Semi (Sanand)** became the **third** venture to start commercial production.
- **Big projects: Tata Electronics-PSMC fab at Dholera** (India's first commercial fab, under construction) · Tata's **Jagiroad (Assam)** OSAT · Kaynes (Sanand) · HCL-Foxconn (Jewar, UP).

  Static link: The **India Semiconductor Mission** (2021, ₹76,000 crore) sits under **MeitY**, with 50% fiscal support from the Centre for approved fabs and OSATs.

5.9 National Quantum Mission

- **Facts:** The **National Quantum Mission**, for **2023-31**, has an outlay of **₹6,003.65 crore** and is implemented by the **Department of Science and Technology**.

  Static link: Its work covers quantum computing, communication, sensing and materials. **A qubit is a quantum bit**, associated with superposition of 0 and 1.
- **Remember: DST runs the mission, not MeitY**. Thematic hubs are at **IISc Bengaluru, IIT Madras, IIT Bombay and IIT Delhi**.

D. Nuclear, Energy Tech and Materials

5.10 PFBR Kalpakkam reaches first criticality (6 Apr 2026)

- **Facts:** The **500 MWe Prototype Fast Breeder Reactor** at **Kalpakkam (Tamil Nadu)** reached **first criticality on 6 Apr 2026**. It was built by **BHAVINI** and is the start of **stage two** of India's nuclear programme.

  Static link: The **three-stage programme (Homi J. Bhabha)**:

  - 1. PHWRs using natural uranium.
  - 2. Fast breeders using **plutonium-based MOX** fuel, with a **thorium blanket** that breeds **U-233**.
  - 3. **Thorium**-based reactors. India has one of the largest thorium reserves (monazite sands of Kerala and Odisha).
- **Policy:** The **SHANTI Act 2025** opened the sector to private players (Chapter 2). The **Nuclear Energy Mission** (Budget 2025-26) targets **5 indigenous SMRs by 2033** and **100 GW** of nuclear power by **2047**.

5.11 J&K and Ladakh S&T hooks

- **Hanle (Ladakh):** The **Indian Astronomical Observatory** (IIA). The **MACE** gamma-ray telescope (2024) is the **world's highest imaging Cherenkov telescope**, at about 4,300 m. **Hanle Dark Sky Reserve** (2022) was **India's first**.
- **Puga Valley (Ladakh):** India's first **geothermal** power pilot (ONGC).
- **Reasi (J&K):** Inferred **lithium** resources of about **5.9 million tonnes** (GSI, 2023). Auction attempts have **not** yet succeeded.
- **Chenab Bridge:** The world's highest railway arch bridge (359 m above the river), opened Jun 2025 (Chapter 1).

E. Biotech and Health

5.12 Biotech and health milestones 2025-26

Item	What and who	Hook
Genome-edited rice (May 2025)	**DRR Dhan 100 (Kamala)** and **Pusa DST Rice 1** by **ICAR**: the **world's first genome-edited rice varieties** to be released	CRISPR-Cas. SDN-1/SDN-2 edits contain **no foreign DNA**, so they are exempt from GM rules (2022)
AdFalciVax (2025)	**ICMR**'s indigenous **multi-stage malaria vaccine** candidate, offered to industry	It targets *Plasmodium falciparum*
Measles-Rubella	The national **Zero MR Elimination Campaign 2025-26** targets elimination by **2026**	**U-WIN** immunisation registry
Nafithromycin ("Miqnaf")	India's **first indigenous antibiotic** (for community-acquired pneumonia)	BIRAC support
BioE3 policy (Aug 2024)	Biotechnology for Economy, Environment and Employment	Biomanufacturing hubs
Trachoma	WHO declared India free of trachoma as a public health problem (Oct 2024)	Kala-azar is near elimination

F. Nobel Prizes in Science

5.13 Nobel Prizes 2025: science

Prize	Laureates	Discovery / contribution
Physics	**John Clarke, Michel H. Devoret, John M. Martinis**	**Macroscopic quantum tunnelling and energy quantisation in an electric circuit**.
Chemistry	**Susumu Kitagawa, Richard Robson, Omar M. Yaghi**	**Metal-organic frameworks (MOFs)**.
Physiology or Medicine	**Mary E. Brunkow, Fred Ramsdell, Shimon Sakaguchi**	**Peripheral immune tolerance**, including regulatory T cells.

5.13.1 Nobel science: one clean distinction

- **Remember: MOFs → Chemistry; quantum tunnelling → Physics; regulatory T cells → Medicine.** Shimon Sakaguchi's association is regulatory T cells, not CRISPR or mRNA vaccines.

G. S&T Terms in the News

Term	Meaning
SpaDeX	Space Docking Experiment (PSLV-C60)
NISAR	NASA-ISRO Synthetic Aperture Radar
BAS	Bharatiya Antariksh Station
NGLV	Next Generation Launch Vehicle ("Soorya")
SMR	Small Modular Reactor (up to about 300 MWe)
PFBR	Prototype Fast Breeder Reactor (Kalpakkam)
ATMP / OSAT	Assembly, Testing, Marking & Packaging / Outsourced Semiconductor Assembly & Test
Qubit	Quantum bit (superposition of 0 and 1)
Hyperspectral imaging	Imaging in hundreds of narrow bands (e.g., "Anvesha")
SDN-1/2	Site-Directed Nuclease genome editing **without** foreign DNA

H. Current events and scientific vocabulary

5.14 Science and health: essential terms

Term	What it is	Domain	Hook
CRISPR-Cas9	Gene-editing "molecular scissors"	Biotechnology	**Nobel Chemistry 2020** (Charpentier and Doudna)
mRNA / viral vector / subunit	Three vaccine platforms	Health	mRNA: genetic instructions; viral vector: harmless carrier virus; subunit: purified protein piece
LLM / GPU / inference	Large Language Model · Graphics Processing Unit · running a trained model	AI	IndiaAI Mission (**2024**, ₹10,371.92 crore)
Qubit / superposition / entanglement	Basic units and properties of quantum computing	**National Quantum Mission** (**2023**, ₹6,003.65 crore, 2023-24 to 2030-31)	A qubit can be in a **superposition of the 0 and 1 basis states**
Lagrange points (L1-L5)	Points where the gravity of two bodies balances an object's orbit	Space	**Aditya-L1** sits in a halo orbit around **Sun-Earth L1**, about **1.5 million km** from Earth
AMR	Antimicrobial resistance	Health (**One Health**)	WHO's "silent pandemic"
Zoonosis / spillover	Disease jumping from animals to humans	Epidemiology	Nipah, Mpox, H5N1

06 Environment and Ecology

Kashmir's ecology, India's conservation milestones and the climate-economy connection.

A. Environment Who's Who

Post	Holder	Note
Union Minister, Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC)	**Bhupender Yadav**	Presented the Swachh Vayu Survekshan awards in Sep 2025 and Sep 2026
MoS, MoEFCC	**Kirti Vardhan Singh**	-
UNFCCC Executive Secretary	**Simon Stiell** (Grenada)	Secretariat in **Bonn**
COP30 President (Belém, 2025)	**André Corrêa do Lago** (Brazil)	-
COP31 (Antalya, 2026)	**Murat Kurum** (Türkiye), COP President · **Chris Bowen** (Australia), "President of Negotiations"	A split arrangement agreed at COP30
UNEP Executive Director	**Inger Andersen**	UNEP HQ is in **Nairobi**
WMO Secretary-General	**Celeste Saulo** (Argentina)	First woman WMO SG
IUCN President	**Razan Al Mubarak** (UAE)	**Re-elected Oct 2025** at Abu Dhabi. The first IUCN president from West Asia
IUCN Director-General	**Grethel Aguilar**	IUCN HQ is in **Gland, Switzerland**
Ramsar Secretary-General	**Musonda Mumba**	Secretariat in Gland
CITES Secretary-General	**Ivonne Higuero**	Secretariat in Geneva
CBD Executive Secretary	**Astrid Schomaker**	Secretariat in Montreal
IBCA Director-General	**S.P. Yadav**	IBCA HQ is in **New Delhi**
IMD Director-General	**Mrutyunjay Mohapatra**	-

B. J&K and Ladakh: Environment and Ecology

6.1 Kashmir's "snow drought", winter 2025-26

- **In focus:** Kashmir had one of its driest winters on record. IMD data showed **December 2025 precipitation 77.5% below normal**. In **January 2026**, every district recorded a departure of **-50% to -100%**. Much of **Chillai Kalan** stayed dry.

- **Facts:** Low snowpack means lower **spring discharge in the Jhelum**, stress on **saffron, horticulture and paddy**, a higher **forest-fire** risk, drinking-water shortages, and lower **hydropower** output in winter.
- **Background (static):** Kashmir's winter is split into **Chillai Kalan** (40 days, **21 Dec - 29 Jan**), then **Chillai Khurd** (20 days) and **Chillai Bachha** (10 days). Winter precipitation comes mainly from **Western Disturbances**, which originate over the **Mediterranean**.

6.2 Heat records and climate disasters in J&K

- **2025 disasters:** the **Chasoti (Kishtwar) cloudburst** on 14 Aug 2025 (Machail Mata yatra) and the **Ardhkuwari landslide** on the Vaishno Devi track on 26 Aug 2025, amid the Aug-Sep 2025 floods in Jammu (Tawi, Chenab, Ravi).

  Static link: A **cloudburst** is **≥100 mm of rain in an hour** over a small area (about 20-30 km²), as defined by IMD.

6.3 Wetlands and birds of Kashmir: AWC 2026

- **In focus:** The **Asian Waterbird Census (AWC) 2026** was carried out in Feb 2026 across **27 wetlands of Kashmir**, including Hokersar, Shallabugh, Haigam (Hygam), Wular, Dal, Anchar and Nigeen.
- **Ramsar sites: J&K has 5**: Wular (1990), Hokersar (2005), Surinsar-Mansar (2005), Hygam (2022) and Shallabugh (2022). **Ladakh has 2**: Tso Moriri (2002) and Tso Kar (2020).
- **Facts: Hokersar** is the "Queen of Wetlands", known for its **reedbeds**. **Wular** is India's **largest freshwater lake** and is fed by the **Jhelum**. **Dal Lake is NOT a Ramsar site.** Its outflow goes to the Jhelum, so it is **not endorheic**.

  Static link: The AWC is coordinated by **Wetlands International** and runs each **January-February**. Kashmir sits on the **Central Asian Flyway (CAF)**.

6.4 Ladakh: snow leopard, cold-desert wildlife and Yaya Tso

- **Snow leopard:** India's first national estimate (**SPAI**, Jan 2024) counted **718**: **Ladakh 477**, Uttarakhand 124, Himachal 51, Arunachal 36, Sikkim 21 and **J&K 9**. **Ladakh holds about two-thirds.** IUCN status: **Vulnerable**.
- **Ladakh's state symbols (2021):** state animal **snow leopard**, state bird **black-necked crane**.
  - **Hemis National Park (Leh)** is often called India's largest national park and the "snow leopard capital". **Changthang Wildlife Sanctuary** has the kiang, the black-necked crane and the Pashmina (Changra) goat.

6.5 Glaciers and GLOF risk in the Himalaya

- **In focus:** The NDMA's **National GLOF Risk Mitigation Programme** targets **195 high-risk glacial lakes** in Sikkim, Uttarakhand, HP, Arunachal, **J&K and Ladakh**, with an outlay of about ₹**150 crore** (early-warning systems, lowering lake levels, monitoring).
- **UN framing: 2025 = International Year of Glaciers' Preservation. 21 March = World Day for Glaciers** (first observed in 2025). **2025-2034 = Decade of Action for Cryospheric Sciences.**

  Static link: A GLOF is the sudden release of water from a moraine- or ice-dammed glacial lake. The textbook case is the **South Lhonak (Sikkim) GLOF, Oct 2023**. Major Kashmir glaciers include **Kolahoi** (the Lidder's source) and **Thajiwas** (Sonamarg).

6.6 Ladakh as a green-energy hub

- **13 GW renewable project at Pang (Leh):** solar and wind with about **12 GWh of battery storage**. The power is evacuated through **Green Energy Corridor Phase-II** (an inter-state transmission system), including an **HVDC line from Pang to Kaithal (Haryana)**. The Cabinet approved it in **Oct 2023** at a cost of about ₹**20,773.7 crore**, with **40% central financial assistance**. The target is **FY 2029-30**.
  - Related sites: **Puga Valley geothermal** (ONGC pilot) and **Hanle**, India's first **Dark Sky Reserve**. See Chapter 5.
- **FAA angle:** Central financial assistance (CFA) as a share of project cost, the inter-state transmission system (ISTS), and viability-gap and battery-storage financing are possible economy questions.

C. Climate Change: Negotiations, Targets and Science

6.7 COP30, Belém (Brazil): the "Global Mutirão"

- **In focus: COP30** was held in **Belém** (Pará, at the mouth of the Amazon) from **10 to 21 Nov 2025** and was **extended to 22 Nov**. It was the **first COP in the Amazon**, a decade after Paris. President: **André Corrêa do Lago**.
- **Core outcome:** the **"Global Mutirão"** decision. *Mutirão* is a Tupi-Guarani word for collective community effort. It is part of the **Belém Political Package**.
- **Key decisions:** a call to **at least triple adaptation finance by 2035** · the **Global Implementation Accelerator** and the **"Belém Mission to 1.5°C"** · indicators for the **Global Goal on Adaptation** · the **Belém Gender Action Plan (2026-2034)** · work on a **just-transition mechanism** · the transition of Kyoto-era CDM activities into the **Paris Agreement Crediting Mechanism** (Article 6.4) · **dialogues on unilateral trade measures** (CBAM-type) up to 2028.
- **What failed:** there is **no fossil-fuel phase-out roadmap** in the decision text. Brazil's Presidency will bring **two voluntary roadmaps** (transition away from fossil fuels, and deforestation) to COP31. About **24 countries** signed a separate Belém Declaration on transitioning away from fossil fuels.
- **Side initiative:** the **Tropical Forest Forever Facility (TFFF)**, with a **$125 bn** target corpus, about **$6.7 bn** pledged at launch, and the **World Bank** as trustee. It sits **outside the UNFCCC decision**.
- **Static link (COP ladder):** COP3 Kyoto 1997 (Protocol) → COP21 Paris 2015 (Agreement) → COP26 Glasgow 2021 (Pact; coal "**phase-down**"; Panchamrit) → COP27 Sharm el-Sheikh 2022 (**Loss and Damage Fund agreed**) → COP28 Dubai 2023 (**first Global Stocktake**; "transition away from fossil fuels") → COP29 Baku 2024 (**NCQG: $300 bn/yr by 2035**, within a $1.3 tn goal) → COP30 Belém 2025 (**Mutirão**).

6.9 India's NDC 2031-35 (NDC 3.0)

- **In focus:** The **Union Cabinet approved India's NDC for 2031-35 on 25 Mar 2026**. It was then communicated to the UNFCCC in **Apr 2026**.
- **Adaptation pillars named in the NDC:** mangrove restoration, cyclone early warning, **glacier monitoring in Himalayan states**, GLOF and landslide-resilient infrastructure, and **Heat Action Plans**.
- **Critique:** Climate Action Tracker says it is achievable but has **no absolute emissions cap** and **no peaking year**.

- **FAA angle:** The NDC links to the **Carbon Credit Trading Scheme**, **sovereign green bonds**, Green Hydrogen Mission financing and **BRSR** (business responsibility and sustainability reporting) disclosures.

Element	2015 INDC (for 2030) / 2022 updated NDC (for 2030)	NDC 2031-35 (for 2035)	Achieved so far
Emissions intensity of GDP (vs **2005**)	33-35% cut; 45% cut	**47% cut**	**36%** (2005-2020)
Non-fossil share of **installed electric capacity**	40%; 50%	**60%**	**52.57%** (Feb 2026)
Additional carbon sink (forest and tree cover)	2.5-3 bn t CO_2e; 2.5-3 bn t CO_2e	**3.5-4.0 bn t CO_2e**	2.29 bn t (by 2021)
Long-term goal	-; Net zero **2070** (Panchamrit, COP26)	Net zero **2070**	-

6.10 USA exits the climate regime

- **In focus:** The USA's **second Paris withdrawal**, ordered in Jan 2025, **took effect on 27 Jan 2026**. On **7 Jan 2026** it announced withdrawal from the **UNFCCC**, the **IPCC** and more than 60 other bodies, including the **International Solar Alliance**, IUCN and IPBES.
- **Law:** Under **UNFCCC Art. 25**, withdrawal takes effect **one year after notice**. Leaving the UNFCCC also means leaving the Paris Agreement. Under **Paris Art. 28**, withdrawal also takes effect one year after notice.
- **History:** Kyoto rejection (2001) → first Paris exit (2017 announcement, effective Nov 2020) → rejoined (Feb 2021) → second exit (2025-26) → UNFCCC exit (2026-27). The USA is the **first country to announce an exit from the UNFCCC itself**.

6.11 Climate science reports, 2025-26

Report	Publisher, date	Headline
State of the Global Climate 2025	**WMO**, 23 Mar 2026	2025 was the **2nd or 3rd warmest** year, about **1.43°C** above 1850-1900. **2015-2025 are the 11 warmest years on record.** Earth's energy imbalance is the highest on record
Emissions Gap Report 2025: "Off Target"	**UNEP**, 4 Nov 2025	Full NDCs lead to **2.3-2.5°C**; current policies to **2.8°C**
Global Tipping Points Report 2025	Exeter-led, 160+ scientists, 13 Oct 2025	**Warm-water coral reefs** are the **first tipping point crossed**

6.12 El Niño 2026, a deficient monsoon, heat and cyclones

- **El Niño: NOAA declared on 11 Jun 2026 that El Niño had formed.** It gives a >90% chance of a **very strong** event in the 2026-27 winter.

- **Monsoon 2026:** IMD's updated forecast (29 May 2026) was **90% of the LPA** (below normal). The season (Jun-Sep) **ended 12.6% short: about 759 mm against a normal of 868.6 mm (≈87% of LPA)**. That falls in the **"deficient"** category (<90% of LPA) and is the weakest season in more than a decade. In 2026, IMD used **two AI-enabled monsoon forecast models** for the first time.
- **IMD categories (static):** deficient <90% · below normal 90-95% · **normal 96-104%** · above normal 105-110% · excess >110%. **The LPA is 87 cm** (1971-2020 average).
- **Cyclones 2026: No named cyclonic storm had formed in the North Indian Ocean by 30 Sep 2026** (7 depressions, 4 of them deep). **BOB 06 (21-27 Sep 2026)** was only a **deep depression** that brought floods to UP, Odisha and AP. **The viral "Cyclone Arnab" was not an official name.** The next names on the list are **Arnab** (Bangladesh), **Murasu** (India), **Akvan** (Iran), **Kaani** (Maldives) and **Ngamann** (Myanmar).
- **FAA angle:** A deficient monsoon hits **kharif output**, raises **food inflation** (CPI) and weakens **rural demand**. These effects influence **RBI MPC decisions**, **reservoir levels**, **hydropower** and the **fiscal** cost of relief.

6.13 Carbon markets: India's CCTS and Article 6

- **In focus:** On **21 Mar 2026**, Power Minister **Manohar Lal** launched the **Indian Carbon Market (ICM) Portal** at the **Prakriti 2026** conference, New Delhi. It handles registration, monitoring/reporting/verification (MRV), and **issuing Carbon Credit Certificates (CCCs)**.
- **Compliance targets:** GHG emission-intensity targets now cover **7 sectors** (aluminium, cement, chlor-alkali, pulp and paper, and others). Entities that beat their targets earn CCCs; those that fall short must **buy and surrender** CCCs.
- **Architecture: Carbon Credit Trading Scheme, 2023** (under the **Energy Conservation Act, 2001**, amended in 2022) · administrator **Bureau of Energy Efficiency (BEE)** · registry **Grid-India** · trading regulator **CERC** · trading on the **power exchanges**.
- **Article 6 (Paris):** Art 6.2 covers bilateral deals (ITMOs). Art 6.4 is the UN-run **Paris Agreement Crediting Mechanism (PACM)**, which replaces the Kyoto CDM. COP30 operationalised the CDM-to-PACM transition.

D. Biodiversity, Land and Ocean Conventions

6.14 UNCCD COP17, Ulaanbaatar (17-28 Aug 2026)

- **In focus:** The first COP of the **2026 Triple-COP year**, held in **Mongolia** under the theme **"Restoring Land. Restoring Hope."** About **15,000** participants attended.
- **Outcomes: 34 decisions**, including on **rangelands and pastoralists** (recognising the **Coalition of Rangeland States**), **sand and dust storms**, land tenure and the Science-Policy Interface. **No agreement on a legally binding drought instrument.** Drought becomes a **stand-alone agenda item from COP18**. **COP18 → Egypt, 2028.**
- **Context: 2026 = International Year of Rangelands and Pastoralists.** Rangelands cover about **54%** of the world's land.

  Static link: UNCCD was adopted in **1994 (Paris)** and entered into force in **1996**. Secretariat: **Bonn**. **India hosted COP14 (Greater Noida, 2019)**. COP16 was in **Riyadh** (2024). India's target is to **restore 26 million ha of degraded land by 2030**.

6.14.1 Land restoration and biodiversity

- **Facts: UNCCD COP17** used the theme **Restoring Land. Restoring Hope.** India's restoration target is **26 million hectares of degraded land by 2030**.

  Static link: The **Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework** has **4 goals and 23 targets**, including **30×30**: conserve 30% of land and sea by 2030.

  Static link: The **UNCCD**, adopted at **Paris in 1994**, entered into force in **1996** and has its secretariat in **Bonn**. India hosted **COP14 at Greater Noida in 2019**. The **CBD** was adopted at Rio in 1992 and has its secretariat in **Montreal**. These two Rio-convention families concern different problems: degraded land and biodiversity.

- **Facts:** The biodiversity framework was agreed at **CBD COP15, Montreal, 2022**. **COP16**, held in **Cali** and resumed in **Rome**, created the **Cali Fund** for digital sequence information. India's updated **National Biodiversity Strategy and Action Plan** has **23 national targets**. A biological-data finance mechanism is distinct from the land-restoration commitments considered under UNCCD.

6.16 CMS COP15, Ramsar COP15, CITES CoP20

Meeting	Venue, dates	Key points
CMS COP15 (Bonn Convention, 1979)	**Campo Grande, Brazil**, 23-29 Mar 2026 (first CMS COP in Brazil, at the edge of the Pantanal)	Interim **State of the World's Migratory Species 2026**: **49%** of CMS-listed populations are declining and **24%** of listed species face extinction. Action plan for **Amazonian migratory catfish**. **India hosted CMS COP13 (Gandhinagar, 2020; mascot "Gibi", the Great Indian Bustard)**
Ramsar COP15 (Ramsar, Iran, 1971)	**Victoria Falls, Zimbabwe**, 23-31 Jul 2025	Adopted the **5th Strategic Plan (2025-2034)**. **Indore and Udaipur** became India's first accredited **Wetland Cities** (announced Jan 2025)
CITES CoP20 (Washington, 1973; in force 1975)	**Samarkand, Uzbekistan**, 24 Nov-5 Dec 2025 (first in Central Asia; 50 years of CITES in force)	A genus-wide framework for **anguillid eels**, a **jaguar** resolution, and debates on saiga, rhino and elephant trade proposals. **India joined CITES in 1976.** Secretariat: Geneva

6.17 IUCN Congress and the Red List update

- **IUCN World Conservation Congress, Abu Dhabi, 9-15 Oct 2025. Razan Al Mubarak** was re-elected President.
- **Red List update (Oct 2025): 172,620** species assessed, of which **48,646** are threatened. The **green turtle** has recovered (moved to **Least Concern**). **Three Arctic seal species** are more threatened because of climate change. **61% of bird species** are declining. The IUCN's first **Green Status** assessment of the **tiger** rated it **"Critically Depleted"**.

  Static link: IUCN was founded in **1948 (Fontainebleau)**; HQ **Gland**. Red List categories: EX, EW, **CR, EN, VU** (the three "threatened" categories), NT, LC, DD, NE.

6.18 Oceans and plastics

- **UN Ocean Conference 3: Nice (France), Jun 2025**, co-hosted by **France and Costa Rica**. UNOC4 (2028) will be co-hosted by **Chile and the Republic of Korea**.

E. India: Wildlife, Protected Areas and Heritage

6.19 Ramsar sites: India crosses 100

- **In focus: 100th site: Surha Tal (Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary), Ballia, UP**, announced around **World Environment Day 2026** and hailed by the PM. **101st site: Glaw Lake, Arunachal Pradesh (3 Aug 2026)**, the state's **first**. It is a freshwater lake inside the **Kamlang Tiger Reserve**, with 150+ tree species and 49 orchid species.
- **Growth: 26 sites (2014) → 101 (Aug 2026).** Early-2026 additions included **Patna Bird Sanctuary** (Etah, UP) and **Chhari-Dhand** (Kutch, Gujarat).
- **Rankings: Tamil Nadu** has the most sites (**20**), then **UP**. India is **1st in Asia** and **3rd in the world** by number of sites (after the **UK and Mexico**).
- **Firsts by state: 2025:** Jharkhand (**Udhwa Lake**), Sikkim (**Khecheopalri**), Chhattisgarh (**Kopra Jalashay**). **2026:** Arunachal (**Glaw Lake**).
- **Static superlatives:** first sites **Chilika and Keoladeo (1981)** · largest **Sundarbans** · smallest **Renuka** · largest freshwater lake **Wular** · on the **Montreux Record**: **Keoladeo and Loktak**.

6.20 UNESCO: Sarnath (45th WHS) and Cold Desert (13th Biosphere Reserve)

- **Sarnath:** The "**Ancient Buddhist Site, Sarnath**" (Varanasi, UP) was inscribed on **25 Jul 2026** at the **48th World Heritage Committee session, Busan (South Korea)**. It is **India's 45th WHS** (cultural). The property covers the **Chaukhandi Stupa** and the **Archaeological Remains of Sarnath** (the **Dhamek** and **Dharmarajika** stupas). Together they form the historic **Deer Park**, also called **Rishipatana, Isipatana or Mrigadava**. The **Buddha gave his first sermon** here. The session inscribed **25 new sites**, bringing the list to **1,248 properties in 170 countries**.
- **India's recent run: Moidams (Assam), 2024 = 43rd** (46th session, **New Delhi**) → **Maratha Military Landscapes, 2025 = 44th** (47th session, **Paris**; 12 forts) → **Sarnath, 2026 = 45th** (48th session, **Busan**). India has **7 natural** sites and **1 mixed** site (**Khangchendzonga**).
- **Cold Desert Biosphere Reserve (Himachal: Spiti and Lahaul):** In **Sep 2025** it became **India's 13th** reserve in UNESCO's **World Network of Biosphere Reserves**, at the **5th World Congress of Biosphere Reserves, Hangzhou, China**. It is the first **high-altitude cold-desert** reserve in the network (Pin Valley NP, Kibber, Chandratal). India has **18 biosphere reserves** in total.
- **Other UNESCO 2025 hooks: Deepavali** was added to the Intangible Cultural Heritage list in **Dec 2025**, at the committee session held at the **Red Fort, New Delhi**. **Lucknow** was named a **Creative City of Gastronomy** (2025). **Srinagar** is a Creative City of **Crafts and Folk Arts** (2021), a J&K link.

6.21 Tigers: 58 reserves, AITE-2026 and record deaths

- **58 tiger reserves.** The **58th is Madhav (MP), Mar 2025**. Before it: 57th **Ratapani** (MP), 56th **Guru Ghasidas-Tamor Pingla** (Chhattisgarh). **MP now has 9 TRs.** The **MEETR 2026** management-effectiveness evaluation covers all 58 and adds a **solid-waste criterion**.

Static link: **Project Tiger began on 1 Apr 1973. NTCA** is a statutory body under the **WPA 1972, as amended in 2006**.

6.22 Project Cheetah: Botswana batch, Gandhi Sagar and Banni

- **Timeline: 17 Sep 2022**: 8 cheetahs from **Namibia** to **Kuno NP (MP)** · **Feb 2023**: 12 from **South Africa** · **20 Apr 2025**: 2 males moved to **Gandhi Sagar WLS** (Mandsaur-Neemuch, MP), the 2nd site · **28 Feb 2026**: **9 cheetahs from Botswana** arrive at Kuno (count rises to 48) · **20 Sep 2026**: a Botswana female (CCB-2) is released into Gandhi Sagar.

6.23 International Big Cat Alliance and the first Big Cat Summit

- **IBCA:** Launched on **9 Apr 2023** (Project Tiger at 50) and in force as a **treaty-based body from 23 Jan 2025**. HQ **New Delhi**. It covers **7 big cats**: tiger, lion, leopard, snow leopard, cheetah, **jaguar and puma**. The **clouded leopard is excluded**. India committed **₹150 crore** over 5 years.

6.24 Wildlife census scoreboard

Species	Latest figure	Released	Key detail
Hangul (J&K)	**323**	2025 census (reported Jan 2026)	Up from 289 (2023) and 261 (2021). Dachigam. **JA 2026 PYQ**
Snow leopard	**718** (Ladakh **477**)	SPAI, Jan 2024	First national estimate
Tiger	**3,682**	2022 (released Jul 2023)	AITE-2026 results due in 2027
Asiatic lion	**891**	**May 2025** (16th estimation)	Up **32.2%** from 674 (2020). Gir and the Saurashtra landscape
Elephant	**22,446** (range 18,255-26,645)	**14 Oct 2025** (SAIEE)	**First DNA-based count**. Lower than 27,312 (2017) because the method changed. **Karnataka** has the most
River dolphins	**6,327** (Ganges 6,324 + **Indus 3**, Beas, Punjab)	**Mar 2025**	First riverine dolphin estimate. **UP** has the most
Cheetah	**52** (32 born in India)	Sep 2026	Kuno and Gandhi Sagar

6.25 Great Indian Bustard: the SC judgment of 19 Dec 2025

- **Background:** The SC's 2021 blanket order to **underground** lines was modified in **Mar 2024** (*M.K. Ranjitsinh*). That 2024 order also recognised a **right against the adverse effects of climate change** under **Articles 14 and 21**.

  Static link: The GIB is **Critically Endangered** and the **state bird of Rajasthan**. It is protected in **Desert NP (Jaisalmer)**. Fewer than about 150 remain in the wild.

F. Pollution, Environmental Law and Governance

6.26 Solid Waste Management Rules, 2026

- **In focus:** MoEFCC notified the **SWM Rules, 2026** on **28 Jan 2026**. They **replace the SWM Rules, 2016** and came **into force on 1 Apr 2026**. They are framed under the **Environment (Protection) Act, 1986**.
- **Key features: mandatory 4-stream source segregation** (**wet**, **dry**, **sanitary** and **special-care** waste) · defined duties for **bulk waste generators** (extended bulk-waste-generator responsibility) · **environmental compensation** on the **polluter-pays** principle · an **online, centralised system to track** the whole waste chain · **faster land allocation** for processing plants.

  Static link: Related rules: Plastic Waste Management Rules 2016 (the single-use plastic ban from **1 Jul 2022**; carry bags must be ≥**120 microns**) · E-Waste Rules 2022 (EPR) · Battery Waste Rules 2022. **Swachh Bharat Mission (Urban) 2.0** is the urban funding programme.

6.27 Clean air: NCAP and Swachh Vayu Survekshan 2025 and 2026

- **NCAP:** Launched in **Jan 2019** for **130 cities** (non-attainment and million-plus). The revised goal is **up to a 40% cut in PM10, or meeting the national standard (60 µg/m³), by 2025-26**, against a 2017-18 baseline. Portal: **PRANA**. Funding comes through NCAP and **15th Finance Commission** grants.
- **Swachh Vayu Survekshan (SVS):** CPCB and MoEFCC rank NCAP cities in **3 population categories**: **>10 lakh**, **3-10 lakh** and **<3 lakh**.
- **SVS 2026 hook: Lucknow overtook Indore for the first time.** The 1st prize was ₹**1.5 crore**. There is also a **ward-level ranking**, where Lucknow's Ward 70 was 1st.
- **Delhi cloud seeding (late Oct 2025):** IIT Kanpur's trials produced **no meaningful rain** because the air was too dry. The **CAQM** runs **GRAP** (Graded Response Action Plan, stages I-IV).

Category	SVS 2025 (Inspector 2026 PYQ)	SVS 2026 (announced Sep 2026)
>10 lakh	**1. Indore** · 2. Jabalpur · 3. Agra and Surat (joint)	**1. Lucknow (198)** · 2. **Indore (197)** · 3. **Jabalpur (195)** · Agra 4th

6.30 Forests: ISFR 2023 and FAO FRA 2025

- **FAO Global Forest Resources Assessment 2025 (22 Oct 2025):** India is **9th** in total forest area (up from 10th) and **3rd** in **annual net forest gain**.

6.32 World Environment Day 2026 and UN years

- **WED 2026 (5 Jun): Host: Azerbaijan (Baku). Theme focus: climate action.** Azerbaijan's national campaign slogan was "Inspired by Nature. For Climate. For Our Future."
- **Earlier WEDs: 2025: Republic of Korea (Jeju), ending plastic pollution (#BeatPlasticPollution)** · **2024: Saudi Arabia, land restoration** · 2023: Côte d'Ivoire, plastics · **2018: India, "Beat Plastic Pollution"**.
- **UN years: 2026 = International Year of Rangelands and Pastoralists** (and of **Women Farmers**). **2025 = International Year of Glaciers' Preservation.**

G. Static Linkage Table: Conventions at a Glance

- **Indian law anchors:** Water Act **1974** · Air Act **1981** · **Wildlife (Protection) Act 1972** (amended 2022) · **Environment (Protection) Act 1986** · Biological Diversity Act **2002** (amended 2023) · **NGT Act 2010** · Forest (Conservation) Act 1980, renamed the **Van (Sanrakshan Evam Samvardhan) Adhiniyam** in 2023 · **Arts 48A and 51A(g)** were added by the **42nd Amendment (1976)**.

Convention	Signed (place, year) / In force	Secretariat	India link
Ramsar (wetlands)	Ramsar, Iran, **1971**; in force 1975	Gland	Joined **1982**. **101 sites**
CITES (wildlife trade)	Washington, **1973**; in force **1975**	Geneva	Joined **1976**
CMS / Bonn (migratory species)	Bonn, **1979**; in force 1983	Bonn	Hosted COP13 (2020)
Vienna / Montreal (ozone)	1985 / **1987**; in force 1988 / 1989	Nairobi	**Kigali Amendment (2016)** on HFCs
UNFCCC (climate)	Rio, **1992**; in force 1994	**Bonn**	Hosted COP8 (2002)
CBD (biodiversity)	Rio, **1992**; in force 1993	Montreal	Hosted COP11 (2012)
UNCCD (desertification)	Paris, **1994**; in force 1996	Bonn	Hosted COP14 (2019)
Kyoto Protocol	Kyoto, **1997**; in force 2005	Bonn	-
Paris Agreement	Paris, **2015**; in force **4 Nov 2016**	Bonn	Ratified **2 Oct 2016**
BBNJ (high seas)	New York, **2023**; in force **17 Jan 2026**	-	Signed 2024. Not ratified
Minamata (mercury)	**2013**; in force 2017	Geneva	Ratified 2018

07 Defence and Security

J&K's defence geography, major inductions, exercise pairs and the finance behind modernisation.

A. Defence Who's Who

Post	Incumbent / Took over	Predecessor	Exam note
Raksha Mantri (Defence Minister)	**Rajnath Singh**; 31 May 2019; continued in Modi 3.0 (Jun 2024)	Nirmala Sitharaman	Chairs the **Defence Acquisition Council (DAC)**
Raksha Rajya Mantri (MoS Defence)	**Sanjay Seth**; Jun 2024	Ajay Bhatt	MP from Ranchi
Chief of Defence Staff (CDS) & Secretary, DMA	**Gen N.S. Raja Subramani (3rd CDS)**; **31 May 2026**	Gen Anil Chauhan (2nd CDS)	1st CDS: Gen Bipin Rawat (1 Jan 2020)
Chief of the Army Staff (COAS)	**Gen Dhiraj Seth (31st COAS)**; **30 Jun 2026**	Gen Upendra Dwivedi (30th)	PIB confirms "31st COAS"
Chief of the Naval Staff (CNS)	**Adm Krishna Swaminathan (27th CNS)**; **31 May 2026**	Adm Dinesh K. Tripathi (26th)	Previously FOC-in-C, Western Naval Command
National Security Adviser	**Ajit Doval**; 2014	Shivshankar Menon	5th NSA; chairs the Executive Council of the Nuclear Command Authority
Director General, Indian Coast Guard	**Paramesh Sivamani (26th DG)**; 15 Oct 2024	Rakesh Pal (died Aug 2024)	ICG comes under MoD; raised 1 Feb 1977

B. J&K and Ladakh Defence Focus

7.1 Operation Sindoor (7-10 May 2025): the J&K trigger and what followed

- **In focus:** This was the biggest India-Pakistan military action since 1971. It was a direct response to the **Pahalgam (Baisaran meadow) terror attack of 22 Apr 2025**. Its lessons continue to shape procurement (more S-400s, BrahMos, counter-drone systems), gallantry lists and doctrine through 2026.
- **7 May 2025 (early hours):** precision strikes on **9 terror sites**, 4 in Pakistan (including **Bahawalpur**, the JeM base, and **Muridke**, the LeT base) and 5 in **PoK** (including Muzaffarabad and Kotli).
  - After a DGMO-level contact, both sides agreed to stop firing and military action from **10 May 2025**.
- **Media briefers:** Foreign Secretary **Vikram Misri**, **Col Sofiya Qureshi** and **Wg Cdr Vyomika Singh**.
  - At least **15 BrahMos** were fired; the **S-400** performed well. The IAF chief later said 5 Pakistani fighters and 1 large aircraft were shot down.

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- **Background:** Earlier cross-border responses were the **surgical strikes of 29 Sep 2016** (after Uri, 18 Sep 2016) and the **Balakot air strike of 26 Feb 2019** (after Pulwama, 14 Feb 2019). On 23 Apr 2025, India placed the **Indus Waters Treaty (1960) "in abeyance"** (see topic **1.16**).

  Static link: The **LoC** replaced the 1949 ceasefire line under the **Simla Agreement (1972)**. Pakistan's name for its counter-operation was **Operation Bunyan-um-Marsoos**.

7.2 Operation Mahadev and the J&K counter-terror grid

- **In focus:** On **28 Jul 2025**, **Op Mahadev** near Lidwas/Harwan (Dachigam area, Srinagar outskirts) killed **3 Pakistani LeT terrorists**, including **Suleiman Shah (alias Hashim Musa)**, identified as the Pahalgam attacker.
  - **Rashtriya Rifles (RR)**, raised in **1990**, is the Army's counter-insurgency force in J&K.
  - **Village Defence Guards (VDGs)**, the renamed Village Defence Committees (2022), operate in hilly Jammu districts.

7.3 Nyoma (Mudh) Air Base, eastern Ladakh

- **In focus:** On **12 Nov 2025**, **ACM A.P. Singh** landed a **C-130J** at the new **Mudh-Nyoma air base**, making it operational. It can handle fighters and is among the world's highest operational air bases.
- **Background:** Other Ladakh airfields: **Daulat Beg Oldi (DBO)** ALG (~16,600 ft), the world's highest airstrip; **Thoise** (Nubra); **Leh** (Kushok Bakula Rimpochee Airport); and **Kargil**.

  Static link: The LAC in Ladakh faces Aksai Chin. The 2024 India-China patrolling arrangement covered **Depsang and Demchok**.

7.4 Northern Command, the J&K corps and J&K-linked regiments

- **JAK LI** (J&K Light Infantry) grew out of the J&K Militia (1947) and became JAK LI in 1976.
  - **JAK RIF** (J&K Rifles) descends from the J&K State Forces; its regimental centre is at Jabalpur.
  - **Ladakh Scouts** ("Snow Warriors"; centre at Leh) became a full infantry regiment in 2000.

  Static link: The other Army commands are Western (Chandimandir), Eastern (Kolkata), Southern (Pune), Central (Lucknow), South Western (Jaipur) and ARTRAC (Shimla).

Formation	Nickname	HQ	Area
Northern Command	-	Udhampur	J&K and Ladakh
14 Corps (raised 1999, after Kargil)	Fire & Fury	Leh	Ladakh (LAC and Kargil sector)
15 Corps	Chinar Corps	Srinagar	Kashmir valley, LoC
16 Corps	White Knight	Nagrota	Jammu region, Pir Panjal south

7.5 BRO in J&K and Ladakh: projects, passes and tunnels

- **In focus:** BRO built the Nyoma airfield and keeps Ladakh's border roads open. The Shinku La and Zojila tunnels are 2025-26 talking points.
  - **Umling La** (19,024 ft) was BRO's **2021 Guinness-record road**. The newer **Likaru-Mig La-Fukche route**, built by **Project Himank** and reported completed in **Oct 2025**, crosses **Mig La at 19,400 ft**, higher than Umling La. Do not use the old Umling La superlative as an undated 2026 answer.
- **Background:** BRO was raised on **7 May 1960** (BRO Day) and has been fully under the MoD since 2015.

Static link: The **Zojila tunnel** (~14 km, Sonamarg-Drass) and the **Z-Morh / Sonamarg tunnel** (6.5 km, opened 13 Jan 2025) are **NHIDCL (MoRTH) projects, not BRO**.

Project	Raised	HQ	Area
Beacon (oldest BRO project)	1960	Srinagar	Kashmir valley
Sampark	1975	Jammu	Jammu region
Himank	1985	Leh	Ladakh (built Umling La road)
Vijayak	2010	Kargil	Kargil-Zanskar

7.6 Siachen, Kargil and 1947-48: evergreen J&K defence statics

- **In focus:** Anniversaries come up every year. **Siachen Day** is 13 Apr (**Op Meghdoot, 1984**); **Kargil Vijay Diwas** is 26 Jul (2026 = 27th anniversary); **Infantry Day** is 27 Oct (1 Sikh landed at Srinagar airfield on 27 Oct 1947).
  - **Siachen** (Karakoram, Saltoro Ridge, Nubra) is the world's highest battlefield.
- **Kargil, 1999:** the Army's **Op Vijay**, the IAF's **Op Safed Sagar** and the Navy's **Op Talwar**.
- **Kargil PVCs:** Capt Vikram Batra, Lt Manoj Kumar Pandey, Grenadier Yogendra Singh Yadav and Rifleman Sanjay Kumar.
- **Background:** India's **first Param Vir Chakra** went to **Maj Somnath Sharma** (posthumous), for the battle of **Badgam on 3 Nov 1947**. Brig Mohammed Usman, the "Lion of Naushera", won the MVC (posthumous) at Jhangar in 1948.

Static link: The PVC was designed by **Savitri Khanolkar**. Wartime awards, in order: PVC > MVC > Vir Chakra.

C. Leadership and Higher Defence Reforms

7.7 Gen N.S. Raja Subramani: India's 3rd Chief of Defence Staff

- **In focus:** He took over as **CDS and Secretary, Department of Military Affairs (DMA)** on **31 May 2026**, succeeding **Gen Anil Chauhan** (CDS 30 Sep 2022 - May 2026).
- **Background:** The post came out of the **Kargil Review Committee** (K. Subrahmanyam, 1999), the 2001 GoM, the Naresh Chandra Task Force (2012) and the **Shekatkar Committee (2016)**. The CCS approved it on **24 Dec 2019**.

Static link: What the CDS does:

- Principal military adviser to the Raksha Mantri
- Military adviser to the **Nuclear Command Authority**
- Four-star rank; **age ceiling 65**
- **Does not command the three services**
- Heads the **DMA, the 5th department of MoD** (the others: Defence, Defence Production, Defence R&D, Ex-Servicemen Welfare)

7.8 Service chiefs: appointments and tenure

- **In focus:** Two of the three service chiefs changed in mid-2026.
- **Navy: Adm Krishna Swaminathan** became the **27th CNS on 31 May 2026** (PIB), succeeding **Adm Dinesh K. Tripathi** (26th). He was earlier **FOC-in-C, Western Naval Command (Mumbai)**.
- **Background:** Service chiefs serve **3 years or until age 62, whichever comes first**.
  - First Indian C-in-C: **Gen K.M. Cariappa** (15 Jan 1949 → Army Day). The Army's two Field Marshals are **Sam Manekshaw (1973)** and **Cariappa (1986)**.
  - **Marshal of the IAF Arjan Singh** (2002) is the only five-star IAF officer.
  - First Indian Navy chief: **Vice Adm R.D. Katari (1958)**. First Indian Air chief: **Air Marshal Subroto Mukerjee (1954)**.

7.9 DRDO: leadership change and key laboratories

- **Facts:** The 2025-26 test campaign (Agni variants, IADWS, Project Kusha, LRLACM, BMD) continued without a break. The **Advanced Weapon System Complex at DRDL, Hyderabad** was inaugurated on **12 Jun 2026**.
- **Background:** DRDO was formed in **1958**. Its motto is *Balasya Mulam Vigyanam* ("the source of strength is science"). It has 40+ labs.
- **DRDL, Hyderabad:** missiles
- **GTRE, Bengaluru:** Kaveri engine
- **ADA, Bengaluru:** designs the LCA and AMCA
- **CVRDE, Avadi:** tanks
- **DIHAR, Leh:** Defence Institute of High Altitude Research (Ladakh link)
  - **DEAL, Dehradun**
  - Missile test sites: **ITR Chandipur** and **APJ Abdul Kalam Island** (formerly Wheeler Island, renamed 2015)

7.10 Jointness and restructuring: theatre commands, Year of Reforms, new Army formations

- **Rudra** all-arms brigades (infantry, mechanised, armour, artillery, special forces and UAVs under one brigade)
  - **Bhairav** light commando battalions
  - **Shaktibaan** artillery regiments (drones and loitering munitions)
  - **Divyastra** batteries
  - Drone platoons in infantry battalions
  - **Andaman & Nicobar Command (2001)** is India's first and only operational tri-service command.
  - **Strategic Forces Command (2003)**
  - **Defence Intelligence Agency (2002)**
  - **Defence Space Agency** (Bengaluru), **Defence Cyber Agency** (New Delhi) and the **Armed Forces Special Operations Division** (2018-19)

Static link: The **Inter-Services Organisations (Command, Control & Discipline) Act, 2023** gives heads of inter-service organisations disciplinary powers over personnel from all three services.

7.11 Agnipath: first batch nears exit

- Launched **14 Jun 2022**
  - Entry age **17.5-21** (raised to 23 for the first year)
  - **4-year** tenure
  - **Up to 25%** retained as regulars
  - **Seva Nidhi** exit package ≈ **₹11.71 lakh**, tax-free
  - No pension or gratuity for those who exit
- **Background:** Ex-Agniveers get reservations in CAPF (e.g., **10% in BSF and CISF constables**) and age relaxation. Many states also offer quotas.

Static link: Agniveers are **not** Short Service Commission officers. They enter **below officer rank**.

D. Defence Economy

7.12 Defence Budget 2026-27: ₹7.85 lakh crore

- **In focus:** The **Union Budget of 1 Feb 2026** gave the **Ministry of Defence ₹7.85 lakh cr**, the **highest allocation of any ministry**.
- **Background:** The MoD budget has four parts: **Defence Services (Revenue)**, **Capital Outlay**, **Defence Pensions** and **MoD (Civil)**. In accounting terms, capex creates assets (aircraft, ships); revenue spending covers pay, maintenance and stores.
- **Static link (FAA):** Revenue vs capital expenditure. Defence capital outlay counts towards the **Union's effective capital expenditure**.

Item	2026-27 BE	Note
Total MoD allocation	**₹7.85 lakh cr**	**+15.19%** over BE 2025-26 (₹6.81 lakh cr)
Share of Union Budget	**14.67%**	Highest among ministries
Capital outlay (modernisation)	**≈₹2.19 lakh cr** (₹2,19,306.47 cr)	**27.95%** of the MoD budget
Share of GDP	≈2%	Unchanged band
2013-14 comparison	₹2.53 lakh cr	About 3× rise since

7.13 Record defence production and exports (FY 2025-26)

- **Production:** ₹**1.78 lakh cr in FY26**, an all-time high, up from ₹46,000 cr in 2014 (nearly **4×**).
- **Exports:** ₹**38,424 cr in FY26**, **+62.66%** over ₹**23,622 cr in FY25** (PIB, 2 Apr 2026).
- **Static link (FAA):** Export growth % = (38,424 - 23,622) / 23,622 × 100 ≈ **62.7%**. This kind of percentage-change question is a common FAA numerical.

7.14 Procurement: DAC approvals, draft DAP 2026 and key contracts

- **In focus:** FY26 set a record: **55 AoNs worth ₹6.73 lakh cr** and **503 contracts worth ₹2.28 lakh cr**. The **draft Defence Acquisition Procedure (DAP) 2026** was released on **10 Feb 2026**, with comments open until 3 Mar 2026.
- **27 Mar 2026:** DAC approved ₹**2.38 lakh cr**, including **5 more S-400 squadrons**, **Dhanush** guns and about **60 Medium Transport Aircraft**.
- **6 Mar 2026:** contracts worth ₹**5,083 cr**, including **6 ALH Mk-III for the Coast Guard (₹2,901 cr)**.

  Static link: **AoN** (Acceptance of Necessity) is the first formal approval in the procurement chain. Very large deals then go to the **Cabinet Committee on Security (CCS)**, which the **PM chairs**.

7.15 Defence PSUs, industrial corridors and indigenisation

- **Ordnance Factory Board** split into **7 DPSUs on 1 Oct 2021**: AWEIL, MIL, AVNL, TCL, YIL, IOL and GIL.
- **Uttar Pradesh:** Agra, Aligarh, Chitrakoot, Jhansi, Kanpur, Lucknow
- **Tamil Nadu:** Chennai, Coimbatore, Hosur, Salem, Tiruchirappalli
- **Background: Maharatna criteria:** already a Navratna, listed, average turnover > ₹25,000 cr, average net worth > ₹15,000 cr and average net profit > ₹5,000 cr (over 3 years). **BEL** is a Navratna.
- **Static link (FAA):** The CPSE ladder is **Miniratna → Navratna → Maharatna**. The **Department of Public Enterprises** sits under the Ministry of Finance.

E. Missiles, Air Defence and Strategic Forces

7.16 The Agni family: 2025-26 test series

- **In focus:** DRDO and the SFC carried out an unusually dense run of strategic missile tests:

- **Background: Mission Divyastra (11 Mar 2024)** was the first **Agni-V MIRV** test (MIRV = Multiple Independently-targetable Re-entry Vehicles). The **IGMDP (1983**, led by Dr A.P.J. Abdul Kalam) produced **Prithvi, Agni, Trishul, Akash and Nag**.

Test	Significance
Agni-Prime from a rail-based mobile launcher	India's first rail-mobile, canisterised launch; puts India in a small group of countries
Advanced Agni with MIRV, APJ Abdul Kalam Island	Builds on Mission Divyastra
Agni-1 training launch	User (SFC) trial of a deployed system
Agni-4	Routine check of operational readiness

Missile	Approx. range
Agni-1	700-900 km
Agni-2	2,000+ km
Agni-3	3,000+ km
Agni-4	~4,000 km
Agni-5	>5,000 km
Agni-Prime (new-generation, canisterised)	1,000-2,000 km

7.17 Air and missile defence: Mission Sudarshan Chakra, IADWS, Project Kusha, BMD

- **Mission Sudarshan Chakra**, announced from the Red Fort on **15 Aug 2025**, aims to build a national security shield over strategic and civilian sites **by 2035**.
  - **IADWS** had its maiden flight tests on **23 Aug 2025** (Odisha coast).
  - **Project Kusha** (long-range SAM) had its maiden test on **23 Jul 2026**.
  - A **two-tier BMD** test and the maiden **NASM-MR** test took place on 10-11 Jun 2026.
  - **IADWS** = **QRSAM + Advanced VSHORADS + high-power laser Directed Energy Weapon**, all indigenous.

Static link: **NASM-MR** = Naval Anti-Ship Missile - Medium Range. **QRSAM** = Quick Reaction SAM. **VSHORADS** = Very Short Range Air Defence System.

7.18 Cruise missiles: BrahMos and LRLACM

- **BrahMos** was the main precision weapon in **Op Sindoor** (≥15 fired) and remains India's flagship export (**Philippines**, $375 mn deal, Jan 2022).
  - BrahMos is an **India-Russia JV (1998)** of DRDO and NPO Mashinostroyeniya. The name joins **Brahmaputra + Moskva**.
  - Speed is about **Mach 2.8-3** (supersonic). Range was extended beyond 290 km after India joined the **MTCR in 2016**.
  - LRLACM is subsonic and derived from **Nirbhay**.

- **Background:** India joined the **MTCR (2016)**, the **Wassenaar Arrangement (Dec 2017)** and the **Australia Group (Jan 2018)**. It is **not** in the **NSG**.

7.19 Nuclear triad: INS Aridhaman (3rd SSBN) and the SFC

- **In focus: INS Aridhaman**, India's **third nuclear-powered ballistic missile submarine (SSBN)**, was commissioned on **3 Apr 2026**.
- **Facts:** The SSBN line is **INS Arihant (2016) → INS Arighaat (29 Aug 2024) → INS Aridhaman (2026)**. They come from the **Advanced Technology Vessel (ATV)** programme and are built at the Ship Building Centre, **Visakhapatnam**. Their missiles are **K-15 (Sagarika) and K-4** SLBMs.
- **Background:** The **Nuclear Command Authority (2003)** has a **Political Council chaired by the PM** and an **Executive Council chaired by the NSA**. The **SFC (2003)** manages the missiles.
- **Static link (doctrine, 2003): No First Use**, **credible minimum deterrence** and **massive retaliation**. Nuclear tests: **Pokhran-I (18 May 1974, "Smiling Buddha")** and **Pokhran-II (11-13 May 1998, Op Shakti)**. **11 May** is National Technology Day.

F. Platforms and Inductions

7.20 Navy commissionings 2025-26 (the "builders' navy")

- **In focus:** The Navy commissioned an unusually large number of ships in 2025-26, almost all built in India.
- **Background: INS Vikrant** (first Indigenous Aircraft Carrier) was commissioned on **2 Sep 2022 at Cochin Shipyard**, along with the new naval ensign (inspired by Shivaji's seal). **INS Vikramaditya** is the former Russian *Admiral Gorshkov* (2013).

  Static link: **P-15B = destroyers** (Visakhapatnam-class), **P-17A = frigates** (Nilgiri-class, 7 ships: MDL 4, GRSE 3), **P-75 = conventional submarines** (Kalvari / Scorpene, French Naval Group design), **P-75I = future AIP submarines**.

Ship / Class / project	Note
INS Surat; P-15B destroyer (4th and last, Visakhapatnam-class)	Triple commissioning by PM, Mumbai
INS Nilgiri; P-17A stealth frigate (lead ship)	-
INS Vaghsheer; P-75 Kalvari-class (6th and last Scorpene)	-
INS Arnala; 1st ASW Shallow Water Craft	Visakhapatnam
INS Tamal; Talwar/Krivak follow-on	**Last imported warship**
INS Udaygiri and **INS Himgiri**; P-17A frigates	Two ships from two yards commissioned together, Visakhapatnam
INS Aridhaman; SSBN (3rd)	Nuclear triad

7.21 International Fleet Review 2026 and MILAN 2026, Visakhapatnam

- **In focus:** India hosted the **International Fleet Review (IFR) 2026** together with **Exercise MILAN 2026** at **Visakhapatnam (Eastern Naval Command)** from **15-25 Feb 2026**. **74 countries** took part in MILAN, up from 47 in 2024.
- **Background: MILAN** started in **1995 at Port Blair** with 4 nations and has since moved to Visakhapatnam.

Static link: Visakhapatnam hosts the Eastern Naval Command, the Ship Building Centre (SSBNs) and the 2022 Presidential Fleet Review.

7.22 IAF: MiG-21 farewell, Tejas Mk1A, AMCA engine, Rafale-M

- The **MiG-21 was retired on 26 Sep 2025 at Chandigarh** after **62 years** (inducted 1963).
  - **Tejas Mk1A** deliveries ran late because of **GE F404 engine** supply problems. GE resumed supply, with 3 engines arriving in Aug 2026.
- **Rafale-M: 26 jets** (22 single-seat + 4 twin-seat) for **INS Vikrant**. The IGA was signed in Apr 2025 (≈₹63,000 cr).
- **MQ-9B:** 31 drones (Oct 2024).
- **Background:** The existing Tejas Mk1 squadrons, **No. 45 "Flying Daggers"** and **No. 18 "Flying Bullets"**, are at **Sulur (TN)**. In **Feb 2019**, **Wg Cdr Abhinandan Varthaman** shot down an F-16 while flying a **MiG-21 Bison**.

7.23 Army and helicopter acquisitions: LCH Prachand, guns, light tank

- The **LCH Prachand** is the only attack helicopter that can **land and take off at 5,000 m (16,400 ft)**, which matters for **Siachen and eastern Ladakh**.
  - **Dhanush** guns were approved on 27 Mar 2026.
- **Background:** Other HAL helicopters: the ALH **Dhruv** and the LUH. **Apache** (from the US) serves both the Army and the IAF.

Static link: Zorawar is named after **General Zorawar Singh**, the **Dogra general** of Maharaja Gulab Singh who conquered **Ladakh (1834-40)** and died in the **Tibet campaign (1841)**. That makes it a J&K static link.

G. Military Exercises 2025-26

7.24 Yudh Abhyas 2026 (22nd edition), Auli, Uttarakhand

- **In focus:** India's largest bilateral Army exercise with the US, the **22nd edition**, ran **9-28 Sep 2026 at Auli (Uttarakhand)**. The opening ceremony was on about 15 Sep 2026.
  - US troops came from the **11th Airborne Division** (Arctic-trained, Fort Wainwright, Alaska) and the **3rd Multi-Domain Task Force** (long-range precision fires).
  - It included the **first-ever deployment to India of a US counter-drone system (MLIDS)**, under the "Operation Pathways" framework.
  - Format: command post exercise + field training exercise, ending in a combined live-fire demonstration.
- **Background:** The **21st edition** was held on **1-14 Sep 2025 at Fort Wainwright, Alaska**. The venue alternates between India and the US. The series began in **2004**.

- **Yudh Abhyas:** Army
- **Vajra Prahar:** Special Forces
- **Cope India:** Air Force
- **Tiger Triumph:** tri-service, amphibious
- **Malabar:** Navy, Quad

7.25 Big domestic and India-hosted exercises: Trishul, Vayu Shakti, Tarang Shakti

- **Exercise Trishul** (**30 Oct - ~10 Nov 2025**) was a **tri-service** exercise on the western front (Rajasthan, Gujarat, **Sir Creek**). It involved **20,000+ troops**, with the BSF and Coast Guard also taking part.
  - **Vayu Shakti 2026**, the IAF firepower demonstration, was held at **Pokhran** on 27 Feb 2026.
  - **Tarang Shakti 2026**, an **IAF-hosted multinational air exercise**, runs **26 Sep - 12 Oct 2026 at Jodhpur**. France has sent Rafales, MRTTs and A400Ms.
- **Background:** The **1st Tarang Shakti** was held in **2024** (Sulur and Jodhpur). **Gagan Shakti** (2024) was a pan-India IAF exercise. **Bharat Shakti** (Pokhran, Mar 2024) was a tri-service live-fire showcase of indigenous equipment.

Static link: **Sir Creek** is a disputed 96 km tidal estuary between Gujarat and Sindh.

7.26 Multilateral exercises: Malabar, RIMPAC, Pitch Black, MILAN

- **Malabar 2025 (29th edition)**: Guam, Nov 2025.
  - **RIMPAC 2026** (US-hosted, Hawaii): **30 nations including India**, with 30 ships, 5 submarines, more than 190 aircraft and more than **30,000 personnel**.
- **Facts:** Malabar began in **1992** as an India-US bilateral exercise. **Japan** became a permanent member in **2015** and **Australia** rejoined in **2020**, making it the Quad naval exercise.
- **Background: RIMPAC** (Rim of the Pacific) is the world's largest maritime exercise and is held every two years. **Sea Dragon** is a US-led anti-submarine warfare exercise off Guam.

7.27 Bilateral exercise roundup (2026)

- **Maitree-XV** with **Thailand**: from **18 Aug 2026**, Surat Thani, with **9 Gorkha Rifles**.
  - **Dustlik 2026** with **Uzbekistan**: **Namangan**.
  - **CINBAX-II** with **Cambodia**.
- **Facts:** Exercise **Hand-in-Hand** with **China** has been suspended since 2020. See topic **7.31** for exercise-country pairs.

H. Gallantry, Partnerships and the Neighbourhood

7.29 India's strategic defence partnerships

- **GSOMIA (2002):** military information security
- **LEMOA (2016):** logistics
- **COMCASA (2018):** secure communications
- **BECA (2020):** geospatial data
- **France:** Rafale-M (2025) and Horizon 2047.

- **Russia:** S-400 (more approved 2026) and INS Tamal (2025).
- **Background:** The US designated India a **Major Defence Partner in 2016** and moved it to **STA-1** export-control status in 2018.

I. Static Master Tables (Defence)

7.31 Bilateral and multilateral exercises: country → service

Country	Army	Navy	Air Force / other
USA	**Yudh Abhyas**; Vajra Prahar (SF)	**Malabar** (Quad); Tiger Triumph (tri-service, amphibious)	**Cope India**; Red Flag (multilateral)
Russia	**Indra** (tri-service)	Indra Navy	-
France	**Shakti**	**Varuna**	**Garuda**; Desert Knight (with UAE)
UK	**Ajeya Warrior**	**Konkan**	Indradhanush
Japan	**Dharma Guardian**	**JIMEX**	Veer Guardian; Shinyuu Maitri
Australia	**AUSTRAHIND**	**AUSINDEX**	**Pitch Black** (multilateral, Darwin)
Sri Lanka	**Mitra Shakti**	**SLINEX**	Dosti (coast guards: India-Maldives-Sri Lanka)
Bangladesh	**Sampriti**	Bongosagar	-
Nepal	**Surya Kiran**	-	-
Maldives	**Ekuverin**	Ekatha	-
Mongolia	**Nomadic Elephant**	-	Khaan Quest (multilateral)
Kyrgyzstan / Kazakhstan / Uzbekistan	**Khanjar** / **KAZIND** / **Dustlik**	-	-
Oman	Al Najah	Naseem Al Bahr	Eastern Bridge
UAE	Desert Cyclone	Zayed Talwar	Desert Eagle
Saudi Arabia	Sada Tanseeq	Al Mohed Al Hindi	-
Egypt	Cyclone (SF)	-	Bright Star (multilateral)
Singapore	Bold Kurukshetra	**SIMBEX**	-
Thailand	**Maitree**	Indo-Thai CORPAT	-
Indonesia	Garuda Shakti (SF)	Samudra Shakti	-

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Country	Army	Navy	Air Force / other
Malaysia	Harimau Shakti	Samudra Laksamana	-
Vietnam / Cambodia	VINBAX / **CINBAX**	-	-
China	Hand-in-Hand (**suspended since 2020**)	-	-

7.32 Missiles and air-defence systems: quick identifier

System	Type	Remember
Agni-1 to Agni-5, Agni-Prime	Surface-to-surface ballistic	Agni-V MIRV = Mission Divyastra (2024); Agni-P rail launch (2025)
Prithvi	Short-range ballistic missile	First IGMDP missile
Pralay	Quasi-ballistic short-range ballistic missile	Conventional, tactical
BrahMos	Supersonic cruise	India-Russia JV; exported to the Philippines
Nirbhay / LRLACM	Subsonic cruise	LRLACM ~1,000 km (2026)
Akash / QRSAM / VSHORADS	SAMs (medium / quick-reaction / very short-range)	QRSAM + VSHORADS + DEW = IADWS
MRSAM	Medium-range SAM	With Israel (IAI)
Project Kusha	Long-range SAM	Maiden test 23 Jul 2026
S-400 Triumf	Long-range SAM (Russia)	IAF name "Sudarshan Chakra"; CAATSA
Astra	Beyond-visual-range air-to-air	Su-30MKI, Tejas
Rudram	Anti-radiation air-to-surface	Targets enemy radars
Nag / Helina / Dhruvastra	Anti-tank guided missiles	Helina = helicopter-launched Nag
K-15 (Sagarika) / K-4	Submarine-launched ballistic missiles	Arihant-class SSBNs
SMART	Missile-assisted torpedo release	Anti-submarine warfare
HSTDV	Hypersonic scramjet demonstrator	Not a weapon yet

7.33 Defence days and anniversaries

Date	Day	Origin
1 Jan	DRDO Day	DRDO formed in 1958
14 Jan	Armed Forces Veterans' Day	Field Marshal Cariappa retired (1953)
15 Jan	**Army Day**	Gen K.M. Cariappa took over as C-in-C (1949). 2026: 78th, at Jaipur
1 Feb	Coast Guard Day	ICG raised in 1977
13 Apr	Siachen Day	Op Meghdoot (1984)
7 May	BRO Raising Day	1960
11 May	National Technology Day	Pokhran-II (1998)
26 Jul	**Kargil Vijay Diwas**	Op Vijay (1999)
8 Oct	**Air Force Day**	IAF formed in 1932
9 Oct	Territorial Army Day	1949
21 Oct	Police Commemoration Day	**Hot Springs, Ladakh (1959)**: CRPF men killed by Chinese troops
27 Oct	**Infantry Day**	1 Sikh landed at Srinagar airfield (1947)
4 Dec	**Navy Day**	Op Trident, Karachi (1971). 2025 demo at Thiruvananthapuram
7 Dec	Armed Forces Flag Day	Since 1949
16 Dec	**Vijay Diwas**	Dhaka surrender (1971)

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08 Awards and Honours

Local achievers and major prizes, organised by winner, field and awarding institution.

A. Awards Who's Who 2025-26 (master table)

Award (edition)	Winner(s) / Conferred by	Hook
Padma Awards 2026	131 awards: **5 Padma Vibhushan, 13 Padma Bhushan, 113 Padma Shri**; President (announced by MHA)	19 women, 16 posthumous, 6 foreigners/NRI/PIO/OCI
Padma Shri 2026 (J&K and Ladakh)	**Brij Lal Bhat** (Social Work), **Prof Shafi Shauq** (Literature & Education), **Dr Padma Gurmet** (Medicine, Ladakh); President	
Kirti Chakra (Independence Day 2026)	9 awards (7 posthumous); President	78 gallantry awards in total
60th Jnanpith (for 2025)	**Vairamuthu** (Tamil); Bharatiya Jnanpith (private trust)	3rd Tamil winner
Sahitya Akademi Award 2025	24 languages. J&K: **Ali Shaida** (Kashmiri), **Khajur Singh Thakur** (Dogri), **Pritpal Singh Betab** (Urdu); Sahitya Akademi	Late announcement (normally December)
72nd National Film Awards (films of 2024)	Best Feature Film: **Article 370**; Best Actor: **Mammootty and Kartik Aaryan**; Best Actress: **Yami Gautam**; President (I&B Ministry)	J&K-themed film wins
Dadasaheb Phalke Award 2024	**Anant Nag** (Kannada actor); Government of India (I&B)	Highest honour in Indian cinema
Rashtriya Vigyan Puraskar 2025	Vigyan Ratna: **Prof Jayant V. Narlikar** (posthumous); President	2nd edition; 24 awards
National Sports Awards 2025	**No Khel Ratna** (first time since 2014); 17 Arjuna awards; MYAS	Hardik Singh was recommended but dropped
Nobel Peace Prize 2025	**María Corina Machado** (Venezuela); Norwegian Nobel Committee, Oslo	20th woman Peace laureate
Ramon Magsaysay 2026 (68th)	**Tommy Koh** (Singapore), **Runa Khan** (Bangladesh), **Bo Kyi** (Myanmar); RM Award Foundation, Manila	Ceremony 15 Nov 2026
Award (edition)	**Winner(s) / Conferred by**	**Hook**
International Booker 2026	***Taiwan Travelogue***, Yáng Shuāng-zǐ (translated by Lin King); Booker Prize Foundation	First win for a book translated from Taiwanese Mandarin

Award (edition)	Winner(s) / Conferred by	Hook
98th Oscars	Best Picture: ***One Battle After Another***; AMPAS (private, US)	New category: Best Casting
Foreign honour for PM Modi	**Bintang Adipurna** (Indonesia); Indonesia	Tally **35** (DD India); 2nd Indian PM after Nehru to receive it

B. J&K and Ladakh in the Awards (2025-26)

8.1 Padma Shri 2026: three from J&K and Ladakh

- **In focus:** Two people from J&K UT and one from Ladakh UT are among the **113 Padma Shri** awardees of 2026 (announced 25 Jan 2026).
- **Background:** Padma awards were instituted in **1954**. They are announced on the eve of Republic Day and **conferred by the President** at Rashtrapati Bhavan around March-April. Anyone can nominate online.
  - **Sowa-Rigpa** was recognised as an **AYUSH** system in **2010**. The **National Institute of Sowa Rigpa** is at **Leh** (approved 2019).
  - **Habba Khatoon** ("Nightingale of Kashmir") was the 16th-century poet-queen of **Yusuf Shah Chak**.
  - **Kota Rani** was the last Hindu ruler of Kashmir (died 1339).

Awardee	UT	Field	Known for
Brij Lal Bhat (80, Roop Nagar, Jammu)	J&K	**Social Work**	Reconnecting displaced Kashmiri Pandits with their roots; chairs SRMA-Vivekananda Kendra, Nagdandi (Achhabal, Anantnag); former Director, Horticulture
Prof Shafi Shauq (75, Harwan, Srinagar)	J&K	**Literature & Education**	Kashmiri writer and former Kashmir University faculty; 60+ books; TV scripts for *Habba Khatoon*, *Kota Rani* and *Panah*; Sahitya Akademi Award (2006) and Translation Award
Dr Padma Gurmet	Ladakh	**Medicine**	Preserving and modernising **Sowa-Rigpa** (Amchi / Tibetan medicine)

8.2 Sahitya Akademi Awards 2025: Kashmiri, Dogri and Urdu go to J&K writers

- **In focus:** The Akademi announced its **2025 awards in 24 languages on 16 Mar 2026**, with the ceremony on 31 Mar 2026 (₹1 lakh, plaque, shawl). That is unusually late; announcements normally come in December.

- **English:** Navtej Sarna, *Crimson Spring* (novel)
- **Hindi:** Mamta Kalia, *Jeete Jee Allahabad* (memoir)
- **Sanskrit:** Sadhu Bhadreshdas
- **Punjabi:** Jinder, *Safety Kit*
- **Tamil:** Sa. Tamilselvan
- **Background:** The Sahitya Akademi was set up in **March 1954**. It is an autonomous body under the **Ministry of Culture**. It gives awards in **24 languages**: the 22 Eighth Schedule languages + **English** + **Rajasthani**.
  - **Kashmiri** has been in the Eighth Schedule since **1950**. **Dogri** was added by the **92nd Amendment (2003)**, along with Bodo, Maithili and Santhali.
  - **Rahman Rahi (2004)** is the **only Kashmiri Jnanpith** winner.

Language	Writer	Book	Genre
Kashmiri	**Ali Shaida**	*Najdavanek'y Pot Aalav*	Poetry
Dogri	**Khajur Singh Thakur**	*Thakur Satsayie*	Poetry
Urdu	**Pritpal Singh Betab**	*Safar Jaari Hai*	Poetry

8.3 J&K on screen: 72nd National Film Awards

- ***Article 370*** (Hindi; director **Aditya Suhas Jambhale**), a political thriller about the **abrogation of Article 370 (Aug 2019)**, won **Best Feature Film**.
  - Its lead **Yami Gautam** won **Best Actress**.
  - ***Amaran*** (Tamil), the biopic of **Maj Mukund Varadarajan**, won **Best Direction** (Rajkumar Periasamy). He received the Ashoka Chakra posthumously after being killed in a counter-terror operation in **Shopian, 2014** (44 RR).
- **Facts:** Announced **18 Jul 2026**. Presented by **President Droupadi Murmu** on **22 Sep 2026 at Kevadia (Ekta Nagar), Gujarat**.

  Static link: **Article 370 and 35A** were made inoperative on **5-6 Aug 2019**. The **J&K Reorganisation Act, 2019** created **two UTs on 31 Oct 2019**.

8.4 Gallantry with a J&K link

- **In focus:** Most Army gallantry citations in 2026 come from **Rashtriya Rifles** and **Assam Rifles** counter-terror operations. On Independence Day 2026, **Maj Paramveer (Garhwal Rifles, 36 RR)** got the **Shaurya Chakra** and **Maj Aditya Pratap Singh (44 Assam Rifles)** got a **Bar to Shaurya Chakra**.
- **Background:** Police medals were rationalised in 2024 into a single **Medal for Gallantry (GM)**, the **President's Medal for Distinguished Service (PSM)** and the **Medal for Meritorious Service (MSM)**.

  Static link: **Police Commemoration Day (21 Oct)** marks the 1959 **Hot Springs (Ladakh)** clash with Chinese troops.

C. National Civilian and Gallantry Awards

8.5 Padma Awards 2026: the headline names

- **In focus:** There were **131 awards** (5 PV, 13 PB, 113 PS), including **19 women**, **16 posthumous**, **6 foreigners/NRI/PIO/OCI** and **2 duo cases** (a duo counts as one award).
  - **Dharmendra** (Art, Maharashtra, posthumous)
  - **K.T. Thomas** (Public Affairs, Kerala; retired Supreme Court judge)
  - **N. Rajam** (Art, UP; Hindustani violinist)
  - **P. Narayanan** (Literature & Education, Kerala)
  - **V.S. Achuthanandan** (Public Affairs, Kerala, posthumous; former Kerala CM)
- **Background:** The three Padma awards were instituted in **1954**. They were suspended in **1977-80 and 1992-95**. The **Balaji Raghavan case (1995)** held that they are **not "titles"** under Article 18.

  Static link: The ladder is Bharat Ratna > Padma Vibhushan > Padma Bhushan > Padma Shri. Padma awards are normally capped at **120 a year**, excluding posthumous and foreign awards.

8.6 Bharat Ratna: key facts and notable firsts

- Instituted **1954**; usually **at most 3 a year** (2024 was an exception with 5).
  - The **PM recommends** and the **President confers**. It **cannot be used as a title** (Art. 18).
- **1954:** C. Rajagopalachari, S. Radhakrishnan, C.V. Raman
- **First posthumous:** Lal Bahadur Shastri (1966)
- **First woman:** Indira Gandhi (1971)
- **First non-citizens:** Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan (1987) and Nelson Mandela (1990)
- **Youngest:** Sachin Tendulkar (2014)

8.4.1 Gallantry: learn the order

Context	Highest	Second	Third
Wartime	Param Vir Chakra	Maha Vir Chakra	Vir Chakra
Peacetime	Ashoka Chakra	Kirti Chakra	Shaurya Chakra

8.8 Independence Day 2026 gallantry list

- **In focus: 78 gallantry awards** (13 posthumous) and **89 Mentions-in-Despatches**, on the eve of the "80th Independence Day":
  - **9 Kirti Chakras** (7 posthumous)
  - 1 Bar to Shaurya Chakra
  - **19 Shaurya Chakras** (1 posthumous)
  - 5 Bar to Sena Medals
  - 36 Sena Medals (5 posthumous)
  - 3 Nao Sena Medals and 5 Vayu Sena Medals

D. Literature

8.9 60th Jnanpith Award: Vairamuthu (Tamil)

- **In focus:** Tamil poet and lyricist **Vairamuthu** was chosen for the **60th Jnanpith Award (for the year 2025)**, announced on **14 Mar 2026**.
- **Facts:** He is the **3rd Tamil recipient**, after **Akilan (1975)** and **Jayakanthan (2002)**, and the first chosen mainly as a **poet**. The prize is ₹**11 lakh**, a Vagdevi (Saraswati) statue and a citation.
- **58th (2023): Gulzar** (Urdu) and **Jagadguru Rambhadracharya** (Sanskrit)
  - The first Jnanpith (**1965**) went to **G. Sankara Kurup** (Malayalam)
- **Kashmiri Jnanpith: Rahman Rahi (2004)**, the only one.
- **Urdu Jnanpiths:** Firaq Gorakhpuri (1969), Qurratulain Hyder (1989), Ali Sardar Jafri (1997), Shahryar (2008) and Gulzar (2023).
  - The award is given by **Bharatiya Jnanpith**, a **private trust** (Sahu Jain family).

8.10 Sahitya Akademi 2025: national highlights and how the Akademi works

- **In focus:** The **24 winners** (8 poetry collections, 4 novels, 6 short-story books, 2 essay collections, 1 criticism, 1 autobiography, 2 memoirs) were announced on 16 Mar 2026.
- **Facts: Navtej Sarna** (former ambassador) won in English for *Crimson Spring*. **Mamta Kalia** won in Hindi for *Jeete Jee Allahabad*. **Sadhu Bhadreshdas** won in Sanskrit; he had also won the **Saraswati Samman 2024**.
- **Background:** Other Akademi honours: the **Yuva Puraskar** (writers under 35), the **Bal Sahitya Puraskar** (children's literature), the **Bhasha Samman** (classical/medieval literature and unrecognised languages), **Fellowships**, and the **Premchand Fellowship** (SAARC writers).

8.11 Booker and International Booker (2025-26)

- **International Booker 2025:** ***Heart Lamp*** by **Banu Mushtaq**, translated from **Kannada** by **Deepa Bhasthi**. It was the **first Kannada work** and the first **short-story collection** to win.
- **International Booker 2026:** ***Taiwan Travelogue*** by **Yáng Shuāng-zǐ**, translated by **Lin King**. It was the first book translated from **Taiwanese Mandarin** to win. Indian critic **Nilanjana S. Roy** was on the jury.
- **Booker Prize 2025:** ***Flesh*** by **David Szalay** (10 Nov 2025).
- **Facts:** The **International Booker** is for a work **translated into English**, and the **£50,000 is split equally** between author and translator. The **Booker Prize** is for an original English-language novel (£50,000; £2,500 for each shortlisted author).
- **Background:** Indian-origin Booker winners: **Arundhati Roy** (*The God of Small Things*, 1997), **Kiran Desai** (*The Inheritance of Loss*, 2006) and **Aravind Adiga** (*The White Tiger*, 2008). **Salman Rushdie** (*Midnight's Children*, 1981) is also a winner. International Booker 2022: **Geetanjali Shree**, *Tomb of Sand* (Hindi; translated by Daisy Rockwell).

8.12 Other literary prizes: Saraswati Samman, Pulitzer

- **Pulitzer Prize for Fiction 2026:** ***Angel Down*** by **Daniel Kraus**. Pulitzers are administered by **Columbia University** (since 1917).

E. Cinema

8.13 72nd National Film Awards and the Dadasaheb Phalke Award (Anant Nag)

- **In focus:** These awards honour **films of 2024**. They were announced on **18 Jul 2026** and presented by **President Murmu** at **Kevadia, Gujarat** on **22 Sep 2026**.
- **Background:** The **Dadasaheb Phalke Award** was instituted in **1969**; the first winner was **Devika Rani**. It carries the **Swarna Kamal** and ₹**10 lakh**. Recent winners: **Mithun Chakraborty (2022)**, **Mohanlal (2023)** and **Anant Nag (2024)**.

Category	Winner
Dadasaheb Phalke Award (2024)	**Anant Nag** (Kannada actor)
Best Feature Film	***Article 370*** (Hindi)
Best Popular Film	***Kalki 2898 AD*** (Telugu)
Best Direction	Rajkumar Periasamy, ***Amaran*** (Tamil)
Best Actor (shared)	**Mammootty** (*Bramayugam*) and **Kartik Aaryan** (*Chandu Champion*)
Best Actress	**Yami Gautam** (*Article 370*)
Best Supporting Actor	Sanjay Mishra (*Bhakshak*)
Best Debut Film of a Director	Randeep Hooda (*Swatantrya Veer Savarkar*)
Best Hindi Film	*Srikanth*
Best Children's Film	*35 Chinna Katha Kaadu* (Telugu)
Best Non-Feature Film	*Bhangaar*

8.14 71st National Film Awards recap (films of 2023)

- **Best Feature Film: *12th Fail***
- **Best Actor (shared): Shah Rukh Khan** (*Jawan*), his first National Award, and **Vikrant Massey** (*12th Fail*)
- **Best Actress: Rani Mukerji** (*Mrs Chatterjee vs Norway*)
- **Dadasaheb Phalke Award 2023: Mohanlal**

8.15 98th Academy Awards (Oscars, 15 Mar 2026)

- **Best Picture: *One Battle After Another***
- **Best Director: Paul Thomas Anderson**
- **Best Actor: Michael B. Jordan** (*Sinners*)
- **Best Actress: Jessie Buckley** (*Hamnet*)

- **Best Supporting Actor:** Sean Penn
  - A new **Best Casting** category debuted, the first new competitive category since Animated Feature (2001).
  - ***"Golden"*** (*KPop Demon Hunters*) became the first **K-pop** song to win Best Original Song.
- **Background:** The Oscars are given by **AMPAS**, a **private US academy**, at the Dolby Theatre in Los Angeles.

F. Science and Sports Awards

8.16 Rashtriya Vigyan Puraskar 2025: Vigyan Ratna for J.V. Narlikar (posthumous)

- **In focus:** In the **2nd edition** of India's unified science awards, **24 awards** were presented by **President Murmu** at **Gantantra Mandap, Rashtrapati Bhavan** on **23 Dec 2025**.
- **Vigyan Ratna 2025: Prof Jayant Vishnu Narlikar** (Physics, posthumous). He died in May 2025. He co-developed the **Hoyle-Narlikar theory** of gravity and was founder-director of **IUCAA, Pune (1988)**.
  - **Vigyan Shri** winners include Dr Gyanendra Pratap Singh (Agriculture), Dr Yusuf Mohammad Seikh (Atomic Energy), Dr K. Thangaraj (Biology), Prof Pradeep Thalappil (Chemistry), Prof Aniruddha B. Pandit (Engineering) and Dr S. Venkata Mohan (Environment).
- **Background:** RVP was created in **2024** and **replaced about 300 earlier science awards**. It has **4 categories**:
  - **Vigyan Ratna** (lifetime)
  - **Vigyan Shri**
  - **Vigyan Yuva-Shanti Swarup Bhatnagar** (age ≤ 45)
  - **Vigyan Team**

8.17 National Sports Awards 2025: no Khel Ratna

- **In focus:** The final list (Aug 2026) has **no Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna** for 2025. This is the **first year since 2014** without one. Hockey's **Hardik Singh** was recommended in Dec 2025 but **dropped from the final list**.
  - **17 Arjuna Awards**, including:
  - Athletics: **Tejaswin Shankar** (decathlon), Muhammed Ajmal V, Priyanka Goswami
  - Badminton: **Treesa Jolly** and **Gayatri Gopichand**
  - Boxing: Narender Berwal
  - Chess: **Vidit Gujrathi** and **Divya Deshmukh**
  - Hockey: Lalremsiami and Rajkumar Pal
  - Kabaddi: Surjeet and Pooja
  - Para sports: Rudransh Khandelwal (shooting) and Ekta Bhyan (athletics)
  - Rowing: Arvind Singh; Shooting: Akhil Sheoran
  - Deaf shooting: Dhanush Srikanth
- **Arjuna (Lifetime): I. Arumainayagam** (football; 1962 Asian Games gold).
- **Dronacharya (Regular):** Parveer Singh, Chhote Lal Yadav, Neha Nandkumar Chavan. **Dronacharya (Lifetime):** Dharmendra Singh Yadav, Virender Kumar.
- **Rashtriya Khel Protsahan Puraskar: Army Paralympic Node, Pune**.

- **Background: Khel Ratna 2024** went to **Manu Bhaker, D. Gukesh, Harmanpreet Singh and Praveen Kumar**. The award was renamed from *Rajiv Gandhi* to *Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna* in **2021**.

  Static link: **29 Aug**, National Sports Day, is **Major Dhyan Chand's birthday**. The awards are given by the **Ministry of Youth Affairs & Sports**. The **Arjuna** award counts the **past 4 years'** performance.

G. International Awards

8.18 Nobel Prizes 2025 (and the 2026 schedule)

- **Background:** Nobel Prizes were first awarded in **1901**. They are presented on **10 Dec**, the anniversary of Nobel's death. **Peace is given in Oslo**, the rest in **Stockholm**. The **Economics prize (1968, Sveriges Riksbank)** is not in Nobel's will. A prize can be shared by **at most 3** people.
  - **Rabindranath Tagore** (Literature, 1913)
  - **C.V. Raman** (Physics, 1930)
  - **Mother Teresa** (Peace, 1979)
  - **Amartya Sen** (Economics, 1998)
  - **Kailash Satyarthi** (Peace, 2014)
  - Indian-origin: **Har Gobind Khorana** (1968), **S. Chandrasekhar** (1983), **V. Ramakrishnan** (2009), **Abhijit Banerjee** (2019)

Prize	2025 laureate(s)	For
Physics	**John Clarke, Michel H. Devoret, John M. Martinis**	Macroscopic quantum tunnelling and energy quantisation in an electric circuit (the basis of superconducting qubits)
Chemistry	**Susumu Kitagawa** (Japan), **Richard Robson** (Melbourne), **Omar M. Yaghi** (UC Berkeley; born in Amman)	Development of **metal-organic frameworks (MOFs)**
Physiology or Medicine	**Mary E. Brunkow, Fred Ramsdell, Shimon Sakaguchi**	**Peripheral immune tolerance**: regulatory T cells
Literature	**László Krasznahorkai** (Hungary)	Visionary fiction "in the midst of apocalyptic terror"
Peace	**María Corina Machado** (Venezuela)	Democratic rights; 20th woman Peace laureate
Economic Sciences	**Joel Mokyr** (half); **Philippe Aghion and Peter Howitt** (half)	**Innovation-driven economic growth**, including the Aghion-Howitt model of **creative destruction**

8.19 Ramon Magsaysay Award 2026 (68th edition)

- **In focus:** Announced on **31 Aug 2026** (Magsaysay's birth anniversary) in Manila. The formal ceremony is on **15 Nov 2026** at the Metropolitan Theater.
- **Tommy Koh (Singapore):** diplomat who led the **UNCLOS** negotiations; founding chair of the NUS Centre for International Law.

- **Runa Khan (Bangladesh):** founder of the NGO **Friendship** (2002), which runs **hospital ships**, mobile clinics and schools for people living on river *chars* (sandbars).
- **Bo Kyi (Myanmar):** former political prisoner and co-founder of the **Assistance Association for Political Prisoners** (Mae Sot, Thailand).
  - Since 1958 the award has gone to 331 individuals and 28 organisations.
- **Background:** The **2025** winners included **Educate Girls (India)**, the **first Indian organisation** to win. It was founded by **Safeena Husain**.

Static link: The award is given by the **Ramon Magsaysay Award Foundation** (a private body, est. 1957) and is often called "Asia's Nobel". Since 2009 there have been no fixed categories, except **Emergent Leadership** (age ≤ 40).

8.21 UNEP Champions of the Earth: environmental award

- **Background:** Champions of the Earth (est. **2005**) is the **UN's highest environmental honour**. Earlier Indian winners: **PM Modi (2018, with Emmanuel Macron)**, **Cochin International Airport (2018)** and **Purnima Devi Barman (2022)**.

8.22 Other global prizes 2026 (one-liners)

- **Abel Prize 2026: Gerd Faltings** (Max Planck Institute, Bonn), from the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters. Mathematics has no Nobel.
- **Pritzker Architecture Prize 2026: Smiljan Radić Clarke** (Chile). Indian winner: **B.V. Doshi (2018)**.
- **ACM Turing Award (for 2025, announced Mar 2026): Charles H. Bennett and Gilles Brassard**, for quantum information science (**BB84** quantum key distribution).
- **Templeton Prize 2026: Simon Conway Morris** (Cambridge palaeontologist).

8.24 Sant Kabir and National Handloom Awards 2026

- **In focus:** On **7 Aug 2026**, President Murmu honoured **22 master artisans** on **National Handloom Day**.

Static link: 7 Aug marks the launch of the **Swadeshi Movement (1905)**. The day was first observed in **2015** (Chennai). The awards are given by the **Ministry of Textiles**. J&K's **Pashmina** and **Kani shawls** are GI-tagged handloom crafts.

H. Static Master Tables (Awards)

8.25 Indian awards: body, year, field

Award	Conferred by	Instituted	Field / key fact
Bharat Ratna	President (PM recommends)	1954	Any field; not a title; total 53 (to 2024)
Padma Vibhushan / Bhushan / Shri	President (MHA process)	1954	Announced 25 Jan; cap of 120 a year
PVC / MVC / Vir Chakra	President	26 Jan 1950 (effective from 15 Aug 1947)	Wartime gallantry

Award	Conferred by	Instituted	Field / key fact
Ashoka / Kirti / Shaurya Chakra	President	1952 (renamed 1967)	Peacetime gallantry
Jnanpith	Bharatiya Jnanpith (trust)	Est. 1961; first award 1965	₹11 lakh; 22 languages + English
Sahitya Akademi Award	Sahitya Akademi (Ministry of Culture)	1954	24 languages; ₹1 lakh
Saraswati Samman / Vyas Samman	K.K. Birla Foundation	1991	₹15 lakh / Hindi only
Dadasaheb Phalke Award	GoI (I&B)	1969	Cinema; Swarna Kamal + ₹10 lakh
Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna	MYAS	1991-92 (renamed 2021)	Highest sports award
Rashtriya Vigyan Puraskar	GoI (MoST)	2024	Vigyan Ratna, Shri, Yuva-SSB, Team
Gandhi Peace Prize	GoI	1995	₹1 crore; individuals or institutions
Indira Gandhi Peace Prize	Indira Gandhi Memorial Trust	1986	Private trust
Tagore Award for Cultural Harmony	GoI	2012	Tagore's 150th birth anniversary
National Teachers' Award	Ministry of Education	1958	Given on **5 Sep** (Teachers' Day)

8.26 International awards: body, city, key fact

Award	Body	Base	Key fact
Nobel (5 + Economics)	Swedish academies / Karolinska; Norwegian Committee (Peace)	Stockholm; Oslo (Peace)	Since 1901; Economics from 1969; max 3 per prize; 10 Dec
Booker Prize	Booker Prize Foundation	London	Since 1969; English-language novel; £50,000
International Booker	Booker Prize Foundation	London	Translated into English; prize split author/translator (annual since 2016)
Ramon Magsaysay	RM Award Foundation	Manila	Since 1958; announced 31 Aug
Pulitzer	Columbia University	New York	Since 1917; journalism and the arts

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Award	Body	Base	Key fact
Oscars	AMPAS	Los Angeles	Since 1929
Abel / Fields	Norwegian Academy / IMU	Oslo / ICM	Abel since 2003; Fields every 4 years, under 40
Turing	ACM	-	"Nobel of computing"; since 1966
Pritzker	Hyatt Foundation	-	"Nobel of architecture"; India: B.V. Doshi (2018)
World Food Prize	WFP Foundation	Des Moines, USA	First laureate **M.S. Swaminathan (1987)**
Right Livelihood	RL Foundation	Stockholm	"Alternative Nobel"
Champions of the Earth	**UNEP**	Nairobi	UN's top environmental honour (2005)
Kalinga Prize	**UNESCO**	Paris	Popularisation of science (1952)

8.27 J&K and Ladakh award statics (frequently asked)

Person	Field	Award to remember
Rahman Rahi	Kashmiri poetry	**Jnanpith 2004** (only Kashmiri); Padma Shri 2000
Pt. Shivkumar Sharma	Santoor (Jammu-born)	**Padma Vibhushan 2001**
Bhajan Sopori	Santoor	Padma Shri 2004
Sonam Wangchuk	Education and innovation (Ladakh; SECMOL, ice stupa)	**Ramon Magsaysay 2018**
Chewang Norphel ("Ice Man of Ladakh")	Artificial glaciers	**Padma Shri 2015**
Ghulam Nabi Azad	Public Affairs	Padma Bhushan 2022
Prof Shafi Shauq / Brij Lal Bhat / Dr Padma Gurmet	Literature / Social Work / Medicine	**Padma Shri 2026**
Ali Shaida / Khajur Singh Thakur / Pritpal Singh Betab	Kashmiri / Dogri / Urdu	**Sahitya Akademi 2025**

09 Sports and Games

J&K's sporting firsts, India's major results and the static facts that make them memorable.

A. Sports Who's Who 2025-26 (master table)

Event (edition)	Winner / Runner-up / note	Venue and date	Hook
Ranji Trophy 2025-26 (91st season)	**Jammu & Kashmir** (maiden title); Karnataka (8-time champions)	KSCA Stadium, **Hubballi**; final ended 28 Feb 2026	Won on a **291-run first-innings lead**; captain **Paras Dogra**
ICC Men's T20 World Cup 2026 (10th)	**India**; New Zealand (lost by 96 runs)	Narendra Modi Stadium, **Ahmedabad**; 8 Mar 2026	India's 3rd title (2007, 2024, 2026); captain **Suryakumar Yadav**; Player of the Match **Jasprit Bumrah**
ICC Women's ODI World Cup 2025 (13th)	**India** (maiden title); South Africa (lost by 52 runs)	DY Patil Stadium, **Navi Mumbai**; 2 Nov 2025	Captain **Harmanpreet Kaur**; **Deepti Sharma** scored 58 and took 5/39
ICC Women's T20 World Cup 2026	**Australia**; England (lost by 7 wickets)	**Lord's**, London; 5 Jul 2026	Australia's 7th title
IPL 2026 (19th season)	**Royal Challengers Bengaluru**; Gujarat Titans	Narendra Modi Stadium, Ahmedabad; 31 May 2026	Back-to-back titles (2025 and 2026)
ICC Champions Trophy 2025	**India**; New Zealand (by 4 wickets)	Dubai; 9 Mar 2025	Pakistan was the host (hybrid model); India's 3rd Champions Trophy
FIFA World Cup 2026 (23rd)	**Spain**; Argentina (1-0 after extra time)	**MetLife Stadium**, New Jersey; 19 Jul 2026	Ferran Torres scored in the 106th minute; first 48-team World Cup; Spain's 2nd title
Commonwealth Games 2026 (Glasgow)	India **4th**: 39 medals (13 G, 17 S, 9 B); -	Glasgow, Scotland; 23 Jul-2 Aug 2026	India topped the **boxing** table (7 G)
Winter Olympics 2026 (25th)	**Norway** top (18 G, 41 medals); USA 2nd	**Milano-Cortina**, Italy; 6-22 Feb 2026	Ski mountaineering made its debut
Winter Paralympics 2026	**China** top; USA in the top two	Milano-Cortina; Mar 2026	-
46th Chess Olympiad (Open)	**Uzbekistan**; **India** (silver); Germany (bronze)	**Samarkand**, Uzbekistan; 15-27 Sep 2026	India were the defending champions
FIH Women's Hockey World Cup 2026	**Argentina**; Netherlands (3-1 shootout)	Netherlands (co-host)	Ended the Dutch run of three straight titles

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Event (edition)	Winner / Runner-up / note	Venue and date	Hook
Thomas Cup 2026 (men)	**China**; France (3-1)	Horsens, Denmark; 3 May 2026	**India won bronze**
Australian Open 2026	**Carlos Alcaraz**; **Elena Rybakina**; Novak Djokovic; Aryna Sabalenka	Melbourne; Jan 2026	Alcaraz completed the career Grand Slam
French Open 2026	**Alexander Zverev**; **Mirra Andreeva**; Flavio Cobolli; Maja Chwalińska	Paris; Jun 2026	First Grand Slam title for both
Wimbledon 2026	**Jannik Sinner**; **Linda Nosková**; Alexander Zverev; Karolína Muchová	London; Jul 2026	All-Czech women's final
Khelo India Winter Games 2026 (6th)	**Indian Army** (hat-trick); -	Leh (ice events, from 20 Jan) and **Gulmarg** (snow events, from 23 Feb 2026)	

B. J&K and Ladakh Sports

9.1 J&K win their maiden Ranji Trophy (2025-26)

- **In focus:** Jammu & Kashmir won the **Ranji Trophy for the first time** in the 2025-26 season (91st edition). They beat **Karnataka** in the final at the **KSCA Stadium, Hubballi**, which ended on Saturday, 28 Feb 2026.
- **Result:** The final was **drawn**. J&K took the title on a **291-run first-innings lead**, because a drawn knockout match is decided by the first-innings lead.
- **Captain: Paras Dogra** (41), a veteran batter.
- **Century in the final: Shubham Pundir**.
- **Player of the Series and leading wicket-taker: Auqib Nabi** (60 wickets).
- **Leading run-scorer of the season: Ravichandran Smaran** (Karnataka, 950 runs).
- **Defending champions: Vidarbha** (2024-25).
- **League stage:** J&K finished **2nd in Group D**, behind Mumbai, and still qualified for the knockouts.
- **Season window:** 15 Oct 2025 - 28 Feb 2026.
    - **Karnataka** have won the title **8 times**. **Mumbai** hold the record with **42 titles**.
    - The Ranji Trophy began in **1934-35**. It is named after **K.S. Ranjitsinhji** (Jam Sahib of Nawanagar), and the trophy was donated by **Maharaja Bhupinder Singh of Patiala**. The first winner was **Bombay**.
    - The record for most wickets in a Ranji season is **68**, by **Ashutosh Aman** (Bihar, 2018-19).

9.2 Auqib Nabi and J&K's cricketing names

- **In focus:** J&K seamer **Auqib Nabi** was **Player of the Series** in Ranji 2025-26 and its **leading wicket-taker (60 wickets)**.
  - His 60 wickets fall just short of the all-time season record (68, Ashutosh Aman).

Name	Role	Exam hook
Paras Dogra	Batter, J&K captain	Led J&K to the maiden Ranji title (2025-26)
Auqib Nabi	Seam bowler	Player of the Series, 60 wickets (2025-26)
Shubham Pundir	Batter	Century in the 2025-26 final
Parvez Rasool	All-rounder	First J&K cricketer to play for India (ODI debut 2014) and in the IPL
Umran Malik	Fast bowler (Jammu)	Express pace; India debut 2022 (T20I)
Abdul Samad, **Rasikh Salam Dar**	Batter / bowler	Recent J&K IPL names

9.3 Khelo India Winter Games 2026 (6th edition): Leh and Gulmarg

- **In focus:** The **6th Khelo India Winter Games** were held in two legs. The **ice events** were at **Leh (Ladakh)** from **20 Jan 2026**, and the **snow events** were at **Gulmarg (J&K)** from **23 Feb 2026**. The **Indian Army** team won the overall title for the **third time in a row** (a hat-trick).
- **Ice disciplines (Leh):** ice hockey and skating.

9.4 Sheetal Devi: the armless para archer from Kishtwar

- She is from **Loidhar village in Kishtwar district** (J&K).
  - She was born with **phocomelia** (no arms) and shoots by holding the bow with her feet and drawing with a shoulder-and-mouth release.
  - She trained at the **Shri Mata Vaishno Devi Shrine Board Sports Complex, Katra**, under coaches **Kuldeep Vedwan** and **Abhilasha Chaudhary**.
  - **Asian Para Games 2022** (Hangzhou, held 2023): 2 gold and 1 silver.
- **Paris 2024 Paralympics: bronze in the mixed team compound** event with **Rakesh Kumar**. She was 17, India's youngest Paralympic medallist.
  - **Arjuna Award 2023.**

Static link: **World Archery** has its headquarters in **Lausanne**. At **Paris 2024**, India won **29 Paralympic medals (7 G, 9 S, 13 B)**, its best-ever haul.

9.5 Khelo India Water Sports Festival on Dal Lake

- **Dal Lake** is called the "jewel in the crown of Kashmir". It has floating gardens ("Rad"), Char Chinar and Nehru Park, and the **Hazratbal** shrine stands on its bank.
  - The largest freshwater lake in J&K (and among India's largest) is **Wular** (Bandipora), a **Ramsar site since 1990**.

- **J&K's Ramsar sites:** Wular, Hokersar, Surinsar-Mansar, Hygam and Shallbugh. **Ladakh's:** Tso Moriri and Tsokar. **Dal is not a Ramsar site.**

9.6 J&K sports: static who's who and venues

Person / place	Sport	Claim to fame
Sheetal Devi (Kishtwar)	Para archery	Paris 2024 bronze; Arjuna 2023
Arif Khan (Gulmarg)	Alpine skiing	India's sole athlete at Beijing 2022
Umran Malik (Jammu)	Cricket	Fast bowler, India debut 2022
Paras Dogra / Auqib Nabi	Cricket	Maiden Ranji title (2025-26)
Sher-i-Kashmir Stadium	Cricket	Srinagar's international venue (hosted ODIs in the 1980s)
Maulana Azad Stadium	Cricket	Jammu
Royal Springs Golf Course	Golf	Srinagar, overlooking Dal Lake
Gulmarg	Skiing	KIWG snow events; HAWS; Gondola
Pahalgam / Sonamarg	Adventure sports	Trekking, rafting on the Lidder and Sindh rivers

C. Cricket

9.7 ICC Men's T20 World Cup 2026: India retain the title

- **In focus:** India beat **New Zealand by 96 runs** in the final at the **Narendra Modi Stadium, Ahmedabad** on **8 Mar 2026**. India made **255/5** and bowled New Zealand out for **159**.
  - This was the **10th edition**, co-hosted by **India and Sri Lanka**, with **20 teams**.
- **Captain: Suryakumar Yadav**. **Player of the Match (final): Jasprit Bumrah** (4 wickets).
- **Semi-final:** India beat **England by 7 runs**.
- **Records:** India became the **first team to win three T20 World Cups** (2007, 2024, 2026), the **first to defend the title**, and the **first host nation to win it**.
  - **2007** (Johannesburg): India beat Pakistan by 5 runs under **MS Dhoni**.
  - **2024** (Kensington Oval, Barbados): India beat South Africa by 7 runs under **Rohit Sharma**.
  - The **ICC** has its headquarters in **Dubai**. Its Chairman is **Jay Shah** (since 1 Dec 2024).
- **Upcoming ICC events:** Men's ODI World Cup **2027** (South Africa, Zimbabwe, Namibia); Men's T20 World Cup **2028** (Australia and New Zealand); Champions Trophy **2029** (India); Men's T20 World Cup **2030** (England, Ireland, Scotland); Men's ODI World Cup **2031** (India and Bangladesh).

9.8 India win their maiden Women's ODI World Cup (2025)

- **In focus:** India beat **South Africa by 52 runs** in the final at the **DY Patil Stadium, Navi Mumbai** on **2 Nov 2025**. It was India's **first women's World Cup title**, after losing the finals in **2005 and 2017**.
- **Captain: Harmanpreet Kaur**.

- **Background:** Australia has the most titles (7), followed by England (4) and New Zealand (1, in 2000). India became the **4th** country to win the event.

  Static link: The first Women's World Cup was held in **1973** in England, **two years before** the first men's World Cup (1975).

9.9 IPL 2026: RCB go back-to-back

- RCB's **first title** came in **2025**, when they beat **Punjab Kings** on 3 Jun 2025 in Ahmedabad under captain **Rajat Patidar**.
- **Back-to-back champions: CSK** (2010, 2011), **MI** (2019, 2020) and **RCB** (2025, 2026).
- **Most titles:** MI and CSK, with **5 each**.

  Static link: The IPL began in **2008**. The first champions were **Rajasthan Royals**, captained by **Shane Warne**.

9.10 Women's T20 World Cup 2026: Australia win at Lord's

- **In focus: Australia beat hosts England by 7 wickets** in the final at **Lord's** on **5 Jul 2026**.

9.11 Major cricket results (2025)

Event	Result	Venue and date	Hook
ICC Champions Trophy 2025	**India** beat New Zealand by 4 wickets	Dubai; 9 Mar 2025	Pakistan hosted under a hybrid model; **Rohit Sharma** was Player of the Match in the final; India's 3rd title (2002 shared with Sri Lanka, 2013, 2025)
World Test Championship final 2025 (2023-25 cycle)	**South Africa** beat Australia by 5 wickets	**Lord's**; 11-14 Jun 2025	Captain **Temba Bavuma**; **Aiden Markram** scored 136; South Africa's first ICC title since 1998
Test retirements	**Rohit Sharma** and **Virat Kohli** retired from Tests	May 2025	Gill was named Test captain

9.12 Domestic cricket trophies and bilateral trophies

Trophy	Format	Note
Ranji Trophy	First-class (multi-day), states	Since 1934-35; **2025-26: J&K**
Irani Cup	Ranji champion vs Rest of India	Since 1959-60; named after **Z.R. Irani**
Duleep Trophy	First-class, zonal	Since 1961-62; named after **K.S. Duleepsinhji**
Vijay Hazare Trophy	List-A (one-day), states	Since 2002-03
Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy	T20, states	Since 2006-07
Deodhar Trophy	List-A, zonal	Since 1973-74 (revived 2023)

Trophy	Format	Note
C.K. Nayudu Trophy	Under-23 multi-day	Named after India's first Test captain
Cooch Behar Trophy	Under-19 multi-day	-
Vinoo Mankad Trophy	Under-19 one-day	-

Bilateral trophy	Teams
Border-Gavaskar Trophy	India vs Australia (Tests)
Anderson-Tendulkar Trophy	India vs England (Tests), from 2025
Freedom Trophy (Gandhi-Mandela)	India vs South Africa (Tests)
The Ashes	England vs Australia
Chappell-Hadlee Trophy	Australia vs New Zealand (ODIs)
Frank Worrell Trophy	Australia vs West Indies (Tests)

D. Football

9.13 FIFA World Cup 2026: Spain are champions

- **In focus: Spain beat Argentina 1-0 after extra time** in the final at **MetLife Stadium, East Rutherford (New Jersey)** on **19 Jul 2026**. **Ferran Torres** scored in the **106th minute**.
  - This was the **23rd** World Cup, co-hosted by the **USA, Canada and Mexico**. It was the first World Cup with **three host nations** and the first with **48 teams**.
  - **104 matches** were played in **16 host cities** over **39 days** (11 Jun - 19 Jul 2026).
  - The opening match was at **Estadio Azteca, Mexico City**.
  - It was Spain's **2nd** title; their first was in **2010** (South Africa, beating the Netherlands). **Argentina** were the defending champions (2022, Qatar).
  - **FIFA** was founded in **1904** and has its headquarters in **Zurich**. Its President is **Gianni Infantino**.
  - The first World Cup was in **1930** (Uruguay). **Brazil** have the most titles (5).
- **Next hosts: 2030** Morocco, Spain and Portugal, with three centenary matches in **Uruguay, Argentina and Paraguay**; **2034** Saudi Arabia; **Women's World Cup 2027** Brazil (the first in South America).

9.14 Other football to know

Item	Detail
Subroto Cup	Inter-school football (since 1960), named after **Air Marshal Subroto Mukerjee**
AIFF President	**Kalyan Chaubey**

E. Multi-sport Events

9.15 Commonwealth Games 2026, Glasgow

- **In focus:** The **23rd Commonwealth Games** were held in **Glasgow, Scotland** (23 Jul - 2 Aug 2026). India finished **4th** with **39 medals (13 G, 17 S, 9 B)**, including para events.
  - Glasgow ran a **slimmed-down 10-sport programme** to cut costs. **Hockey, wrestling, shooting, badminton, cricket, table tennis and squash were dropped**, and most of those are Indian medal sports.
  - **74** nations and territories took part.
  - India **topped the boxing table** (7 G, 3 S).
- **Background: Victoria (Australia)** withdrew as host in **July 2023** over costs. **Glasgow** stepped in (confirmed **Sep 2024**). Glasgow had also hosted the **2014** Games. At **Birmingham 2022**, India won **61 medals (22 G)** and also finished 4th.

  Static link: The Games began as the **British Empire Games** in **1930** at **Hamilton, Canada**. **Commonwealth Sport** (formerly the CGF) has its headquarters in **London**. India hosted the **2010** Games in **Delhi**.

Indian medallist	Event	Medal
Mirabai Chanu	Weightlifting, women's 48 kg	**Gold** (3rd consecutive CWG gold)
Neeraj Chopra	Javelin	Silver
Gulveer Singh	10,000 m / 5,000 m	Silver / Bronze
Tejaswin Shankar	Decathlon	Bronze (India's **first CWG decathlon medal**)
Narender Berwal	Boxing, +90 kg	Silver
Asmita Dey, **Harsh Singh**	Judo	Gold
Soman Rana, **Sharmila Dhankar** (F57 shot put), **Dilip Gavit**	Para athletics	Gold
Jhandu Kumar	Para powerlifting	Bronze

9.16 Asian Games: host and history

- **In focus:** The **20th Asian Games** were hosted by **Aichi-Nagoya, Japan**, from September 2026.

  Static link: The first Asian Games were held in **New Delhi, 1951**. India hosted again in **Delhi, 1982**, with the mascot **Appu**. The **Olympic Council of Asia** is headquartered in **Kuwait City**.
- **Remember:** Aichi-Nagoya is the Asian Games venue; **Milano-Cortina** is the Winter Olympics venue.

  Static link: Japan previously hosted at **Tokyo in 1958** and **Hiroshima in 1994**, so Aichi-Nagoya is its **third Asian Games host setting**. The **Hangzhou 2022** edition was held in **2023**, demonstrating how an edition label can differ from the actual competition year. The future hosts already identified here are **Doha, 2030**, and **Riyadh, 2034**.

9.17 Winter Olympics and Paralympics 2026, Milano-Cortina

- **In focus:** The **25th Winter Olympics** were held in **Milan and Cortina d'Ampezzo, Italy** (6-22 Feb 2026).

  Static link: **Next Winter Games: 2030 French Alps** and **2034 Salt Lake City-Utah**. The **IPC** has its headquarters in **Bonn**.

9.18 Future hosts and India's Olympic bid

- **IOC leadership: Kirsty Coventry** (Zimbabwe) is the first woman and first African IOC President. She was elected in Mar 2025 and took office on **23 Jun 2025**. The IOC has its headquarters in **Lausanne**.
- **New sports at LA 2028:** cricket (T20), flag football, lacrosse (sixes), squash, and baseball/softball.

Event	Future hosts
Summer Olympics	**2028 Los Angeles** (LA's 3rd, after 1932 and 1984); **2032 Brisbane**
Winter Olympics	**2030 French Alps**; **2034 Salt Lake City-Utah**
Asian Games	**2030 Doha**; **2034 Riyadh**
Commonwealth Games	**2030 Ahmedabad** (centenary)
FIFA World Cup	**2030** Morocco-Spain-Portugal (+ centenary matches in South America); **2034** Saudi Arabia
ICC events	ODI World Cup **2027** (SA, Zimbabwe, Namibia); T20 World Cup **2028** (Australia, NZ); Champions Trophy **2029** (India)

F. Chess

9.19 46th Chess Olympiad, Samarkand 2026

- **In focus:** The **46th Chess Olympiad** was held from **15 to 27 Sep 2026** in **Samarkand, Uzbekistan**.
- **Open section: Uzbekistan won gold**, their 2nd title after Chennai 2022, this time at home. **India**, the defending champions, took **silver**, and **Germany** took bronze.
- **45th Olympiad, Budapest 2024: India won double gold** (Open and Women) for the first time.
- **44th Olympiad, Chennai (Mamallapuram) 2022:** India's first time as host. Uzbekistan won the Open and Ukraine won the Women's section, with India taking bronze in both (India-2 Open, India-1 Women). The **Olympiad torch relay** began in 2022, starting from India.
- **Trophies:** the **Hamilton-Russell Cup** (Open), the **Vera Menchik Cup** (Women) and the **Nona Gaprindashvili Trophy** (best combined).
  - The first official Olympiad was held in **1927 in London**.

9.20 World Championship cycle: Gukesh vs Sindarov, and Vaishali's win

- **D Gukesh** became the **18th** and **youngest** undisputed world champion (aged 18) by beating **Ding Liren** 7.5-6.5 in **Singapore** on **12 Dec 2024**. He is the second Indian champion after **Viswanathan Anand**.
  - **R Vaishali** is the sister of **R Praggnanandhaa**. She became India's 3rd woman GM in 2023, after Koneru Humpy (2002) and Harika Dronavalli (2011).

Static link: **Viswanathan Anand** was India's first GM (1988) and is a 5-time world champion. **Koneru Humpy** is a 2-time Women's World Rapid Champion (2019, 2024).

G. Tennis, Hockey, Badminton and Other Sports

9.21 Tennis Grand Slams 2026

- **Wimbledon** is the oldest Slam (**1877**), played on grass at the All England Club.
  - **Roland Garros**'s main court is **Philippe-Chatrier** (clay). The **Australian Open**'s is **Rod Laver Arena**. The **US Open**'s is **Arthur Ashe Stadium** at **Flushing Meadows**.
  - The **ITF** has its headquarters in **London**. Team events: the **Davis Cup** (men, from 1900) and the **Billie Jean King Cup** (women, formerly the Fed Cup, from 1963).

Slam (surface, month)	Men's singles	Women's singles
Australian Open (hard; Jan)	**Carlos Alcaraz** beat Novak Djokovic; this completed his **career Grand Slam**	**Elena Rybakina** beat Aryna Sabalenka 6-4 4-6 6-4 (31 Jan); her first AO and 2nd Slam
French Open (clay; May-Jun)	**Alexander Zverev** beat **Flavio Cobolli** in five sets; his **first Slam**, after three lost finals	**Mirra Andreeva** beat qualifier **Maja Chwalińska** 6-3 6-2; her first Slam, and the youngest RG women's champion since Monica Seles
Wimbledon (grass; Jul)	**Jannik Sinner** beat Zverev (12 Jul)	**Linda Nosková** beat **Karolína Muchová** in an all-Czech final

9.22 FIH Hockey World Cups 2026

- **In focus: Belgium and the Netherlands** co-hosted the 2026 World Cups (Aug 2026).
- **Men: Germany beat Spain 1-0** (goal by **Michel Struthoff**) at the **Belfius Hockey Arena, Wavre, Belgium** on **30 Aug 2026**. Germany retained the title, their **4th** (2002, 2006, 2023, 2026).

- **Women: Argentina beat the Netherlands 3-1 in a shootout**, dethroning the three-time defending champions on Dutch soil.
  - India's only Men's World Cup title came in **1975 in Kuala Lumpur** (beat Pakistan 2-1; captain **Ajit Pal Singh**).
  - India hosted in **2018** and **2023** (Bhubaneswar and **Rourkela**; Rourkela's **Birsa Munda Stadium** is India's largest hockey stadium).
  - India has **8 Olympic golds** (1928, 1932, 1936, 1948, 1952, 1956, 1964, 1980), plus bronzes at **Tokyo 2020** and **Paris 2024**.
  - The **FIH** has its headquarters in **Lausanne**; its President is **Tayyab Ikram**. The **Hockey India** President is **Dilip Tirkey**.
  - **National Sports Day (29 Aug)** marks **Major Dhyan Chand**'s birthday.

9.23 Thomas and Uber Cup 2026

- **In focus:** The finals were held at **Horsens, Denmark** (final day 3 May 2026).
  - The **Thomas Cup** (men's world team championship) began in **1949** (after **Sir George Thomas**). The **Uber Cup** (women's) began in **1957** (after **Betty Uber**). The **Sudirman Cup** (mixed team) began in **1989** (after **Dick Sudirman**).
  - India won its first **Thomas Cup in 2022** (Bangkok), beating 14-time champions Indonesia 3-0.
  - The **BWF** has its headquarters in **Kuala Lumpur**.

9.24 Indian athletes: key individual feats

Athlete	Sport	Feat (2025-26)
Mirabai Chanu	Weightlifting	CWG 2026 gold (48 kg, 3rd straight CWG gold); Asian Games 2026 silver (49 kg)
Gulveer Singh	Long-distance running	CWG 2026 silver (10,000 m) and bronze (5,000 m)
Tejaswin Shankar	Decathlon	CWG 2026 bronze, India's first CWG decathlon medal
Neeru Dhanda	Shooting (trap)	Asian Games 2026 double gold (women's trap and mixed trap)
Jyothi Surekha Vennam	Compound archery	Asian Games 2026 women's team gold (title defence)
Narender Berwal	Boxing	CWG 2026 silver (+90 kg)
Sharmila Dhankar	Para athletics (F57 shot put)	CWG 2026 gold
Sheetal Devi	Para archery	See 9.4

9.25 Kho Kho World Cup 2025 and indigenous sports

- **In focus:** The **first Kho Kho World Cup** was held at the **Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium, New Delhi** (13-19 Jan 2025). **India won both** the men's and women's titles, beating **Nepal** in both finals.

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- **Kabaddi:** India won gold in **both men's and women's kabaddi** at the Asian Games 2026. Kabaddi has been an Asian Games sport since **1990 (Beijing)**. India's men lost the gold only once, to **Iran in 2018**.

  Static link: In **Kho Kho**, each team has **12 players**, with **9 on the field**. **Kabaddi** has **7 players** on court per side.

H. Sports Governance and National Events

9.26 Sports institutions and anti-doping framework

Static link: **NADA** was set up in **2005**, and the **National Anti-Doping Act** was passed in **2022**. **WADA** has its headquarters in **Montreal**. The **Sports Authority of India (SAI)** was established in **1984**.

9.27 Khelo Bharat Niti 2025 (National Sports Policy 2025)

- **In focus:** The Union Cabinet approved **Khelo Bharat Niti 2025** on **1 Jul 2025**. It replaces the **National Sports Policy, 2001**.
  - 1. **Excellence on the global stage**
  - 2. **Sports for economic development** (sports manufacturing, sports tourism, start-ups)
  - 3. **Sports for social development**
  - 4. **Sports as a people's movement** (Jan Andolan)
  - 5. **Integration with education** (NEP 2020)
- **TOPS (Target Olympic Podium Scheme):** 2014.
- **Fit India Movement:** launched on **29 Aug 2019**.

9.28 National Games and Khelo India events

Event	Host and date	Result
Khelo India Winter Games 2026 (6th)	Leh and Gulmarg	**Indian Army** (hat-trick)

I. Static Master Tables (Sports GK)

9.29 Trophies and cups → sport

Sport	Trophies and cups
Cricket	Ranji, Irani, Duleep, Vijay Hazare, Syed Mushtaq Ali, Deodhar, C.K. Nayudu, Cooch Behar, Vinoo Mankad; The Ashes; Border-Gavaskar; Anderson-Tendulkar
Football	Santosh Trophy, **Durand Cup** (1888), Subroto Cup, IFA Shield, Federation Cup; Copa América, UEFA Euro, AFC Asian Cup

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Sport	Trophies and cups
Hockey	**Beighton Cup** (Kolkata, 1895; among the oldest hockey tournaments), Agha Khan Cup, Rangaswamy Cup, Murugappa Gold Cup, Obaidullah Khan Cup, **Sultan Azlan Shah Cup** (Malaysia), Sultan of Johor Cup (junior)
Badminton	**Thomas Cup** (men), **Uber Cup** (women), **Sudirman Cup** (mixed)
Tennis	**Davis Cup** (men), **Billie Jean King Cup** (women), Hopman Cup (mixed), Laver Cup
Golf	**Ryder Cup** (USA vs Europe, men), **Solheim Cup** (women), Walker Cup, Presidents Cup
Table tennis	**Swaythling Cup** (men's world team), **Corbillon Cup** (women's)
Polo	**Ezra Cup**, Prithi Singh Cup
Chess	Hamilton-Russell Cup (Olympiad Open), Vera Menchik Cup (Olympiad Women)
Bridge / Rowing / Boat race	Holkar Trophy / Wellington Trophy / **Nehru Trophy Boat Race** (Punnamada Lake, Alappuzha)

9.30 Sports bodies: headquarters and heads

Body	HQ	Head / note
IOC	Lausanne	**Kirsty Coventry** (since 23 Jun 2025)
FIFA	Zurich	Gianni Infantino
ICC	Dubai	**Jay Shah** (Chairman)
FIH (hockey)	Lausanne	Tayyab Ikram
World Athletics	Monaco	Sebastian Coe
BWF (badminton)	Kuala Lumpur	-
ITF (tennis)	London	-
IPC (Paralympics)	Bonn	-
WADA	Montreal	-
OCA	Kuwait City	-
Commonwealth Sport	London	-
World Archery	Lausanne	-
IOA (India)	New Delhi	**P.T. Usha**

9.31 Players per side

Sport	Players	Sport	Players
Football / Hockey / Cricket	11	Kabaddi	7
Kho Kho	9 on field (12 in squad)	Volleyball	6
Basketball	5	Netball / Handball / Water polo	7
Polo	4	Rugby union	15
Baseball	9	Rugby league	13

9.32 Terms → sport

Term	Sport
Bully, penalty corner, short corner	Hockey
Chinaman, googly, doosra, leg-bye, silly point	Cricket
Love, deuce, ace, let, smash	Tennis (smash and let also in badminton)
Checkmate, castling, stalemate, en passant	Chess
Birdie, eagle, albatross, bogey, caddie	Golf
Raider, do-or-die raid, bonus line, "lona"	Kabaddi
Free throw, slam dunk, travelling	Basketball
Snatch, clean and jerk	Weightlifting
Bullseye, bow string	Archery
Chukker, hook, near side	Polo

9.33 India's Olympic milestones

Milestone	Detail
First modern Olympics	**1896 Athens**
India's first participation	**1900 Paris** (Norman Pritchard, 2 silvers in athletics)
First Indian team	**1920 Antwerp**
First individual gold	**Abhinav Bindra**, 10 m air rifle, **Beijing 2008**
First athletics gold	**Neeraj Chopra**, javelin, **Tokyo 2020**
Best tally	**Tokyo 2020: 7 medals** (1 G, 2 S, 4 B)
Paris 2024	**6 medals** (1 S, 5 B); Manu Bhaker won 2 bronzes at one Games
Paris 2024 Paralympics	**29 medals** (7 G, 9 S, 13 B), India's best

9.34 Famous stadiums

Stadium	City	Note
Narendra Modi Stadium	Ahmedabad	World's largest cricket stadium; 2026 T20 World Cup and IPL finals
Eden Gardens	Kolkata	Cricket
Wankhede Stadium	Mumbai	Cricket; 2011 World Cup final
Sher-i-Kashmir Stadium	Srinagar	J&K's international cricket venue
Birsa Munda Stadium	Rourkela	Hockey (2023 World Cup)
Kalinga Stadium	Bhubaneswar	Hockey and athletics
Lord's	London	"Home of Cricket"; 2025 WTC final; 2026 Women's T20 World Cup final
MetLife Stadium	New Jersey	2026 FIFA World Cup final
Maracanã	Rio de Janeiro	Football
Rod Laver Arena / Arthur Ashe Stadium	Melbourne / New York	Tennis

10 Reports and Indices

Major reports and indices: publishing institutions, reference periods and India's position.

A. Economic reports: institutions and measurements

10.1 Economic Survey and the Budget

- **In focus:** The **Economic Survey 2025-26** was prepared by the **Economic Division, Department of Economic Affairs**, under Chief Economic Adviser **V. Anantha Nageswaran**.

  Static link: The Survey reviews economic conditions. The **Union Budget**, called the **Annual Financial Statement**, is provided for under **Article 112**.

- **Remember:** The Survey is **not a constitutional or statutory requirement**. It is distinct from the Budget and is not prepared by NITI Aayog. The first Survey was presented in **1950-51**.

- **Facts:** The 2025-26 Survey contained **16 chapters**. It cited a **2.2% gross NPA ratio**, described as a multi-decadal low, and a record **$387.6 billion in services exports for FY2024-25**. Banking-asset quality and services exports are different indicators, and their reference periods need to be read separately.

10.3 Statistics: identify the new base year

Series	New base	Compiling body
GDP / National Accounts	2022-23	NSO, MoSPI
Consumer Price Index	2024 = 100	NSO, MoSPI

10.3.1 Base years and statistical agencies

- **Facts:** The new CPI series was released in **February 2026**; its weights draw on **HCES 2023-24**. The new GDP series was also released in February 2026.

  Static link: The **NSO**, under **MoSPI**, was formed in 2019 by merging CSO and NSSO. The **WPI** is compiled by the **Office of the Economic Adviser, DPIIT**; **CPI-AL/RL** comes from the **Labour Bureau**.

- **Remember:** The CPI base is a **calendar year**; the GDP base is a **financial year**. A base-year change is a statistical revision, not evidence of higher growth by itself.

- **Facts:** The GDP revision uses information including **GST data, MCA filings, PLFS, ASUSE and HCES**. The revised CPI uses the **COICOP 2018 classification**, with **12 divisions** and updated consumption weights. The base-year revision therefore concerns both the reference year and the statistical information used in the series, rather than merely replacing the year printed beside an unchanged measure.

10.4 RBI's recurring publications

Publication	Frequency / reference	Purpose
Financial Stability Report	Half-yearly: June and December	Financial-system risks and resilience
Monetary Policy Report	Half-yearly: April and October	Monetary policy and inflation assessment
Annual Report	Annual; statutory	RBI operations and accounts
State Finances: A Study of Budgets	RBI publication	State government finances
Report on Currency and Finance	RBI publication	Economic and financial analysis
Trend and Progress of Banking in India	RBI publication	Banking-sector developments

10.4.1 Financial Inclusion Index

- **In focus:** The **RBI Financial Inclusion Index** was **70.0 for March 2026**, compared with **67.0 for March 2025**, on a **0-100 scale**.
- **Facts:** Its parameters are **Access: 35%**, **Usage: 45%**, and **Quality: 20%**. The index is published in July for the year ending March.
- **Remember: Usage has the greatest weight.** An index value is not a country rank. The FSR is the RBI's report and reflects the FSDC sub-committee's views.

  Static link: The three parameters separate the reach of services from their use and quality. The **weights add to 100%**, while the index itself is presented on a **0-100 scale**. The March reference date and July publication cycle are separate: "March 2026" identifies the period assessed, rather than necessarily the day on which the index was announced. **Global Findex**, by contrast, is a **World Bank** financial-inclusion database.

10.5 J&K: read the economic indicators

- **Facts:** The **J&K Economic Survey 2025-26** recorded **5.82% real GSDP growth**, nominal GSDP of **₹2.86 lakh crore** and per-capita NSDP of **₹1,68,243**.

  Static link: The **tertiary sector**, about **61%**, had the largest share. Per-capita NSDP is a state-income measure.
- **Remember:** The national comparison is **₹2,19,575**. J&K's figure is lower. For the J&K Budget and Economic Survey, see Chapter 1.
- **Facts:** The Survey's **nominal GSDP growth was 8.89%**, while the reported **real growth was 5.82%**. Its **₹2.86 lakh crore GSDP** is the nominal size of the economy. The **61% tertiary-sector share** describes the composition of that economy, not a rate of annual growth. Keeping size, growth, sector share and per-capita income in separate categories prevents interpreting every percentage as the same kind of indicator.

10.2 Global institutions and their reports

Institution	Flagship report	Reference use
IMF	World Economic Outlook; Global Financial Stability Report; Fiscal Monitor	Growth outlook; financial risks; public finances
World Bank	Global Economic Prospects; World Development Report	Global outlook; development themes
OECD	Economic Outlook	Economic projections and policy analysis
World Bank	Global Findex	Financial-inclusion database
World Bank	B-READY / Business Ready	Business environment; replacement for Doing Business

10.21 Business Ready and Doing Business

- **Facts:** The World Bank discontinued **Doing Business in 2021**. **B-READY** is the replacement report, with **three pillars and ten topics**.
- **Remember:** Old Doing Business rankings belong to a discontinued series. **IMF = World Economic Outlook**; **World Bank = Global Economic Prospects**; **OECD = Economic Outlook**.

Static link: Other World Bank products include the **Logistics Performance Index**, **Human Capital Index**, **World Development Report** and **Global Findex**. The **IMF** publishes the **World Economic Outlook**, **Global Financial Stability Report** and **Fiscal Monitor**. These names distinguish economic outlooks, business conditions, financial inclusion and fiscal analysis; the shared economic theme does not make the reports interchangeable.

10.2.1 Report frequency and reference periods

Static link: The **IMF World Economic Outlook** is published twice a year, in **April and October**, with updates in **January and July**. **World Bank Global Economic Prospects** appears in **January and June**, while the **World Development Report** is annual. **OECD Economic Outlook** is also published twice a year.

- **Remember:** A forecast belongs to a specific publication date and forecast year; it is not a settled outturn. The report's title and institution provide the stable association, while its forecast can be revised. This distinction is why a current-affairs question should be read for both the publisher and the reference period.

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B. Development and welfare: selected report editions

10.6 Development indices and India's position

Edition	Publisher	India: key result
Human Development Report 2025	UNDP	HDI: 130 of 193; 0.685; medium human development
World Happiness Report 2026	UN SDSN, with Gallup and Oxford Wellbeing Research Centre	116 of 147; Finland first
Global Gender Gap Report 2025	World Economic Forum	131 of 148; Iceland first
Global Hunger Index 2025	Concern Worldwide and Welthungerhilfe	102 of 123; serious hunger
Sustainable Development Report 2025	UN SDSN	SDG Index: 99th
SDG India Index 2023-24	NITI Aayog	India score: 71; Kerala and Uttarakhand first

10.6.1 HDI: what is actually measured?

Static link: The **Human Development Index** measures **health, education and standard of living**.

- **Health:** life expectancy.
- **Education:** expected and mean years of schooling.
- **Income:** GNI per capita at purchasing-power parity.

- **Remember:** HDI uses **GNI per capita, PPP**, rather than nominal GDP per capita. It was developed by **Mahbub ul Haq**, with **Amartya Sen**, and first published in **1990**.
- **In focus:** The 2025 report was titled **A Matter of Choice: People and Possibilities in the Age of AI**. India's **0.685** placed it in the **Medium Human Development** category; the High category begins at **0.700**. The reported comparison was **0.676 for 2022 data** against **0.685 for 2023 data**, showing that a report's publication year can differ from the year measured.

Static link: UNDP also publishes the **Gender Inequality Index** and, with Oxford's **OPHI**, the **Global Multidimensional Poverty Index**. These are separate measures within the development-report family. The presence of education, health or income in more than one framework does not make **HDI**, **Global MPI** and **Gender Inequality Index** synonyms.

10.9 Hunger: the four indicators

Static link: The Global Hunger Index uses **undernourishment, child stunting, child wasting and child mortality**. Its publishers are non-governmental organisations, not FAO or WFP.

- **Remember:** A rank must be read with its **edition year and number of countries**. A changed denominator makes a direct year-to-year ranking comparison incomplete.
- **Facts:** India's **2025 score was 25.8**, in the **serious** category. The four indicators combine overall undernourishment with three child outcomes. The score and the ordinal rank are separate results: **102**

of 123 identifies relative position, while **25.8** determines the severity category. A different number of ranked countries between editions can alter how a rank comparison should be read.

10.8 Gender-gap and SDG concepts

Static link: The Gender Gap Report covers **economic participation, educational attainment, health and survival, and political empowerment**.

- **Remember:** The **WEF Global Gender Gap** and **UNDP Gender Inequality Index** are different. The SDGs have **17 goals and 169 targets**, with a **2030** deadline. The global SDG Index and SDG India Index have different publishers.
- **Facts:** The Global Gender Gap score expresses the **share of the gap closed** across its four dimensions. The **Global Gender Gap Report** comes from the **WEF**, a Swiss foundation, whereas **UNDP's Gender Inequality Index** is part of a different institutional framework. In the SDG family, the global index compares countries, while **NITI Aayog's SDG India Index** compares performance within India.

  Static link: The **SDG India Index 2023-24** was its **fourth edition**. **Kerala and Uttarakhand** scored **79**, while India's composite score was **71**. The national score had risen from **57 in 2018**. **Goal 14, Life Below Water**, is left out of the composite India score because its state assessment applies only to coastal states. A state score is not India's global rank.

10.19 Poverty and population reports

- **Facts: Global MPI:** UNDP and **OPHI, Oxford**; ten indicators in three dimensions. **National MPI: NITI Aayog**; twelve indicators, adding maternal health and bank accounts.

  Static link: **State of World Population = UNFPA**. **World Population Prospects = UN DESA**. **PLFS** and **HCES** are NSO / MoSPI surveys; HCES informs the CPI consumption basket.

  Static link: The **World Inequality Report 2026** comes from the **World Inequality Lab at the Paris School of Economics**. Its India finding assigns about **58% of national income to the top 10%**, and about **15% to the bottom 50%**. This is an **income distribution** statement. It should not be reworded as the share of national wealth, or as the number of people below a poverty line.
- **Remember: World Population Prospects** provides UN population projections; **State of World Population** is the **UNFPA** flagship. **Global MPI** has **ten indicators**; the Indian national framework has **twelve**. The two additional national indicators are **maternal health and bank accounts**. Keep the institution, unit of assessment and indicator count together rather than treating every poverty or population report as a World Bank publication.

10.7 Happiness: method and institution

Static link: The report uses the **Cantril ladder**, a **0-10 life-evaluation scale**, and six explanatory factors: **GDP per capita, social support, healthy life expectancy, freedom, generosity and perceived corruption**. It is associated with **20 March, International Day of Happiness**.

- **Remember:** The **World Happiness Report** is distinct from Bhutan's **Gross National Happiness** concept. A life-evaluation measure is not identical to the HDI's three-dimension framework. Both discuss human well-being, but their publisher, inputs and scale differ.

C. Governance, innovation and mobility

10.10 Core index mappings

Edition / index	Publisher	India / key result
Corruption Perceptions Index 2025	Transparency International	91 of 182; score 39
Henley Passport Index 2026	Henley & Partners	77th; 59 accessible destinations
Global Peace Index 2026	Institute for Economics & Peace	127th; Iceland most peaceful
Global Innovation Index 2025	WIPO	38 of 139; Switzerland first
World Press Freedom Index	Reporters Without Borders / RSF	Publisher mapping; Paris-based NGO
Global Terrorism Index	Institute for Economics & Peace	Measures terrorism impact

10.10.1 Corruption Perceptions Index

Static link: Transparency International is headquartered in **Berlin**. The CPI score runs from **0, highly corrupt**, to **100, very clean**, and reflects expert and business assessments.

- **Remember:** In economy questions, **CPI** may mean **Consumer Price Index**. In governance questions, it may mean **Corruption Perceptions Index**; read the context.
- **Facts:** The **2025 index**, published in **February 2026**, ranked **182 countries**. **Denmark** was the leading country. The index uses **expert and business surveys**, while Transparency International's **Global Corruption Barometer** is a **public-opinion survey**. The two products share a publisher but collect and present different kinds of evidence; the Barometer should not be substituted for the CPI.

10.13 Peace, terrorism and passports

- **Remember: Global Peace Index:** a lower rank number means more peaceful. **Global Terrorism Index:** rank one means most affected. Both come from **IEP, Sydney**.

  Static link: The **Henley Passport Index** uses **IATA data**. It measures visa-free or visa-on-arrival access, rather than income or diplomatic influence.
- **Facts: Iceland** has led the Global Peace Index since **2008**. **Singapore** led the Henley Passport Index 2026, with access to **193 destinations**, against India's **59**. The passport count describes destination access, not the number of countries issuing passports. Henley's measure also differs from the **Arton Capital Passport Index**, despite the similar subject.

10.14 Innovation and the two GIIs

Static link: **WIPO**, headquartered in **Geneva**, is a UN specialised agency and publishes the **Global Innovation Index**.

- **Remember: GII** can mean **Global Innovation Index, WIPO**, or **Gender Inequality Index, UNDP**. The abbreviated name alone does not identify the publication.
- **Facts:** In the innovation index, **Switzerland** ranked first and India was **38th of 139** in **2025**. India's earlier rank of **81st in 2015** provides long-term context. **WIPO** is associated with intellectual property

and innovation; **UNDP** with human-development measures. When the abbreviation **GII** appears, the expanded title determines which institutional and statistical framework the question concerns.

D. Environmental reports and indicators

10.17 Environmental indices

Edition	Publisher	India / key point
Environmental Performance Index 2026	Yale and Columbia	176 of 177
Climate Change Performance Index 2026	Germanwatch, NewClimate Institute and CAN	23rd; ranks 1-3 vacant
Climate Risk Index 2026	Germanwatch	9th most affected, 1995-2024
Energy Transition Index 2025	WEF and Accenture	71st
Swachh Vayu Survekshan 2026	CPCB / MoEFCC	Lucknow first: over-10-lakh category
India State of Forest Report 2023	Forest Survey of India	Forest-and-tree cover: 25.17%

10.17.1 Environmental rankings: useful distinctions

- **Remember: EPI is not UNEP's report.** In **CCPI**, no country occupies ranks **1-3**; **Denmark at fourth** is the leading country.

  Static link: **Swachh Vayu Survekshan** assesses air-quality action; **Swachh Survekshan**, under **MoHUA**, assesses cleanliness.

  Static link: The **EPI is biennial**. **Germanwatch** is linked to both the **Climate Change Performance Index** and the **Climate Risk Index**, but the first concerns climate performance while the second concerns impacts of extreme weather. The 2026 Climate Risk Index result refers to **1995-2024**. Its edition year is not the entire time period underlying the risk assessment.

10.18 UN environment and food reports

Report	Publisher	Core subject
Emissions Gap Report 2025: Off Target	UNEP	Gap between emissions pledges and pathways
Adaptation Gap Report 2025: Running on Empty	UNEP	Adaptation finance and needs
Global Environment Outlook	UNEP	Climate, biodiversity and pollution

Report	Publisher	Core subject
State of the Global Climate; Greenhouse Gas Bulletin	WMO	Climate observations and greenhouse gases
World Water Development Report	UNESCO for UN-Water	Water and development
State of Food Security and Nutrition in the World	FAO, IFAD, UNICEF, WFP and WHO	Food security and nutrition

10.18.1 Reports, observations and assessments

Static link: The **IPCC**, established by **WMO and UNEP in 1988**, assesses published research; it does not conduct original research. **WMO** reports climate observations; **UNEP** publishes the gap reports.

- **Remember: SOFI** has **five joint publishers**. **World Water Development Report** comes from UNESCO for UN-Water; neither report is a single-agency hunger index.
- **Facts:** UNEP's **Emissions Gap Report 2025** estimates **2.3-2.5°C** warming with full NDC implementation. Its **Adaptation Gap Report 2025** identifies annual developing-country needs of **$365 billion by 2035**, against **$26 billion public adaptation finance in 2023**. The first report concerns the emissions pathway; the second compares adaptation needs with finance. Their related "gap" titles describe different gaps.

E. Indian indices: essential institutions

10.22 Indian reporting institutions

Publisher	Indices / reports
NITI Aayog	SDG India Index; National MPI; Fiscal Health Index; Export Preparedness Index
RBI	Financial Inclusion Index; State Finances: A Study of Budgets
Ministry of Education	National Institutional Ranking Framework / NIRF
DARPG	Good Governance Index
Forest Survey of India	India State of Forest Report
MoHUA	Swachh Survekshan
MoEFCC / CPCB	Swachh Vayu Survekshan

10.22.1 Use the right edition

- **Remember:** Learn the **report-publisher pair first**, then its edition-specific number. A **rank** is an ordinal position; an **index value** is a score; a **forecast** is a projection.

  Static link: NIRF is the **Education Ministry's framework**. The **Fiscal Health Index** is a **NITI Aayog** product; **State Finances** is an **RBI** report.

- **Facts:** Within India, the same publisher can produce different indices. **NITI Aayog** produces development, poverty and fiscal-health measures. **RBI** produces financial-inclusion and state-finance reports. **FSI** reports forests, while **CPCB / MoEFCC** assess air-quality action. Matching the topic to the institution is a practical first step before learning the edition-specific value.

10.19.1 Indian household and labour surveys

- **Facts: HCES** means **Household Consumption Expenditure Survey**; the **2023-24 survey** informs the revised CPI weights. **PLFS** means **Periodic Labour Force Survey**. Both are released through **NSO / MoSPI**, but one concerns household consumption and the other labour-market estimates.
- **In focus: Monthly PLFS estimates began in 2025**, in addition to the earlier quarterly urban and annual reporting framework. A survey's subject should be learned with its publisher, since consumption, employment and price statistics have different roles even when the same statistical office is involved.

11 Appointments & Institutions

Key officeholders, financial institutions and the constitutional rules behind appointments.

A. Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh

11.1 Regional officeholders

Office	Officeholder	Essential connection
Lieutenant Governor, J&K	**Manoj Sinha**	Second LG of the UT; first was G.C. Murmu.
Chief Minister, J&K	**Omar Abdullah**	Assumed office on 16 October 2024; holds Finance.
Chief Secretary, J&K	**Atal Dulloo**	In office from 1 December 2023.
Chief Justice, J&K and Ladakh High Court	**Pushpendra Singh Bhati**	Took oath on 9 September 2026.
Lieutenant Governor, Ladakh	**Vinai Kumar Saxena**	Fourth LG; took oath on 13 March 2026.
Chief Secretary, Ladakh	**Ashish Kundra**	Took charge on 1 January 2026.
Chairman, JKSSB	**Vikas Kundal**	JKSSB recruits for non-gazetted posts, including FAA.
Interim Chairman, JKPSC	**Farooq Ahmad Lone**	JKPSC recruits for gazetted services.

11.1.1 A common High Court for two UTs

- **In focus: Arun Palli** moved from the J&K and Ladakh High Court to the Supreme Court in June 2026. **Sanjeev Kumar** served as Acting Chief Justice before Pushpendra Singh Bhati took over.
- **Facts:** Bhati's oath was administered by **V.K. Saxena**, then holding additional charge of J&K. The High Court has wings in **Jammu and Srinagar**.

Static link: The President appoints High Court judges under **Article 217** and an Acting Chief Justice under **Article 223**. Article 219 concerns the oath; Article 231 permits a common High Court. Retirement: **62 for HC judges; 65 for SC judges**.

Static link: The **J&K Reorganisation Act, 2019** retained the common High Court after the former state was reorganised into two UTs. A High Court judge's **appointment**, **oath** and **acting-Chief-Justice arrangement** are therefore three separate legal questions, governed by Articles 217, 219 and 223 respectively.

11.3 Public Service Commissions

- **In focus:** JKPSC Chairman **Arun Kumar Choudhary** retired in August 2026 on reaching 62; Farooq Ahmad Lone became interim Chairman.

Static link: **Articles 315-323** govern PSCs. A State PSC member serves six years or until 62; a UPSC member until 65. Article 316(1A) covers performance of the Chairman's duties during a vacancy.

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- **Remember:** State PSC members are appointed by the **Governor** but removed by the **President**. For misbehaviour, removal follows a **Supreme Court inquiry** under Article 317.

11.4 J&K Bank and the audit connection

- **In focus:** J&K Bank's part-time Chairman is **S. Krishnan**; its MD & CEO is **Amitava Chatterjee**. Principal Accountant General (A&E), J&K: **Jay Prakash Narayan Singh**.

  Static link: J&K Bank was founded in **1938**, is headquartered in **Srinagar**, and is classified by RBI as a **private-sector bank** despite government majority ownership. RBI approval of its chairman or MD is required under **Section 35B of the Banking Regulation Act, 1949**.

- **Remember:** A&E offices handle accounts, GPF and pensions; audit is a separate function. **G.C. Murmu**, J&K's first LG, later became the **14th CAG**.

- **Facts:** J&K Bank's part-time Chairman and MD & CEO are separate positions. The bank chooses its leadership through its own governance process, while **RBI approval** is the regulatory requirement. Government shareholding alone does not turn it into a nationalised public-sector bank.

B. Audit, accounts and financial leadership

11.13 CAG and CGA: two different functions

- **In focus: K. Sanjay Murthy** is the **15th Comptroller and Auditor General**. **T.C.A. Kalyani** took charge as the **29th Controller General of Accounts** on 1 September 2025.

- **Facts:** The **CGA**, in the Department of Expenditure, Ministry of Finance, is the Union Government's **principal accounts adviser** and runs **PFMS**. It compiles monthly accounts, **Union Finance Accounts and Appropriation Accounts**. The **CAG audits** the annual accounts before they are placed before Parliament. Union accounts were separated from audit in **1976**, when ICAS was created.

  Static link: The **President appoints the CAG**, whose removal is like that of a Supreme Court judge. Tenure is **six years or 65 years of age**, under the **CAG (Duties, Powers and Conditions of Service) Act, 1971**. Office expenses are charged on the Consolidated Fund of India. The CAG cannot hold a further government office after retirement.

- **Facts:** In many States, Accountant General **A&E offices under the CAG** still compile accounts. This differs from the Union's separation of accounting and audit. The CGA holds an **executive** position, whereas the CAG has a constitutionally protected office.

- **Remember: Articles 148-151** form a functional chain: **148 = office and appointment; 149 = duties and powers; 150 = form of accounts; 151 = audit reports**. The President prescribes the form of Union and State accounts on CAG's advice. Reports go to the President or Governor for placement before the respective legislature.

11.14 Finance: office and institution

Institution / office	Head	Static connection
RBI Governor	**Sanjay Malhotra**	26th Governor; RBI Act, 1934.
SEBI	**Tuhin Kanta Pandey**	Securities-market regulator; SEBI Act, 1992.
IRDAI	**Ajay Seth**	Insurance regulator; IRDA Act, 1999.

Institution / office	Head	Static connection
PFRDA	**Sivasubramanian Ramann**	Pensions; PFRDA Act, 2013.
NABARD	**Shaji K.V.**	Apex rural-development bank; established 1982.
SBI	**C.S. Setty**	SBI Act, 1955.
LIC	**R. Doraiswamy**	CEO & MD; LIC Act, 1956.
Chief Economic Adviser	**V. Anantha Nageswaran**	Economic Survey; Department of Economic Affairs.
ICAI President, 2026-27	**Prasanna Kumar D**	74th President; Chartered Accountants Act, 1949.

11.14.1 RBI Deputy Governors

- **In focus:** The four Deputy Governors are **Swaminathan J, Poonam Gupta, S.C. Murmu and Rohit Jain**. Rohit Jain succeeded **T. Rabi Sankar** in May 2026.

  Static link: Under Section 8 of the RBI Act, 1934, the maximum number of Deputy Governors is **four**. The Governor and Deputy Governors are appointed by the **Central Government**.

- **Remember:** RBI approval governs private-bank leadership. **FSIB** recommends heads of public-sector banks and financial institutions.

  Static link: The RBI Central Board combines the **Governor and up to four Deputy Governors** with directors drawn from the four local boards, directors nominated by the Centre and government officials. The local boards are associated with **Mumbai, Kolkata, Chennai and New Delhi**. This statutory board is different from the **Monetary Policy Committee**, which determines the policy repo rate.

11.16 Commissions and professional bodies

- **In focus: 16th Finance Commission:** Arvind Panagariya. **8th Central Pay Commission:** Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai, who earlier chaired the J&K Delimitation Commission. **NITI Aayog Vice-Chairperson:** Ashok Kumar Lahiri; **CEO:** Anurag Jain.

  Static link: The **Finance Commission** is constitutional under **Article 280** and has a Chairman plus four members. A **Pay Commission** is created by executive resolution. **NITI Aayog** was created by Cabinet resolution in 2015; the Prime Minister is its Chairperson.

- **Remember: ICAI** was established on **1 July 1949**. **MCA** notifies Ind AS. **GASAB**, established in 2002, functions under the CAG.

- **Facts:** The Chief Economic Adviser's team prepares the **Economic Survey** in the **Department of Economic Affairs**. The **Chief Statistician of India** heads the National Statistics Office under **MoSPI**. These are different roles: economic analysis and statistical compilation should not be interchanged.

  Static link: The **Finance Commission** is appointed by the President under Article 280, with member qualifications prescribed by the **Finance Commission (Miscellaneous Provisions) Act, 1951**. A Central Pay Commission is appointed to examine government pay; its executive origin is different from the Finance Commission's constitutional origin.

  Static link: NITI Aayog replaced the **Planning Commission** through a Cabinet resolution on **1 January 2015**. Its Governing Council includes Chief Ministers and UT Lieutenant Governors. The Vice-Chairperson has Cabinet rank; the CEO is a Secretary-rank officer. **Neither constitutional nor statutory** is the legal-status distinction: the institution rests on an executive resolution.

11.15 Regulators: law, field and location

Institution	Legal basis	Field / useful location
SEBI	SEBI Act, 1992	Securities markets; began as a non-statutory body in 1988.
IRDAI	IRDA Act, 1999	Insurance; Hyderabad headquarters.
PFRDA	PFRDA Act, 2013	NPS and Atal Pension Yojana.
IBBI	Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, 2016	Insolvency regulation; established on 1 October 2016.
IFSCA	IFSCA Act, 2019	International financial-services centres; GIFT City, Gandhinagar.
NFRA	Companies Act, 2013, Section 132	Auditors of listed and large companies; established in 2018.
GSTAT	CGST Act, 2017, Section 109	GST Appellate Tribunal; first President: Sanjaya Kumar Mishra.

11.18 Accounting bodies: a short institutional map

Static link: **ICAI**, created under the Chartered Accountants Act, 1949, is under the **Ministry of Corporate Affairs** and is headquartered in New Delhi. **ICSI** is linked to the Company Secretaries Act, 1980; **ICMAI** to the Cost and Works Accountants Act, 1959.

- **Remember:** Professional bodies, standard-setting authority and audit oversight are separate. **MCA notifies Ind AS; NFRA oversees covered corporate auditors; GASAB advises on government accounting standards under the CAG.** An organisation's familiar name does not by itself identify which of these functions it performs.

C. Constitutional offices and selection rules

11.6 Names with their constitutional anchors

- **Facts: President Droupadi Murmu** and **Vice-President C.P. Radhakrishnan** are the 15th holders of their respective offices. **Surya Kant** became the **53rd CJI** on 24 November 2025, succeeding **B.R. Gavai**.

  Static link: President's oath: **CJI, Article 60**. Vice-President's oath: **President, Article 69**. SC judges are appointed by the President under **Article 124**.

- **In focus:** Attorney General **R. Venkataramani** was reappointed for **two years from 1 October 2025**.
- **Remember:** Under **Article 76**, the Attorney General holds office at the President's pleasure. Under **Article 88**, the AG may participate in either House but **cannot vote**. The Solicitor General is an executive office.

11.12 Election Commission

- **In focus: Gyanesh Kumar** is the **26th CEC**. Election Commissioners: **Sukhbir Singh Sandhu** and **Vivek Joshi**.

Static link: Under the **2023 appointment Act**, the Selection Committee comprises the **Prime Minister, a Union Cabinet Minister nominated by the PM, and the Lok Sabha Leader of Opposition**. Tenure: **six years or 65**, whichever is earlier.

- **Remember: Article 324(5):** the CEC is removed like an SC judge; an Election Commissioner can be removed only on the CEC's recommendation.

11.19 Selection committees to distinguish

Office	Selection committee	Legal basis
Central Vigilance Commissioner	PM, Home Minister, Lok Sabha LoP	CVC Act, 2003
Chief Information Commissioner	PM, Lok Sabha LoP, Cabinet Minister nominated by PM	RTI Act, 2005
CBI Director	PM, Lok Sabha LoP, CJI or nominated SC judge	DSPE Act, 1946

11.24 International institutions

- **In focus: UNHCR:** Barham Salih, former President of Iraq, from January 2026. **IMF Managing Director:** Kristalina Georgieva; **First Deputy MD:** Dan Katz, who replaced Gita Gopinath in October 2025. **World Bank:** Ajay Banga. **AIIB:** Zou Jiayi, second President from January 2026.

  Static link: UNHCR headquarters: **Geneva**; AIIB: **Beijing**. UNHCR concerns refugees; the UN Human Rights Council is a separate body.

  Static link: **UNHCR**, established in 1950, received the Nobel Peace Prize in **1954 and 1981**. The **UN Human Rights Council**, established in 2006, has **47 members** serving three-year terms. A refugee agency and a human-rights intergovernmental council are different institutions.

- **Facts:** Other financial heads: **Masato Kanda = ADB; Dilma Rousseff = New Development Bank**. ADB is headquartered in **Manila**; NDB in **Shanghai**. The first NDB President was India's **K.V. Kamath**; AIIB's founding President was **Jin Liqun**.

11.7 Governor and Lieutenant Governor: appointment rules

Static link: A Governor is appointed by the **President under Article 155**, serves a nominal five-year term under Article 156, and holds office at the President's pleasure. The minimum age is **35**. Under Article 159, the oath is administered by the **High Court Chief Justice**.

- **Remember: Article 153** allows the same person to be Governor of more than one State. A UT Administrator or LG operates under **Article 239**, has no fixed constitutional tenure, and should not be confused with a State Governor or an elected Chief Minister.

11.19.1 Vigilance, information and investigation

Static link: The **CVC** began in 1964 following the **Santhanam Committee** and became statutory under the **CVC Act, 2003**. The **CIC** is established under the **RTI Act, 2005**. The **CBI** was set up in 1963 and its director-selection provision is in the **DSPE Act, 1946**.

- **Facts:** CVC tenure is **four years or 65**. CIC tenure is governed by central rules following the **2019 RTI amendment**; the earlier five-year rule should not be carried forward automatically. A CBI Director has a minimum two-year term, extendable in one-year steps up to five years in all.

12 Books & Authors

Prominent current titles, essential J&K texts and the author-book pairs worth revising.

A. J&K titles in focus

12.1 Recent books and their authors

Book	Author / translator	Essential connection
Living the Gita Today	Vandana Sharma, Shachi Sood and Vinay Kumar	Released by LG Manoj Sinha, September 2026.
Journal of the Waypoints	Poetry: Satish Vimal; translation: Mushtaque B. Barq	Kashmiri poetry presented in English.
History of Kashmiri Language and Poetry	Abdul Ahad Azad; translation: Umar Shah	English translation released in September 2026.
The Stranger Besides Me	Neerja Mattoo	Released at Lok Bhavan, Srinagar.
Sardar Patel and Kashmir: The Untold History	Edited by Rizwan Kadri	Released by LG Manoj Sinha, September 2026.
When the Heart Speaks	Upendra Kaul	Autobiography; second edition launched in August 2026.
Najdavanek'y Pot Aalav	Ali Shaida	Sahitya Akademi 2025; Kashmiri poetry.
Thakur Satsayie	Khajur Singh Thakur	Sahitya Akademi 2025; Dogri poetry.
Safar Jaari Hai	Pritpal Singh Betab	Sahitya Akademi 2025; Urdu poetry.

12.1.1 Keep the roles separate

- **Remember:** The person who **releases** a book need not be its author. **Rizwan Kadri** edited the Patel title; **Abdul Ahad Azad** wrote the Kashmiri literary history; **Umar Shah** translated it. In Journal of the Waypoints, **Satish Vimal** is the poet and **Mushtaque B. Barq** the translator.

  Static link: The J&K Official Languages Act, 2020 recognises **Kashmiri, Dogri, Urdu, Hindi and English**. Sahitya Akademi awards cover 24 languages: the 22 Eighth Schedule languages plus **English and Rajasthani**.

- **Facts: Living the Gita Today** applies selected Gita verses to leadership, ethics, stress and purpose. **Journal of the Waypoints** contains translated Kashmiri poetry, whereas **History of Kashmiri Language and Poetry** is literary history. Learning the type of work alongside the author helps separate similarly presented titles.

  Static link: **Abdul Ahad Azad** is remembered as a Kashmiri poet; he is not Maulana Abul Kalam Azad, the author of **India Wins Freedom**. **Kashmiri** was one of the original Eighth Schedule languages. **Dogri** belongs to the J&K official-language set and was added to the Eighth Schedule in 2003.

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12.5 Chinar Book Festival

- **In focus:** The **third Chinar Book Festival** took place at **SKICC, Srinagar**, from 18-26 July 2026. Tagline: **"Together We Read, Together We Lead."**

  Static link: Organiser: **National Book Trust, India**, under the **Ministry of Education**, with the Srinagar district administration. NBT was established in **1957**; it also organises the New Delhi World Book Fair.

- **Facts:** The festival brought publishers and books in **Kashmiri, Urdu, Hindi, English and other languages** to the Valley. Its SKICC setting links it to Srinagar and Dal Lake; its institutional organiser links it to **NBT**, rather than the Sahitya Akademi or the J&K Academy of Art, Culture and Languages.

- **Remember: NBT promotes books and reading; Sahitya Akademi recognises literary achievement.** Similar cultural visibility does not make them the same organisation. The Sahitya Akademi is an autonomous body under the **Ministry of Culture**, whereas NBT is under Education.

B. Finance, law and defence titles

12.12 Cashless Nation: How UPI Changed Everything

- **In focus:** Authors: **Santanu Paul and B. Sambamurthy**. The 2026 book marks **ten years of UPI** and traces the development of India's payments ecosystem.

  Static link: **UPI** was launched in **2016** and is operated by **NPCI**. It uses IMPS infrastructure. **IDRBT**, established by RBI in 1996, is based in Hyderabad.

- **Remember:** NPCI operates UPI; RBI is the regulator. The authors of Cashless Nation are different from **Nandan Nilekani and Viral Shah**, who wrote Rebooting India.

- **Facts:** The book was launched in Hyderabad and later unveiled by Finance Minister **Nirmala Sitharaman** at **Sangam 2026, Bengaluru**. Its authors are linked to banking technology and the payments ecosystem; its central theme is the transition from institutional payment systems to interoperable digital public infrastructure.

  Static link: NPCI is a **not-for-profit company owned by banks**, created with RBI and IBA support. **IDRBT** stands for **Institute for Development and Research in Banking Technology**. The book's title is therefore best recalled through **authors → UPI → NPCI → banking technology**, rather than through a long list of launch attendees.

12.13 Operational Risk Management

- **In focus: G.P. Mistry**, a former RBI Deputy General Manager, wrote **Operational Risk Management - A Practical Guide to Urban Co-operative Banks**. Amit Shah released it at the **Sahakar Nav-Kranti** event in Mumbai on 8 August 2026.

- **Facts:** The event also launched a **Security Operations Centre** for UCB cyber security and a **Bank in a Box** service.

  Static link: Operational risk means loss arising from **failed or inadequate internal processes, people, systems or external events**. It differs from credit risk and market risk. UCBs are subject to **RBI supervision**; NUCFDC is their umbrella organisation.

  Static link: The Basel framework separates **operational**, **credit** and **market** risk. Failed internal systems or processes belong to operational risk; a borrower's failure to repay belongs to credit risk; changes in interest or exchange rates belong to market risk. These distinctions give the book a direct connection to banking concepts.

- **Facts:** The **Banking Regulation (Amendment) Act, 2020** brought UCBs more fully under RBI supervision. **NUCFDC** stands for **National Urban Co-operative Finance and Development Corporation**. Its umbrella role, the cyber Security Operations Centre and Bank in a Box relate to shared support for urban co-operative banks.

12.11 Other useful title-author pairs

Book	Author	Connection
The Bench, the Bar and the Bizarre	Tushar Mehta	Solicitor General; courtroom stories.
The Lawful and the Awful	Tushar Mehta	Stories from the legal world.
Four Stars of Destiny	M.M. Naravane	Memoir of the former Army Chief.
Kitne Ghazi Aaye, Kitne Ghazi Gaye	K.J.S. "Tiny" Dhillon	Former Chinar Corps commander.
Operation SINDOOR	K.J.S. "Tiny" Dhillon	2025 private publication.

12.11.1 A short institutional connection

- **Remember:** The **Attorney General** is a constitutional office under Article 76; the **Solicitor General** is an executive office. Dhillon's Operation SINDOOR is distinct from the **official commemorative compilation** released in 2026.

12.14 Economics and banking: selected classics

Book	Author	Recall link
Arthashastra	Kautilya	Statecraft and treasury.
The Wealth of Nations	Adam Smith	Economics; 1776.
Das Kapital	Karl Marx	Capitalism.
The General Theory of Employment, Interest and Money	J.M. Keynes	Demand management.
Poverty and Un-British Rule in India	Dadabhai Naoroji	Drain theory.
The Problem of the Rupee	B.R. Ambedkar	Currency and monetary policy.
Fault Lines; I Do What I Do	Raghuram Rajan	Former RBI Governor.
Advice and Dissent	Y.V. Reddy	Former RBI Governor.
Who Moved My Interest Rate?	D. Subbarao	Former RBI Governor.

Book	Author	Recall link
Overdraft: Saving the Indian Saver	Urjit Patel	Banking and NPAs.
Rebooting India	Nandan Nilekani and Viral Shah	Digital public infrastructure.
The Economic History of India	R.C. Dutt	Economic critique of British rule.
Poverty and Famines; Development as Freedom	Amartya Sen	Entitlements and capabilities.
Poor Economics; Good Economics for Hard Times	Abhijit Banerjee and Esther Duflo	Development economics; Nobel 2019.
Capital in the Twenty-First Century	Thomas Piketty	Economic inequality.
Breaking the Mould	Raghuram Rajan and Rohit Lamba	Services-led growth for India.
Quest for Restoring Financial Stability in India	Viral Acharya	Former RBI Deputy Governor.
Forks in the Road: My Days at RBI and Beyond	C. Rangarajan	Former RBI Governor; 12th Finance Commission Chair.
Backstage	Montek Singh Ahluwalia	Former Planning Commission Deputy Chairman.
Of Counsel	Arvind Subramanian	Former Chief Economic Adviser.
India: The Emerging Giant	Arvind Panagariya	Chairman of the 16th Finance Commission.

12.14.1 Quick author distinctions

- **Remember: Naoroji** wrote on the drain of wealth; **Ambedkar** wrote The Problem of the Rupee. **Advice and Dissent = Y.V. Reddy; Who Moved My Interest Rate? = Subbarao; Overdraft = Urjit Patel; Fault Lines = Rajan.**

  Static link: **The Wealth of Nations** is linked to Adam Smith and the invisible hand. **The General Theory** is linked to Keynes and demand management. **Poverty and Un-British Rule in India** is linked to Naoroji's drain theory, while **The Problem of the Rupee** is linked to Ambedkar's currency work.
- **Remember:** A shared professional background does not mean a shared bibliography. **Rajan, Reddy, Subbarao, Patel and Rangarajan** were RBI Governors; **Viral Acharya** was a Deputy Governor. Learn one distinctive title with each name before attempting longer author-book matches.

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C. Book fairs and landmark works

12.17 New Delhi World Book Fair 2026

- **In focus:** Held at **Bharat Mandapam** from 10-18 January 2026. Theme: **"Indian Military History: Valour & Wisdom @ 75."** Guest of Honour country: **Qatar**; Focus Country: **Spain**.

  Static link: The fair began in **1972**. **World Book and Copyright Day** is **23 April**, designated by UNESCO. **Rabat, Morocco**, is World Book Capital for **2026**; Rio de Janeiro held the title in 2025.

- **Remember: Guest of Honour and Focus Country are separate labels.** A World Book Capital's title year begins on 23 April.

  Static link: **UNESCO** designated World Book and Copyright Day in **1995**; 23 April recalls the literary associations of Shakespeare and Cervantes. The first World Book Capital was **Madrid in 2001**; **Delhi** held the title in **2003**. The capital title is distinct from hosting a book fair.

12.21 Essential J&K works

Work	Author	Recall link
Rajatarangini	Kalhana	"River of Kings"; Sanskrit history; eight tarangas.
Dvitiya Rajatarangini	Jonaraja	Continuation of Kalhana's chronicle.
Kathasaritsagara	Somadeva	"Ocean of the Streams of Stories."
Tantraloka	Abhinavagupta	Kashmir Shaivism.
Vakhs	Lal Ded	Kashmiri mystic poetry.
Shruks	Sheikh Noor-ud-Din	Rishi tradition; Charar-e-Sharief.
Gulabnama	Diwan Kirpa Ram	Life of Maharaja Gulab Singh.
The Valley of Kashmir	Walter Lawrence	Classic survey; 1895.
Aatish-e-Chinar	Sheikh Mohammad Abdullah	Autobiography; The Blazing Chinar in English.
My Frozen Turbulence in Kashmir	Jagmohan	Former J&K Governor.
Brihatkathamanjari	Kshemendra	Kashmiri Sanskrit literary tradition.
Vikramankadevacharita	Bilhana	Kashmiri poet at the Chalukya court.
Tarikh-i-Rashidi	Mirza Haidar Dughlat	Persian history; ruled Kashmir in the 16th century.
Kashir	G.M.D. Sufi	History of Kashmir.
Heir Apparent	Karan Singh	Autobiography of the last Sadar-i-Riyasat.
The Country Without a Post Office	Agha Shahid Ali	Poetry.
Meri Kavita Mere Geet	Padma Sachdev	Dogri; Sahitya Akademi Award, 1971.

12.19 Prominent recent literary titles

Title	Author / translator	Award connection
Flesh	David Szalay	Booker Prize 2025.
The Loneliness of Sonia and Sunny	Kiran Desai	Booker 2025 shortlist.
Heart Lamp	Banu Mushtaq; translated by Deepa Bhasthi	International Booker 2025; Kannada.
Taiwan Travelogue	Yáng Shuāng-zǐ; translated by Lin King	International Booker 2026.
Satantango; **The Melancholy of Resistance**	**László Krasznahorkai**	Hungary; **Nobel Prize in Literature 2025**.

12.19.1 Booker and International Booker

Static link: The **Booker Prize** recognises an original English novel. The **International Booker** recognises fiction translated into English and shares the prize between **author and translator**.

- **Remember:** A **shortlisted** book is not automatically the winner. Kiran Desai's 2025 title was shortlisted; her winning novel was **The Inheritance of Loss (2006)**.
- **Remember:** The **Nobel Prize in Literature recognises a body of work**; do not assign the award automatically to a single title.

12.22 Kashmir's literary forms and historical writing

Static link: **Rajatarangini**, composed in Sanskrit in 1148-49, is organised into **eight tarangas**. **Jonaraja** continued Kalhana's chronicle; **Srivara's Jaina Rajatarangini** is associated with the period of Zain-ul-Abidin. These works form a historical-writing sequence, not a list of autobiographies.

- **Facts: Lal Ded's vakhs** belong to Kashmiri mystical poetry. **Nund Rishi's shruks** are associated with the Rishi tradition and **Charar-e-Sharief**. **Walter Lawrence's The Valley of Kashmir** is a survey; **Gulabnama** is a life of Gulab Singh.

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12.23 Selected Indian classics

Work	Author	Useful association
Anandamath	Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay	Contains Vande Mataram.
Gitanjali	Rabindranath Tagore	Nobel Literature, 1913.
Hind Swaraj; My Experiments with Truth	M.K. Gandhi	Gujarati writing; the latter is an autobiography.
Gita Rahasya	Bal Gangadhar Tilak	Written in Mandalay jail.
Discovery of India	Jawaharlal Nehru	Written in Ahmednagar Fort jail.
Annihilation of Caste	B.R. Ambedkar	Undelivered speech.
India Wins Freedom	Maulana Abul Kalam Azad	Autobiographical narrative.
Wings of Fire	A.P.J. Abdul Kalam with Arun Tiwari	Autobiography.

12.24 A short sports-autobiography shelf

Book	Sportsperson	Field
Playing It My Way	Sachin Tendulkar	Cricket.
The Test of My Life	Yuvraj Singh	Cricket.
The Race of My Life	Milkha Singh	Athletics.
A Shot at History	Abhinav Bindra	Shooting.
Unbreakable	M.C. Mary Kom	Boxing.
Ace Against Odds	Sania Mirza	Tennis.

13 Important Days & Themes

Dates with a reason: J&K observances, finance days and a selective set of major national and international themes.

A. J&K and Ladakh: dates with context

13.1 Regional observances

Date	Observance	Why remember it
23 September	Maharaja Hari Singh's birthday	Born 1895; J&K public holiday from 2022.
26 October	Accession Day	Instrument of Accession signed by Hari Singh in 1947.
27 October	Infantry Day	1st Battalion, Sikh Regiment landed at Srinagar in 1947.
31 October	UT Foundation Day	J&K and Ladakh became UTs on this date in 2019.
21 October	Police Commemoration Day	1959 ambush at Hot Springs, Ladakh.
26 July	Kargil Vijay Diwas	Operation Vijay, 1999; memorial at Drass.
13 April	Siachen Day	Operation Meghdoot, 1984.

13.1.1 The 2026 J&K holiday list

- **Facts:** The list retains **23 September**, **26 October** and **Nauroz (21 March)**. **13 July** and **5 December** are absent from the official 2026 list.

  Static link: **Mela Khir Bhawani** is a **Kashmir provincial** holiday; the shrine is at **Tulmulla, Ganderbal**. **Lohri** is a Jammu provincial holiday. Muslim festival dates depend on the sighting of the moon.

- **Remember:** Accession was **signed on 26 October 1947**; Mountbatten accepted it and Indian troops landed on **27 October**. These are separate events.

  Static link: **Nauroz** is the Persian New Year, associated with the spring equinox and observed by Kashmir's Shia community. **Nund Rishi**, or Sheikh Noor-ud-Din Wali, founded the Rishi order; his shrine is at **Charar-e-Sharief, Budgam**. **Shah-i-Hamdan** is associated with **Khanqah-e-Moula, Srinagar**. These place-festival connections are more useful than memorising a complete local holiday annexure.

B. Audit, accounts, tax and banking days

13.8 Finance dates and their origins

Date	Observance	Origin / essential fact
16 November	Audit Diwas	Sir Edward Drummond, first Auditor General, took charge in 1860; observed since 2021.
1 March	Civil Accounts Day	ICAS created in 1976; 2026 marked its golden jubilee and 50th Civil Accounts Day.
29 June	Statistics Day	Birth anniversary of P.C. Mahalanobis; observed since 2007.
20 October	World Statistics Day	UN observance every five years; fourth edition in 2025.
24 July	Income Tax Day	Income tax introduced by James Wilson in 1860; 167th Income Tax Day in 2026.
1 July	GST Day	GST launched in 2017; ninth GST Day in 2026.
24 February	Central Excise Day	Central Excises and Salt Act, 1944.
1 July	Chartered Accountants' Day	ICAI established in 1949.
1 July	SBI foundation day	SBI established in 1955.
1 April	RBI foundation day	RBI began operations in 1935.
12 July	NABARD foundation day	Established in 1982; CRAFICARD / B. Sivaraman Committee.
30 October in India	World Savings Day	31 October internationally; first congress at Milan, 1924.
First Saturday of July	International Day of Cooperatives	4 July in 2026.

13.8.1 Finance observances and institutional roles

- **Remember: Audit Diwas = CAG; Civil Accounts Day = CGA/ICAS.** ICAS is in the **Department of Expenditure, Ministry of Finance**, not under the CAG.

  Static link: Mahalanobis founded the **Indian Statistical Institute in Kolkata (1931)** and is associated with the **Second Five-Year Plan**. World Statistics Day is held **every five years**, while Indian Statistics Day is annual.

- **Remember:** An **edition number** may differ from elapsed years: 1860-2026 is 166 years, while the official event is the **167th Income Tax Day**.

- **Facts: Pay and Accounts Offices** undertake pre-check and payment. Departmentalisation means each Union ministry keeps its accounts, with its Secretary as the **Chief Accounting Authority**.

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Static link: The **Central Boards of Revenue Act, 1963** is associated with both **CBDT** and **CBIC**. Income Tax Day links to direct-tax administration; GST and Central Excise days link to indirect taxes. **GST's constitutional framework** comes from the **101st Amendment**, while **Article 279A** establishes the GST Council.

Static link: The **RBI's 1935 foundation** connects to the **RBI Act, 1934** and the **Hilton Young Commission**; nationalisation followed on **1 January 1949**. **SBI**, established in **1955**, succeeded the **Imperial Bank of India** following the **Gorwala Committee/AIRCS** recommendation.

- **Facts:** The **Ministry of Cooperation** was created on **6 July 2021**. The **97th Constitutional Amendment, 2011**, added **Part IX-B** and **Article 43B** concerning cooperatives. These are the institutional and constitutional connections behind Cooperative Day.

13.10 Themes for the finance paper

Observance	Year	Theme
Statistics Day	2026	**Unlocking the Potential of Administrative Data**
World Statistics Day	2025	**Driving change with quality statistics and data for everyone**
International Day of Cooperatives	2026	**Cooperatives for a peaceful world**

C. Major national observances

13.13 National dates: selected anchors

Date	Day	Static connection
26 January	Republic Day	Constitution in force from 1950; 77th Republic Day in 2026.
26 November	Constitution Day	Constitution adopted in 1949; observance from 2015.
25 January	National Voters' Day	ECI founded in 1950; first NVD in 2011, 16th in 2026.
28 February	National Science Day	Raman Effect announced in 1928.
23 August	National Space Day	Chandrayaan-3 landing in 2023; first observance in 2024.
15 January	Army Day	K.M. Cariappa became Army Chief in 1949.
4 December	Navy Day	Operation Trident, 1971.
8 October	Air Force Day	IAF formed in 1932.
14 September	Hindi Diwas	Hindi adopted as Union official language in 1949.
10 January	World Hindi Day	First World Hindi Conference: Nagpur, 1975.

Date	Day	Static connection
12 January	National Youth Day	Swami Vivekananda's birthday.
23 January	Parakram Diwas	Subhas Chandra Bose's birthday.
31 October	Rashtriya Ekta Diwas	Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel's birthday.
15 November	Janjatiya Gaurav Divas	Birsa Munda's birthday.
23 September	Ayurveda Day	Fixed date from 2025; earlier observed on Dhanteras.
5 September	Teachers' Day in India	S. Radhakrishnan's birthday; World Teachers' Day is 5 October.

13.13.1 The 2025-26 national highlights

- **In focus:** Republic Day 2026 theme: **"150 Years of Vande Mataram."** Chief guests: **António Costa**, President of the European Council, and **Ursula von der Leyen**, President of the European Commission.
- **Facts:** On Constitution Day 2025 the Constitution was released in nine additional languages, including **Kashmiri**. National Voters' Day 2026 theme: **"My India, My Vote: Citizen at the Heart of Indian Democracy."**

  Static link: **Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay** wrote Vande Mataram, which appeared in **Anandamath**. It is the National Song; **Jana Gana Mana**, by Tagore, is the National Anthem.
- **Remember: Adoption: 26 November 1949. Commencement: 26 January 1950.** The European Council and European Commission are different institutions.

13.14 Commemorations linked to a work or discovery

Static link: The 150-year Vande Mataram commemoration connects **Bankim Chandra's song**, the novel **Anandamath**, and the National Song. **Sardar Patel's** and **Birsa Munda's** 150th birth anniversaries in 2025 connect to **Rashtriya Ekta Diwas** and **Janjatiya Gaurav Divas** respectively.

- **Facts: National Science Day** marks the Raman Effect; Raman received the **1930 Physics Nobel**. **National Technology Day, 11 May**, recalls Pokhran-II in 1998. **National Space Day** recalls Chandrayaan-3's 2023 landing. Each is tied to a different achievement, even though all three relate to science.

D. Major international days and themes

13.23 Selected 2026 themes

Date	Observance	2026 theme / focus
21 June	International Day of Yoga	**Yoga for Healthy Ageing**
5 June	World Environment Day	Climate action; host: **Azerbaijan**.
22 April	Earth Day	**Our Power, Our Planet**

Date	Observance	2026 theme / focus
22 May	International Day for Biological Diversity	**Acting locally for global impact**
16 September	World Ozone Day	**Global action for a cooler planet**
2 February	World Wetlands Day	**Wetlands and traditional knowledge: Celebrating cultural heritage**
3 March	World Wildlife Day	**Medicinal and Aromatic Plants: Conserving Health, Heritage and Livelihoods**
21 March	International Day of Forests	**Forests and Economies**
22 March	World Water Day	**Water and Gender**
7 April	World Health Day	**Together for health. Stand with science.**
8 March	International Women's Day, UN theme	**Rights. Justice. Action. For ALL Women and Girls**

13.23.1 Dates tied to institutions

Static link: World Wetlands Day recalls the **Ramsar Convention (2 February 1971)**. World Wildlife Day recalls **CITES (3 March 1973)**. World Health Day marks the **WHO's founding (7 April 1948)**. Ozone Day marks the **Montreal Protocol (16 September 1987)**.

- **Remember:** The International Day of Yoga began in **2015**; 2026 was the **12th** edition. The **UN** theme for Women's Day differs from the private campaign slogan **"Give To Gain."**

13.29 International Years: 2026

- **Facts:** The UN-designated International Years for 2026 are **Rangelands and Pastoralists**, **Volunteers for Sustainable Development**, and **the Woman Farmer**.

  Static link: Rangelands and pastoralists connects to **Gujjar-Bakarwal** seasonal migration in J&K and **Changpa** communities raising Pashmina goats in Ladakh.

- **Remember: Cooperatives** and **Glaciers' Preservation** were International Years for **2025**; **Millets** was **2023**.

13.26 Additional major dates and their origins

Date	Observance	Origin / institution
24 March	World TB Day	Koch announced the TB bacillus in 1882.
4 February	World Cancer Day	UICC; "United by Unique" campaign covers 2025-27.
31 May	World No Tobacco Day	WHO; tobacco-control awareness.
14 June	World Blood Donor Day	Karl Landsteiner's birthday.

Date	Observance	Origin / institution
21 February	International Mother Language Day	1952 Bengali Language Movement; proclaimed by UNESCO in 1999.
8 September	International Literacy Day	UNESCO; proclaimed in 1966.
27 September	World Tourism Day	UN Tourism, headquartered in Madrid.
18 April	International Day for Monuments and Sites	Also known as World Heritage Day; ICOMOS.
10 December	Human Rights Day	Universal Declaration of Human Rights adopted in 1948.
2 October	International Day of Non-Violence	UN observance declared in 2007.

13.26.1 Read themes with the right institution

- **Facts:** World TB Day 2026 used **"Yes! We can end TB! Led by countries. Powered by people."** International Mother Language Day used **"Youth voices on multilingual education."** International Literacy Day used **"Literacy for People, Planet and Prosperity."**
- **Remember:** A multi-year campaign need not change annually: World Cancer Day's **"United by Unique"** covers **2025-2027**.

13.29.1 International Years and ongoing UN Decades

- **Facts:** The **2025 International Years** included **Cooperatives, Quantum Science and Technology, Glaciers' Preservation, and Peace and Trust**. The quantum year marked a century of quantum mechanics; the glaciers year connects directly to Himalayan water security.

  Static link: The **2026 Rangelands and Pastoralists year** is FAO-led and was proposed by **Mongolia**. Its J&K/Ladakh connection is seasonal pastoralism: **Gujjar-Bakarwal** communities move between plains and mountain pastures, while **Changpa** communities raise Pashmina goats on Changthang.

13.29.2 Selected UN Decades

Decade	Period	Connection
Ecosystem Restoration	2021-2030	Repairing degraded ecosystems.
Ocean Science for Sustainable Development	2021-2030	Ocean knowledge and sustainable use.
Healthy Ageing	2021-2030	Connects to Yoga Day's 2026 theme.
Indigenous Languages	2022-2032	Language and cultural preservation.
Action for Cryospheric Sciences	2025-2034	Glaciers and frozen-water systems.

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14 People & Their Contributions

A short association guide: the person, the institution or achievement, and one useful static connection.

A. J&K and Ladakh: distinctive contributions

14.3 Selected regional personalities

Person	Association	Recall link
Col Sonam Wangchuk	Ladakh Scouts; capture of **Chorbat La**, Batalik sector, 1999	**Maha Vir Chakra**; "Lion of Ladakh."
Sonam Wangchuk, educationist	SECMOL and Himalayan education	Ramon Magsaysay Award, 2018.
Phunchok Stobdan	Diplomacy and Himalayan strategic affairs	Former Indian Ambassador to **Kyrgyzstan**; The Great Game in the Buddhist Himalayas.
Maj Gen Sunil Kumar Razdan	7 PARA; military service after a spinal injury	**Kirti Chakra**; Vishisht Seva Medal.

14.3.1 Two useful distinctions

- **Remember: Col Sonam Wangchuk** is the soldier associated with Chorbat La. **Sonam Wangchuk the educationist** is associated with SECMOL. They are different people.

  Static link: Wartime gallantry: **Param Vir Chakra** → **Maha Vir Chakra** → **Vir Chakra**. Peacetime gallantry: **Ashoka Chakra** → **Kirti Chakra** → **Shaurya Chakra**. VSM is a distinguished-service award.

- **Facts:** Kyrgyzstan's capital is **Bishkek**. Stobdan's Ladakh connection is diplomacy and strategic affairs, not Sowa-Rigpa medicine.

- **Facts:** The **Ladakh Scouts**, known as the **Snow Warriors**, recruit mainly from Ladakh and have their regimental centre at **Leh**. Col Wangchuk's Chorbat La association belongs to **Operation Vijay, 1999**. Kargil Vijay Diwas is **26 July**; the Kargil War Memorial is at **Drass**.

  Static link: Razdan's **Kirti Chakra** belongs to the peacetime gallantry series. His **Vishisht Seva Medal** recognises distinguished service, so the two honours belong to different categories.

B. Institutions and enterprise

14.11 Dhanendra Kumar and competition regulation

- **Facts: Dhanendra Kumar** was the first **full-time Chairperson of the Competition Commission of India (2009-11)**. **Vinod Dhall** had served earlier as Acting Chairperson.

  Static link: The **Competition Act, 2002** replaced the **MRTP** framework. **CCI**, established in **2003**, is under the **Ministry of Corporate Affairs**. Appeals lie with **NCLAT**, into which the former **COMPAT** was merged in **2017**.

- **Facts:** The Act addresses **anti-competitive agreements under Section 3**, **abuse of a dominant position under Section 4**, and combinations under Sections 5-6. Core competition provisions became operational in **2009**; merger control followed in **2011**.
- **Remember:** The **2023 amendment** introduced a **₹2,000-crore deal-value threshold** for combinations. CCI has a **Chairperson and 2-6 Members**, appointed through a selection committee headed by the **CJI or nominee**.

14.12 People and major brands

Person	Company / brand	Essential distinction
Gopichand Hinduja	Hinduja Group; promoter link with **IndusInd Bank**	IndusInd is a private-sector bank, established in 1994.
Simone Tata	Built **Lakmé**; later led **Trent**	Lakmé became an HUL brand; Westside belongs to Trent.
Vijaypat Singhania	**Raymond**	Raymond is a Singhania enterprise.

14.8 Shivraj Patil: an institutional association

- **Facts: Shivraj Patil** was Lok Sabha Speaker during **1991-96**, later Union Home Minister, and Governor of Punjab with charge as Administrator of Chandigarh.
- **Remember:** When he became Home Minister in **2004**, he entered Parliament through the **Rajya Sabha**. He was not then a Lok Sabha member.

  Static link: Under **Article 93**, the Lok Sabha elects its Speaker and Deputy Speaker. Patil was Speaker of the **10th Lok Sabha**. The **Punjab Governor** has also held the role of **Administrator of Chandigarh since 1984**; a State governorship and a UT administrative role are separate offices held by the same person.

C. Science, environment and national landmarks

14.13 Madhav Gadgil and the Western Ghats

- **Facts: Madhav Gadgil** chaired the **Western Ghats Ecology Expert Panel (WGEEP)**. Its **2011** report proposed treating the whole Western Ghats as ecologically sensitive through **three graded zones**, with a strong role for **gram sabhas**.

  Static link: The later **High-Level Working Group**, chaired by **K. Kasturirangan** in **2013**, proposed an **Ecologically Sensitive Area covering about 37%** of the Ghats.
- **Facts:** Gadgil pioneered **People's Biodiversity Registers** and community-based conservation. He founded the **Centre for Ecological Sciences at IISc, Bengaluru, in 1983**.

  Static link: The Western Ghats run through **Gujarat, Maharashtra, Goa, Karnataka, Kerala and Tamil Nadu**. Their UNESCO inscription dates to **2012**; ecological protection under the **Environment (Protection) Act, 1986** is a separate legal route from World Heritage recognition.

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14.14 Contributions worth recognising

Person	Contribution	Static connection
E.V. Chitnis	INCOSPAR and selection of **Thumba** as India's early rocket-launch site	INCOSPAR was set up in 1962 under Vikram Sarabhai.
V. Rajaraman	Pioneer of computer-science education in India	IIT Kanpur and IISc; Fundamentals of Computers.
James Watson	DNA double helix with Francis Crick	1962 Medicine Nobel shared with Crick and **Maurice Wilkins**.
François Englert	Mass-generating mechanism in particle physics	2013 Physics Nobel shared with **Peter Higgs**.
Jane Goodall	Chimpanzee research at **Gombe, Tanzania**	Jane Goodall Institute; Roots & Shoots.
Ram V. Sutar	Designed the **Statue of Unity**	Sardar Patel; **182 metres**; Ekta Nagar, Gujarat.

14.19 Designer and builder

Static link: The **Statue of Unity** was designed by **Ram V. Sutar** and constructed by **L&T**. It represents Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel; the designer and construction company are different associations.

14.14.1 E.V. Chitnis and V. Rajaraman: the institution behind the name

- **Facts: E.V. Chitnis** helped identify **Thumba**, near Thiruvananthapuram and the magnetic equator, for India's first rocket launch. The first launch in 1963 used a **Nike-Apache** rocket. He later directed the **Space Applications Centre, Ahmedabad**, and helped develop the **Satellite Instructional Television Experiment (SITE)**.

  Static link: SITE used **NASA's ATS-6 satellite** in **1975-76** to deliver educational television. **INCOSPAR** preceded **ISRO**, established in **1969**. **TERLS**, the Thumba Equatorial Rocket Launching Station, was dedicated to the UN in **1968**. The **Department of Space and Space Commission** followed in **1972**.
- **Facts: V. Rajaraman** helped establish computer-science education at **IIT Kanpur** and later worked with the **Supercomputer Education and Research Centre at IISc**. His textbook **Fundamentals of Computers** is a useful work-author association.
- **Remember:** The first Thumba launch used an **American Nike-Apache in 1963**. The first **Indian sounding rocket**, **Rohini RH-75**, flew in **1967**; the imported first launch and the indigenous sounding rocket are different milestones.

14.15 DNA, the Higgs mechanism and primate research

Static link: **Watson and Crick** established the **DNA double-helix structure in 1953**, with X-ray evidence from **Rosalind Franklin**, associated with **Photo 51**. The **1962 Medicine Nobel** went to **Watson, Crick and Wilkins**. Watson also wrote **The Double Helix (1968)** and was the first head of the **Human Genome Project, 1990-92**.

- **Facts: François Englert and Robert Brout** proposed a mass-generating mechanism in **1964**. The **2013 Physics Nobel** went to **Englert and Peter Higgs**. The Higgs boson was discovered at **CERN's Large Hadron Collider**, using **ATLAS and CMS**. **CERN**, the European Organisation for Nuclear Research, is in **Geneva**; India became an **Associate Member in 2017**. The word boson honours **S.N. Bose**.
- **Facts: Jane Goodall** studied chimpanzees at **Gombe Stream, Tanzania, from 1960**, observing their use and making of tools. She founded the **Jane Goodall Institute (1977)** and **Roots & Shoots (1991)**, and became a **UN Messenger of Peace in 2002**.

15 Places, Terms & Static Connections

Current places and terms connected to the rivers, heritage, institutions and concepts behind them.

A. J&K and Ladakh: place and connection

15.1 Zehanpora: Kashmir's Buddhist heritage

- **In focus:** Excavations at **Zehanpora, Baramulla**, revealed a roughly **2,000-year-old Kushan-period Buddhist complex**, with stupa bases, monastic structures and artefacts.

  Static link: **Kanishka**, a Kushan ruler, is associated with the **Fourth Buddhist Council**. In Kalhana's Sanskrit **Rajatarangini**, Kashmir's Buddhist past is linked with **Ashoka** and the Kushan kings **Hushka, Jushka and Kanishka**. The text credits Ashoka with founding **Srinagari** and spreading Buddhism in Kashmir.

- **Facts: Rajatarangini** was composed in **1148-49 CE** in eight books, called **tarangas**. Its town associations include **Hushkapura-Ushkur**, **Jushkapura-Zukur** and **Kanishkapura-Kanispora**.
- **Remember: Zehanpora = Buddhist, Kushan, Baramulla. Burzahom = Neolithic, Srinagar. Parihaspora = Karkota, Lalitaditya.** The sites belong to different periods despite all being part of Kashmir's ancient heritage.

15.1.1 Selected heritage sites

Site	District / area	Identity
Burzahom	Srinagar	Neolithic pit dwellings and dog burials with humans; UNESCO Tentative List.
Gufkral	Pulwama	Neolithic; "cave of the potter."
Semthan	Bijbehara, Anantnag	Neolithic to Kushan layers.
Harwan	Srinagar	Kushan Buddhist monastery; moulded terracotta tiles.
Ushkur	Baramulla	Kushan Hushkapura; Huvishka association.
Parihaspora	Baramulla	Lalitaditya's Karkota-period capital.
Ambaran	Akhnoor, Jammu	Kushan stupa with a relic casket.
Martand Sun Temple	Anantnag	Lalitaditya Muktapida; 8th-century Sun temple.

15.2 Mudh-Nyoma and the Changthang region

- **In focus:** The **Mudh-Nyoma Air Force Station**, operationalised in November 2025, is in **eastern Ladakh**. Air Chief **A.P. Singh** made the inaugural landing in a **C-130J**.

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Static link: **Changthang** is a high plateau associated with **Changpa** nomads and **Changthangi goats**, the Pashmina connection. **Hanle** in the same region hosts the **Indian Astronomical Observatory** and India's first **Dark Sky Reserve**, designated in **2022**. **Nyoma** is the headquarters of the new Changthang district.

- **Facts:** Mudh-Nyoma was upgraded from an **Advanced Landing Ground (ALG)** to a base capable of handling **fighters, helicopters and transport aircraft**. Its location is eastern Ladakh near the LAC. A fighter-capable base, an ALG and a civilian airport describe different aviation functions.

15.5 Cloudbursts and Mughal garden patrons

- **Facts:** The IMD's commonly used **cloudburst** threshold is **at least 100 mm of rainfall in one hour over a small area**.

Static link: The **Mughal Gardens of Kashmir** are on UNESCO's **Tentative List**. The patron-garden pairs are **Shalimar-Jahangir**, **Nishat-Asaf Khan**, **Chashme Shahi-Shah Jahan** and **Pari Mahal-Dara Shikoh**. Shalimar was created for Nur Jahan in **1619**; Nishat dates to **1633**, and Chashme Shahi to **1632**.

- **Remember:** A **Tentative List** entry is not the same as inscription as a World Heritage Site.

15.2.1 Ladakh airfields: location and role

Airfield	Geographical connection	Identity
Daulat Beg Oldi	Near Karakoram Pass	Advanced Landing Ground.
Fukche	Eastern Ladakh, near LAC	Advanced Landing Ground.
Thoise	Nubra valley	Supports the Siachen sector.
Leh	Leh	Kushok Bakula Rimpochee Airport.

15.3 Three rivers behind the regional news

Static link: The **Jhelum** rises at **Verinag in Anantnag**. Its route runs through Srinagar and Wular to Baramulla, then through the Uri area into Pakistan-administered Kashmir. **Kishanganga** is called the **Neelum** across the border.

- **Facts:** The **Chenab** is formed by the union of the **Chandra and Bhaga at Tandi**, in **Lahaul-Spiti, Himachal Pradesh**. The regional hydropower map places **Dulhasti in Kishtwar** and **Sawalkote in Ramban/Udhampur**. Sawalkote lies between **Baglihar upstream** and **Salal downstream**.

Static link: The **Tawi**, called **Surya Putri**, rises in the **Kali Kundi/Kailash Kund area near Bhaderwah, Doda**. It flows through Udhampur and Jammu city, then joins the Chenab in Pakistan. **Bahu Fort** stands on the Tawi's bank.

15.4 Tulbul: navigation, lake and river

- **Facts:** The **Tulbul Navigation Project** lies on the **Jhelum at the outflow of Wular Lake**, near Sopore. It is also known as the **Wular Barrage**. Its purpose is to maintain a steady lean-season flow for navigation between **Srinagar and Baramulla**, with a flood-control connection.

Static link: **Wular**, in **Bandipora**, is India's largest freshwater lake and was designated a **Ramsar site in 1990**. The **Nilamata Purana** calls it **Mahapadmasar**. The project name, lake name and river name therefore refer to connected features, rather than three separate projects.

15.6 Srinagar's landscape and seasonal vocabulary

Static link: The **Zabarwan range**, between the **Sindh and Lidder valleys**, is associated with **Dachigam National Park**, the Hangul, Shankaracharya hill and Kashmir's Mughal gardens. The Tulip Garden was opened in **2008 at Siraj Bagh**, at the range's foothills.

- **Facts: Dal Lake** is fed mainly by the **Telbal Nallah**, is linked to **Nigeen Lake**, and has the **Hazratbal shrine** on its bank. **Drung waterfall**, near **Tangmarg on the Gulmarg road**, belongs to **Baramulla district**.
- **Facts:** The traditional winter vocabulary describes successive cold periods:
  - **Chillai Kalan:** the harshest **40 days**, from **21 December to about 30 January**.
  - **Chillai Khurd:** the following **20 days**.
  - **Chillai Bachha:** the next **10 days**.

15.7 Passes and the routes they serve

Static link: **Shinku La** connects **Lahaul in Himachal Pradesh with Zanskar in Ladakh**, on the **Nimmu-Padum-Darcha** route. **Zoji La** connects the Kashmir side with Drass. These are two different approaches to Ladakh, with different regional endpoints.

- **Facts: Fotu La** is the highest point on the **Srinagar-Leh highway**. **Taglang La** lies on the **Manali-Leh** route; **Baralacha La** is in Himachal Pradesh. **Khardung La** serves the Leh-Nubra connection and **Chang La** the Leh-Pangong route.

B. Banking and market vocabulary

15.8 Know the term and its institution

Term	Meaning	Institution / distinction
SRVA	Special Rupee Vostro Account: foreign bank's rupee account with an Indian authorised-dealer bank	RBI framework for rupee trade settlement.
CBDC / e₹	Digital rupee issued by RBI; legal tender and RBI liability	RBI; different from cryptocurrency or a UPI transfer.
SDF	Standing Deposit Facility; absorbs liquidity without collateral	RBI liquidity tool.
CRR	Cash reserve kept with RBI as a share of NDTL	Different from SLR assets held by the bank.
SLR	Statutory Liquidity Ratio; bank-held liquid assets such as cash, gold and government securities	Banking Regulation Act, 1949.
T-Bills	Zero-coupon Treasury Bills: 91, 182 and 364 days	Issued by the Centre; States issue SDLs.

Term	Meaning	Institution / distinction
NPA	A loan with interest or principal overdue for more than 90 days under general bank-loan norms	RBI asset-classification framework.
PCA	Prompt Corrective Action	RBI framework; not a moratorium.
AIF / REIT / InvIT	Alternative Investment Fund / Real Estate Investment Trust / Infrastructure Investment Trust	Regulated by **SEBI**.
B-READY	Business Ready: business-climate assessment	**World Bank**; successor to Doing Business.

15.8.1 Priority-sector lending

- **Facts:** The overall PSL target for **Small Finance Banks is 60% from FY 2025-26**, following the RBI's June 2025 revision. RRBs have a **75%** target.
- **Remember:** PSL targets use **ANBC or credit-equivalent off-balance-sheet exposure, whichever is higher**. **Vostro** means "your account with us"; **Nostro** means "our account with you."

C. Public finance and constitutional provisions

15.9 Funds, statements and authorisation

Concept	Constitutional anchor	What to remember
Annual Financial Statement	**Article 112**	Constitutional name for the Union Budget.
Consolidated Fund of India	**Article 266(1)**	Revenues, borrowings and loan repayments; withdrawals require appropriation by law.
Public Account	**Article 266(2)**	Provident funds, small savings and deposits; government acts as a banker.
Contingency Fund	**Article 267(1)**	Imprest at the President's disposal for unforeseen spending, pending parliamentary authorisation.
Charged expenditure	**Article 112(3)**	Can be discussed but is not voted; includes CAG salary and debt charges.
Appropriation Bill	**Article 114**	Authorises withdrawal from the Consolidated Fund.
Concept	**Constitutional anchor**	**What to remember**
Vote on account	**Article 116**	Advance grant pending completion of the budget process.

Concept	Constitutional anchor	What to remember
Money Bill	**Article 110**	Introduced in Lok Sabha; Rajya Sabha recommendations within 14 days.
GST Council	**Article 279A**	Union Finance Minister chairs; 101st Amendment, 2016.

15.9.1 Deficits: four compact definitions

- **Facts:** Read each deficit as a relationship between receipts and expenditure.
  - **Fiscal deficit** = total expenditure - revenue receipts - non-debt capital receipts.
  - **Revenue deficit** = revenue expenditure - revenue receipts.
  - **Primary deficit** = fiscal deficit - interest payments.
  - **Effective revenue deficit** = revenue deficit - grants for creation of capital assets.
- **Remember: Charged** does not mean "cannot be discussed." CAG salary is charged on the CFI. High Court judges' **salaries** are charged on the State fund; their **pensions** are charged on the CFI.

15.9.2 Parliamentary financial committees

Committee	Members	Purpose / distinction
Public Accounts Committee	22: 15 Lok Sabha + 7 Rajya Sabha	Examines public accounts and audit reports.
Estimates Committee	30; all Lok Sabha	Examines estimates.
Committee on Public Undertakings	22: 15 Lok Sabha + 7 Rajya Sabha	Examines public undertakings.

15.9.3 Accounts and digital systems

Static link: Union government accounts use a **cash basis**. **PFMS** is the Public Financial Management System; **e-Kuber** is RBI's core banking solution; **GeM** is the Government e-Marketplace.

- **Remember:** An **Outcome Budget** links spending to results; a **Gender Budget Statement** identifies spending with gender-related objectives. Both were introduced in 2005-06.

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D. India and world: selected map anchors

15.13 Indian passes and infrastructure

Place	State / country	Recall connection
Shipki La	Kinnaur, Himachal Pradesh	Sutlej enters India nearby; border-trade pass.
Lipulekh	Pithoragarh, Uttarakhand	Kailash Mansarovar route.
Nathu La	Sikkim	India-China border pass.
Ken-Betwa link	Madhya Pradesh-Uttar Pradesh	Bundelkhand; Daudhan dam in Panna Tiger Reserve.
New Pamban bridge	Tamil Nadu	Mainland-Rameswaram; vertical-lift sea bridge.

15.14 Regional Ramsar sites and the convention

Static link: The **Ramsar Convention** was signed on **2 February 1971 at Ramsar, Iran**. That date is observed as **World Wetlands Day**. India joined the convention in **1982**.

- **Facts:** J&K's five sites and their designation years are **Wular (1990)**, **Hokersar (2005)**, **Surinsar-Mansar (2005)**, **Hygam (2022)** and **Shallabugh (2022)**. Ladakh has **Tso Moriri (2002)** and **Tso Kar (2020)**.
- **Remember: Dal Lake is not a Ramsar site.** A familiar tourist lake and a designated wetland are different categories. The first Indian Ramsar sites were **Chilika and Keoladeo**, designated in **1981**.

15.13.1 Indian rivers, lakes and falls

Feature	State / area	Static connection
Mahi	MP-Rajasthan-Gujarat	Crosses Tropic of Cancer twice; Gulf of Khambhat.
Musi	Hyderabad, Telangana	Tributary of Krishna.
Subarnarekha	Jharkhand-WB-Odisha	Rises near Ranchi; Hundru Falls.
Indrayani	Pune, Maharashtra	Tributary of Bhima.
Jog Falls	Karnataka	Sharavathi river.
Duduma Falls	Odisha-Andhra Pradesh border	Machkund river.
Vembanad	Kerala	India's longest lake; Ramsar, 2002.

15.13.2 Mountains, volcanoes and water projects

Static link: **Nanda Devi**, in **Uttarakhand**, is the **highest peak wholly in India**, at **7,816 m**. **Nanda Devi National Park and the Valley of Flowers** together form a UNESCO World Heritage Site. **Parasnath**, in **Giridih, Jharkhand**, is the state's highest peak; it is associated with **Shikharji** in Jain tradition and **Marang Buru** in Santhal tradition.

- **Facts: Baratang in the Andaman Islands** is associated with **mud volcanoes**. **Barren Island** is India's active volcano. A mud-volcano location and an active volcanic island answer different place-identification questions.

  Static link: **Lower Subansiri** lies on the **Assam-Arunachal Pradesh border**. **Almatti** is a **Krishna** project in Karnataka; **Mekedatu** is associated with the **Cauvery** in Karnataka. The **Ken-Betwa** link concerns **Bundelkhand in Madhya Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh**, and its **Daudhan dam** is inside Panna Tiger Reserve.

- **Remember:** Lake identities depend on the qualifier: **Vembanad = longest lake; Wular = largest freshwater lake; Chilika = largest brackish-water lagoon**. Vembanad's **Punnamada** stretch is associated with the **Nehru Trophy boat race**.

15.15 World places: country and connection

Place	Country / area	Connection
Strait of Hormuz	Iran-Oman	Persian Gulf-Gulf of Oman.
Preah Vihear	Cambodia, near Thailand	UNESCO-inscribed temple, 2008.
Medog	Tibet, China	Yarlung Tsangpo basin.
Chancay	Peru	Deep-water port, opened November 2024.
Mongla	Bangladesh	Pasur river, near Sundarbans.
Córdoba	Spain	Mezquita Mosque-Cathedral; World Heritage association.
Cebu and Leyte	Philippines	Pacific Ring of Fire.
Kilimanjaro	Tanzania	Major African mountain.

15.15.1 Polar places and transboundary river names

- **Facts: Thwaites Glacier** is in **West Antarctica**. **A23a** originated from the **Filchner ice shelf in 1986**; its name belongs to an iceberg, rather than a glacier or research station. **Concordia Station**, at **Dome C in Antarctica**, is a **French-Italian research base**.

  Static link: The **Yarlung Tsangpo** of Tibet becomes the **Siang** in India and then the **Brahmaputra**. The news connection at **Medog** is therefore geographically upstream of the Indian river system.

- **Remember: Hormuz** joins the **Persian Gulf and Gulf of Oman**. **Bab-el-Mandeb** is the Red Sea connection. For Preah Vihear, distinguish the temple's **Cambodian** location from the broader Thailand-Cambodia border setting.

E. Trade, environmental and scientific vocabulary

15.10 International terms and their institutions

Term	Meaning	Body / distinction
BBNJ	Biodiversity Beyond National Jurisdiction, or High Seas Treaty	Agreement under **UNCLOS**.
CBAM	Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism	**European Union** measure on embedded carbon in imports.
FATF	Financial Action Task Force	Anti-money-laundering body; not a UN agency.
MFN	Most-Favoured-Nation treatment	WTO/GATT non-discrimination principle; GATT Article I.

15.12 Trade agreements: status matters

- **Remember: Negotiations concluded → agreement signed → ratification / domestic procedures → entry into force.** These are different stages. A concluded negotiation does not itself make an agreement operational.

  Static link: **EFTA** consists of **Switzerland, Norway, Iceland and Liechtenstein**; it is separate from the EU. India's agreement label is **TEPA: Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement**.

15.12.1 The economic-integration ladder

Stage	What members share or remove	Example
Preferential trade agreement	Reduced tariffs on some goods.	India-MERCOSUR PTA.
Free trade area	Internal tariffs removed; own external tariffs retained.	India-ASEAN trade agreement.
Customs union	Free trade area plus a common external tariff.	Southern African Customs Union.
Common market	Customs union plus free movement of capital and labour.	EU single market.
Economic union	Common market plus common economic policies.	Euro area.

15.12.2 Trade remedies and maritime distances

- **Facts: Countervailing duty** addresses subsidised imports; **anti-dumping duty** addresses imports priced below normal value. **NTB** means a non-tariff barrier. In India, the investigating body for trade remedies is the **Directorate General of Trade Remedies**, under the **Commerce Ministry**.

Static link: Under the **UNCLOS** distance framework, the **territorial sea extends to 12 nautical miles**, the **contiguous zone to 24**, and the **Exclusive Economic Zone to 200**, measured from the baseline. The unit is **nautical miles**, not kilometres.

- **Remember:** The **FATF**, formed in **1989** following the G7 initiative in Paris, is separate from the UN system. Its **grey list** concerns jurisdictions under increased monitoring; its **black list** concerns high-risk jurisdictions subject to a call for action.

15.12.3 Agreement labels: expansion and association

Label	Full name	Selected Indian association
CEPA	Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement	UAE, South Korea, Japan.
CECA	Comprehensive Economic Cooperation Agreement	Singapore.
CECPA	Comprehensive Economic Cooperation and Partnership Agreement	Mauritius.
CETA	Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement	United Kingdom.
TEPA	Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement	EFTA.
ECTA	Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement	Australia.

15.10.1 Environmental acronyms: treaty and purpose

Static link: **BBNJ**, the Biodiversity Beyond National Jurisdiction agreement, belongs under **UNCLOS**. The **Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework (KMGBF)** belongs under the **Convention on Biological Diversity**, adopted at **COP15 in 2022**. It contains **23 targets**, including the **30-by-30** protection goal for land and sea by 2030.

- **Facts: REDD+** expands to reducing emissions from deforestation and forest degradation, within the **UNFCCC** framework. **MRV** means **Measurement, Reporting and Verification**; **ETF** means **Enhanced Transparency Framework**, associated with the Paris Agreement.
- **Remember: CBAM**, the **Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism**, is an **EU measure** on the embedded carbon in imports. Its institution differs from the UN climate framework. **GRAP**, the four-stage **Graded Response Action Plan** for Delhi-NCR air pollution, is administered through the **Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM)**.

15.10.2 Green credit and carbon credit

- **Facts:** The **Green Credit Programme** provides a market-based incentive for green actions. It comes under **MoEFCC** and is administered by the **Indian Council of Forestry Research and Education (ICFRE)**. The **Carbon Credit Trading Scheme (CCTS)** is associated with the **Bureau of Energy Efficiency (BEE)** and the **Energy Conservation Act**, amended in **2022**.

15.11 Technology and health: concise meanings

Static link: **CRISPR-Cas9** is a gene-editing system, often called molecular scissors. Vaccine platforms: **mRNA = genetic instructions; viral vector = harmless carrier virus; subunit = purified protein piece**.

- **Facts: LLM = Large Language Model; GPU = Graphics Processing Unit; inference = running a trained model.** A quantum **qubit** can be in a **superposition of the 0 and 1 basis states**.

  Static link: **Aditya-L1** uses a halo orbit around **Sun-Earth L1**, about **1.5 million km from Earth**. **MIRV = Multiple Independently Targetable Re-entry Vehicles**: one missile, several warheads, separate targets. India's first test was **Mission Divyastra, Agni-5, March 2024**.

- **Facts: AMR = antimicrobial resistance**, linked to **One Health**. **Zoonosis/spillover** connects infection crossing from animals to humans; examples include **Nipah, Mpox and H5N1**.

PRACTICE 01

Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh

Q1. Consider the following statements about the resolution passed by the J&K Legislative Assembly on 28 September 2026:

1. It sought the immediate and urgent restoration of full statehood.
2. Statehood will stand restored once the Lieutenant Governor assents to the resolution.
3. It referred to the autonomy resolutions of 2000 and 2024.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q2. The bi-annual "Darbar Move", resumed in November 2025, was started in:

(a) 1846 by Gulab Singh
(b) 1872 by Maharaja Ranbir Singh
(c) 1925 by Maharaja Hari Singh
(d) 1952 by Sheikh Abdullah

Q3. Consider the following pairs (new district of Ladakh - headquarters):

1. Nubra - Diskit
2. Sham - Khaltse
3. Changthang - Hanle
4. Zanskar - Padum

How many of the above pairs are correctly matched?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) Only three
(d) All four

Q4. With reference to the Ladakh regulations notified in June 2025, consider:

1. Up to 85% of government jobs (excluding EWS) are reserved for residents.
2. Domicile requires 15 years of residence in Ladakh.
3. One-third of seats in the Hill Councils are reserved for women.
4. Bhoti and Purgi are among the official languages.

Which are correct?

(a) 1, 2 and 3 only
(b) 2, 3 and 4 only
(c) 1, 3 and 4 only
(d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Q5. Consider the following statements about the Zojila Tunnel:

1. Its breakthrough was achieved in June 2026 at Minamarg in Kargil.
2. It will connect Sonamarg with Drass/Kargil on NH-1.
3. It is the same tunnel the PM inaugurated in January 2025.

Which are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q6. Which of the following statements about the Chenab Rail Bridge is **incorrect**?

(a) It is the world's highest railway arch bridge.
(b) It is located in Reasi district.
(c) It stands about 359 m above the river bed.
(d) It is India's first cable-stayed railway bridge.

Q7. The 1,000 MW Pakal Dul Hydroelectric Project is located on the river:

(a) Chenab
(b) Marusudar
(c) Jhelum
(d) Kishanganga

Q8. The 1,856 MW Sawalkote project on the Chenab lies between which two existing projects?

(a) Dulhasti and Baglihar
(b) Baglihar (upstream) and Salal (downstream)
(c) Salal and Ratle
(d) Kiru and Kwar

Q9. With reference to the Indus Waters Treaty, which India placed in abeyance in April 2025, consider:

1. It was signed in 1960 at Karachi.
2. It was brokered by the World Bank.
3. India has unrestricted rights over the waters of the Chenab.

Which are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q10. Consider the following pairs (Padma Shri 2026 - field):

1. Brij Lal Bhat - Literature & Education
2. Prof. Shafi Shauq - Literature & Education
3. Dr Padma Gurmet - Medicine

How many pairs are correctly matched?

(a) None
(b) Only one
(c) Only two
(d) All three

Q11. Who won the Sahitya Akademi Award 2025 for **Dogri**?

(a) Ali Shaida
(b) Khajur Singh Thakur
(c) Pritpal Singh Betab
(d) Mamta Kalia

Q12. *Najdavanek'y Pot Aalav*, which won the Sahitya Akademi Award 2025, is a work in:

(a) Dogri
(b) Urdu
(c) Kashmiri
(d) Punjabi

Q13. The hangul population as per the 2025 census (reported January 2026) was:

(a) 261
(b) 289
(c) 323
(d) 412

Q14. Consider the following statements about the hangul:

1. It is the state animal of J&K.
2. It is largely confined to Dachigam National Park in the Zabarwan range.
3. It is listed in Schedule I of the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972.

Which are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q15. Which team was J&K's opponent in the Ranji Trophy 2025-26 final, where J&K won the title on first-innings lead?

(a) Mumbai
(b) Vidarbha
(c) Karnataka
(d) Kerala

Q16. Consider the following statements about the Khelo India Winter Games 2026:

1. It was the sixth edition.
2. Ice sports were held in Leh and snow sports in Gulmarg.
3. Jammu & Kashmir emerged as the overall champion.

Which are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q17. Mithun Manhas, elected in September 2025, is the:

(a) 36th BCCI President
(b) 37th BCCI President
(c) ICC Chairman
(d) BCCI Secretary

Q18. Consider the following statements about the J&K Budget 2026-27:

1. It was presented by the Chief Minister, who holds the Finance portfolio.
2. The net budget is about ₹1.14 lakh crore.
3. The fiscal deficit is projected at about 4.6% of GSDP.

Which are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q19. As per the J&K Economic Survey 2025-26, the largest share of the UT's economy comes from the:

(a) primary sector
(b) secondary sector
(c) tertiary sector
(d) primary and secondary equally

Q20. Under the J&K Budget 2026-27, the Restructured Weather Based Crop Insurance Scheme was extended to:

(a) apple, saffron, mango and litchi
(b) paddy and maize only
(c) walnut and almond only
(d) saffron only

Q21. Consider the following statements about the MUMKIN scheme of J&K:

1. It is a livelihood generation scheme for young people.
2. It provides a subsidy of up to ₹80,000 or 10% of the on-road price, whichever is lower, to buy small commercial vehicles.
3. The applicant should be 18-35 years old.

Which are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 1 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q22. For Census 2027, the reference date for Ladakh and the snow-bound areas of J&K is:

(a) 1 March 2027
(b) 1 October 2026
(c) 1 April 2026
(d) 16 June 2025

Q23. Which Amarnath Yatra route starts from Ganderbal district?

(a) Pahalgam
(b) Baltal
(c) Chandanwari
(d) Sheshnag

Q24. Which J&K scheme gives universal health cover of ₹5 lakh per family to all residents?

(a) MUMKIN
(b) Tejaswini
(c) AB-PMJAY SEHAT
(d) HADP

Q25. The Holistic Agriculture Development Programme (HADP) of J&K has:

(a) ₹5,013 crore and 29 projects
(b) ₹1,000 crore and 10 projects
(c) ₹3,000 crore and 29 projects
(d) ₹5,013 crore and 50 projects

Q26. Under the J&K Reorganisation Act, 2019, which subject is reserved for the LG (Union) and not the elected government of the UT of J&K?

(a) Public order and police
(b) Education
(c) Health
(d) Agriculture

PRACTICE 02

National Affairs and Polity

Q1. Consider the following pairs (State - CM sworn in in May 2026):

1. Tamil Nadu - C. Joseph Vijay
2. Kerala - Pinarayi Vijayan
3. Assam - Himanta Biswa Sarma
4. Puducherry - N. Rangasamy

How many of the above pairs are correctly matched?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) Only three
(d) All four

Q2. With reference to the Vice-Presidential election of 9 September 2025, consider:

1. Nominated members of the Rajya Sabha were eligible to vote.
2. Members of State Legislative Assemblies were eligible to vote.
3. Disputes about the election are decided by the Supreme Court.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q3. When elected Vice-President in 2025, C.P. Radhakrishnan was serving as the Governor of:

(a) Jharkhand
(b) Telangana
(c) Maharashtra
(d) Tamil Nadu

Q4. The 2025 Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls was first carried out in:

(a) Assam
(b) Bihar
(c) West Bengal
(d) Delhi

Q5. Consider the following statements about the qualifying dates for enrolment as a voter:

1. There are four qualifying dates in a year.
2. They were introduced by the Election Laws (Amendment) Act, 2021.
3. 1 October is one of them.

Which are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q6. The Constitution (129th Amendment) Bill, 2024 relates to:

(a) removal of Ministers after 30 days in custody
(b) simultaneous elections
(c) raising Lok Sabha strength to 850
(d) women's reservation

Q7. The Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill, 2026 proposed raising the maximum strength of the Lok Sabha to:

(a) 750
(b) 800
(c) 850
(d) 888

Q8. Under Article 334A, reservation of seats for women in the Lok Sabha takes effect:

(a) from the commencement of the 106th Amendment Act
(b) after delimitation based on the first census taken after commencement
(c) automatically from the 2029 general election
(d) after ratification by half the States

Q9. Consider the following about removing the Speaker of the Lok Sabha:

1. The resolution needs at least 14 days' notice.
2. It must be passed by a majority of all the then members of the House.
3. While the resolution is being considered, the Speaker cannot vote at all.

Which are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q10. The Presidential Reference on Governors' assent to Bills (answered on 20 November 2025) was made under:

(a) Article 142
(b) Article 143
(c) Article 145
(d) Article 200

Q11. Consider the following about the Supreme Court's opinion of 20 November 2025:

1. It upheld the fixed timelines laid down in the April 2025 Tamil Nadu Governor case.
2. It ruled out "deemed assent".
3. It held that a Governor's prolonged, unexplained inaction may attract limited judicial scrutiny.

Which are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q12. Justice Surya Kant, the 53rd Chief Justice of India, is from:

(a) Punjab
(b) Rajasthan
(c) Haryana
(d) Himachal Pradesh

Q13. Kerala was renamed "Keralam" by a law in force from 25 August 2026. Which statement is correct?

(a) It required a special majority under Article 368
(b) It required ratification by half the States
(c) It was enacted under Article 3 by a simple majority
(d) It was done by a Presidential Order under Article 4

Q14. Raj Niwas, the official residence of Lieutenant Governors, has been renamed:

(a) Lok Bhavan
(b) Lok Niwas
(c) Jan Niwas
(d) Seva Sadan

Q15. "Seva Teerth", inaugurated on 13 February 2026, houses:

(a) the new Parliament's committee rooms
(b) the PMO, the National Security Council Secretariat and the Cabinet Secretariat
(c) the Ministries of Home Affairs and External Affairs
(d) the Election Commission of India

Q16. Who took oath as Manipur CM on 4 February 2026, when President's Rule was revoked?

(a) N. Biren Singh
(b) Th. Biswajit Singh
(c) Yumnam Khemchand Singh
(d) Nemcha Kipgen

Q17. President's Rule under Article 356 can be continued beyond one year only if:

1. A National Emergency is in operation in India or in the whole or part of the State.
2. The Election Commission certifies that elections cannot be held.
3. The State Legislative Assembly passes a resolution to that effect.

Select the correct answer:

(a) 1 only
(b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q18. The AP Reorganisation (Amendment) Act, 2026 recognises which city as the sole and permanent capital of Andhra Pradesh?

(a) Visakhapatnam
(b) Kurnool
(c) Amaravati
(d) Vijayawada

Q19. Consider the following statements about Census 2027:

1. It will be the first census with caste enumeration since 1931.
2. The reference date for snow-bound areas such as Ladakh and J&K is 1 October 2026.
3. Census is a subject in the Concurrent List.

Which are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q20. The VB-G RAM G Act, 2025, which replaced MGNREGA, guarantees how many days of wage employment per rural household per year?

(a) 100
(b) 120
(c) 125
(d) 150

Q21. Which of the following laws were repealed and consolidated by the Immigration and Foreigners Act, 2025?

1. Foreigners Act, 1946
2. Citizenship Act, 1955
3. Passport (Entry into India) Act, 1920
4. Registration of Foreigners Act, 1939

(a) 1, 2 and 3 only
(b) 1, 3 and 4 only
(c) 2, 3 and 4 only
(d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Q22. The SHANTI Act, 2025 relates to:

(a) peacekeeping deployments
(b) nuclear energy
(c) inland waterways
(d) communal harmony

Q23. Under the Promotion and Regulation of Online Gaming Act, 2025:

(a) all online games are banned
(b) only chance-based money games are banned
(c) online money games are banned, whether skill-based or chance-based
(d) online money games are allowed under licence

Q24. Which provision of the Waqf (Amendment) Act, 2025 did the Supreme Court stay in its interim order of 15 September 2025?

(a) The entire Act
(b) The requirement to have practised Islam for five years to create a waqf
(c) Registration on the UMEED portal
(d) The renaming of the Act

Q25. Which was the first State declared fully literate under ULLAS?

(a) Kerala
(b) Goa
(c) Mizoram
(d) Tripura

Q26. Which State was declared free of extreme poverty on 1 November 2025?

(a) Kerala
(b) Goa
(c) Sikkim
(d) Himachal Pradesh

Q27. The chief guests at Republic Day 2026 were:

(a) Prabowo Subianto
(b) Emmanuel Macron
(c) António Costa and Ursula von der Leyen
(d) Keir Starmer

Q28. Consider the following pairs (anniversary marked in 2025 - year):

1. Vande Mataram - composed in 1875
2. Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel - born in 1875
3. Birsa Munda - born in 1875
4. Guru Tegh Bahadur - martyred in 1675

How many of the above pairs are correctly matched?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) Only three
(d) All four

Q29. Match List I with List II:

A. Article 3 - 1. Advisory jurisdiction of the Supreme Court
B. Article 82 - 2. Removal of the Speaker
C. Article 94 - 3. Alteration of the name of a State
D. Article 143 - 4. Readjustment after each census

(a) A-3, B-4, C-2, D-1
(b) A-4, B-3, C-1, D-2
(c) A-3, B-2, C-4, D-1
(d) A-1, B-4, C-2, D-3

PRACTICE 03

Economy, Banking and Finance

Q1. In August 2026, the RBI policy repo rate was:

(a) 5.50%
(b) 5.25%
(c) 6.00%
(d) 5.00%

Q2. Consider the following statements about the RBI's August 2026 policy:

1. The MPC kept the repo rate unchanged by a unanimous vote.
2. The stance was changed to "accommodative".
3. CPI inflation for 2026-27 was projected at 5.0%.

Which are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q3. The CRR of 3% came into effect after a phased cut of:

(a) 50 bps in Feb 2025
(b) 100 bps announced in June 2025
(c) 25 bps in Dec 2025
(d) 150 bps in 2024

Q4. Who notifies the inflation target under the RBI Act, and for which period was the 4% ±2% target retained in March 2026?

(a) RBI; 2026-2029
(b) Central Government; 1 Apr 2026 - 31 Mar 2031
(c) MPC; 2026-2031
(d) Finance Commission; 2026-2031

Q5. The Monetary Policy Committee is constituted under which section of the RBI Act, 1934?

(a) Section 7
(b) Section 45ZB
(c) Section 42
(d) Section 17

Q6. Rohit Jain, who took charge in May 2026, is:

(a) SEBI Chairman
(b) RBI Deputy Governor
(c) Chief Economic Adviser
(d) NABARD Chairman

Q7. The weights of the new CPI series (base 2024) are derived from:

(a) Census 2011
(b) HCES 2023-24
(c) PLFS 2023-24
(d) NSS 68th round

Q8. According to the June 2026 Provisional Estimates, India's real GDP growth in FY 2025-26 was:

(a) 6.5%
(b) 7.4%
(c) 7.7%
(d) 8.2%

Q9. Real GDP growth in Q1 (April-June) of 2026-27 was:

(a) 6.9%
(b) 7.4%
(c) 7.8%
(d) 8.4%

Q10. In the Budget 2026-27 "Rupee comes from" chart, the largest single source is:

(a) Income tax
(b) Corporation tax
(c) Borrowings and other liabilities
(d) GST

Q11. In the "Rupee goes to" chart, the largest item is:

(a) Interest payments
(b) States' share of taxes
(c) Defence
(d) Central sector schemes

Q12. Biopharma SHAKTI, announced in Budget 2026-27, has an outlay of:

(a) ₹1,000 crore
(b) ₹10,000 crore over 5 years
(c) ₹40,000 crore
(d) ₹1 lakh crore

Q13. The Rare Earth Corridors announced in Budget 2026-27 cover:

(a) Odisha, Kerala, Andhra Pradesh, Tamil Nadu
(b) Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh, MP, Rajasthan
(c) Gujarat, Maharashtra, Goa, Karnataka
(d) Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, Mizoram

Q14. Consider the following statements:

1. As per the Economic Survey 2025-26, India accounts for more than 5% of global merchandise exports.
2. As per the Economic Survey 2025-26, India's services imports were greater than its exports.

Which is/are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both
(d) Neither

Q15. The Economic Survey 2025-26 projected India's real GDP growth for 2026-27 at:

(a) 6.3-6.8%
(b) 6.8-7.2%
(c) 7.0-7.5%
(d) 6.5%

Q16. Which statement about the Sixteenth Finance Commission's horizontal-devolution criteria is correct?

(a) Income distance has the greatest weight; contribution to GDP and area have equal weights.
(b) Population has the greatest weight; contribution to GDP exceeds area.
(c) Area has the greatest weight; income distance and population have equal weights.
(d) Contribution to GDP has the greatest weight; area exceeds population.

Q17. The share of states in the divisible pool recommended by the 16th Finance Commission is:

(a) 42%
(b) 41%
(c) 40%
(d) 43%

Q18. Which criterion was newly introduced by the 16th Finance Commission?

(a) Tax and fiscal effort
(b) Forest cover
(c) Contribution to GDP
(d) Demographic performance

Q19. Under GST 2.0 (effective 22 September 2025), which slabs were removed?

(a) 5% and 18%
(b) 12% and 28%
(c) 0.25% and 3%
(d) 18% and 28%

Q20. Consider the following about the Income-tax Act, 2025:

1. It came into force on 1 April 2026.
2. It introduces the concept of "tax year".
3. It abolished the old tax regime.

Which are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q21. Under the Banking Laws (Amendment) Act, 2025, a depositor can nominate up to:

(a) 2 persons
(b) 3 persons
(c) 4 persons
(d) 5 persons

Q22. The Sabka Bima Sabki Raksha (Amendment of Insurance Laws) Act, 2025 allows FDI in insurance companies up to:

(a) 49%
(b) 74%
(c) 100%
(d) 26%

Q23. EFTA does **not** include:

(a) Norway
(b) Iceland
(c) Liechtenstein
(d) Denmark

Q24. Which agency upgraded India's sovereign rating to BBB in August 2025?

(a) Moody's
(b) Fitch
(c) S&P Global
(d) DBRS

Q25. The Mission for Aatmanirbharta in Pulses aims at self-sufficiency in pulses by:

(a) 2027-28
(b) 2030-31
(c) 2035
(d) 2047

Q26. PM Surya Sarovar Yojana (July 2026) relates to:

(a) rooftop solar for 1 crore homes
(b) 5,000 MW of floating solar
(c) solar pumps for farmers
(d) solar parks in deserts

Q27. Who is the 74th President of ICAI (2026-27)?

(a) Charanjot Singh Nanda
(b) Prasanna Kumar D
(c) Ranjeet Kumar Agarwal
(d) Mangesh Kinare

Q28. Zou Jiayi heads which institution?

(a) NDB
(b) ADB
(c) AIIB
(d) IMF

PRACTICE 04

International Affairs

Q1. Consider the following statements about the Strait of Hormuz:

1. It connects the Persian Gulf with the Gulf of Oman.
2. Oman's Musandam peninsula lies on its southern side.
3. It connects the Red Sea with the Gulf of Aden.

Which are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q2. "Operation Sindhu" was launched by India to:

(a) evacuate Indians from Sudan
(b) evacuate Indians from Iran and Israel during the June 2025 conflict
(c) send relief to Sri Lanka after Cyclone Ditwah
(d) evacuate Indians from Ukraine

Q3. India's relief operation for Sri Lanka after Cyclone Ditwah (Nov 2025) was named:

(a) Operation Brahma
(b) Operation Sagar Bandhu
(c) Operation Dost
(d) Operation Kaveri

Q4. With reference to the 18th BRICS Summit, consider:

1. It was held in New Delhi on 12-13 September 2026.
2. It was India's third BRICS chairship.
3. Its outcome document is the New Delhi Declaration.
4. Malaysia and Thailand attended as full members.

Which are correct?

(a) 1 and 3 only
(b) 1, 2 and 3 only
(c) 2 and 4 only
(d) 1, 3 and 4 only

Q5. The theme of India's 2026 BRICS chairship is "Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and ___":

(a) Security
(b) Sustainability
(c) Solidarity
(d) Sovereignty

Q6. The 26th SCO Summit (2026) was held in:

(a) Astana
(b) Tianjin
(c) Bishkek
(d) Dushanbe

Q7. Consider the following about the SCO:

1. Its Regional Anti-Terrorist Structure (RATS) is based in Tashkent.
2. Belarus became its tenth member in 2024.
3. India refused to sign the SCO Defence Ministers' joint document at Qingdao (June 2025) because it left out the Pahalgam attack.

Which are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q8. The first G20 Leaders' Summit in Africa was held in:

(a) Cape Town, 2024
(b) Johannesburg, 2025
(c) Cairo, 2025
(d) Nairobi, 2026

Q9. Consider the following about the G20:

1. The African Union became a permanent member at the New Delhi Summit (2023).
2. The USA holds the presidency for 2026.
3. The United Kingdom will hold the 2027 presidency.

Which are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q10. The Quad Foreign Ministers' Meeting of May 2026 was held in:

(a) Tokyo
(b) Canberra
(c) New Delhi
(d) Washington

Q11. Which of the following statements about the Quad is/are correct?

1. It is a treaty-based military alliance.
2. It was first proposed by Shinzo Abe in 2007.
3. India hosted a Quad Leaders' Summit in 2025.

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q12. The G7 Summit of June 2026, where PM Modi addressed outreach sessions, was held at:

(a) Kananaskis
(b) Evian
(c) Hiroshima
(d) Apulia

Q13. NATO's 2026 summit was held in:

(a) The Hague
(b) Vilnius
(c) Ankara
(d) Washington

Q14. Which country became the 11th member of ASEAN in October 2025?

(a) Papua New Guinea
(b) Timor-Leste
(c) Bangladesh
(d) Sri Lanka

Q15. Under the UN Charter, the Secretary-General is:

(a) elected by the Security Council
(b) appointed by the General Assembly on the recommendation of the Security Council
(c) elected by a two-thirds majority of the General Assembly, without the Security Council
(d) appointed by the P5 by consensus

Q16. Who was elected President of the 81st session of the UN General Assembly?

(a) Annalena Baerbock
(b) Philemon Yang
(c) Khalilur Rahman
(d) Dennis Francis

Q17. The ICJ advisory opinion on climate change (July 2025) followed a UNGA request led by:

(a) Tuvalu
(b) Maldives
(c) Vanuatu
(d) Fiji

Q18. Who became Nepal's first woman Prime Minister (interim) in September 2025?

(a) Bidya Devi Bhandari
(b) Sushila Karki
(c) Hisila Yami
(d) Arzu Rana Deuba

Q19. Which Myanmar junta chief was elected President by Parliament in April 2026?

(a) Than Shwe
(b) Min Aung Hlaing
(c) Soe Win
(d) Thein Sein

Q20. Which was the first country to formally recognise the Taliban government of Afghanistan (July 2025)?

(a) China
(b) Pakistan
(c) Russia
(d) Qatar

Q21. UN Security Council Resolution 2803 (November 2025) relates to:

(a) Ukraine
(b) Gaza and the Board of Peace
(c) Sudan
(d) Afghanistan

Q22. The chief guests at India's Republic Day 2026 were leaders of:

(a) ASEAN
(b) the European Union
(c) the African Union
(d) BIMSTEC

Q23. With reference to India-China relations in 2025-26, consider:

1. Direct flights resumed in October 2025.
2. The Kailash Mansarovar Yatra resumed in 2025.
3. China began building a mega-dam on the Yarlung Tsangpo at Medog in July 2025.

Which are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q24. The Yarlung Tsangpo enters India as the:

(a) Lohit
(b) Subansiri
(c) Siang
(d) Teesta

Q25. India announced the upgrade of its technical mission in Kabul to an embassy during the visit of:

(a) Hamid Karzai
(b) Amir Khan Muttaqi
(c) Mullah Baradar
(d) Sirajuddin Haqqani

Q26. The WTO's 14th Ministerial Conference (March 2026) was held in:

(a) Abu Dhabi
(b) Yaoundé
(c) Geneva
(d) Nairobi

Q27. Kirsty Coventry, who became IOC President in 2025, is from:

(a) South Africa
(b) Kenya
(c) Zimbabwe
(d) Nigeria

Q28. Which of the following explicitly condemned the Pahalgam terror attack?

1. The Rio de Janeiro BRICS Declaration (2025)
2. The Tianjin SCO Declaration (2025)
3. The Quad Foreign Ministers' meeting, New Delhi (May 2026)

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

PRACTICE 05

Science and Technology

Q1. With the SpaDeX docking (16 Jan 2025), India became the ___ country to achieve space docking:

(a) 3rd
(b) 4th
(c) 5th
(d) 6th

Q2. Consider the following about SpaDeX:

1. It was launched by PSLV-C60.
2. Its two satellites were named SDX-01 (Chaser) and SDX-02 (Target).
3. It was launched from the Kulasekarapattinam spaceport.

Which are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q3. The 100th launch from Sriharikota (Jan 2025) was:

(a) PSLV-C60
(b) GSLV-F15/NVS-02
(c) LVM3-M5
(d) SSLV-D3

Q4. Which of the following ISRO missions failed because of a third-stage problem?

1. PSLV-C61 (May 2025)
2. PSLV-C62 (Jan 2026)
3. GSLV-F17 (Sep 2026)

(a) 1 only
(b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q5. GSLV-F17 (Sep 2026) launched EOS-05 (GISAT-1A), notable as:

(a) India's first navigation satellite
(b) India's first imaging satellite in geosynchronous orbit
(c) India's first hyperspectral satellite
(d) India's first radar satellite

Q6. The heaviest communication satellite launched from Indian soil (2 Nov 2025) was:

(a) GSAT-24
(b) CMS-03
(c) GSAT-20
(d) BlueBird Block-2

Q7. With reference to NISAR, consider:

1. It carries L-band (NASA) and S-band (ISRO) radars.
2. It was launched by a NASA rocket from Cape Canaveral.
3. It was placed in a sun-synchronous orbit by GSLV-F16.

Which are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q8. Shubhanshu Shukla flew to the International Space Station as part of:

(a) Crew-10
(b) Axiom Mission 4
(c) Soyuz MS-27
(d) Gaganyaan H1

Q9. Rakesh Sharma flew in 1984 aboard:

(a) Soyuz T-11 to Salyut-7
(b) Space Shuttle Columbia
(c) Soyuz TMA to Mir
(d) Vostok-6

Q10. Which of the following is NOT a Gaganyaan astronaut-designate?

(a) Prasanth Balakrishnan Nair
(b) Angad Pratap
(c) Ajit Krishnan
(d) Rakesh Sharma

Q11. The first module of the Bharatiya Antariksh Station (BAS-1) is targeted for:

(a) 2026
(b) 2028
(c) 2032
(d) 2035

Q12. India's first private orbital launch, Vikram-1 (July 2026), was carried out by:

(a) Agnikul Cosmos
(b) Skyroot Aerospace
(c) Pixxel
(d) Dhruva Space

Q13. Artemis II (April 2026) was:

(a) an uncrewed lunar landing
(b) a crewed lunar flyby without landing
(c) a crewed lunar south-pole landing
(d) a Mars sample-return mission

Q14. Jeremy Hansen, a member of the Artemis II crew, is from:

(a) the UK
(b) Japan
(c) Canada
(d) Germany

Q15. 3I/ATLAS, discovered in July 2025, is:

(a) a near-Earth asteroid
(b) the third known interstellar object
(c) a new moon of Saturn
(d) a Chinese space telescope

Q16. The India AI Impact Summit 2026 was held at:

(a) Yashobhoomi
(b) Bharat Mandapam
(c) Vigyan Bhawan
(d) Mahatma Mandir

Q17. "Vikram 3201", presented at Semicon India 2025, is:

(a) a launch vehicle
(b) a 32-bit space-grade processor from ISRO's SCL, Mohali
(c) a quantum chip
(d) a 5G modem

Q18. India's first commercial semiconductor fab is being built at:

(a) Sanand
(b) Dholera
(c) Jagiroad
(d) Jewar

Q19. Which department implements the National Quantum Mission?

(a) MeitY
(b) DST
(c) DAE
(d) DoT

Q20. The Prototype Fast Breeder Reactor that reached first criticality on 6 April 2026 is at:

(a) Tarapur
(b) Kudankulam
(c) Kalpakkam
(d) Rawatbhata

Q21. Consider the following about the PFBR:

1. It uses liquid sodium as coolant.
2. It marks the start of stage two of India's nuclear programme.
3. It was built by NPCIL.

Which are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q22. India's first Dark Sky Reserve is at:

(a) Spiti
(b) Hanle
(c) Kutch
(d) Pench

Q23. The world's highest imaging Cherenkov telescope, MACE, is in:

(a) Sikkim
(b) Ladakh
(c) Arunachal Pradesh
(d) Himachal Pradesh

Q24. The world's first genome-edited rice varieties (May 2025) were released by:

(a) IRRI
(b) ICAR
(c) CSIR
(d) DBT

Q25. Match the 2025 Nobel Prize with the discovery:

A. Physics - 1. Metal-organic frameworks
B. Chemistry - 2. Peripheral immune tolerance
C. Medicine - 3. Macroscopic quantum tunnelling

(a) A-3, B-1, C-2
(b) A-1, B-3, C-2
(c) A-2, B-1, C-3
(d) A-3, B-2, C-1

Q26. Shimon Sakaguchi, a 2025 Nobel laureate, is known for discovering:

(a) CRISPR
(b) regulatory T cells
(c) mRNA vaccines
(d) graphene

Q27. Lithium resources of about 5.9 million tonnes (inferred) were reported by GSI in 2023 in:

(a) Reasi, J&K
(b) Leh, Ladakh
(c) Kinnaur, HP
(d) Korba, Chhattisgarh

PRACTICE 06

Environment and Ecology

Q1. "Chillai Kalan", in news during Kashmir's dry winter of 2025-26, refers to:

(a) the 40-day harshest phase of the Kashmir winter
(b) a glacier in Gurez
(c) a Kashmiri harvest festival
(d) a wetland in Ganderbal

Q2. Winter precipitation in J&K and Ladakh comes mainly from:

(a) the south-west monsoon
(b) Western Disturbances
(c) the north-east monsoon
(d) tropical cyclones from the Arabian Sea

Q3. As per India's first Snow Leopard Population Assessment (SPAI, 2024), the number of snow leopards in Ladakh is about:

(a) 124
(b) 718
(c) 9
(d) 477

Q4. Consider the following statements:

1. J&K has five Ramsar sites, including Hygam and Shallabugh, designated in 2022.
2. The Tso Kar wetland complex in Ladakh is entirely a freshwater system.
3. Dal Lake is not a Ramsar site.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q5. The NDMA's National GLOF Risk Mitigation Programme covers about how many high-risk glacial lakes?

(a) 56
(b) 128
(c) 195
(d) 7,500

Q6. The UN declared 2025 as the International Year of:

(a) Glaciers' Preservation
(b) Rangelands and Pastoralists
(c) Millets
(d) Camelids

Q7. The 13 GW renewable energy project in Ladakh, linked to Green Energy Corridor Phase-II, is located at:

(a) Puga
(b) Hanle
(c) Nyoma
(d) Pang

Q8. The overarching political decision of COP30 (Belém) is popularly known as the:

(a) Global Mutirão
(b) Belém Accord
(c) Dubai Consensus
(d) Baku Roadmap

Q9. Which of the following pairs is INCORRECTLY matched?

(a) COP27: Loss and Damage Fund agreed
(b) COP28: first Global Stocktake
(c) COP29: NCQG of $300 billion a year by 2035
(d) COP30: Paris Rulebook finalised

Q10. Under its NDC for 2031-35, India aims to reduce the emissions intensity of its GDP, from 2005 levels, by 2035 by:

(a) 47%
(b) 45%
(c) 50%
(d) 60%

Q11. Consider the following statements about India's NDC 2031-35:

1. It targets 60% of electricity generation from non-fossil sources by 2035.
2. India had already crossed 50% non-fossil share of installed power capacity by early 2026.
3. It raises the additional carbon sink target to 3.5-4.0 billion tonnes of CO_2 equivalent.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q12. The USA's second withdrawal from the Paris Agreement became legally effective on:

(a) 20 Jan 2025
(b) 27 Jan 2026
(c) 7 Jan 2026
(d) 4 Nov 2020

Q13. UNEP's Emissions Gap Report 2025 was titled:

(a) Broken Record
(b) No more hot air… please!
(c) Turning Point
(d) Off Target

Q14. According to the WMO State of the Global Climate 2025 report:

(a) 2025 was the 2nd or 3rd warmest year, about 1.43°C above pre-industrial levels
(b) 2025 was the warmest year on record
(c) 2025 was cooler than 2015
(d) the 1.5°C Paris limit has been formally breached

Q15. The 2026 south-west monsoon ended at about 87% of the Long Period Average. Under IMD's classification this is:

(a) normal
(b) below normal
(c) deficient
(d) excess

Q16. The Indian Carbon Market Portal was launched in March 2026 at the "Prakriti 2026" conference by the Union Minister of:

(a) Power
(b) Environment
(c) Finance
(d) Earth Sciences

Q17. The administrator of India's Carbon Credit Trading Scheme (CCTS) is the:

(a) SEBI
(b) CERC
(c) Bureau of Energy Efficiency
(d) CPCB

Q18. UNCCD COP17 (Aug 2026), held under the theme "Restoring Land. Restoring Hope.", took place at:

(a) Riyadh
(b) Yerevan
(c) Samarkand
(d) Ulaanbaatar

Q19. CITES CoP20 (Nov-Dec 2025) was held at:

(a) Samarkand
(b) Panama City
(c) Geneva
(d) Nairobi

Q20. The BBNJ (High Seas) Agreement entered into force on:

(a) 19 Jun 2023
(b) 20 Sep 2025
(c) 17 Jan 2026
(d) 8 Jun 2026

Q21. India's 100th Ramsar site, designated in 2026, is:

(a) Glaw Lake
(b) Patna Bird Sanctuary, Etah
(c) Chhari-Dhand, Kutch
(d) Surha Tal (Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary), Ballia

Q22. Glaw Lake, India's 101st Ramsar site, lies within:

(a) Namdapha Tiger Reserve
(b) Kamlang Tiger Reserve
(c) Pakke Tiger Reserve
(d) Keibul Lamjao National Park

Q23. The Ancient Buddhist Site, Sarnath, became India's 45th World Heritage Site at the 48th World Heritage Committee session held in:

(a) New Delhi
(b) Paris
(c) Busan
(d) Riyadh

Q24. Consider the following about the Sarnath World Heritage property:

1. It includes the Chaukhandi Stupa.
2. The Dhamek Stupa is part of it.
3. Mrigadava and Isipatana are old names for its Deer Park.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q25. In Sep 2025, India's 13th biosphere reserve in UNESCO's World Network became:

(a) Cold Desert (Himachal Pradesh)
(b) Panna
(c) Agasthyamala
(d) Khangchendzonga

Q26. India's 58th tiger reserve, notified in March 2025, is:

(a) Ratapani
(b) Madhav
(c) Guru Ghasidas-Tamor Pingla
(d) Veerangana Durgavati

Q27. Nine cheetahs from Botswana arrived at Kuno National Park on:

(a) 17 Sep 2022
(b) 18 Feb 2023
(c) 20 Apr 2025
(d) 28 Feb 2026

Q28. Which of the following census figures is INCORRECTLY matched?

(a) Elephants (SAIEE 2025): 22,446
(b) Asiatic lions (2025): 891
(c) River dolphins (2025): 6,327
(d) Snow leopards (SPAI 2024): 3,682

Q29. The hangul population counted in the 2025 census (reported Jan 2026) is:

(a) 261
(b) 289
(c) 323
(d) 412

Q30. The Solid Waste Management Rules, 2026 require source segregation into how many streams?

(a) Two
(b) Three
(c) Four
(d) Five

Q31. In Swachh Vayu Survekshan 2026, the top city in the over-10-lakh population category was:

(a) Indore
(b) Jabalpur
(c) Surat
(d) Lucknow

Q32. In the Environmental Performance Index 2026, India ranked:

(a) 120th
(b) 176th out of 177
(c) 150th
(d) 180th out of 180

Q33. The global host of World Environment Day 2026 was:

(a) Republic of Korea
(b) Azerbaijan
(c) Saudi Arabia
(d) Côte d'Ivoire

Q34. In the Climate Change Performance Index 2026, India ranked 23rd. Which statement about the CCPI is correct?

(a) It is published by UNEP
(b) Denmark ranked 1st
(c) The top three ranks were left vacant because no country performed well enough
(d) India improved from 30th

PRACTICE 07

Defence and Security

Q1. Operation Sindoor (May 2025) was launched in response to the terror attack at:

(a) Pulwama
(b) Uri
(c) Pahalgam (Baisaran)
(d) Reasi

Q2. Operation Mahadev (28 Jul 2025), which killed the Pahalgam attackers, took place near:

(a) Kulgam
(b) Dachigam/Harwan, Srinagar
(c) Kishtwar
(d) Poonch

Q3. The Mudh-Nyoma air base, made operational in Nov 2025, is in:

(a) Eastern Ladakh
(b) the Gurez valley
(c) Kargil town
(d) North Sikkim

Q4. Match these BRO projects to their HQs, in this order: Beacon, Himank, Vijayak, Sampark.

(a) Srinagar, Leh, Kargil, Jammu
(b) Leh, Srinagar, Jammu, Kargil
(c) Jammu, Kargil, Leh, Srinagar
(d) Srinagar, Kargil, Leh, Jammu

Q5. The "Chinar Corps" is:

(a) 14 Corps, Leh
(b) 16 Corps, Nagrota
(c) 15 Corps, Srinagar
(d) 1 Corps, Mathura

Q6. Which of these tunnels is NOT a BRO project?

(a) Atal Tunnel
(b) Sela Tunnel
(c) Shinku La Tunnel
(d) Zojila Tunnel

Q7. India's first Param Vir Chakra recipient, Maj Somnath Sharma, was killed in action at:

(a) Badgam
(b) Naushera
(c) Zojila
(d) Rezang La

Q8. Who is India's third Chief of Defence Staff (from 31 May 2026)?

(a) Gen Anil Chauhan
(b) Gen Upendra Dwivedi
(c) Gen Manoj Pande
(d) Gen N.S. Raja Subramani

Q9. Consider these statements about the CDS: (1) Permanent Chairman of the Chiefs of Staff Committee; (2) heads the Department of Military Affairs; (3) chairs the Defence Acquisition Council; (4) age ceiling of 65. Which are correct?

(a) 1, 2 and 4 only
(b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2, 3 and 4 only
(d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Q10. Gen Dhiraj Seth took over as:

(a) 30th COAS on 30 Jun 2026
(b) 31st COAS on 30 Jun 2026
(c) 31st COAS on 31 May 2026
(d) Vice Chief on 30 Jun 2026

Q11. Before becoming the 27th Chief of the Naval Staff, Adm Krishna Swaminathan was:

(a) FOC-in-C, Western Naval Command
(b) FOC-in-C, Eastern Naval Command
(c) Commandant, NDA
(d) DG, Indian Coast Guard

Q12. DIHAR, a DRDO laboratory for high-altitude research, is located at:

(a) Dehradun
(b) Hyderabad
(c) Leh
(d) Avadi

Q13. The "Rudra" brigades announced by the Army in Jul 2025 are:

(a) nuclear-missile units
(b) all-arms integrated brigades
(c) drone-only units
(d) naval commando units

Q14. Under the Agnipath scheme, the maximum share of each batch retained as regulars is:

(a) 50%
(b) 33%
(c) 15%
(d) 25%

Q15. The Ministry of Defence's allocation in Union Budget 2026-27 is about:

(a) ₹6.81 lakh cr
(b) ₹2.19 lakh cr
(c) ₹7.85 lakh cr
(d) ₹5.94 lakh cr

Q16. (FAA numerical) Defence exports rose from ₹23,622 cr (FY25) to ₹38,424 cr (FY26). The growth is about:

(a) 38%
(b) 51%
(c) 62.7%
(d) 72%

Q17. India's record defence production in FY 2025-26 was:

(a) ₹1.27 lakh cr
(b) ₹1.78 lakh cr
(c) ₹2.19 lakh cr
(d) ₹3.00 lakh cr

Q18. Acceptance of Necessity (AoN) for capital acquisitions is granted by:

(a) the Cabinet Committee on Security
(b) the Defence Acquisition Council
(c) DRDO
(d) the Department of Expenditure

Q19. The Agni-Prime test of 24 Sep 2025 was notable because it was the first launch from a:

(a) rail-based mobile launcher
(b) MIRV bus
(c) submarine
(d) ship

Q20. "Mission Divyastra" (Mar 2024) refers to:

(a) an Army artillery battery
(b) the first Agni-V MIRV test
(c) an anti-satellite test
(d) a laser weapon trial

Q21. The Integrated Air Defence Weapon System (IADWS) tested in Aug 2025 combines QRSAM, VSHORADS and:

(a) S-400
(b) BrahMos
(c) a laser-based directed energy weapon
(d) MRSAM

Q22. "Sudarshan Chakra" can refer to: (1) the national security-shield mission announced on 15 Aug 2025; (2) the IAF's name for the S-400. Which is/are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither

Q23. India's third SSBN, commissioned on 3 Apr 2026, is:

(a) INS Arighaat
(b) INS Aridhaman
(c) INS Chakra
(d) INS Vaghsheer

Q24. Which ship (commissioned Jul 2025) is described as the Indian Navy's last imported warship?

(a) INS Tushil
(b) INS Surat
(c) INS Vikramaditya
(d) INS Tamal

Q25. Project 17A relates to:

(a) destroyers
(b) conventional submarines
(c) aircraft carriers
(d) stealth frigates

Q26. The International Fleet Review 2026 and MILAN 2026 were held at:

(a) Visakhapatnam
(b) Kochi
(c) Port Blair
(d) Mumbai

Q27. The IAF retired its MiG-21 fleet on 26 Sep 2025 at:

(a) Ambala
(b) Hindon
(c) Chandigarh
(d) Jodhpur

Q28. The 26 Rafale-M jets ordered in 2025 are for:

(a) the IAF
(b) the Indian Navy (INS Vikrant)
(c) the Coast Guard
(d) Army Aviation

Q29. Yudh Abhyas 2026 (22nd edition) was held at:

(a) Fort Wainwright, Alaska
(b) Mahajan, Rajasthan
(c) Chaubatia
(d) Auli, Uttarakhand

Q30. Exercise Pitch Black is hosted by:

(a) USA
(b) Australia
(c) Japan
(d) France

Q31. Match these exercises to their partner countries, in this order: Mitra Shakti, Maitree, Dustlik, Surya Kiran.

(a) Sri Lanka, Thailand, Uzbekistan, Nepal
(b) Thailand, Sri Lanka, Nepal, Uzbekistan
(c) Sri Lanka, Myanmar, Kazakhstan, Nepal
(d) Nepal, Thailand, Uzbekistan, Sri Lanka

Q32. BECA (2020), signed with the US, concerns:

(a) logistics support
(b) secure communications
(c) military information security
(d) geospatial cooperation

Q33. Pakistan ceded the Shaksgam valley to China in:

(a) 1948
(b) 1962
(c) 1965
(d) 1963

Q34. Police Commemoration Day (21 Oct) honours CRPF personnel killed by Chinese troops in 1959 at:

(a) Galwan
(b) Rezang La
(c) Daulat Beg Oldi
(d) Hot Springs, Ladakh

Q35. The Zorawar light tank is named after the general who conquered Ladakh for:

(a) Dogra ruler Gulab Singh
(b) the Afghan Durrani rulers
(c) Mughal emperor Shah Jahan
(d) Ladakh's Namgyal dynasty

PRACTICE 08

Awards and Honours

Q1. Dr Padma Gurmet (Padma Shri 2026, Ladakh) is known for promoting:

(a) Unani
(b) Sowa-Rigpa
(c) Siddha
(d) Homeopathy

Q2. Prof Shafi Shauq received the Padma Shri 2026 in the field of:

(a) Art
(b) Social Work
(c) Literature & Education
(d) Public Affairs

Q3. Brij Lal Bhat (Padma Shri 2026) is recognised for:

(a) social work reconnecting displaced Kashmiri Pandits
(b) Dogri theatre
(c) santoor music
(d) papier-mâché craft

Q4. The Sahitya Akademi Award 2025 for Kashmiri went to:

(a) Ali Shaida
(b) Khajur Singh Thakur
(c) Pritpal Singh Betab
(d) Shafi Shauq

Q5. Khajur Singh Thakur won the Sahitya Akademi Award 2025 (Dogri) for:

(a) *Safar Jaari Hai*
(b) *Crimson Spring*
(c) *Thakur Satsayie*
(d) *Jeete Jee Allahabad*

Q6. Dogri was added to the Eighth Schedule by the:

(a) 71st Amendment, 1992
(b) 92nd Amendment, 2003
(c) 21st Amendment, 1967
(d) 96th Amendment, 2011

Q7. The only Kashmiri-language Jnanpith awardee is:

(a) Ghulam Ahmad Mahjoor
(b) Dina Nath Nadim
(c) Amin Kamil
(d) Rahman Rahi

Q8. Best Feature Film at the 72nd National Film Awards:

(a) *12th Fail*
(b) *Kalki 2898 AD*
(c) *Amaran*
(d) *Article 370*

Q9. The Dadasaheb Phalke Award for 2024 was conferred on:

(a) Mohanlal
(b) Mithun Chakraborty
(c) Anant Nag
(d) Kamal Haasan

Q10. Best Actor at the 72nd National Film Awards was shared by:

(a) Mammootty and Kartik Aaryan
(b) Shah Rukh Khan and Vikrant Massey
(c) Mohanlal and Ranbir Kapoor
(d) Rishab Shetty and Manoj Bajpayee

Q11. *Amaran* (Best Direction, 72nd NFA) is a biopic of:

(a) Capt Vikram Batra
(b) Maj Mukund Varadarajan
(c) Maj Somnath Sharma
(d) Lt Gen Hanut Singh

Q12. The total number of Padma Awards announced for 2026 is:

(a) 139 (b) 131
(c) 132 (d) 128

Q13. Which of these received the Padma Vibhushan in 2026? (1) K.T. Thomas (2) V.S. Achuthanandan (3) N. Rajam (4) Dharmendra

(a) 1 and 3 only (b) 2 and 4 only
(c) 1, 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Q14. Lt Cdr Dilna K and Lt Cdr Roopa A (INSV Tarini circumnavigation) received the:

(a) Kirti Chakra (b) Ashoka Chakra
(c) Shaurya Chakra (d) Nao Sena Medal

Q15. How many Bharat Ratna awards were announced in 2024?

(a) 3 (b) 4
(c) 5 (d) 2

Q16. The 60th Jnanpith Award (for 2025) went to:

(a) Vairamuthu (b) Vinod Kumar Shukla
(c) Gulzar (d) Damodar Mauzo

Q17. Vairamuthu is which Tamil writer to win the Jnanpith?

(a) First (b) Second
(c) Third (d) Fourth

Q18. The Jnanpith Award is conferred by:

(a) the Ministry of Culture (b) the Sahitya Akademi
(c) Bharatiya Jnanpith, a private trust (d) the K.K. Birla Foundation

Q19. *Heart Lamp* (International Booker 2025) was translated into English from:

(a) Malayalam (b) Kannada
(c) Tamil (d) Urdu

Q20. The International Booker Prize 2026 went to:

(a) *Heart Lamp* (b) *Flesh*
(c) *Tomb of Sand* (d) *Taiwan Travelogue*

Q21. The Booker Prize 2025 was won by:

(a) *Flesh*, David Szalay
(b) *Orbital*, Samantha Harvey
(c) *Prophet Song*, Paul Lynch
(d) *The Seven Moons of Maali Almeida*, Shehan Karunatilaka

Q22. The Vigyan Ratna 2025 was conferred (posthumously) on:

(a) G. Padmanabhan (b) Jayant V. Narlikar
(c) K. Kasturirangan (d) M.S. Swaminathan

Q23. What was notable about the National Sports Awards 2025?

(a) Khel Ratna to Hardik Singh (b) No Khel Ratna awarded
(c) Khel Ratna to Neeraj Chopra (d) Khel Ratna to D. Gukesh

Q24. I. Arumainayagam, Arjuna Award (Lifetime) 2025, played:

(a) hockey
(b) athletics
(c) wrestling
(d) football

Q25. The Nobel Prize in Chemistry 2025 was awarded for:

(a) metal-organic frameworks
(b) quantum dots
(c) click chemistry
(d) computational protein design

Q26. The Nobel Prize in Economic Sciences 2025 went to:

(a) Acemoglu, Johnson and Robinson
(b) Claudia Goldin
(c) Mokyr, Aghion and Howitt
(d) Banerjee, Duflo and Kremer

Q27. The Nobel Peace Prize 2025 was awarded to:

(a) Nihon Hidankyo
(b) Narges Mohammadi
(c) María Corina Machado
(d) UNHCR

Q28. The Nobel Prize in Literature 2025 went to:

(a) Han Kang
(b) Jon Fosse
(c) Annie Ernaux
(d) László Krasznahorkai

Q29. Runa Khan (Ramon Magsaysay Award 2026) is from:

(a) India
(b) Nepal
(c) Sri Lanka
(d) Bangladesh

Q30. Tommy Koh (Magsaysay 2026) is best known for leading negotiations on:

(a) UNCLOS
(b) the WTO Doha Round
(c) the Paris Agreement
(d) the CTBT

Q31. The first Indian organisation to win the Ramon Magsaysay Award (2025) was:

(a) Pratham
(b) SEWA
(c) Educate Girls
(d) Goonj

Q32. The Abel Prize 2026 went to:

(a) Gerd Faltings
(b) Terence Tao
(c) Masaki Kashiwara
(d) Michel Talagrand

Q33. National Handloom Day (7 Aug) commemorates the launch of:

(a) the Quit India Movement
(b) the Swadeshi Movement, 1905
(c) the Dandi March
(d) the Champaran Satyagraha

Q34. The Pritzker Architecture Prize 2026 laureate Smiljan Radić Clarke is from:

(a) Spain
(b) Japan
(c) Mexico
(d) Chile

Q35. The ACM Turing Award (for 2025) to Charles Bennett and Gilles Brassard honours work on:

(a) deep learning
(b) RSA public-key cryptography
(c) compiler design
(d) quantum information science and quantum cryptography (BB84)

Q36. Sowa-Rigpa was recognised as an AYUSH system in:

(a) 2003
(b) 2014
(c) 2019
(d) 2010

PRACTICE 09

Sports and Games

Q1. Jammu & Kashmir's opponent in the final of their maiden Ranji Trophy title season, 2025-26, was:

(a) Mumbai
(b) Vidarbha
(c) Karnataka
(d) Kerala

Q2. The 2025-26 Ranji Trophy final was played at:

(a) M. Chinnaswamy Stadium, Bengaluru
(b) KSCA Stadium, Hubballi
(c) Wankhede Stadium, Mumbai
(d) VCA Stadium, Nagpur

Q3. J&K were declared Ranji Trophy 2025-26 champions on the basis of:

(a) the first-innings lead in a drawn final
(b) an outright win by an innings
(c) a super over
(d) a higher net run-rate

Q4. Who captained J&K to the 2025-26 Ranji Trophy title?

(a) Paras Dogra
(b) Abdul Samad
(c) Umran Malik
(d) Shubham Khajuria

Q5. Who was Player of the Series (60 wickets) in the 2025-26 Ranji Trophy?

(a) Umran Malik
(b) Yudhvir Singh
(c) Auqib Nabi
(d) Rasikh Salam Dar

Q6. The snow events of the 6th Khelo India Winter Games (2026) were held at:

(a) Auli
(b) Gulmarg
(c) Sonamarg
(d) Solang

Q7. Which team won the overall title at the Khelo India Winter Games 2026, completing a hat-trick?

(a) Jammu & Kashmir
(b) Ladakh
(c) Himachal Pradesh
(d) Indian Army

Q8. Para archer Sheetal Devi belongs to which district of J&K?

(a) Kishtwar
(b) Doda
(c) Kupwara
(d) Ramban

Q9. In the Men's T20 World Cup 2026 final at Ahmedabad, India won by 96 runs against:

(a) England
(b) South Africa
(c) Australia
(d) New Zealand

Q10. India's three Men's T20 World Cup titles came in:

(a) 2007, 2014, 2026
(b) 2007, 2024, 2026
(c) 2011, 2024, 2026
(d) 2007, 2016, 2026

Q11. Who was Player of the Match in the Men's T20 World Cup 2026 final?

(a) Suryakumar Yadav
(b) Hardik Pandya
(c) Jasprit Bumrah
(d) Abhishek Sharma

Q12. India's maiden Women's ODI World Cup title (2 Nov 2025) was won at:

(a) Eden Gardens, Kolkata
(b) DY Patil Stadium, Navi Mumbai
(c) Narendra Modi Stadium, Ahmedabad
(d) M.A. Chidambaram Stadium, Chennai

Q13. Which team won IPL 2026, retaining its title?

(a) Gujarat Titans
(b) Punjab Kings
(c) Mumbai Indians
(d) Royal Challengers Bengaluru

Q14. Which team won the ICC Women's T20 World Cup 2026, with the final at Lord's?

(a) England
(b) India
(c) Australia
(d) New Zealand

Q15. The FIFA World Cup 2026 was won by:

(a) Argentina
(b) France
(c) Brazil
(d) Spain

Q16. The FIFA World Cup 2026 final was played at:

(a) Rose Bowl, Pasadena
(b) MetLife Stadium, New Jersey
(c) Estadio Azteca, Mexico City
(d) AT&T Stadium, Dallas

Q17. The FIFA World Cup 2030 will be co-hosted mainly by:

(a) Morocco, Spain and Portugal
(b) Saudi Arabia
(c) USA, Canada and Mexico
(d) Argentina, Uruguay and Paraguay only

Q18. The 2026 Commonwealth Games were held in:

(a) Birmingham
(b) Glasgow
(c) Victoria
(d) Gold Coast

Q19. India's medal tally at the 2026 Commonwealth Games was:

(a) 39 medals, 13 gold
(b) 61 medals, 22 gold
(c) 39 medals, 17 gold
(d) 26 medals, 9 gold

Q20. Who won India's first-ever Commonwealth Games medal in the decathlon (bronze, 2026)?

(a) Tejaswin Shankar
(b) Gulveer Singh
(c) Murali Sreeshankar
(d) Praveen Chithravel

Q21. The 20th Asian Games (2026) are being hosted by:

(a) Hangzhou
(b) Doha
(c) Riyadh
(d) Aichi-Nagoya

Q22. The hosts of the 2030 and 2034 Asian Games, respectively, are:

(a) Doha and Riyadh
(b) Riyadh and Doha
(c) Jakarta and Doha
(d) Doha and Tashkent

Q23. Which country topped the medal table at the Milano-Cortina 2026 Winter Olympics?

(a) USA
(b) Germany
(c) Norway
(d) Italy

Q24. Which country topped the medal table at the 2026 Winter Paralympics?

(a) USA
(b) Ukraine
(c) Canada
(d) China

Q25. Which country won the Open section gold at the 46th Chess Olympiad (Samarkand, 2026)?

(a) India
(b) Uzbekistan
(c) USA
(d) China

Q26. Who won the Candidates Tournament 2026 to challenge D Gukesh for the world title?

(a) Fabiano Caruana
(b) Hikaru Nakamura
(c) Javokhir Sindarov
(d) R Praggnanandhaa

Q27. Which Indian won the Women's Candidates Tournament 2026?

(a) Koneru Humpy
(b) Divya Deshmukh
(c) Harika Dronavalli
(d) R Vaishali

Q28. D Gukesh became world chess champion in Dec 2024 by defeating:

(a) Ian Nepomniachtchi
(b) Ding Liren
(c) Magnus Carlsen
(d) Fabiano Caruana

Q29. Who won the Australian Open 2026 men's singles title, completing a career Grand Slam?

(a) Jannik Sinner
(b) Novak Djokovic
(c) Carlos Alcaraz
(d) Alexander Zverev

Q30. Alexander Zverev won his first Grand Slam title at:

(a) Australian Open 2026
(b) French Open 2026
(c) Wimbledon 2026
(d) US Open 2026

Q31. Who won the Wimbledon 2026 women's singles title?

(a) Linda Nosková
(b) Karolína Muchová
(c) Iga Świątek
(d) Coco Gauff

Q32. Which team won the FIH Men's Hockey World Cup 2026?

(a) Netherlands
(b) Belgium
(c) Spain
(d) Germany

Q33. Khelo Bharat Niti 2025 replaces:

(a) National Sports Policy 1984
(b) National Sports Policy 2001
(c) National Sports Development Code 2011
(d) the Khelo India scheme (2017)

Q34. Which pair is incorrectly matched?

(a) Beighton Cup - Hockey
(b) Durand Cup - Football
(c) Ezra Cup - Golf
(d) Uber Cup - Badminton

Q35. Which body-headquarters pair is incorrect?

(a) ICC - Dubai
(b) FIFA - Zurich
(c) World Athletics - Monaco
(d) FIDE - Moscow

Q36. Consider these statements about the Glasgow 2026 Commonwealth Games:

1. Hockey, wrestling, badminton and cricket were not on the programme.
2. India topped the boxing medal table.
3. Mirabai Chanu won her third consecutive CWG gold.

Which are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q37. Which of the following was NOT a "first" for the FIFA World Cup 2026?

(a) First World Cup with 48 teams
(b) First World Cup with three host nations
(c) First World Cup held in North America
(d) First World Cup with 104 matches

PRACTICE 10

Reports and Indices

Q1. In the UNDP Human Development Report 2025, India's HDI rank was:

(a) 130th
(b) 134th
(c) 126th
(d) 133rd

Q2. The income component of the HDI is measured by:

(a) nominal GDP per capita
(b) NNP at factor cost
(c) GNI per capita (PPP)
(d) household disposable income

Q3. The World Happiness Report is published by:

(a) UNDP
(b) WHO
(c) Gallup alone
(d) UN SDSN, with Gallup and the Oxford Wellbeing Research Centre

Q4. In the Corruption Perceptions Index 2025 (published Feb 2026), India's rank and score were:

(a) 96th, 38
(b) 93rd, 39
(c) 91st, 39
(d) 85th, 40

Q5. The Corruption Perceptions Index is published by:

(a) Transparency International
(b) World Bank
(c) UNODC
(d) Freedom House

Q6. India's rank in the Global Hunger Index 2025 was:

(a) 105th of 127
(b) 111th of 125
(c) 107th of 121
(d) 102nd of 123

Q7. The Global Hunger Index is published by:

(a) FAO and WFP
(b) Concern Worldwide and Welthungerhilfe
(c) UNICEF and WHO
(d) IFPRI alone

Q8. Which of these is NOT an indicator of the Global Hunger Index?

(a) Undernourishment
(b) Child stunting
(c) Adult obesity
(d) Child mortality

Q9. The Global Gender Gap Report is published by:

(a) UN Women
(b) UNDP
(c) World Bank
(d) World Economic Forum

Q10. The World Press Freedom Index is released by:

(a) UNESCO
(b) Freedom House
(c) Reporters Without Borders
(d) Committee to Protect Journalists

Q11. In the Henley Passport Index 2026, India's passport ranked:

(a) 85th
(b) 77th
(c) 80th
(d) 59th

Q12. The Global Peace Index and the Global Terrorism Index are both published by:

(a) SIPRI
(b) Institute for Economics & Peace
(c) UNODC
(d) Economist Intelligence Unit

Q13. India's rank in WIPO's Global Innovation Index 2025 was:

(a) 38th
(b) 39th
(c) 40th
(d) 81st

Q14. In the Sustainable Development Report 2025 (SDSN), India's SDG Index rank was:

(a) 109th
(b) 112th
(c) 101st
(d) 99th

Q15. The SDG India Index is published by:

(a) MoSPI
(b) NITI Aayog
(c) UNDP India
(d) RBI

Q16. In the Environmental Performance Index 2026, India ranked:

(a) 176th of 177
(b) 180th of 180
(c) 168th of 180
(d) 150th of 177

Q17. The Environmental Performance Index is published by:

(a) UNEP
(b) WEF
(c) Germanwatch
(d) Yale and Columbia universities

Q18. In the Climate Change Performance Index 2026, India ranked:

(a) 10th
(b) 7th
(c) 23rd
(d) 4th

Q19. Which organisation publishes both the CCPI and the Climate Risk Index?

(a) Germanwatch
(b) WWF
(c) UNEP
(d) World Resources Institute

Q20. The Economic Survey 2025-26 was prepared by:

(a) NITI Aayog
(b) RBI
(c) Economic Division of DEA, under the CEA
(d) Central Statistics Office

Q21. The base year of the new Consumer Price Index series (Feb 2026) is:

(a) 2022-23
(b) 2024
(c) 2012
(d) 2023-24

Q22. The base year of India's new GDP series (released 27 Feb 2026) is:

(a) 2017-18
(b) 2020-21
(c) 2023-24
(d) 2022-23

Q23. The Financial Stability Report is published:

(a) quarterly by SEBI
(b) half-yearly by the RBI
(c) annually by the Finance Ministry
(d) monthly by the NSO

Q24. In the RBI's Financial Inclusion Index, the parameter with the highest weight is:

(a) Access
(b) Quality
(c) Usage
(d) Literacy

Q25. The RBI Financial Inclusion Index for March 2026 stood at:

(a) 64.2
(b) 67.0
(c) 60.1
(d) 70.0

Q26. The World Bank's B-READY report replaced:

(a) Doing Business
(b) Logistics Performance Index
(c) Human Capital Index
(d) World Competitiveness Ranking

PRACTICE 11

Appointments & Institutions

Q1. Dr Justice Pushpendra Singh Bhati took oath as Chief Justice of the High Court of J&K and Ladakh on 9 September 2026. Who administered the oath?

(a) CJI Surya Kant
(b) LG Manoj Sinha
(c) Vinai Kumar Saxena, LG of Ladakh holding additional charge of J&K
(d) President Droupadi Murmu

Q2. Before his elevation to the Supreme Court in June 2026, Justice Arun Palli was the Chief Justice of which High Court?

(a) Punjab and Haryana
(b) Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh
(c) Bombay
(d) Madhya Pradesh

Q3. Under which Article does the President appoint an Acting Chief Justice of a High Court?

(a) Article 217
(b) Article 219
(c) Article 231
(d) Article 223

Q4. Vinai Kumar Saxena, sworn in on 13 March 2026, is the ___ Lieutenant Governor of Ladakh.

(a) 4th
(b) 3rd
(c) 5th
(d) 2nd

Q5. Who took charge as Chief Secretary of Ladakh on 1 January 2026?

(a) Atal Dulloo
(b) Ashish Kundra
(c) Anurag Jain
(d) Vikas Kundal

Q6. Consider the following statements about the J&K Public Service Commission:

1. Chairperson Arun Kumar Choudhary retired in August 2026 on reaching the age of 62.
2. A member of a State PSC can be removed by the Governor after an inquiry by the High Court.
3. Article 316(1A) allows a member to perform the Chairman's duties while the post is vacant.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q7. Who is the Chairman of the J&K Services Selection Board, the body that conducts the FAA examination?

(a) Indu Kanwal Chib
(b) Dr Farooq Ahmad Lone
(c) Arun Kumar Choudhary
(d) Vikas Kundal

Q8. The appointment of the Chairman of J&K Bank needs the approval of the RBI under:

(a) Section 35B of the Banking Regulation Act, 1949
(b) Section 45ZB of the RBI Act, 1934
(c) Section 132 of the Companies Act, 2013
(d) Section 4A of the DSPE Act, 1946

Q9. Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai, who earlier chaired the J&K Delimitation Commission, now heads the:

(a) 16th Finance Commission
(b) 23rd Law Commission
(c) 8th Central Pay Commission
(d) National Human Rights Commission

Q10. Who was the first Lieutenant Governor of the UT of J&K and later the 14th CAG of India?

(a) Girish Chandra Murmu
(b) R.K. Mathur
(c) Satya Pal Malik
(d) N.N. Vohra

Q11. In September 2025, Attorney General R. Venkataramani was re-appointed for a further term of:

(a) 1 year
(b) 3 years
(c) 5 years
(d) 2 years

Q12. Which of the following is NOT true of the Attorney General of India?

(a) He is appointed by the President under Article 76.
(b) He can speak in either House of Parliament.
(c) He can vote in the House whose proceedings he attends.
(d) He holds office during the pleasure of the President.

Q13. Justice Surya Kant became the 53rd Chief Justice of India on 24 November 2025. He succeeded:

(a) Sanjiv Khanna
(b) D.Y. Chandrachud
(c) Vikram Nath
(d) B.R. Gavai

Q14. Under the CEC and Other ECs (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, 2023, the Selection Committee consists of:

(a) the PM, the LoP in the Lok Sabha and the CJI
(b) the PM, the Home Minister and the LoP in the Lok Sabha
(c) the President, the PM and the CJI
(d) the PM, a Union Cabinet Minister nominated by the PM, and the LoP in the Lok Sabha

Q15. Consider the following statements:

1. The Chief Election Commissioner can be removed only in the manner of a Supreme Court judge.
2. An Election Commissioner can be removed only on the recommendation of the CEC.
3. Under the 2023 Act, the CEC holds office for 6 years or until the age of 65, whichever is earlier.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q16. T.C.A. Kalyani took charge on 1 September 2025 as:

(a) the 15th CAG of India
(b) the 29th Controller General of Accounts
(c) the Chief Economic Adviser
(d) Deputy CAG (Commercial)

Q17. Under Article 150, the form in which the accounts of the Union and the States are kept is prescribed by:

(a) the CAG alone
(b) Parliament by law
(c) the President, on the advice of the CAG
(d) the Union Finance Minister

Q18. Which statement about the Controller General of Accounts is correct?

(a) It is a constitutional authority under Article 148.
(b) It works under the Department of Expenditure, Ministry of Finance.
(c) It is appointed by Parliament.
(d) It audits the accounts of the Union Government.

Q19. Rohit Jain, notified as RBI Deputy Governor in May 2026, succeeded:

(a) M. Rajeshwar Rao
(b) Michael D. Patra
(c) T. Rabi Sankar
(d) Swaminathan J

Q20. The RBI Act, 1934 allows a maximum of how many Deputy Governors?

(a) 2
(b) 3
(c) 5
(d) 4

Q21. Who was appointed Vice-Chairperson of NITI Aayog on 25 April 2026?

(a) Suman K. Bery
(b) Ashok Kumar Lahiri
(c) Anurag Jain
(d) Arvind Panagariya

Q22. Match the posts with their selection committees:

List I: A. Central Vigilance Commissioner · B. Chief Information Commissioner · C. CBI Director

List II: 1. PM, LoP in the Lok Sabha, and the CJI (or an SC judge he nominates) · 2. PM, Union Home Minister and LoP in the Lok Sabha · 3. PM, LoP in the Lok Sabha, and a Union Cabinet Minister nominated by the PM

(a) A-2, B-3, C-1
(b) A-3, B-2, C-1
(c) A-1, B-3, C-2
(d) A-2, B-1, C-3

Q23. Barham Salih, former President of Iraq, took office on 1 January 2026 as head of:

(a) OHCHR
(b) the UN Human Rights Council
(c) IOM
(d) UNHCR

Q24. Who replaced Gita Gopinath as First Deputy Managing Director of the IMF on 1 October 2025?

(a) Dan Katz
(b) Urjit Patel
(c) Kenji Okamura
(d) Krishna Srinivasan

PRACTICE 12

Books & Authors

Q1. *Journal of the Waypoints*, released by LG Manoj Sinha on 17 September 2026, presents in English the Kashmiri poetry of:

(a) Rahman Rahi
(b) Prof. Shafi Shauq
(c) Ali Shaida
(d) Dr Satish Vimal

Q2. *History of Kashmiri Language and Poetry*, released at Lok Bhavan in September 2026 in an English translation by Umar Shah, was originally written by:

(a) Abdul Ahad Azad
(b) Ghulam Ahmad Mahjoor
(c) Dina Nath Nadim
(d) G.M.D. Sufi

Q3. *Sardar Patel and Kashmir: The Untold History*, launched by LG Sinha on 22 September 2026, was edited by:

(a) A.S. Dulat
(b) Dr Karan Singh
(c) Dr Rizwan Kadri
(d) Rahul Pandita

Q4. The Sahitya Akademi Award 2025 for Kashmiri went to:

(a) Khajur Singh Thakur
(b) Pritpal Singh Betab
(c) Saiqa Sehar
(d) Ali Shaida

Q5. Khajur Singh Thakur of Kathua won the Sahitya Akademi Award 2025 (Dogri) for:

(a) *Safar Jaari Hai*
(b) *Crimson Spring*
(c) *Thakur Satsayie*
(d) *Jeete Jee Allahabad*

Q6. The 3rd Chinar Book Festival (18-26 July 2026) was held at:

(a) SKICC, Srinagar
(b) University of Jammu
(c) Abhinav Theatre, Jammu
(d) Kashmir Haat, Srinagar

Q7. The Chinar Book Festival is organised by the National Book Trust, which works under the:

(a) Ministry of Culture
(b) Ministry of Information and Broadcasting
(c) Ministry of Education
(d) Ministry of Home Affairs

Q8. The tagline of the Chinar Book Festival 2026 was:

(a) Read India, Lead India
(b) Books for Peace
(c) Ek Bharat, Shreshtha Bharat
(d) Together We Read, Together We Lead

Q9. *When the Heart Speaks*, whose second edition CM Omar Abdullah launched in August 2026, is the autobiography of:

(a) Dr Upendra Kaul
(b) Dr Farooq Abdullah
(c) Prof. Shafi Shauq
(d) Dr Jitendra Singh

Q10. *The Bench, the Bar and the Bizarre* and *The Lawful and the Awful* were written by:

(a) Tushar Mehta
(b) R. Venkataramani
(c) Kapil Sibal
(d) Harish Salve

Q11. *Cashless Nation: How UPI Changed Everything* (2026) was written by:

(a) Nandan Nilekani and Viral Shah
(b) Dilip Asbe and Pramod Varma
(c) D. Subbarao
(d) Santanu Paul and B. Sambamurthy

Q12. UPI, the subject of *Cashless Nation*, was launched in 2016 and is operated by:

(a) the RBI's Department of Payment and Settlement Systems
(b) the National Payments Corporation of India
(c) IDRBT, Hyderabad
(d) the Ministry of Electronics and IT

Q13. *Operational Risk Management - A Practical Guide to Urban Co-operative Banks*, released by Amit Shah on 8 August 2026, was written by:

(a) G.P. Mistry, a former Deputy General Manager of the RBI
(b) Swaminathan J, RBI Deputy Governor
(c) Amit Shah
(d) a committee of NABARD

Q14. Consider the following statements about the event of 8 August 2026 in Mumbai:

1. The book was released at the "Sahakar Nav-Kranti" programme.
2. A Security Operations Centre for the cyber security of urban co-operative banks was launched.
3. Urban co-operative banks are regulated only by State Registrars of Co-operative Societies and not by the RBI.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 2 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q15. In banking regulation, "operational risk" refers to the risk of loss arising from:

(a) changes in interest rates
(b) borrowers failing to repay
(c) inadequate or failed internal processes, people and systems, or external events
(d) exchange-rate movements

Q16. *The Problem of the Rupee: Its Origin and Its Solution* (1923) was written by:

(a) Dadabhai Naoroji
(b) R.C. Dutt
(c) M.G. Ranade
(d) B.R. Ambedkar

Q17. Which of the following pairs is correctly matched?

(a) *Overdraft: Saving the Indian Saver* - Urjit Patel
(b) *Advice and Dissent* - D. Subbarao
(c) *Fault Lines* - Viral Acharya
(d) *Backstage* - Bimal Jalan

Q18. Four Stars of Destiny is the memoir of which former Army Chief?

(a) Gen M.M. Naravane
(b) Lt Gen K.J.S. Dhillon
(c) Lt Gen Syed Ata Hasnain
(d) Gen V.K. Singh

Q19. *Kitne Ghazi Aaye, Kitne Ghazi Gaye* and *Operation SINDOOR* (2025) are books by:

(a) Gen V.K. Singh
(b) Lt Gen K.J.S. "Tiny" Dhillon
(c) Lt Gen Syed Ata Hasnain
(d) Gen Bipin Rawat

Q20. The theme of the New Delhi World Book Fair 2026 was:

(a) Indian Knowledge Traditions
(b) Republic @ 75
(c) Indian Military History: Valour & Wisdom @ 75
(d) Viksit Bharat @ 2047

Q21. At the New Delhi World Book Fair 2026, the Guest of Honour country and the Focus Country were, respectively:

(a) Spain and Qatar
(b) Qatar and Spain
(c) Saudi Arabia and France
(d) UAE and Japan

Q22. Which city is UNESCO's World Book Capital for 2026?

(a) Rio de Janeiro
(b) Strasbourg
(c) Rabat
(d) Medellín

Q23. The Booker Prize 2025 was won by:

(a) Kiran Desai for *The Loneliness of Sonia and Sunny*
(b) David Szalay for *Flesh*
(c) Andrew Miller for *The Land in Winter*
(d) Katie Kitamura for *Audition*

Q24. Match the books with their authors:

List I: 1. *Rajatarangini* · 2. *The Valley of Kashmir* · 3. *My Frozen Turbulence in Kashmir* · 4. *Aatish-e-Chinar*

List II: A. Walter Lawrence · B. Sheikh Mohammad Abdullah · C. Kalhana · D. Jagmohan

(a) 1-A, 2-C, 3-D, 4-B
(b) 1-C, 2-D, 3-A, 4-B
(c) 1-B, 2-A, 3-C, 4-D
(d) 1-C, 2-A, 3-D, 4-B

PRACTICE 13

Important Days & Themes

Q1. Which of the following was **not** a gazetted holiday in the J&K holiday list for 2026?

(a) 23 September
(b) 26 October
(c) 21 March (Nauroz)
(d) 13 July

Q2. In the J&K holiday list for 2026, Mela Khir Bhawani is listed as a:

(a) Kashmir provincial holiday
(b) UT-wide holiday under Annexure-A
(c) Jammu provincial holiday
(d) Restricted holiday

Q3. Infantry Day (27 October) commemorates the landing at Srinagar airfield in 1947 of:

(a) 1st Battalion, Kumaon Regiment
(b) 1st Battalion, Sikh Regiment
(c) 4th Battalion, Kumaon Regiment
(d) 2nd Battalion, Dogra Regiment

Q4. The birthday of Maharaja Hari Singh (23 September) has been a public holiday in J&K since:

(a) 2020
(b) 2021
(c) 2022
(d) 2023

Q5. Police Commemoration Day (21 October) recalls the 1959 ambush of policemen by Chinese troops at:

(a) Galwan
(b) Hot Springs, Ladakh
(c) Chushul
(d) Daulat Beg Oldi

Q6. On Constitution Day 2025, the Constitution of India was released in nine languages. Which of the following was one of them?

(a) Dogri
(b) Urdu
(c) Kashmiri
(d) Gojri

Q7. Audit Diwas is observed on 16 November because on that date in 1860:

(a) the CAG (DPC) Act was passed
(b) the Indian Audit and Accounts Service was created
(c) the first Auditor General, Sir Edward Drummond, took charge
(d) income tax was introduced

Q8. Consider the following statements about Civil Accounts Day 2026:

1. It was the 50th Civil Accounts Day.
2. The Indian Civil Accounts Service was created in 1976, when accounting was separated from audit in the Union Government.
3. The Indian Civil Accounts Service works under the Comptroller and Auditor General of India.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q9. The theme of the 20th Statistics Day (29 June 2026) was:

(a) Use of Data for Decision Making
(b) Unlocking the Potential of Administrative Data
(c) Driving change with quality statistics and data for everyone
(d) Statistics for Sustainable Development

Q10. World Statistics Day is observed:

(a) every year on 20 October
(b) every five years on 20 October
(c) every year on 29 June
(d) every five years on 29 June

Q11. On 24 July 2026, the Income Tax Department celebrated the:

(a) 165th Income Tax Day
(b) 166th Income Tax Day
(c) 167th Income Tax Day
(d) 168th Income Tax Day

Q12. Income tax was first introduced in India in 1860 by:

(a) James Wilson
(b) Lord Canning
(c) Richard Temple
(d) Samuel Laing

Q13. India observes World Savings Day on:

(a) 31 October
(b) 30 October
(c) 1 November
(d) 24 October

Q14. NABARD, which celebrated its 45th Foundation Day in July 2026, was set up on the recommendation of the:

(a) Narasimham Committee
(b) Gorwala Committee
(c) CRAFICARD (Sivaraman) Committee
(d) Hilton Young Commission

Q15. The theme of the UN International Day of Cooperatives 2026 (4 July) was:

(a) Cooperatives Build a Better World
(b) Cooperatives for Climate Action
(c) Cooperatives: Partners for Accelerated Sustainable Development
(d) Cooperatives for a peaceful world

Q16. Who were the chief guests at the Republic Day Parade 2026?

(a) António Costa and Ursula von der Leyen
(b) Emmanuel Macron and Olaf Scholz
(c) Prabowo Subianto
(d) Ursula von der Leyen and Roberta Metsola

Q17. What was the theme of Republic Day 2026?

(a) Viksit Bharat
(b) 150 Years of Vande Mataram
(c) Swarnim Bharat: Virasat aur Vikas
(d) Nari Shakti

Q18. What was the theme of the 16th National Voters' Day (25 January 2026)?

(a) Nothing Like Voting, I Vote for Sure
(b) My India, My Vote: Citizen at the Heart of Indian Democracy
(c) Making Elections Inclusive and Accessible
(d) Voting is My Right

Q19. Consider the following statements about Ayurveda Day:

1. From 2025, it is observed on a fixed date, 23 September.
2. Earlier, it was observed on Dhanvantari Jayanti (Dhanteras).
3. 23 September is also the birthday of Maharaja Hari Singh, a public holiday in J&K.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q20. What was the theme of the 12th International Day of Yoga (21 June 2026)?

(a) Yoga for One Earth, One Health
(b) Yoga for Self and Society
(c) Yoga for Humanity
(d) Yoga for Healthy Ageing

Q21. Which country hosted the global celebration of World Environment Day 2026?

(a) Republic of Korea
(b) Saudi Arabia
(c) Côte d'Ivoire
(d) Azerbaijan

Q22. What was the theme of World Water Day 2026?

(a) Glacier Preservation
(b) Water and Gender
(c) Leveraging Water for Peace
(d) Groundwater: Making the Invisible Visible

Q23. What was the **UN** theme for International Women's Day 2026?

(a) Give To Gain
(b) Accelerate Action
(c) Rights. Justice. Action. For ALL Women and Girls
(d) Invest in Women: Accelerate Progress

Q24. Which of the following is **not** an International Year declared by the UN for 2026?

(a) Rangelands and Pastoralists
(b) the Woman Farmer
(c) Volunteers for Sustainable Development
(d) Cooperatives

PRACTICE 14

People & Their Contributions

Q1. Col Sonam Wangchuk of the Ladakh Scouts led the capture of which feature in the Batalik sector in 1999?

(a) Chorbat La
(b) Tiger Hill
(c) Tololing
(d) Point 4875

Q2. Phunchok Stobdan, the Ladakhi diplomat and strategic-affairs expert, served as India's Ambassador to which country?

(a) Kazakhstan
(b) Kyrgyzstan
(c) Mongolia
(d) Tajikistan

Q3. Maj Gen Sunil Kumar Razdan is associated with which gallantry award?

(a) Kirti Chakra
(b) Ashoka Chakra
(c) Shaurya Chakra
(d) Maha Vir Chakra

Q4. Consider the following statements about Shivraj Patil:

1. He was Speaker of the Lok Sabha from 1991 to 1996.
2. He served as Governor of Punjab and Administrator of Chandigarh.
3. He was a member of the Lok Sabha when he became Union Home Minister in 2004.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q5. Dhanendra Kumar was the first full-time Chairperson of which regulatory institution?

(a) SEBI
(b) IRDAI
(c) the Competition Commission of India
(d) PFRDA

Q6. Consider the following statements about the Competition Commission of India:

1. It was established under the Competition Act, 2002, which replaced the MRTP Act, 1969.
2. Appeals against its orders now lie with the National Company Law Appellate Tribunal.
3. The Competition (Amendment) Act, 2023 introduced a deal-value threshold of ₹2,000 crore for combinations.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q7. The Hinduja Group is the promoter of which bank?

(a) Yes Bank
(b) IndusInd Bank
(c) RBL Bank
(d) Bandhan Bank

Q8. Simone Tata is credited with building which cosmetics brand?

(a) Titan
(b) Tanishq
(c) Lakmé
(d) Taj Hotels

Q9. Madhav Gadgil chaired which panel on the Western Ghats?

(a) High-Level Working Group on the Western Ghats (2013)
(b) Western Ghats Ecology Expert Panel (2010-11)
(c) National Biodiversity Authority
(d) National Board for Wildlife

Q10. François Englert shared the 2013 Nobel Prize in Physics with whom?

(a) Peter Higgs
(b) Stephen Hawking
(c) Roger Penrose
(d) Kip Thorne

Q11. James Watson shared the 1962 Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine with whom?

(a) Rosalind Franklin and Linus Pauling
(b) Francis Crick and Rosalind Franklin
(c) Francis Crick and Maurice Wilkins
(d) Maurice Wilkins and Erwin Chargaff

Q12. Ram V. Sutar is associated with the design of which statue?

(a) the Statue of Equality, Hyderabad
(b) the Statue of Belief, Nathdwara
(c) the Thiruvalluvar Statue, Kanyakumari
(d) the Statue of Unity, Ekta Nagar

PRACTICE 15

Places, Terms & Static Connections

Q1. The Buddhist complex at Zehanpora (also spelt Jehanpora), discussed in the 129th episode of *Mann Ki Baat*, is in which district?

(a) Ganderbal
(b) Baramulla
(c) Anantnag
(d) Kulgam

Q2. Mudh-Nyoma Air Force Station is located in:

(a) Jammu division
(b) the Kashmir Valley
(c) Himachal Pradesh
(d) eastern Ladakh

Q3. The Tulbul Navigation Project is associated with:

(a) Chenab at Salal
(b) Tawi at Jammu
(c) Jhelum at Wular Lake
(d) Indus at Leh

Q4. The IMD's commonly used cloudburst threshold is rainfall of at least:

(a) 100 mm in one hour over a small area
(b) 100 mm in one day over a State
(c) 50 mm in one week
(d) 200 mm in one month

Q5. Srinagar's Indira Gandhi Memorial Tulip Garden lies at the foothills of the:

(a) Pir Panjal range
(b) Karakoram range
(c) Ladakh range
(d) Zabarwan range

Q6. Shinku La connects which two regions?

(a) Kashmir and Kargil
(b) Lahaul and Zanskar
(c) Jammu and the Kashmir Valley
(d) Leh and Nubra

Q7. Consider these pairs:

1. Zoji La - Kashmir to Drass
2. Khardung La - Leh to Nubra
3. Chang La - Leh to Pangong

How many are correctly matched?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None

Q8. A Special Rupee Vostro Account is best described as:

(a) a dollar account opened by an Indian bank abroad
(b) a personal savings account for an NRI
(c) a cryptocurrency wallet issued by NPCI
(d) a rupee account opened by a foreign bank with an Indian authorised-dealer bank

Q9. Which feature distinguishes the Standing Deposit Facility from the conventional fixed-rate reverse repo?

(a) It lends money to the government
(b) It absorbs liquidity without collateral
(c) It is administered by SEBI
(d) It can be used only by State governments

Q10. Primary deficit equals:

(a) revenue deficit minus capital expenditure
(b) fiscal deficit minus interest payments
(c) fiscal deficit plus interest payments
(d) revenue receipts minus revenue expenditure

Q11. The Consolidated Fund of India is provided for under:

(a) Article 266(1)
(b) Article 267(1)
(c) Article 280
(d) Article 279A

Q12. Which statement about charged expenditure is correct?

(a) It cannot be discussed in Parliament
(b) All Union ministries' salaries are charged expenditure
(c) The CAG's salary is charged on the Consolidated Fund of India and is not put to vote
(d) High Court judges' salaries are charged on the Consolidated Fund of India

Q13. Consider these parliamentary committee pairs:

1. Public Accounts Committee - 22 members, including 7 from the Rajya Sabha
2. Estimates Committee - 30 members, all from the Lok Sabha
3. Committee on Public Undertakings - 22 members, including 7 from the Rajya Sabha

Which are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q14. Alternative Investment Funds, REITs and InvITs are regulated primarily by:

(a) RBI
(b) IBBI
(c) SEBI
(d) PFRDA

Q15. Under the RBI's revised norms applicable from FY 2025-26, the overall priority-sector lending target for Small Finance Banks is:

(a) 40%
(b) 60%
(c) 75%
(d) 90%

Q16. The Ken-Betwa river-linking project is principally associated with:

(a) Madhya Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh
(b) Punjab and Haryana
(c) Odisha and Andhra Pradesh
(d) Maharashtra and Karnataka

Q17. The new Pamban railway bridge connects the mainland with Rameswaram in:

(a) Kerala
(b) Andhra Pradesh
(c) Gujarat
(d) Tamil Nadu

Q18. Mount Kilimanjaro is located in:

(a) Kenya
(b) Uganda
(c) Ethiopia
(d) Tanzania

Q19. Which of the following is **not** a Ramsar site in J&K?

(a) Wular Lake
(b) Hokersar
(c) Dal Lake
(d) Surinsar-Mansar Lakes

Q20. The statement that negotiations for a free-trade agreement have been "concluded" means:

(a) negotiations are completed, but signature, ratification and entry into force must be checked separately
(b) the agreement automatically enters into force the same day
(c) the partner becomes a member of India's customs union
(d) all tariffs immediately become zero without exceptions

Q21. Consider these regulator/body pairs:

1. e₹ (CBDC) - RBI
2. B-READY - World Bank
3. Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism - European Union

Which are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Q22. The GST Council is established under:

(a) Article 279A
(b) Article 280
(c) Article 300A
(d) Article 267

Answers & explanations

01 Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh

Q	Answer	Explanation
1	B	The resolution is non-binding. Statehood requires parliamentary legislation under Articles 3-4 and changes to the J&K Reorganisation Act.
2	B	Maharaja Ranbir Singh started the Darbar Move in 1872; it resumed in November 2025.
3	C	Changthang headquarters is Nyoma, not Hanle; Nubra-Diskit, Sham-Khaltse and Zanskar-Padum are correct.
4	D	The regulations provide the 85% jobs reservation, 15-year residence condition, one-third women's Hill Council seats, and official-language recognition of Bhoti and Purgi.
5	A	Zojila connects Sonamarg to Drass/Kargil; the tunnel inaugurated in January 2025 was Z-Morh.
6	D	Chenab is an arch bridge; Anji Khad is the first cable-stayed railway bridge. Both are in Reasi.
7	B	Pakal Dul is on the Marusudar, a Chenab tributary, in Kishtwar.
8	B	Sawalkote lies between Baglihar upstream and Salal downstream, in Ramban/Udhampur.
9	A	The 1960 treaty had World Bank involvement. Chenab is a western river allocated to Pakistan, with limited permitted Indian use.
10	C	Brij Lal Bhat received the award for Social Work; Shafi Shauq for Literature and Education; Padma Gurmet for Medicine.
11	B	Khajur Singh Thakur won the Dogri award for Thakur Satsayie.
12	C	Ali Shaida's Najdavanek'y Pot Aalav is Kashmiri poetry.
13	C	The explicitly dated 2025 census count was 323 hangul, reported in January 2026.
14	D	Hangul is J&K's state animal, largely confined to Dachigam in the Zabarwan range, and protected under Schedule I.
15	C	Karnataka was J&K's final opponent. J&K secured its first title on first-innings lead.
16	A	The sixth edition used Leh for ice sports and Gulmarg for snow sports; the Indian Army was overall champion.
17	B	Mithun Manhas became the 37th BCCI President, succeeding Roger Binny.
18	D	Omar Abdullah held Finance; the net Budget Estimate was ₹1,13,767 crore and the fiscal deficit 4.6% of GSDP.
19	C	The tertiary sector had the largest share, at 61.02%.
20	A	RWBCIS was extended to apple, saffron, mango and litchi.
21	D	MUMKIN supports applicants aged 18-35 buying small commercial vehicles, with the lower of ₹80,000 or 10% of on-road price as subsidy.

Q	Answer	Explanation
22	B	The reference date is 1 October 2026 for the designated snow-bound areas, and 1 March 2027 for the rest of India.
23	B	Baltal is in Ganderbal; the Pahalgam-Chandanwari route is in Anantnag.
24	C	AB-PMJAY SEHAT provides ₹5 lakh health cover to all J&K residents.
25	A	HADP has an outlay of ₹5,013 crore and 29 projects.
26	A	Police and public order are reserved to the LG under the J&K Reorganisation Act, 2019.

02 National Affairs and Polity

Q	Answer	Explanation
1	C	Tamil Nadu-Vijay, Assam-Sarma and Puducherry-Rangasamy are correct. Kerala's Chief Minister is V.D. Satheesan.
2	B	Article 66 includes elected and nominated MPs, but not MLAs. Article 71 sends disputes to the Supreme Court.
3	C	C.P. Radhakrishnan was Governor of Maharashtra before becoming Vice-President.
4	B	The 2025 SIR began in Bihar.
5	D	The four qualifying dates are 1 January, 1 April, 1 July and 1 October, introduced by the 2021 amendment.
6	B	The 129th Amendment Bill proposes simultaneous elections, including insertion of Article 82A.
7	C	The Bill proposed a maximum of 850; a proposed strength must not be confused with the existing maximum.
8	B	Article 334A links commencement of reservation to delimitation based on the first census after commencement.
9	A	The resolution requires 14 days' notice and an effective majority. Article 96 allows the Speaker to vote in the first instance.
10	B	Article 143 provides the Supreme Court's advisory jurisdiction for a Presidential Reference.
11	B	The opinion rejected fixed court-imposed timelines and deemed assent, while allowing limited scrutiny of prolonged unexplained inaction.
12	C	Surya Kant is from Haryana and is the 53rd CJI.
13	C	A State-name change under Articles 3-4 requires a simple majority; it is not an Article 368 amendment.
14	B	Raj Niwas became Lok Niwas for LGs; Raj Bhavan became Lok Bhavan for Governors.
15	B	Seva Teerth houses the PMO, National Security Council Secretariat and Cabinet Secretariat.
16	C	Yumnam Khemchand Singh became Chief Minister when President's Rule was revoked.
17	B	Both the National Emergency condition and the Election Commission certificate are required. An Assembly resolution is not an extension condition.

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Q	Answer	Explanation
18	C	The Act recognises Amaravati as Andhra Pradesh's sole and permanent capital.
19	A	The caste-enumeration and snow-bound-date statements are correct. Census is Union List Entry 69, not a Concurrent List subject.
20	C	The guarantee is 125 days per rural household annually, replacing MGNREGA's 100-day guarantee.
21	B	The Foreigners Act, Passport Entry Act and Registration of Foreigners Act were consolidated; the Citizenship Act was not repealed.
22	B	SHANTI concerns licensed private participation in civil nuclear energy.
23	C	The prohibition covers online money games based on skill or chance; it does not ban all online games.
24	B	The Court stayed the five-years-practice requirement, while declining to stay the entire Act.
25	C	Mizoram was the first State under ULLAS; Ladakh was the first UT. Kerala's earlier declaration was a separate campaign.
26	A	Kerala, on Kerala Piravi Day.
27	C	The guests were António Costa of the European Council and Ursula von der Leyen of the European Commission.
28	D	Vande Mataram's composition and the births of Patel and Birsa date to 1875; Guru Tegh Bahadur's martyrdom dates to 1675.
29	A	Article 3: State-name alteration; Article 82: readjustment; Article 94: Speaker removal; Article 143: advisory jurisdiction.

03 Economy, Banking and Finance

Q	Answer	Explanation
1	B	The RBI policy repo rate in August 2026 was 5.25%.
2	B	The hold was unanimous and CPI inflation was projected at 5.0%; the stance remained neutral.
3	B	The June 2025 announcement cut CRR by 100 basis points, from 4% to 3%, implemented in phases.
4	B	Section 45ZA provides for Government notification in consultation with RBI; the retained period is April 2026-March 2031.
5	B	Section 45ZB constitutes the six-member Monetary Policy Committee.
6	B	Rohit Jain became an RBI Deputy Governor in May 2026.
7	B	The CPI consumption weights use HCES 2023-24.
8	C	The June 2026 Provisional Estimates give 7.7% on the new base; 7.4% was the Survey's earlier old-base estimate.
9	C	Q1 FY 2026-27 real GDP growth was 7.8%.
10	C	Borrowings and other liabilities are the largest component, at 24%.
11	B	States' share of taxes is the largest component, at 22%, followed by interest at 20%.

Q	Answer	Explanation
12	B	Biopharma SHAKTI has ₹10,000 crore over five years.
13	A	The corridors cover Odisha, Kerala, Andhra Pradesh and Tamil Nadu.
14	D	Merchandise share was 1.8%, below 5%; services trade was in surplus, so both statements are incorrect.
15	B	The Survey's FY 2026-27 growth projection is 6.8-7.2%.
16	A	Income distance has 42.5%, population 17.5%, and contribution to GDP and area each have 10%. The equal weights do not create an ordering distinction.
17	B	The recommendation is 41% of the divisible pool, unchanged from the 15th Commission.
18	C	Contribution to GDP is the new criterion, with 10% weight.
19	B	The removed slabs are 12% and 28%; the main slabs are 5% and 18%, alongside a special 40% rate.
20	A	The 2025 Act took effect in April 2026 and introduced tax-year terminology; it did not itself abolish the old regime.
21	C	Accounts allow up to four nominees; lockers and safe custody allow successive nominations only.
22	C	The insurer FDI limit rose from 74% to 100%.
23	D	EFTA comprises Switzerland, Norway, Iceland and Liechtenstein; Denmark is not included.
24	C	S&P upgraded India to BBB; Fitch's rating remained BBB-.
25	B	The Pulses Mission targets self-sufficiency by 2030-31.
26	B	PM Surya Sarovar concerns 5,000 MW of floating solar; PM Surya Ghar concerns rooftop solar.
27	B	CA Prasanna Kumar D is ICAI's 74th President for 2026-27.
28	C	Zou Jiayi heads the AIIB, headquartered in Beijing.

04 International Affairs

Q	Answer	Explanation
1	B	Hormuz connects the Persian Gulf and Gulf of Oman, with Musandam to the south; statement 3 describes a different strait.
2	B	Operation Sindhu evacuated Indians from Iran and Israel during the June 2025 conflict.
3	B	Operation Sagar Bandhu provided Sri Lanka relief after Cyclone Ditwah.
4	A	The New Delhi venue and declaration are correct. It was India's fourth chairship; Malaysia and Thailand are partners.
5	B	The final word is Sustainability; the five theme words form BRICS.
6	C	The 26th summit was at Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan; Tianjin hosted the 25th.
7	D	RATS is in Tashkent, Belarus joined as the tenth member, and India's Qingdao decision concerned omission of Pahalgam.

Q	Answer	Explanation
8	B	Johannesburg hosted the first G20 Leaders' Summit in Africa in 2025.
9	D	All correct. The 2026 summit is planned at Doral, Miami.
10	C	The Foreign Ministers' Meeting took place in New Delhi.
11	B	Shinzo Abe proposed the Quad in 2007. It is not a treaty-based military alliance, and India did not host a leaders' summit in 2025.
12	B	The 2026 venue was Evian-les-Bains, France.
13	C	Ankara, Türkiye, hosted NATO's 2026 summit.
14	B	Timor-Leste became ASEAN's eleventh member in October 2025.
15	B	Under Article 97, the Security Council recommends and the General Assembly appoints.
16	C	Khalilur Rahman of Bangladesh was elected for the 81st session; Baerbock headed the 80th.
17	C	Vanuatu led the UNGA initiative requesting the ICJ climate advisory opinion.
18	B	Sushila Karki was the first woman Prime Minister, in an interim role; Bhandari was the first woman President.
19	B	Min Aung Hlaing was elected President by Myanmar's Parliament.
20	C	Russia was the first country to recognise the Taliban government formally, in July 2025.
21	B	Resolution 2803 concerns Gaza, the Board of Peace and the International Stabilization Force.
22	B	António Costa and Ursula von der Leyen.
23	D	All three statements on flights, the yatra and the Medog dam are correct.
24	C	The Yarlung Tsangpo enters as the Siang, then becomes the Brahmaputra in Assam.
25	B	The upgrade announcement accompanied Amir Khan Muttaqi's October 2025 visit.
26	B	The 14th Ministerial Conference was held in Yaoundé, Cameroon.
27	C	Zimbabwe. She is the first woman and first African IOC President.
28	D	All three.

05 Science and Technology

Q	Answer	Explanation
1	B	India became the fourth country to achieve space docking, after the US, Russia and China.
2	B	SpaDeX used PSLV-C60 and the Chaser and Target satellites; its launch site was Sriharikota.
3	B	GSLV-F15 carrying NVS-02 marked Sriharikota's 100th launch.
4	B	PSLV-C61 and C62 failed at the third stage; GSLV-F17 was successful.
5	B	EOS-05/GISAT-1A is associated with imaging from geosynchronous orbit.

Q	Answer	Explanation
6	B	CMS-03 is the communication-satellite record; BlueBird Block-2 is the overall LVM3 payload record.
7	B	NISAR carries NASA's L-band and ISRO's S-band radar, and ISRO launched it on GSLV-F16.
8	B	Shukla was pilot of Axiom Mission 4.
9	A	Rakesh Sharma flew on Soyuz T-11 to Salyut-7 in 1984.
10	D	The designates are Nair, Krishnan, Pratap and Shukla; Rakesh Sharma is not one of the four.
11	B	BAS-1 has a 2028 target; the complete station has a 2035 target.
12	B	Vikram-1 is Skyroot Aerospace's orbital launcher.
13	B	Artemis II was a crewed lunar flyby without a landing.
14	C	Canada (CSA).
15	B	3I/ATLAS is the third known interstellar object, after 'Oumuamua and Borisov.
16	B	The venue was Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi.
17	B	Vikram 3201 is SCL Mohali's indigenous 32-bit space-grade processor.
18	B	The Tata-PSMC commercial fab is at Dholera; Sanand's milestone concerns packaging.
19	B	The Department of Science and Technology implements the National Quantum Mission.
20	C	The 500 MWe PFBR is at Kalpakkam, Tamil Nadu.
21	A	PFBR uses sodium, marks stage two and was built by BHAVINI, not NPCIL.
22	B	Hanle, Ladakh, became India's first Dark Sky Reserve in 2022.
23	B	MACE is at Hanle in Ladakh, at about 4,300 m.
24	B	ICAR released DRR Dhan 100 and Pusa DST Rice 1.
25	A	Physics: macroscopic quantum tunnelling; Chemistry: MOFs; Medicine: peripheral immune tolerance.
26	B	Tregs (peripheral immune tolerance).
27	A	GSI reported the inferred lithium resources in Reasi, J&K.

06 Environment and Ecology

Q	Answer	Explanation
1	A	Chillai Kalan is Kashmir's 40-day harshest winter phase, from 21 December to 29 January.
2	B	Western Disturbances bring winter rain and snow from weather systems originating over the Mediterranean.
3	D	SPAI 2024 estimated 477 snow leopards in Ladakh, out of 718 nationally; J&K had 9.
4	B	Statements 1 and 3 are correct. Tso Kar includes freshwater Startsapuk Tso and hypersaline Tso Kar; Dal is not a Ramsar site.

Q	Answer	Explanation
5	C	The NDMA programme covers 195 high-risk glacial lakes, including lakes in J&K and Ladakh.
6	A	2025 was the International Year of Glaciers' Preservation; 2026 is the year of Rangelands and Pastoralists.
7	D	Pang is the site of the 13 GW solar-and-wind project. Puga is associated with geothermal energy.
8	A	COP30's Global Mutirão decision takes its name from a term meaning collective community effort.
9	D	COP30 did not finalise the Paris Rulebook; that work was completed at COP24 and COP26.
10	A	The 2035 NDC target is a 47% reduction in GDP emissions intensity against the 2005 baseline.
11	B	Statements 2 and 3 are correct. The 60% target concerns installed capacity, not electricity generation.
12	B	Ordered in Jan 2025, it took effect on **27 Jan 2026**. 7 Jan 2026 was the UNFCCC-exit announcement.
13	D	UNEP's 2025 Emissions Gap Report was titled Off Target.
14	A	2015-2025 are the 11 warmest years. 2024 remains the warmest year.
15	C	IMD classifies rainfall below 90% of the Long Period Average as deficient; about 87% falls in that category.
16	A	Power Minister **Manohar Lal** launched it on **21 Mar 2026**.
17	C	BEE administers CCTS. Grid-India is the registry, while CERC regulates trading.
18	D	UNCCD COP17 was held in Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia, with the theme Restoring Land. Restoring Hope.
19	A	CITES CoP20 was held in Samarkand, Uzbekistan. CITES regulates international trade in wildlife.
20	C	The BBNJ Agreement entered into force on 17 January 2026; it concerns biodiversity beyond national jurisdiction.
21	D	Surha Tal, also called Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary, in Ballia, Uttar Pradesh, was the 100th site.
22	B	Glaw Lake lies within Kamlang Tiger Reserve in Arunachal Pradesh and became the state's first Ramsar site.
23	C	Sarnath was inscribed at the 48th World Heritage Committee session in Busan, Republic of Korea.
24	D	Chaukhandi Stupa + Archaeological Remains (Dhamek and Dharmarajika stupas). The Deer Park is also called Rishipatana, Isipatana or Mrigadava.
25	A	Cold Desert in Himachal Pradesh became India's 13th UNESCO-network biosphere reserve in September 2025.
26	B	Madhav in Madhya Pradesh became the 58th tiger reserve; Ratapani was the 57th.
27	D	28 Feb 2026. 17 Sep 2022 = the Namibian batch. Feb 2023 = South Africa. 20 Apr 2025 = Gandhi Sagar release.
28	D	The mismatched figure is snow leopards: their SPAI estimate was 718. The figure 3,682 belongs to tigers.
29	C	The 2025 hangul census reported 323 animals, associated with the Dachigam landscape.
30	C	The 2026 rules require four streams: wet, dry, sanitary and special-care waste.

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Q	Answer	Explanation
31	D	Lucknow topped the over-10-lakh population category in 2026, followed by Indore and Jabalpur.
32	B	176/177. Estonia 1st, Laos last.
33	B	Baku, Azerbaijan, with a focus on climate action. 2025 = Republic of Korea (plastics).
34	C	CCPI (Germanwatch and partners) always leaves ranks 1-3 vacant. Denmark was 4th. India fell from 10th to 23rd.

07 Defence and Security

Q	Answer	Explanation
1	C	Operation Sindoor followed the Pahalgam attack at Baisaran on 22 April 2025.
2	B	Operation Mahadev took place near Dachigam / Harwan on Srinagar's outskirts.
3	A	Mudh-Nyoma is in eastern Ladakh; it became operational in November 2025.
4	A	The correct sequence is Beacon-Srinagar, Himank-Leh, Vijayak-Kargil and Sampark-Jammu.
5	C	Chinar Corps is 15 Corps, headquartered in Srinagar; Fire & Fury is 14 Corps, Leh.
6	D	Zojila is an NHIDCL project under the Road Transport and Highways Ministry, not a BRO project.
7	A	Major Somnath Sharma received the first Param Vir Chakra for the Battle of Badgam in 1947.
8	D	General N.S. Raja Subramani is the third CDS, after Generals Bipin Rawat and Anil Chauhan.
9	A	Statements 1, 2 and 4 are correct. The Defence Minister, rather than the CDS, chairs the DAC.
10	B	General Dhiraj Seth became the 31st Chief of Army Staff on 30 June 2026.
11	A	Western Naval Command (Mumbai); he took over as CNS on 31 May 2026
12	C	DIHAR, the Defence Institute of High Altitude Research, is located in Leh.
13	B	Rudra brigades combine multiple arms, including infantry, armour, artillery, special forces and drones.
14	D	Up to 25% of an Agniveer batch may be retained as regular personnel after the four-year tenure.
15	C	₹7.85 lakh crore is the total MoD allocation; the capital outlay is about ₹2.19 lakh crore.
16	C	The increase is ₹14,802 crore. Dividing by ₹23,622 crore and multiplying by 100 gives approximately 62.7%.
17	B	Defence production in FY2025-26 was ₹1.78 lakh crore; production is distinct from exports and the Budget allocation.
18	B	The Defence Acquisition Council grants Acceptance of Necessity; it is chaired by the Defence Minister.
19	A	The Agni-Prime test used a rail-based mobile launcher, rather than a submarine or ship.
20	B	Mission Divyastra was the first Agni-V test with multiple independently-targetable re-entry vehicles.
21	C	IADWS combines QRSAM and VSHORADS with a laser-based directed-energy weapon.
22	C	Both: the 2025 mission and the IAF's S-400 nickname

Q	Answer	Explanation
23	B	INS Aridhaman is the third SSBN, following INS Arihant and INS Arighaat.
24	D	INS Tamal was built in Russia and commissioned in July 2025 as the Navy's last imported warship.
25	D	Project 17A produces Nilgiri-class stealth frigates. Project 15B concerns destroyers; Project 75 concerns conventional submarines.
26	A	Visakhapatnam hosted both events and is the headquarters of Eastern Naval Command.
27	C	Chandigarh, after 62 years in service (inducted 1963)
28	B	For INS Vikrant: 22 single-seat + 4 twin-seat
29	D	The 2026 edition was at Auli, Uttarakhand; the 2025 edition was in Alaska.
30	B	Royal Australian Air Force, at Darwin
31	A	Mitra Shakti-Sri Lanka, Maitree-Thailand, Dustlik-Uzbekistan and Surya Kiran-Nepal are the correct pairs.
32	D	Geospatial. LEMOA = logistics; COMCASA = communications; GSOMIA = information security
33	D	Under the 1963 China-Pakistan boundary agreement
34	D	Hot Springs, Ladakh, 21 Oct 1959
35	A	Gen Zorawar Singh, the Dogra general of Gulab Singh (Ladakh campaigns, 1834-40)

08 Awards and Honours

Q	Answer	Explanation
1	B	Dr Padma Gurmet is associated with Sowa-Rigpa, the Amchi or Tibetan system of medicine in Ladakh.
2	C	Prof Shafi Shauq received the Padma Shri in Literature & Education, reflecting his contribution to Kashmiri writing.
3	A	Social Work: reconnecting displaced Kashmiri Pandits (SRMA-Vivekananda Kendra, Nagdandi)
4	A	Ali Shaida won the Kashmiri award for the poetry collection Najdavanek'y Pot Aalav.
5	C	Khajur Singh Thakur's Dogri poetry collection Thakur Satsayie won the award.
6	B	The 92nd Amendment, 2003, added Dogri, Bodo, Maithili and Santhali to the Eighth Schedule.
7	D	Rahman Rahi received the Jnanpith for 2004 and is its only Kashmiri-language recipient.
8	D	Article 370 won Best Feature Film; Kalki 2898 AD won Best Popular Film.
9	C	Anant Nag received the Dadasaheb Phalke Award for 2024. The award year and presentation year differ.
10	A	Mammootty for Bramayugam and Kartik Aaryan for Chandu Champion shared Best Actor.
11	B	Maj Mukund Varadarajan, Ashoka Chakra (posthumous), killed in Shopian in 2014
12	B	The total was 131: five Padma Vibhushan, thirteen Padma Bhushan and 113 Padma Shri awards.

Q	Answer	Explanation
13	D	All four named individuals were Padma Vibhushan recipients in 2026.
14	C	Shaurya Chakra, for *Navika Sagar Parikrama II*
15	C	The 2024 batch had five recipients: Karpoori Thakur, L.K. Advani, P.V. Narasimha Rao, Chaudhary Charan Singh and M.S. Swaminathan.
16	A	Vairamuthu, the Tamil poet and lyricist, received the 60th Jnanpith for 2025, announced in 2026.
17	C	After Akilan (1975) and Jayakanthan (2002)
18	C	Bharatiya Jnanpith is a private trust; the Jnanpith is distinct from the government-supported Sahitya Akademi Award.
19	B	Heart Lamp was translated from Kannada by Deepa Bhasthi.
20	D	Taiwan Travelogue by Yáng Shuāng-zǐ, translated by Lin King, won the International Booker 2026.
21	A	David Szalay won the Booker Prize 2025 for Flesh, an original English-language novel.
22	B	Jayant Vishnu Narlikar received Vigyan Ratna 2025 posthumously.
23	B	No Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna was awarded in the final National Sports Awards 2025 list.
24	D	Football; part of the 1962 Asian Games gold-winning team
25	A	The Chemistry prize recognised the development of metal-organic frameworks.
26	C	Mokyr, Aghion and Howitt were recognised for work on innovation-driven economic growth and creative destruction.
27	C	María Corina Machado of Venezuela received the 2025 Peace Prize.
28	D	The Hungarian writer László Krasznahorkai received the 2025 Literature Prize.
29	D	Runa Khan is from Bangladesh and founded the NGO Friendship.
30	A	Tommy Koh is associated with the UNCLOS negotiations; UNCLOS is the UN Convention on the Law of the Sea.
31	C	Educate Girls, founded by Safeena Husain, became the first Indian organisation to receive the award in 2025.
32	A	Faltings. Kashiwara won in 2025 and Talagrand in 2024
33	B	Swadeshi Movement, launched 7 Aug 1905
34	D	Chile
35	D	BB84 quantum key distribution / quantum information
36	D	2010

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09 Sports and Games

Q	Answer	Explanation
1	C	Karnataka. The final was drawn; J&K won the title on a 291-run first-innings lead.
2	B	The final was at the **KSCA Stadium, Hubballi**, not Bengaluru.
3	A	The drawn final was decided by J&K's first-innings lead; it was not an outright victory or a super-over result.
4	A	Paras Dogra captained J&K to their maiden title.
5	C	Auqib Nabi was Player of the Series and took 60 wickets, the most in the season.
6	B	Gulmarg hosted the snow events; Leh hosted the ice events.
7	D	The Indian Army won its third successive overall title.
8	A	Sheetal Devi comes from Loidhar in Kishtwar district.
9	D	India defeated New Zealand by 96 runs in the Ahmedabad final.
10	B	India won in 2007, 2024 and 2026; the 2026 title was its third.
11	C	**Jasprit Bumrah** took 4 wickets in the final.
12	B	The final was held at DY Patil Stadium in Navi Mumbai, where India beat South Africa.
13	D	Royal Challengers Bengaluru retained the title by beating Gujarat Titans.
14	C	Australia won the women's T20 title; India's 2025 title was in the ODI format.
15	D	Spain won the 2026 title, defeating Argentina in the final.
16	B	The final venue was MetLife Stadium in New Jersey.
17	A	**Morocco, Spain and Portugal**, plus three centenary matches in Uruguay, Argentina and Paraguay. 2034 goes to Saudi Arabia.
18	B	Glasgow hosted the 2026 Commonwealth Games after Victoria withdrew as host.
19	A	India won 39 medals: 13 gold, 17 silver and 9 bronze.
20	A	**Tejaswin Shankar** won bronze.
21	D	Aichi-Nagoya in Japan hosted the 20th Asian Games.
22	A	**Doha (2030)**, then **Riyadh (2034)**.
23	C	Norway topped the Winter Olympics medal table; China topped the Winter Paralympics.
24	D	**China** topped the 2026 Winter Paralympics.
25	B	Uzbekistan won Open gold at Samarkand; India took Open silver.
26	C	Javokhir Sindarov of Uzbekistan won the 2026 Candidates Tournament.
27	D	R Vaishali won the Women's Candidates; Divya Deshmukh won the separate 2025 Women's World Cup.
28	B	Gukesh defeated Ding Liren in Singapore to become world champion in December 2024.

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Q	Answer	Explanation
29	C	Carlos Alcaraz won the Australian Open and completed a career Grand Slam.
30	B	**French Open 2026** (beat Flavio Cobolli). He then won the US Open too.
31	A	**Linda Nosková** beat Karolína Muchová (all-Czech final).
32	D	Germany won the men's title against Spain; Argentina won the women's title.
33	B	Khelo Bharat Niti replaced the National Sports Policy 2001; it is distinct from the Khelo India programme.
34	C	The **Ezra Cup** is a **polo** trophy.
35	D	FIDE is headquartered in Lausanne, not Moscow. The other listed pairs are correct.
36	D	All three are correct. The slimmed 10-sport programme dropped hockey, wrestling, badminton, cricket and others.
37	C	North America had hosted before: the **USA (1994)** and **Mexico (1970, 1986)**.

10 Reports and Indices

Q	Answer	Explanation
1	A	India ranked 130th of 193 countries in HDR 2025, with an HDI value of 0.685.
2	C	HDI measures income using GNI per capita at purchasing-power parity, rather than nominal GDP.
3	D	UN SDSN publishes the report with Gallup and the Oxford Wellbeing Research Centre.
4	C	India ranked 91st with a score of 39 in CPI 2025.
5	A	Transparency International publishes the index and is headquartered in Berlin.
6	D	India ranked 102nd among 123 countries in the 2025 edition.
7	B	Concern Worldwide and Welthungerhilfe publish the GHI; it is not an FAO-WFP index.
8	C	Adult obesity is not a GHI indicator. The four indicators are undernourishment, child stunting, child wasting and child mortality.
9	D	The World Economic Forum publishes the Global Gender Gap Report.
10	C	Reporters Without Borders, also known as RSF, publishes the index.
11	B	India ranked 77th; the figure 59 refers to accessible destinations, not its rank.
12	B	Both indices are products of the Institute for Economics & Peace, Sydney.
13	A	India ranked 38th of 139 countries in the 2025 Global Innovation Index.
14	D	India's SDG Index rank was 99th in the Sustainable Development Report 2025.
15	B	NITI Aayog publishes the domestic SDG India Index; SDSN publishes the global SDG Index.
16	A	The 2026 EPI placed India 176th of 177 countries.
17	D	Yale and Columbia universities publish the EPI; it is not a UNEP publication.

Q	Answer	Explanation
18	C	India ranked 23rd in CCPI 2026. The index leaves ranks 1-3 vacant.
19	A	Germanwatch publishes the Climate Risk Index and co-publishes CCPI with NewClimate Institute and CAN.
20	C	The Economic Division of the Department of Economic Affairs prepares the Survey under the Chief Economic Adviser.
21	B	The new CPI base is 2024 = 100, a calendar-year base.
22	D	The new GDP base is the financial year 2022-23, distinct from the CPI's 2024 base.
23	B	RBI publishes the Financial Stability Report half-yearly, in June and December.
24	C	Usage has the largest weight, 45%, compared with Access at 35% and Quality at 20%.
25	D	The FI-Index stood at 70.0 for March 2026, compared with 67.0 for March 2025.
26	A	B-READY replaced Doing Business, which the World Bank discontinued in 2021.

11 Appointments & Institutions

Q	Answer	Explanation
1	C	**V.K. Saxena**, holding additional charge of J&K, administered Bhati's oath. **Article 219** covers the High Court judge's oath.
2	B	**Arun Palli** was Chief Justice of the **High Court of J&K and Ladakh** before his elevation to the Supreme Court.
3	D	**Article 223** provides for appointment of an Acting Chief Justice of a High Court by the President.
4	A	**V.K. Saxena** is the **fourth LG of Ladakh**, after R.K. Mathur, B.D. Mishra and Kavinder Gupta.
5	B	**Ashish Kundra** became Chief Secretary of **Ladakh** on 1 January 2026. Atal Dulloo is the J&K Chief Secretary.
6	C	Statements **1 and 3** are correct: the State PSC age limit is **62**, and Article 316(1A) covers an acting Chairman. Under **Article 317**, removal for misbehaviour is by the **President after a Supreme Court inquiry**, not by the Governor.
7	D	**Vikas Kundal** heads **JKSSB**, the recruiting body for non-gazetted posts including FAA. Farooq Ahmad Lone is the interim JKPSC Chairman.
8	A	**Section 35B of the Banking Regulation Act, 1949** requires RBI approval for the chairman, MD or whole-time director of a private bank. J&K Bank is classified as a **private-sector bank**.
9	C	**Ranjana Prakash Desai** chairs the **8th Central Pay Commission**. **Arvind Panagariya** chairs the 16th Finance Commission.
10	A	**G.C. Murmu** was the **first LG of the UT of J&K** and later the **14th CAG**.
11	D	Venkataramani's further term is **two years**, from **1 October 2025 to 30 September 2027**.
12	C	The incorrect statement is that the Attorney General **can vote**. **Article 88** permits participation in Parliament, but gives no voting right.

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Q	Answer	Explanation
13	D	**Surya Kant**, the 53rd CJI, succeeded **B.R. Gavai**, the 52nd CJI.
14	D	The committee is the **PM, a Union Cabinet Minister nominated by the PM, and the Lok Sabha LoP**. The CJI is not a member under the **2023 Act**.
15	D	All three statements are correct. **Article 324(5)** protects the CEC's removal and requires the CEC's recommendation for removal of an EC; the **2023 Act** sets tenure at **six years or 65**.
16	B	**T.C.A. Kalyani** took charge as the **29th CGA**. **K. Sanjay Murthy** is the 15th CAG.
17	C	Under **Article 150**, the **President**, on the **CAG's advice**, prescribes the form of Union and State accounts.
18	B	The CGA works in the **Department of Expenditure, Ministry of Finance**. It compiles Union accounts; the CAG audits them.
19	C	**Rohit Jain** succeeded **T. Rabi Sankar** as RBI Deputy Governor.
20	D	**Section 8 of the RBI Act, 1934** permits a maximum of **four Deputy Governors**.
21	B	**Ashok Kumar Lahiri** became NITI Aayog Vice-Chairperson. The **Prime Minister** is Chairperson; **Anurag Jain** is CEO.
22	A	**CVC:** PM, Home Minister, Lok Sabha LoP. **CIC:** PM, Lok Sabha LoP, PM-nominated Cabinet Minister. **CBI Director:** PM, Lok Sabha LoP, CJI or nominated SC judge.
23	D	**Barham Salih** became head of **UNHCR**, the UN refugee agency. UNHCR is separate from the UN Human Rights Council and OHCHR.
24	A	**Dan Katz** replaced **Gita Gopinath** as IMF First Deputy Managing Director on 1 October 2025.

12 Books & Authors

Q	Answer	Explanation
1	D	The poems are by **Satish Vimal**. **Mushtaque B. Barq** translated and explained them in English.
2	A	The original author is **Abdul Ahad Azad**; **Umar Shah** translated the work into English.
3	C	**Rizwan Kadri** edited **Sardar Patel and Kashmir: The Untold History**. The LG released the book.
4	D	**Ali Shaida** received the Kashmiri award for **Najdavanek'y Pot Aalav**, a poetry collection.
5	C	**Khajur Singh Thakur** won for **Thakur Satsayie**, in **Dogri**.
6	A	The festival was held at **SKICC, Srinagar**.
7	C	The **National Book Trust** is under the **Ministry of Education**. It was established in 1957.
8	D	The tagline was **"Together We Read, Together We Lead."**
9	A	**When the Heart Speaks** is the autobiography of cardiologist **Upendra Kaul**.
10	A	Both books are by **Tushar Mehta**, the Solicitor General. He is the author; the people attending or releasing the books are not the authors.

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Q	Answer	Explanation
11	D	**Santanu Paul and B. Sambamurthy** wrote **Cashless Nation**. Nilekani and Viral Shah wrote **Rebooting India**.
12	B	**NPCI** operates UPI; **RBI** regulates the payment system. UPI was launched in **2016**.
13	A	The author is **G.P. Mistry**, a former RBI **Deputy General Manager**, not a Deputy Governor.
14	C	Statements **1 and 2** are correct: the Sahakar Nav-Kranti event included the UCB Security Operations Centre launch. Statement 3 is incorrect because **UCBs are subject to RBI banking regulation**.
15	C	Operational risk arises from **inadequate or failed processes, people, systems or external events**. Borrower non-payment is credit risk; interest-rate and exchange-rate movements are market risks.
16	D	**B.R. Ambedkar** wrote **The Problem of the Rupee**. **Dadabhai Naoroji** wrote Poverty and Un-British Rule in India.
17	A	**Overdraft = Urjit Patel**. The other pairs are mismatched: **Advice and Dissent = Y.V. Reddy; Fault Lines = Raghuram Rajan; Backstage = Montek Singh Ahluwalia**.
18	A	**Four Stars of Destiny** is the memoir of former Army Chief **M.M. Naravane**.
19	B	Both titles are associated with **K.J.S. "Tiny" Dhillon**, a former Chinar Corps commander.
20	C	The fair's theme was **"Indian Military History: Valour & Wisdom @ 75."**
21	B	**Qatar** was the Guest of Honour; **Spain** was the Focus Country. The two labels are distinct.
22	C	**Rabat, Morocco**, is the **2026 UNESCO World Book Capital**. Rio de Janeiro held the title in 2025.
23	B	**David Szalay's Flesh** won the **Booker Prize 2025**. Kiran Desai's title was shortlisted, not the winner.
24	D	The matching is **1-C, 2-A, 3-D, 4-B**: Kalhana, Walter Lawrence, Jagmohan and Sheikh Mohammad Abdullah respectively.

13 Important Days & Themes

Q	Answer	Explanation
1	D	**13 July** is absent from the official **2026 J&K holiday list**. **23 September, 26 October and Nauroz** are retained.
2	A	**Mela Khir Bhawani** is a **Kashmir provincial** holiday, not a UT-wide holiday.
3	B	**1st Battalion, Sikh Regiment (1 SIKH)** landed at Srinagar on **27 October 1947**; Infantry Day marks that landing.
4	C	The birthday holiday was introduced in **2022**.
5	B	Police Commemoration Day recalls the **1959 ambush at Hot Springs, Ladakh**.
6	C	**Kashmiri** was among the nine languages in which the Constitution was released on Constitution Day 2025.
7	C	**Sir Edward Drummond**, the first Auditor General, took charge on **16 November 1860**. Audit Diwas marks that date.

Q	Answer	Explanation
8	A	Statements **1 and 2** are correct. **ICAS**, created in 1976, is headed by the **CGA in the Ministry of Finance**, not by the CAG.
9	B	The theme was **"Unlocking the Potential of Administrative Data."** The quality-statistics-and-data theme belongs to **World Statistics Day 2025**.
10	B	World Statistics Day is held **every five years on 20 October**: 2010, 2015, 2020 and 2025.
11	C	The official 2026 event was the **167th Income Tax Day**. The 166 elapsed years since 1860 should not be confused with the event's edition number.
12	A	**James Wilson** introduced income tax in India in **1860**.
13	B	India observes World Savings Day on **30 October**; the international date is **31 October**.
14	C	NABARD was recommended by **CRAFICARD**, chaired by **B. Sivaraman**.
15	D	The 2026 theme was **"Cooperatives for a peaceful world."** "Cooperatives Build a Better World" belongs to the **2025 International Year of Cooperatives**.
16	A	The chief guests were **António Costa** of the European Council and **Ursula von der Leyen** of the European Commission.
17	B	The 2026 Republic Day theme was **"150 Years of Vande Mataram."**
18	B	The theme was **"My India, My Vote: Citizen at the Heart of Indian Democracy."**
19	D	All three statements are correct: Ayurveda Day moved to **23 September from 2025**, earlier fell on **Dhanteras**, and shares its date with **Hari Singh's birthday**.
20	D	The **2026** theme was **"Yoga for Healthy Ageing."** "Yoga for One Earth, One Health" was the 2025 theme.
21	D	**Azerbaijan** hosted World Environment Day 2026, with a focus on **climate action**.
22	B	The 2026 World Water Day theme was **"Water and Gender."**
23	C	The UN theme was **"Rights. Justice. Action. For ALL Women and Girls." "Give To Gain"** was a separate private campaign slogan.
24	D	**Cooperatives** was an International Year for **2025**. The listed 2026 years are Rangelands and Pastoralists, the Woman Farmer, and Volunteers for Sustainable Development.

14 People & Their Contributions

Q	Answer	Explanation
1	A	Col Sonam Wangchuk is associated with **Chorbat La**, in the Batalik sector, during the Kargil war. He received the **Maha Vir Chakra**.
2	B	Stobdan served as India's Ambassador to **Kyrgyzstan**, whose capital is **Bishkek**.
3	A	Razdan received the **Kirti Chakra**, the second-highest peacetime gallantry award.
4	A	Statements **1 and 2** are correct: Patil was Speaker during 1991-96 and later Governor of Punjab/Administrator of Chandigarh. Statement 3 is incorrect: he entered Parliament through the **Rajya Sabha** when he became Home Minister in 2004.

Q	Answer	Explanation
5	C	**Dhanendra Kumar** was CCI's first **full-time Chairperson**. **Vinod Dhall** had earlier held acting charge.
6	D	All three statements are correct: the **Competition Act, 2002** replaced the MRTP framework; appeals lie with **NCLAT**; and the **2023 amendment** introduced the **₹2,000-crore deal-value threshold**.
7	B	The Hinduja Group is associated with **IndusInd Bank**, a private-sector bank established in 1994.
8	C	Simone Tata helped build **Lakmé** and later led **Trent**, associated with Westside.
9	B	**Gadgil** chaired the **WGEEP**. **Kasturirangan** chaired the later **HLWG**.
10	A	The 2013 Physics Nobel was shared by **François Englert and Peter Higgs**.
11	C	The 1962 Medicine Nobel was shared by **Watson, Francis Crick and Maurice Wilkins** for work on DNA's molecular structure.
12	D	Sutar designed the **Statue of Unity**, representing Sardar Patel at **Ekta Nagar, Gujarat**.

15 Places, Terms & Static Connections

Q	Answer	Explanation
1	B	**Zehanpora** is in **Baramulla**; the site is associated with a Kushan-period Buddhist complex.
2	D	**Mudh-Nyoma** is in **eastern Ladakh**, not the Kashmir Valley.
3	C	**Tulbul Navigation Project** is at the outflow of **Wular Lake on the Jhelum**.
4	A	The commonly used IMD threshold is **at least 100 mm of rain in one hour over a small area**.
5	D	The Srinagar Tulip Garden lies at the foothills of the **Zabarwan range**.
6	B	**Shinku La** links **Lahaul in Himachal Pradesh** with **Zanskar in Ladakh**.
7	C	All three are correct: **Zoji La = Kashmir-Drass; Khardung La = Leh-Nubra; Chang La = Leh-Pangong**.
8	D	An **SRVA** is a foreign bank's **rupee account with an Indian authorised-dealer bank**, used for rupee trade settlement.
9	B	**SDF absorbs liquidity without collateral**. A conventional reverse-repo transaction uses securities.
10	B	**Primary deficit = fiscal deficit - interest payments**.
11	A	The **Consolidated Fund of India** is under **Article 266(1)**. Public Account is Article 266(2); Contingency Fund is Article 267.
12	C	CAG salary is **charged on the CFI and not voted**, although charged expenditure may be discussed. High Court judges' salaries are charged on the **State** fund; their pensions are charged on the **CFI**.
13	D	All three are correct: **PAC and COPU each have 22 members (15 LS + 7 RS)**; **Estimates has 30, all from Lok Sabha**.
14	C	**SEBI** regulates **AIFs, REITs and InvITs**.
15	B	The Small Finance Bank target is **60%**, from FY 2025-26, of **ANBC or credit-equivalent off-balance-sheet exposure, whichever is higher**.

Q	Answer	Explanation
16	A	The **Ken-Betwa link** is principally associated with **Madhya Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh**, in the Bundelkhand region.
17	D	The **Pamban bridge** is in **Tamil Nadu** and connects the mainland with **Rameswaram**.
18	D	**Mount Kilimanjaro** is in **Tanzania**.
19	C	**Dal Lake is not a Ramsar site**. Wular, Hokersar and Surinsar-Mansar are designated J&K Ramsar wetlands.
20	A	Concluded negotiations do not themselves bring a trade agreement into force. **Signature, domestic procedures and entry into force** are distinct later stages.
21	D	All three pairs are correct: **CBDC/e₹ = RBI; B-READY = World Bank; CBAM = European Union**.
22	A	The **GST Council** is established under **Article 279A**. **Article 280** concerns the Finance Commission.

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